

ARCHIVAL MASTER: RECONSTRUCTION AND COEFFICIENT-CHANGE HILBERT GEOMETRY

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ABSTRACT. This repository archive preserves every mathematical statement and proof from the complete preceding reconstruction and Hilbert-boundary manuscripts and includes the new conductor-duality and tangent-cover arguments. The two publication papers and the complete technical supplement provide separate reading routes. This master is not a third journal submission.

READING THE ARCHIVE

The earlier mathematical development is retained in full. The final sections present the independently readable conductor and nonmonomial coefficient-change route. Source-history front matters are archived separately. An external independent full audit of the inverse theorem and the complete Ballico 1993 comparison are not represented as completed.

1. FIRST RELATIONS, UNGRADED ISOMORPHISMS, AND INVERSE SYSTEMS

The passage from a finite local algebra to its first relation space is independent of pencils. We isolate it before undertaking the geometric inverse. In this section E denotes a space of degree-one *generators*; thus it is a cotangent space, rather than the dual normal space used later. Let $e = \dim E$, $d \geq 2$, and $K \subset \operatorname{Sym}^d E$. Set

$$A(K) = \operatorname{Sym} E / ((K) + \mathfrak{m}^{d+1}), \quad \mathfrak{m} = (E), \quad \mathfrak{n} = \mathfrak{m}A(K). \quad (1.1)$$

The grading in this presentation is not supplied to an isomorphism.

Proposition 1.1 (The first-relation orbit principle). *The abstract algebra $A(K)$ recovers E and K , up to linear isomorphism, by*

$$E = \mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2, \quad K = \ker[\operatorname{Sym}^d(\mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2) \longrightarrow \mathfrak{n}^d]. \quad (1.2)$$

Consequently $A(K) \simeq A(K')$ as ungraded complex algebras if and only if some $a : E \xrightarrow{\sim} E'$ satisfies $(\operatorname{Sym}^d a)K = K'$.

More precisely, after fixing the homogeneous inclusions of generators, all isomorphisms with tangent map a are exactly the substitutions

$$x \longmapsto a(x) + u(x), \quad u \in \operatorname{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(E, \mathfrak{n}^2).$$

These assertions about substitutions remain valid after scalar extension to any commutative complex algebra.

Proof. The positive ideal is the unique maximal ideal, and $\mathfrak{n}^{d+1} = 0$. Multiplication of d lifts of cotangent vectors is independent of their lifts: replacing any one by an element of $\mathfrak{n}^2$ changes the product in $\mathfrak{n}^{d+1}$. There are no relations of smaller degree, and the degree- d quotient is $\operatorname{Sym}^d E/K$. This proves (1.2). In particular every isomorphism induces the stated linear equivalence.

Conversely substitute $a(x) + u(x)$ for each generator. A relation of degree d changes, beyond its linear substitution, only in degrees at least $d + 1$. Those terms vanish. The relations of degree

$d + 1$ also vanish. The induced map on associated graded algebras is the isomorphism induced by a ; a finite filtration then makes the algebra map invertible. Every map with this tangent map has precisely such generator images. These polynomial identities hold over any commutative complex coefficient algebra. The intrinsic preservation of the augmentation under that scalar extension is verified in the next proof, so no preservation of a chosen origin has tacitly been added to the isomorphism problem. $\square$

Proposition 1.2 (The full automorphism group scheme). *Write $\ell = \dim_{\mathbb{C}} A(K) = \binom{e+d}{d} - \dim K$ and $H_K = \text{Stab}_{\text{GL}(E)}(K)$, with its closed subgroup scheme structure. The functor $D \mapsto \text{Aut}_D(A(K) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} D)$ is an affine group scheme of finite type and fits into a split exact sequence of affine group schemes over $\mathbb{C}$:*

$$1 \longrightarrow U_K \longrightarrow \text{Aut}(A(K)) \longrightarrow H_K \longrightarrow 1. \quad (1.3)$$

The kernel is unipotent. Choosing the homogeneous lifting of E identifies its underlying scheme, but not generally its group law, with the affine space associated to $\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(E, \mathfrak{n}^2)$. Its dimension is $e(\ell - 1 - e)$. Intrinsically, U_K acts simply transitively on the affine space of linear splittings of $\mathfrak{n} \twoheadrightarrow \mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2$. The splitting of (1.3) uses a choice of such a lifting; it is not an additional intrinsic grading.

Proof. Choose a basis of the finite-dimensional vector space $A = A(K)$. Inside $\text{GL}(A)$, the equations $f(1) = 1$ and $f(xy) = f(x)f(y)$, imposed on basis elements, are polynomial equations. They represent the automorphism functor, including its values on nonreduced complex algebras.

The augmentation can be recovered without mistaking the absolute nilradical after scalar extension for the augmentation ideal. If M_z denotes multiplication by z , the homogeneous filtration gives

$$\text{tr}(M_z) = \ell \epsilon(z). \quad (1.4)$$

Indeed multiplication by a positive-degree element is strictly triangular, whereas multiplication by a scalar has that scalar on every diagonal entry. Identity (1.4) holds over every commutative complex algebra D . Algebra automorphisms conjugate multiplication matrices, so they preserve $\epsilon = \ell^{-1} \text{tr}(M_{(-)})$, its kernel $\mathfrak{n}_D$, and all its powers. Thus the tangent map is a morphism of group schemes into H_K , not merely a map on complex points.

Linear substitutions give a morphism $H_K \rightarrow \text{Aut}(A)$ sectioning this tangent map. By Proposition 1.1, its kernel has, functorially in D , the unique parametrization $x \mapsto x + u(x)$ with $u : E_D \rightarrow \mathfrak{n}_D^2$. Reading generator images and making these substitutions are inverse polynomial maps. On a basis ordered by the positive filtration all kernel matrices are unitriangular, proving unipotence. Multiplication is substitution, which need not be addition of corrections. The dimension follows from $\dim \mathfrak{n}^2 = \ell - 1 - e$.

Finally two splittings of $\mathfrak{n} \twoheadrightarrow E$ differ by exactly a map $E \rightarrow \mathfrak{n}^2$. Any splitting generates A , and its degree- d products impose exactly K ; the preceding substitution argument therefore gives the unique element of U_K relating any two splittings. This is the asserted coordinate-free torsor description. $\square$

1.1. The inverse-system description and its precise role. Put $E^{\vee} = \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(E, \mathbb{C})$. Use the apolar pairing in which dual divided monomials satisfy $\langle x^{\alpha}, y^{\beta} / \beta! \rangle = \delta_{\alpha\beta}$. Here the pairing means evaluation at the origin after applying the constant-coefficient differential operator. For $I = (K) + \mathfrak{m}^{d+1}$, its Macaulay inverse system is

$$I^{\perp} = \bigoplus_{j < d} \text{Sym}^j E^{\vee} \oplus K^{\perp}, \quad K^{\perp} \subset \text{Sym}^d E^{\vee}. \quad (1.5)$$

To check this equality, the relations of degree $d + 1$ bound the degree of every inverse-system element by d . The degree- d relations pair only with its top component. All lower components are

unrestricted. Conversely that direct sum is stable under every partial derivative: differentiating its top part lands in the full lower-degree space. It is therefore annihilated by I , proving the displayed equality. Thus the orbit problem for K is equivalently the contragredient orbit problem for $K^\perp$. This uses the classical inverse-system correspondence; it does not assert a new canonical-grading theorem.

Elias and Rossi prove that Gorenstein local algebras with Hilbert function $(1, e, e, 1)$ are canonically graded [7, Theorem 3.3 and Corollaries 3.4–3.5]. Their proof removes a lower-degree term of the inverse-system generator by a nonlinear coordinate change. In their later work, compressed Gorenstein algebras of socle degree at most four are canonically graded, with counterexamples beyond the stated range [8, Theorem 3.1 and Examples 3.3–3.5]. In contrast, (1.1) is homogeneous by construction, and its truncation makes all higher substitutions invisible to its first relation. We do not deduce that an arbitrary filtered deformation with the same Hilbert function is graded.

For the pencil algebras, $e = n^2$, $d = n^2 + 2n - 4 \geq 11$, and $\dim K = \binom{N}{2}$. They are not Gorenstein: their socles contain $\mathfrak{n}^d$, whose dimension is $\binom{e+d-1}{d} - \binom{N}{2} > 1$. For example, the first binomial is at least $\binom{e+1}{2}$, while $e = n^2 > N$. The issue left by Proposition 1.1 is accordingly not the removal of a nonhomogeneous inverse-system term. It is the recovery of the matrix factors and defining coefficient data from the *unrestricted* $\mathrm{GL}(E)$ -orbit of K . The next sections establish that recovery and its global descent.

2. INTRINSIC TENSOR RULINGS

The first step of the inverse problem is to recognize the two tensor factors of a determinant cone without an ambient marking. The following scheme-theoretic ruling calculation and descent lemma supply precisely this step. They apply to the pencil argument independently of the web and exterior-contraction constructions in the separate research archive.

Lemma 2.1 (The relative scheme of maximal rank-one spaces). *Let B be any complex scheme and E, F vector bundles of rank $n \geq 2$. In $\mathrm{Gr}_B(n, E \otimes F)$, let $Z(E, F)$ be the zero scheme of the restriction of the quadratic rank-one equations to the universal subbundle $\mathcal{T}$. Equivalently it is the zero scheme of*

$$\mathrm{Sym}^2 \mathcal{T} \longrightarrow \bigwedge^2 E \otimes \bigwedge^2 F.$$

The natural morphism

$$\mathbb{P}_B(E) \sqcup \mathbb{P}_B(F) \longrightarrow Z(E, F), \quad \ell \mapsto \ell \otimes F, \quad m \mapsto E \otimes m, \quad (2.1)$$

is an isomorphism. It commutes with arbitrary change of complex base, including change to a nonreduced base.

Proof. We first work over $\mathbb{C}$. Each displayed map to the Grassmannian is a closed immersion. Its composition with the Pluecker embedding is the degree- n Veronese embedding on $\ell^{\otimes n} \otimes \det F$, respectively $\det E \otimes m^{\otimes n}$, followed by its natural linear inclusion into $\bigwedge^n(E \otimes F)$. This linear inclusion is injective: polarization of the nonzero pure-power map gives the corresponding irreducible symmetric-power summand. The rank-one equations vanish identically on both universal families, so the closed immersions factor through $Z(E, F)$.

Every geometric point is in one of the two images. Indeed the sum of two rank-one tensors is rank at most one only if their first factors or their second factors are proportional. Starting with two independent tensors, this observation forces a linear space consisting of rank-one tensors to fix the same factor throughout. A space of dimension n is then exactly one of the displayed spaces. The two images are disjoint: a space fixing both factors has dimension one, not n .

We verify that these pointwise statements omit no infinitesimal structure. At $\ell \otimes F$, choose a generator of ℓ and a complement in E . A Grassmannian tangent vector is a map $\phi : F \rightarrow (E/\ell) \otimes F$. For each coordinate of E/ℓ , write its component as $A : F \rightarrow F$. Linearizing the restricted minors gives

$$u \wedge A(u) = 0 \quad \text{for every } u \in F.$$

Polarizing this diagonal identity gives

$$u \wedge A(v) + v \wedge A(u) = 0 \quad (u, v \in F).$$

In characteristic zero the diagonal and polarized identities are equivalent. These are precisely all coefficients of the bilinear linearization of the restricted quadratic map on $\text{Sym}^2 F$, so no infinitesimal equation is omitted by testing the diagonal. Taking the basis vectors shows that A is diagonal; taking their pairwise sums makes all its diagonal entries equal. Conversely a scalar A satisfies all the linearized equations. Thus the Zariski tangent space to $Z(E, F)$ is precisely $\text{Hom}(\ell, E/\ell)$, of dimension $n - 1$. The other image has the symmetric calculation.

At every closed point the closed immersed projective space gives local dimension at least $n - 1$, whereas the tangent calculation gives embedding dimension exactly $n - 1$. The local ring is therefore regular. A finite-type complex scheme whose closed-point local rings are regular is reduced: a nonempty support of its nilradical would contain a closed point. In particular there is no nilpotent thickening or embedded associated structure at either image. The disjoint union of the two closed immersions is itself a closed immersion, surjective on geometric points. Its ideal in the now reduced target vanishes at every closed point, so it is zero. This proves the scheme isomorphism over $\mathbb{C}$.

For general B , trivialize E, F on a common open cover. The Grassmannian and the zero scheme of the displayed universal quadratic map are, on such an open, the base change of the constant construction just proved. Thus (2.1) is an isomorphism there even if the base has nilpotents. The maps are natural under changes of frame and hence glue. This argument is an identification by equations and base change, not an inference of relative flatness from a fibrewise tangent calculation. $\square$

Lemma 2.2 (Oriented relative Segre descent). *Let B be a connected projective complex variety with $H^0(B, \mathcal{O}_B) = \mathbb{C}$, and let V, V' have the same dimension $n \geq 2$. Let $\mathcal{U}, \mathcal{U}'$ be vector bundles of rank n on B . Suppose a linear bundle isomorphism*

$$\alpha : V \otimes \mathcal{U}^* \xrightarrow{\sim} V' \otimes \mathcal{U}'^*$$

preserves the rank-one cones and the ruling whose parameter bundle is $\mathbb{P}(V) \times B$. The induced isomorphism $\mathbb{P}(V) \times B \simeq \mathbb{P}(V') \times B$ is regular and is induced by one constant projective isomorphism $[g] : \mathbb{P}(V) \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(V')$. Locally $\alpha(T) = gTh^{-1}$, with the same $[g]$ on every chart. The possible line-bundle twists of vector-bundle lifts do not change the projective left coefficient lines of any homogeneous functorial coefficient construction.

Proof. Lemma 2.1, applied to $E = V \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$ and $F = \mathcal{U}^*$, identifies the closed relative Fano scheme with $(\mathbb{P}(V) \times B) \sqcup \mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^*)$. In particular its two components carry their displayed scheme structures, with no additional nilpotent or embedded components. The isomorphism α induces a regular map of these relative parameter schemes, and the orientation hypothesis preserves the first component.

For completeness, an isomorphism of two trivial $\mathbb{P}^{n-1}$ -bundles over any base gives a regular projective-matrix-valued map, not merely a fibrewise collection. Its pullback of the relative $\mathcal{O}(1)$ has the form $\mathcal{O}(1) \otimes p^*L$ for a line bundle L on the base. To see this, tensor by $\mathcal{O}(-1)$; the resulting line bundle is trivial on every projective-space fibre, and its pushforward and evaluation identify it with a pullback from the base. Pushing forward $\mathcal{O}(1)$ now gives an isomorphism of

the corresponding trivial rank- n bundles, with that line-bundle twist. On charts trivializing L , it is an invertible matrix g_i of regular functions. On overlaps, $g_j = u_{ij}g_i$ for an invertible regular function u_{ij} . The classes $[g_i]$ thus glue to a regular morphism to the projective-isomorphism scheme, identified after choosing fixed bases with PGL_n . This accounts explicitly for the possible absence of a global linear lift.

The group PGL_n is affine: it is the determinant-nonzero principal open in the projective space of matrices. A morphism from B to an affine scheme factors through $\mathrm{Spec} H^0(B, \mathcal{O}_B) = \mathrm{Spec} \mathbb{C}$, so the projective map is constant. Choose a constant linear lift g . Each local g_i then differs from g by a scalar unit. After removing its two projective-factor actions, a linear map preserving every decomposable line is scalar: apply it to sums of two tensors with one common factor. Consequently the remaining action is a right bundle map, and the scalar units may be absorbed in its local lifts h . This proves the local tensor formula.

Finally a scalar multiplying a lift acts on a homogeneous functor of degree a by its scalar to the power a (or $-a$ on its dual). It cannot alter a projective coefficient line. The conclusion applies to every homogeneous degree. In particular, no right change of frame can replace the single projective left map by separate transformations on different coefficient spaces. $\square$

3. ACTUAL FACTOR DESCENT AND MOVING COEFFICIENT SPACES

We now separate the linear-preserver input, the descent of vector bundles, and the recovery of coefficients. The resulting principle allows several varying coefficient spaces, of arbitrary prescribed ranks, rather than only the line associated with a pencil.

Lemma 3.1 (Linear preservers of the determinant cone). *Let U, V, U', V' be complex vector spaces of dimension $n \geq 2$. An invertible linear map $\Phi : \mathrm{Hom}(U, V) \rightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(U', V')$ carrying the determinant hypersurface onto the determinant hypersurface has one of the forms*

$$T \mapsto gTh^{-1}, \quad T \mapsto gT^{\mathrm{t}}h^{-1},$$

where the second formula is written after choosing identifications for transposition. The two cases respectively preserve and exchange the two rank-one rulings. In the first case the pair (g, h) is unique up to a common nonzero scalar.

Proof. At a matrix of rank r , an invertible r -minor reduces the local rank condition to the rank condition on a generic $(n - r)$ -square matrix. The singular locus of the rank-at-most s variety is therefore the rank-at-most $s - 1$ variety for $1 \leq s < n$: on the rank- s stratum the Schur-complement entries give independent equations, whereas on a lower stratum the linear terms of its defining $(s + 1)$ -minors vanish. Starting with the determinant cone and iterating reduced singular loci hence recovers the rank-one cone. For $n = 2$ that cone is already the determinant cone.

If $v \otimes u$ and $w \otimes z$ have rank one, their sum has rank at most one only if v, w or u, z are dependent. It follows that each maximal linear space of rank-one tensors has one factor fixed. The two families are $\mathbb{P}(V)$ and $\mathbb{P}(U^*)$. The induced Segre automorphism must preserve these families or exchange them. In the preserving case its restriction to a ruling gives projective linear maps on each factor. Remove linear lifts of both maps. The remaining linear transformation fixes each decomposable line. In tensor bases its eigenvalues at $v_i \otimes u_j$ agree along each row and each column by applying it to $(v_i + v_k) \otimes u_j$ and $v_i \otimes (u_j + u_l)$. They are all equal, so the remaining map is scalar. This proves the first form and its uniqueness. Composing with transposition reduces the exchanging case to the first.

This is the square invertible case of the classical rank-one preserver theorem of Marcus and Moyls [9, Theorem 1, pp. 1218–1219]; the argument above specifies the reduction from the determinant hypersurface that is needed here. $\square$

Lemma 3.2 (An actual tensor map removes the line twist). *Let B be a reduced complex variety, V a complex vector space with $\dim V \geq 2$, and $\mathcal{A}_1, \mathcal{A}_2$ vector bundles. Suppose an actual bundle isomorphism*

$$\Psi : V \otimes \mathcal{A}_1 \xrightarrow{\sim} V \otimes \mathcal{A}_2$$

preserves the rank-one cones and induces the identity on the $\mathbb{P}(V)$ -parameter space of rulings. There is a unique bundle isomorphism $a : \mathcal{A}_1 \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_2$ with $\Psi = 1_V \otimes a$.

Equivalently, the intrinsic operation of taking the commutant of the constant matrix algebra gives

$$\mathcal{H}om_{\text{End}(V) \otimes \mathcal{O}_B}(V \otimes \mathcal{A}_1, V \otimes \mathcal{A}_2) \simeq \mathcal{H}om_{\mathcal{O}_B}(\mathcal{A}_1, \mathcal{A}_2). \quad (3.1)$$

Thus after a constant left projective map has been lifted linearly, no residual line-bundle twist is left in the recovery of the right factor from Ψ .

Proof. For every constant line $\mathbb{C}v \subset V$, the corresponding ruling is fixed, so on every geometric fibre Ψ maps $v \otimes \mathcal{A}_1$ onto $v \otimes \mathcal{A}_2$. Choose a basis $v_1, \dots, v_n$ for the purpose of checking this assertion as an equality of bundle maps. The rulings for v_i force all off-diagonal blocks of Ψ to vanish. The rulings for $v_i + v_j$ force its diagonal blocks to agree. Since B is reduced, fibrewise zero morphisms of vector bundles are zero. Therefore Ψ commutes with every constant matrix unit, hence with $\text{End}(V) \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$.

For clarity, commutant recovery itself is canonical and does not use these chosen matrix units as extra data. Tensoring a bundle map a with 1_V gives the forward map in (3.1). Commutation with matrix units shows locally that it is bijective, with inverse reading any diagonal block. This proves that it is an isomorphism of sheaves, independent of the checking basis. Its inverse applied to the global section Ψ produces a global section a , not projective local sections requiring arbitrary scalar lifts. Applying the same operation to Ψ^{-1} proves that a is invertible. Uniqueness follows from injectivity of $a \mapsto 1_V \otimes a$.

Projective-factor data alone would permit replacing a bundle by a line twist. The additional datum used here is the actual linear map of the tensor bundles. It is this datum, recovered from the dual of the first nilradical quotient, that makes the commutant argument applicable. $\square$

3.1. A general finite-order coefficient inverse. Fix $n \geq 2$, $q \geq 1$, and integers $0 \leq r_\lambda \leq m_\lambda = \dim \mathbb{S}_\lambda \mathbb{C}^n$ for partitions λ of q of length at most n . Assume that for at least one partition

$$0 < r_\lambda < m_\lambda. \quad (3.2)$$

Let B be a smooth connected projective complex variety, V a constant n -dimensional space, and $\mathcal{U}$ a rank- n bundle. For each λ , choose a subbundle with locally free quotient

$$\mathcal{L}_\lambda \subset \mathbb{S}_\lambda V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_B, \quad \text{rank } \mathcal{L}_\lambda = r_\lambda.$$

Zero and full subbundles are permitted. In the matrix bundle $\mathcal{E} = \text{Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V \otimes \mathcal{O}_B)$, the multiplicity-one Cauchy decomposition supplies the subbundle

$$\mathcal{J}_q = \bigoplus_{\lambda} \mathcal{L}_\lambda \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda \mathcal{U} \subset \text{Sym}^q \mathcal{E}^*. \quad (3.3)$$

Let $\mathcal{D}_n \subset \text{Sym}^n \mathcal{E}^*$ be the determinant line, put $D = n + q$, and define

$$\mathcal{K} = \mathcal{D}_n \mathcal{J}_q, \quad \mathcal{A} = \text{Sym } \mathcal{E}^* / ((\mathcal{K}) + \mathfrak{a}^{D+1}), \quad Y = \text{Spec}_B \mathcal{A}, \quad (3.4)$$

where $\mathfrak{a}$ is the positive homogeneous ideal. The notation D in this subsection is an integer, not a failure locus. The scheme Y is finite over B , and need not be zero-dimensional over $\mathbb{C}$.

Theorem 3.3 (Unmarked descent for moving coefficient spaces). *For fixed $n, q, (r_\lambda)$ satisfying (3.2), the abstract complex scheme Y recovers its coefficient data as follows. Two such schemes Y_1, Y_2 are isomorphic if and only if there are an isomorphism $\sigma : B_1 \rightarrow B_2$, a constant linear*

isomorphism $g : V_1 \rightarrow V_2$, and an actual bundle isomorphism $h : \mathcal{U}_1 \rightarrow \sigma^* \mathcal{U}_2$ such that, for every λ ,

$$\mathcal{L}_{1,\lambda} = (\mathbb{S}_\lambda g)^* \sigma^* \mathcal{L}_{2,\lambda}. \quad (3.5)$$

Every unmarked isomorphism induces a normal-bundle map $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$; for that map the pair (g, h) is unique up to a common nonzero constant scalar. Conversely every such triple lifts homogeneously to an isomorphism. The scheme is finite locally free over its reduced base of rank

$$\binom{n^2 + D}{D} - \sum_{\lambda} r_{\lambda} m_{\lambda}.$$

No nontriviality hypothesis on $\mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^*)$ is required.

Proof. Recovering the intrinsic linear data. Multiplication by a determinant polynomial is an injective linear map of polynomial spaces. In local bundle frames its matrix is constant over $\mathbb{C}$ and its cokernel is free. The Cauchy summands and the $\mathcal{L}_{\lambda}$ are subbundles, so $\mathcal{K}$ is a subbundle of rank $\sum r_{\lambda} m_{\lambda}$. The graded pieces of $\mathcal{A}$ below D are the full symmetric powers; its top piece is $\text{Sym}^D \mathcal{E}^* / \mathcal{K}$. This proves local freeness and the rank formula.

The nilradical $\mathfrak{n}$ of $\mathcal{O}_Y$ is its positive ideal, since B is reduced. Thus $Y_{\text{red}} = B$ and $\mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2 = \mathcal{E}^*$ intrinsically. The multiplication kernel

$$\ker[\text{Sym}^D(\mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2) \rightarrow \mathfrak{n}^D]$$

is precisely $\mathcal{K}$, by the proof of Proposition 1.1 in local frames. An abstract isomorphism consequently gives the base isomorphism σ and an actual linear normal-bundle isomorphism carrying $\mathcal{K}_1$ to $\mathcal{K}_2$ contravariantly. The normal map is linear over the reduced base even when the original scheme map does not preserve the chosen graph projection. Indeed the action on $\mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2$ is linear over $\mathcal{O}_Y/\mathfrak{n}$.

Recovering and orienting the factors. Generate the homogeneous ideal $(\mathcal{K})$ in the recovered symmetric algebra; do not confuse its cone with the finite truncation. Its radical is the determinant ideal. To verify this, at an invertible matrix T , the map $\mathbb{S}_{\lambda} T$ is invertible. For a partition with $r_{\lambda} > 0$, a nonzero covector in $\mathcal{L}_{\lambda}$ has a nonzero matrix coefficient there. Thus the residual coefficients cannot all vanish off the determinant. All generators vanish on the determinant. The relative determinant hypersurface is reduced over the smooth base; the equality of radicals follows on affine charts from this equality of closed points. Successive reduced singular loci and Lemma 2.1 recover its two unordered tensor rulings with their relative scheme structures.

Cancellation of the determinant line is intrinsic and recovers the ideal generated by $\mathcal{J}_q$, and hence its degree- q piece. In a Cauchy summand the two contraction supports of $\mathcal{L}_{\lambda} \otimes \mathbb{S}_{\lambda} \mathcal{U}$ have ranks $(r_{\lambda}, m_{\lambda})$. Separate factor changes preserve these ranks. By Lemma 3.1, an exchange of the two matrix factors interchanges the ranks in each summand. At a partition satisfying (3.2), the result $(m_{\lambda}, r_{\lambda})$ cannot equal $(r_{\lambda}, m_{\lambda})$ for the other datum. Thus no fibre permits an exchange. Twisting local factor lifts by lines changes no support rank. The V -ruling is thereby oriented intrinsically, including when both projective ruling bundles are trivial.

Descending the actual map. By Lemma 2.2, the induced morphism $B_1 \rightarrow \text{Isom}(\mathbb{P}(V_1), \mathbb{P}(V_2))$ is constant: the target is affine and $H^0(B_1, \mathcal{O}_{B_1}) = \mathbb{C}$. Choose a constant linear lift g . Remove it from the actual normal map. Lemma 3.2, applied to $\mathcal{A}_1 = \mathcal{U}_1^*$ and $\mathcal{A}_2 = (\sigma^* \mathcal{U}_2)^*$, supplies the unique global right factor. Dualizing its inverse gives the actual isomorphism h . This step uses more than an isomorphism of projective bundles; it is exactly what excludes an undetected line twist. Replacing g by cg replaces h by ch . These are all ambiguities because the left lift is constant.

Recovering every coefficient subbundle. The oriented Cauchy decomposition is now functorial for the recovered left-right map. Project the residual degree- q module onto each summand and

contract against the full right dual factor. The image is precisely $\mathcal{L}_\lambda$, as a subbundle of the constant left module, not just a collection of fibrewise projective subspaces. The right map acts invertibly on the full Schur factor and hence does not change this image. Pullback by the normal map therefore gives (3.5) for the same constant g in all summands. Scalar choices in the determinant line do not change these subbundles. This proves necessity.

Conversely $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$ carries the determinant line, all coefficient subbundles, and every power of the positive ideal to the corresponding objects. It induces the required homogeneous scheme isomorphism. The stated uniqueness refers to the induced normal map; it does not eliminate the higher-order automorphisms of that scheme. $\square$

3.2. Identical fibres and graded bundles do not determine a family. The global conclusion has content even when neither fibre isomorphism classes nor the underlying graded vector bundles vary. The following example uses the general coefficient theorem, not a further spectral readout of a reconstructed pencil.

Example 3.4 (Two isotrivial thickenings separated by coefficient descent). Take $B = \mathbb{P}^1$, $V = \mathbb{C}^3$, $\mathcal{U} = \mathcal{O}_B^3$, $q = 1$, and $r_{(1)} = 1$. The two everywhere nonzero columns

$$(s^3, t^3, 0)^t, \quad (s^3 + st^2, t^3, 0)^t$$

define subbundles $\mathcal{L}_0, \mathcal{L}_1 \subset V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$, both isomorphic to $\mathcal{O}_B(-3)$. Let Y_0, Y_1 be their order-4 thickenings (3.4). They are finite flat of rank 712 over B and Zariski locally trivial with the same Artin algebra as fibre. Their nilradical graded vector bundles are isomorphic in every degree, although Y_0 and Y_1 are not isomorphic as abstract complex schemes.

Proof. Neither column vanishes, since its second entry is nonzero when $t \neq 0$, and its first is nonzero at $t = 0$. The left coefficient map to its image line $\mathbb{P}^1 \subset \mathbb{P}(V^*)$ is, in the coordinate $z = s/t$, respectively

$$f_0(z) = z^3, \quad f_1(z) = z^3 + z.$$

A local frame completing a generator of $\mathcal{L}_i$ to a basis of $V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}$ changes the coefficient line to a fixed line. This gives Zariski local product presentations of both thickenings. Alternatively, equality of the fibre isomorphism classes follows from transitivity of $\mathrm{GL}(V)$ on nonzero coefficient lines. The rank formula is $\binom{13}{4} - 3 = 712$.

Let $E = V^* \otimes \mathbb{C}^3$, of dimension nine. For $j < 4$, the degree- j nilradical quotient is $\mathrm{Sym}^j E \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$. Multiplication by the fixed determinant embeds E as a fixed nine-dimensional subspace of $\mathrm{Sym}^4 E$. Choosing a constant linear complement gives, for the top quotient,

$$\mathfrak{n}_i^4 \simeq \mathcal{O}_B^{486} \oplus ((V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_B)/\mathcal{L}_i)^{\oplus 3}.$$

Each column has only its first two entries nonzero, and these two entries have no common zero. The rank-one quotient of $\mathcal{O}_B^2$ by $\mathcal{O}_B(-3)$ is consequently $\mathcal{O}_B(3)$, by determinants. Thus the displayed top bundle is $\mathcal{O}_B^{489} \oplus \mathcal{O}_B(3)^{\oplus 3}$ for both i . The assertions about every graded vector bundle follow. They are not assertions that the graded *algebra* structures agree.

If an abstract isomorphism $Y_0 \simeq Y_1$ existed, Theorem 3.3 would identify their coefficient maps by one automorphism of B and one constant projective transformation of V^* . Both maps have as image the same projective line, so the latter transformation would restrict to a projective automorphism of that line. Hence f_0 and f_1 would be equivalent by independent projective changes in source and target. This is impossible. The map f_0 has two ramification points, each of index three. The map f_1 has the two simple zeros of $3z^2 + 1$, each of index two, and infinity, of index three. Ramification indices are invariant under those projective changes. Thus the unmarked algebra scheme distinguishes these two globally different coefficient maps even though its fibre algebras, conormal bundle, abstract first-relation bundle, and all graded vector bundles agree. $\square$

3.3. Pencils and the category of their automorphisms. For pencils, take $q = 2p$, $p = N - 2$, and $F(H) = \bigwedge^{N-2} \text{Sym}^2 H$. By Lemma 5.2 this is a single Schur module of dimension $M = \binom{N}{2}$, and Lemma F.1 identifies its coefficient subbundle with $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}} = \bigwedge^p (\text{Sym}^2 V/\mathcal{R})^*$. Its rank is one, so the strict-support hypothesis holds for every pencil. Exterior duality recovers the subbundle $\mathcal{R}$ from that line. Theorem 3.3 therefore proves the unrestricted moving-pencil inverse, including its actual source-bundle conclusion. This is a simultaneous reconstruction theorem for a map into a coefficient Grassmannian, not just a classification of its individual fibres.

Corollary 3.5 (Algebraic automorphism sequence for a pencil). *Let $\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]}$ be the unmarked local algebra of Theorem 7.3, and let $G_R = \{g \in \text{GL}(V) : (\text{Sym}^2 g)R = R\}$. There is a split exact sequence of complex affine algebraic groups*

$$1 \longrightarrow U_R \longrightarrow \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]}) \longrightarrow (G_R \times \text{GL}(U))/\mathbb{G}_m \longrightarrow 1, \quad (3.6)$$

where $\mathbb{G}_m$ is the diagonal scalar subgroup. Its intrinsic quotient is the closed stabilizer of K_R in the general linear group of the cotangent space. In that form the sequence represents automorphisms after extension to every commutative complex algebra. Its splitting is homogeneous after choosing generators, and U_R has the intrinsic description and dimension in Proposition 1.2.

Proof. Proposition 1.2 gives the represented sequence with quotient H_{K_R} . The coefficient inverse and Lemma 3.1 identify its complex points with the image of the left-right action; transposition is excluded by the support ranks $(1, M)$. Use the contragredient of the normal action to obtain a homomorphism on the cotangent space. Its kernel is exactly the diagonal scalar subgroup: a tensor product acting identically has both factors scalar, with reciprocal actions on the dual factors. The image is a closed algebraic subgroup and all the groups in question are smooth in characteristic zero [10, Lemma 39.8.2]. Thus the stabilizer and this image agree as closed subgroup schemes, not only on complex points. The induced quotient identification is an isomorphism of algebraic groups: after division by the kernel it is a bijective separable homomorphism between smooth groups. The splitting and kernel are those already constructed by substitutions. $\square$

For a positive-dimensional projective reduction, Theorem F.4 is used as an exact sequence of groups of complex scheme automorphisms, with its stated filtered kernel. We do not identify that sequence with a finite-type affine group scheme or a moduli-stack equivalence. Likewise, the marked construction over nonreduced parameter bases later in the paper retains its specified relative socle: it does not replace that ideal by the absolute nilradical. These distinctions preserve the full unmarked geometric assertion while specifying its category.

4. AN INTRINSIC COEFFICIENT PRINCIPLE

Extracting coefficient data from an abstract scheme and reconstructing a defining relation space from those data are distinct operations. The criterion below isolates the first. Its hypotheses will be verified directly for the multiplication schemes and then on curves.

4.1. The structural criterion. Let X be a finite-type complex scheme with a closed subvariety B specified by a construction preserved by every abstract scheme isomorphism. Write $\mathfrak{b} \subset \mathcal{O}_X$ for its ideal and

$$\mathcal{G} = \bigoplus_{r \geq 0} \mathfrak{b}^r / \mathfrak{b}^{r+1}, \quad \mathcal{A} = \text{Sym}_{\mathcal{O}_B}(\mathcal{G}_1), \quad \mathcal{I} = \ker(\mathcal{A} \twoheadrightarrow \mathcal{G}).$$

Assume the following conditions, for fixed integers $n \geq 2, m \geq 1$.

(i) B is connected and projective, $H^0(B, \mathcal{O}_B) = \mathbb{C}$, and $\mathcal{G}_1$ is locally free. Its dual admits a presentation $V \otimes \mathcal{U}^*$, where $\dim V = \text{rank } \mathcal{U} = n$.

(ii) The reduction of $\mathrm{Spec}_B \mathcal{G}$ in its degree-one ambient bundle is the generic determinant cone. The bundle $\mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^*)$ is not projectively trivial. Thus precisely one of the two ruling parameter bundles of its rank-one locus is projectively trivial.

(iii) If $\mathcal{D} \subset \mathcal{A}$ is the ideal of that reduced cone and $\mathcal{L} = \mathcal{D}_n$, then $\mathcal{I} = \mathcal{D}\mathcal{J}$, where $\mathcal{J}$ is generated in degree m . Under the Cauchy decomposition in any local frame of $\mathcal{U}$,

$$\mathcal{J}_m = \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \Lambda} L_\lambda \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda \mathcal{U} \subset \mathrm{Sym}^m(V^* \otimes \mathcal{U}), \quad L_\lambda \subset \mathbb{S}_\lambda V^*, \quad (4.1)$$

where Λ is a specified collection of partitions of m of length at most n , and the left subspaces are constant over B . Zero subspaces are permitted. The Cauchy inclusions, not just their representation labels, are the coefficient realizations $\beta \otimes \xi \mapsto [T \mapsto \beta(\mathbb{S}_\lambda(T)\xi)]$.

These conditions are hypotheses on the normal cone and its residual coefficient module. They do not assume that an abstract isomorphism extends to an ambient space, preserves a chosen frame, or already acts on all the left subspaces through a common projective transformation.

Theorem 4.1 (Intrinsic coefficient reconstruction). *Suppose X, B satisfy (i)–(iii). The abstract scheme X determines the collection $(L_\lambda)_{\lambda \in \Lambda}$ up to one common projective coordinate transformation on V . More precisely, an isomorphism between two such schemes induces a constant projective isomorphism $[g] : \mathbb{P}(V) \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(V')$ such that*

$$L_\lambda = \mathbb{S}_\lambda(g)^* L'_\lambda \quad (\lambda \in \Lambda).$$

The equality means equality of subspaces; scalar changes of a linear lift of $[g]$ do not affect it.

Proof. An isomorphism transports B , every power of $\mathfrak{b}$, $\mathcal{G}_1$, and the surjection $\mathcal{A} \twoheadrightarrow \mathcal{G}$. In particular it transports $\mathcal{I}$ in the intrinsic degree-one ambient bundle. Iterated reduced singular loci of the determinant cone give its rank-one locus. Lemma 2.1 reconstructs its two ruling parameter schemes, including their scheme structure. Condition (ii) distinguishes the trivial ruling intrinsically. Lemma 2.2 then gives one constant projective map $[g]$. After choosing a constant linear lift and local frames on both bases, the ambient bundle map has the form $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$. These local choices are made only after constructing the graded algebra, its degree-one part, and the ruling.

Locally $\mathcal{D} = (d)$ with $d = \det T$. Its leading coefficient is a unit, so it is a nonzerodivisor over every coefficient ring. Hence $(\mathcal{I} : \mathcal{D}) = \mathcal{J}$, and

$$\mathcal{J}_m \simeq \mathcal{L}^* \otimes \mathcal{I}_{n+m}.$$

This recovers the residual module without choosing a scalar determinant equation. Under $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$, the Cauchy coefficient map transports a tensor by $\mathbb{S}_\lambda(g)^* \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda(h^{-1})$. Projection to the specified Cauchy summand, followed by contraction against its whole right dual, therefore transports exactly L'_λ to L_λ . The right map is invertible and has no effect on that left image. Both determinant-line transition functions and changes of a lift of $[g]$ act by scalar units. Since every partition has size m , this ambiguity is common in degree and disappears on subspaces. This proves the assertion. $\square$

5. QUADRATIC RELATION SPACES AND INTRINSIC RECONSTRUCTION OF PENCILS

The multiplication construction itself supplies a wider natural class for the coefficient criterion. In this section the number of quadratic relations is allowed to vary independently of the embedding dimension. For two relations the resulting theorem recovers every pencil of quadrics, including singular pencils. No extra block is added to the multiplication map.

5.1. Automatic coefficient extraction for quadratic multiplication. Let $\dim V = n \geq 3$, $W = \text{Sym}^2 V$, $N = n(n+1)/2$, and $R \in \text{Gr}(r, W)$, where $1 \leq r < N - n$. Put $p = N - r > n$, $S = W/R$, and

$$A_R = \mathbb{C} \oplus V \oplus S, \quad X_R = \text{Gr}(n, V \oplus S).$$

The only nonzero product in the maximal ideal is the quotient map $\gamma : \text{Sym}^2 V \rightarrow S$. Write $\mathcal{K}$ for the tautological bundle on X_R , and use the same definition (C.1) of $\hat{D}_R$, with A_R in place of B_R . Thus $\hat{D}_R$ is the failure scheme of generating A_R by a varying n -plane and the unit. The notation in this section agrees with the web construction when $(n, r) = (4, 4)$.

Let $\Lambda_{n,p}$ denote the partitions occurring in the classical multiplicity-free decomposition

$$F(V) := \bigwedge^p \text{Sym}^2 V = \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \Lambda_{n,p}} \mathbb{S}_\lambda V. \quad (5.1)$$

Every partition has size $2p$; terms of length greater than n are omitted. Choose a nonzero volume form on S and let $\beta_R \in F(V)^*$ be its pullback by $\bigwedge^p \gamma$. Its component in $\mathbb{S}_\lambda V^*$ is denoted by $\beta_{R,\lambda}$. Only the lines of the nonzero components will be used, so the volume choice is immaterial.

Theorem 5.1 (Automatic intrinsic coefficient extraction). *For every $R \in \text{Gr}(r, \text{Sym}^2 V)$ in the stated range, the abstract scheme $\hat{D}_R$ determines*

$$(\mathbb{C}\beta_{R,\lambda})_{\lambda \in \Lambda_{n,p}}$$

up to one common projective transformation of V , with zero components recorded as zero subspaces. More precisely, the intrinsic construction recovers the base $B = \text{Gr}(n, S)$, its degree-one normal-cone bundle, and the residual ideal generated in degree $2p$ with coefficient module

$$\mathcal{I}_{2p} = \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \Lambda_{n,p}} \mathbb{C}\beta_{R,\lambda} \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda \mathcal{U} \subset \text{Sym}^{2p}(V^* \otimes \mathcal{U}), \quad (5.2)$$

where $\mathcal{U}$ is the tautological rank- n bundle on B . Consequently all geometric hypotheses of Theorem 4.1 hold for this entire Grassmannian family, not just for smooth webs.

Proof. On a frame chart of $\mathcal{K}$, write its inclusion as $\begin{pmatrix} M \\ A_0 \end{pmatrix}$, with M an $n \times n$ matrix. Since A_R is cube-zero, columns of degree greater than two vanish. After retaining the scalar, linear, and quadratic columns, multiplication has the matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & M & 0 \\ 0 & A_0 & \gamma \text{Sym}^2 M \end{pmatrix}. \quad (5.3)$$

A nonzero maximal minor must use the scalar column and all n linear columns: these are the only columns meeting the first $1+n$ rows. Expanding along those rows gives the identity of ideals

$$I_{\hat{D}_R} = (\det M) I_p(\gamma \text{Sym}^2 M). \quad (5.4)$$

The same expansion works for every $m \geq 2$. Where M is invertible, the quadratic map is surjective. Hence the reduction of $\hat{D}_R$ is exactly the Schubert divisor where M is singular, independent of R after identifying the vector spaces S .

Successive reduced singular loci of that divisor are the projection rank loci. Their last nonempty member is $B = \text{Gr}(n, S)$. For clarity, the usual determinantal assertion here is local: at a projection-rank- k point, an invertible k -minor splits away, leaving a generic square $(n-k)$ -matrix and smooth coordinates. Every remaining entry can vary independently by moving the kernel of the projection in V modulo its image. Thus its reduced singular locus is the next rank locus. Since $p > n$, the final base is nonempty, connected and projective, with $H^0(B, \mathcal{O}_B) = \mathbb{C}$.

Near B , a Grassmannian chart consists of a varying plane in S and its graph $T : \mathcal{U} \rightarrow V$. Formula (5.4) is independent of the other graph coordinates and homogeneous in T . It therefore gives its actual normal-cone ideal, not merely an initial reduced support:

$$C_B \hat{D}_R \subset \text{Tot Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V), \quad \mathcal{I} = (\det T) \mathcal{J}, \quad \mathcal{J} = I_p(\gamma \text{Sym}^2 T). \quad (5.5)$$

There are no degree-one equations. The ambient bundle in (5.5) is consequently the dual of the intrinsically recovered degree-one conormal. Its reduced ideal is the determinant ideal $\mathcal{D}$. The determinant polynomial is monic for a suitable monomial order, so cancellation gives $(\mathcal{I} : \mathcal{D}) = \mathcal{J}$. This is an intrinsic ideal quotient; choosing a generator of the determinant line is not part of the recovered datum.

The rank-one locus of the reduced cone determines the two ruling parameter schemes by Lemma 2.1. They are $\mathbb{P}(V) \times B$ and $\mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^*)$. Exactly the first is projectively trivial. Indeed a Schubert line in $\text{Gr}(n, S)$ restricts $\mathcal{U}^*$ to $\mathcal{O}(1) \oplus \mathcal{O}^{n-1}$. A trivial projective bundle on that line would make this bundle a line-bundle twist of $\mathcal{O}^n$; its determinant would then have degree divisible by n , rather than degree one. Thus the trivial ruling is intrinsically oriented. Lemma 2.2 applies: an abstract isomorphism gives a morphism $B \rightarrow \text{PGL}(V)$, constant because B is connected projective and $\text{PGL}(V)$ is affine. Local linear lifts and right changes of frame give $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$ for this one fixed $[g]$.

It remains to prove (5.2), rather than assume it as a condition on the example. The minors are the image, for fixed β_R , of the universal coefficient map

$$F(V)^* \otimes F(U) \longrightarrow \text{Sym}^{2p}(V^* \otimes U), \quad \beta \otimes \xi \longmapsto [T \mapsto \beta(F(T)\xi)]. \quad (5.6)$$

In characteristic zero, the polynomial functor F has the multiplicity-free decomposition (5.1); see [3, Theorem 3.5]. The Cauchy decomposition of the target contains each diagonal $\mathbb{S}_\lambda V^* \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda U$ once, and no off-diagonal pair. Equivariance kills every off-diagonal pair. On each diagonal pair the coefficient map is nonzero: identify U with V , evaluate at $T = 1$, and choose β, ξ in that summand with $\beta(\xi) \neq 0$. Schur's lemma then identifies its image with the specified Cauchy summand. This is the actual matrix-coefficient inclusion, not merely a dimension count. Keeping β_R fixed proves (5.2). All generators have degree $2p$, and at least one minor is nonzero since γ is surjective.

Under $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$, the right map acts within the full factor $\mathbb{S}_\lambda U$. Contracting against its dual therefore leaves exactly the left coefficient line transformed by $\mathbb{S}_\lambda(g)^*$. Determinant-line scalars and local lift ambiguities do not change these lines. This proves the theorem. $\square$

The theorem does not assert that separately projectivized Schur components always determine their relative scalars. For webs this is the recombination problem solved in the separate research archive. For pencils that issue disappears altogether.

5.2. Every pencil, without a regularity hypothesis.

Lemma 5.2 (The exterior square of the quadratic representation). *For $n \geq 2$, $\bigwedge^2 \text{Sym}^2 V = \mathbb{S}_{(3,1)} V$ is irreducible. Consequently $\bigwedge^{N-2} \text{Sym}^2 V$ is irreducible as well.*

Proof. The vector $x_1^2 \wedge x_1 x_2$ is a highest-weight vector of weight $(3, 1)$. By complete reducibility it generates a copy of $\mathbb{S}_{(3,1)} V$. The hook formula gives

$$\dim \mathbb{S}_{(3,1)} V = \frac{n(n-1)(n+1)(n+2)}{8} = \binom{N}{2}.$$

This exhausts the exterior square. The last assertion follows by exterior duality. These are classical representation identities. $\square$

Theorem 5.3 (Intrinsic reconstruction of all quadratic pencils). *Let $n \geq 3$ and let R, R' be two-dimensional subspaces of $\text{Sym}^2 V$. For the natural multiplication-failure schemes of their cube-zero algebras of Hilbert function $(1, n, N - 2)$,*

$$\widehat{D}_R \simeq \widehat{D}_{R'} \iff R' = gR \text{ for some } g \in \text{PGL}(V). \quad (5.7)$$

No pencil, base locus, or discriminant is required to be smooth or regular. The isomorphism on the left is abstract and carries no supplied ambient embedding, base, or tensor-factor marking. All the reduced schemes are isomorphic to the same Schubert divisor.

Proof. Here $p = N - 2 > n$. By Theorem 5.1 and Lemma 5.2, the normal cone has only one left coefficient line to recover: the entire line $\mathbb{C}\beta_R$. The canonical duality

$$\bigwedge^{N-2} W^* \simeq \bigwedge^2 W \otimes (\det W)^* = \bigwedge^2 W \otimes (\det V)^{-(n+1)} \quad (5.8)$$

sends that line to the Pluecker line of R , with the same projective transformation g . Indeed the pullback of a quotient volume is the annihilator-volume dual of the kernel R . The common determinant character is a scalar on projective space. A nonzero decomposable two-vector recovers its plane as $\{w \in W : w \wedge w_R = 0\}$. Thus an abstract scheme isomorphism implies $R' = gR$.

Conversely such a linear coordinate change induces the quotient isomorphism $S_R \rightarrow S_{R'}$, the algebra isomorphism $A_R \rightarrow A_{R'}$, and the corresponding Grassmannian isomorphism. It intertwines multiplication and hence preserves its zeroth Fitting ideal. This proves the reverse implication. The assertion about reductions was proved in (5.4). $\square$

5.3. Discriminants, elementary divisors, and hyperelliptic moduli. A regular pencil means one containing an invertible symmetric matrix; it need not have a reduced discriminant. The classical invariant of such a pencil consists of its discriminant points together with their Jordan-block partitions, usually called its Weierstrass–Segre data. We use the root-labelled partitions, not a pairing of an unlabelled list with an independently unlabelled divisor. Their classification is classical; compare [4, Theorem 1.1, Corollary 2.1 and §2]. The following consequence identifies precisely what the intrinsic failure scheme remembers beyond the discriminant.

Corollary 5.4 (Intrinsic recovery of elementary divisors). *For a regular pencil in any dimension $n \geq 3$, the abstract scheme $\widehat{D}_R$ determines all root-labelled elementary divisors of a matrix pencil, up to projective reparametrization of its parameter line. Conversely these data determine its abstract failure scheme. In particular the invariant distinguishes different Jordan partitions over a fixed multiple discriminant root.*

Proof. The first implication follows by reconstructing R , then choosing an invertible member A and a complementary member B . For completeness, the relevant classical sufficiency can be seen directly. Put $C = A^{-1}B$; it is self-adjoint for A . If $hC = C'h$ identifies the Jordan forms for another pair (A', B') , set

$$H = A^{-1}h^t A' h.$$

Then H is invertible, A -self-adjoint, and commutes with C . There is a polynomial k in H with $k^2 = H$: on each nonzero eigenvalue choose a square root and truncate its Taylor series to the size of the largest Jordan block, then combine by the Chinese remainder theorem. Thus k is invertible, self-adjoint, and commutes with C . The map hk^{-1} is an isometry from A to A' and intertwines C, C' , so it simultaneously identifies A, B with A', B' .

Changing the basis of the pencil replaces C by a fractional linear expression with invertible denominator. At each eigenvalue its derivative is nonzero; hence each Jordan-block size is preserved while its root moves by the same projective transformation. A parameter change can avoid infinity for both finite spectra. Root-labelled elementary divisors therefore suffice, and (5.7)

proves the converse for the failure schemes. This argument recalls the classical classification; the new input is recovery from an unmarked abstract failure scheme. $\square$

Example 5.5 (Identical discriminant, distinct intrinsic failure schemes). Choose distinct nonzero $\mu_3, \dots, \mu_n$, and put

$$S_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad J_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Consider the symmetric pairs

$$\begin{aligned} A_s &= I_n, & B_s &= \text{diag}(0, 0, \mu_3, \dots, \mu_n), \\ A_j &= S_2 \oplus I_{n-2}, & B_j &= S_2 J_2 \oplus \text{diag}(\mu_3, \dots, \mu_n). \end{aligned}$$

Their determinant binary forms agree up to a nonzero scalar:

$$\det(sA_s + tB_s) = -\det(sA_j + tB_j) = s^2 \prod_{i=3}^n (s + \mu_i t). \quad (5.9)$$

At the unique double root the ranks are respectively $n-2$ and $n-1$, so no simultaneous projective equivalence exists. The two root partitions are $(1, 1)$ and (2) . Their abstract failure schemes are therefore nonisomorphic although both their reduced failure schemes and their discriminant divisors, including multiplicities, agree. This realizes inside the same multiplication construction the classical loss of elementary-divisor information under passage to the determinant.

Corollary 5.6 (Hyperelliptic isomorphism classes). *Fix $g \geq 2$ and $n = 2g + 2$. On the locus of pencils with simple discriminant, $\hat{D}_R$ gives an injective invariant of the isomorphism classes of smooth hyperelliptic curves of genus g . All these failure schemes have the same reduction; their nonreduced structures distinguish a $(2g - 1)$ -dimensional family of curve classes. The pencil invariant also distinguishes the two regular boundary pencils in Example 5.5, where their singular discriminant double covers alone do not.*

Proof. The classical curve associated with a simple-discriminant pencil is the double cover of its parameter line branched at $\det(sA + tB) = 0$; see [6, §4.2, equation (4.3)]. Choose an invertible member. Distinct eigenvalues of $A^{-1}B$ have mutually A -orthogonal eigenlines, each nonisotropic, so simultaneous diagonalization identifies the pencil with $\langle \sum x_i^2, \sum \lambda_i x_i^2 \rangle$. The unordered branch divisor modulo PGL_2 therefore determines the pencil, and every reduced divisor of degree $2g + 2$ arises. A smooth curve of genus at least two has a unique degree-two map to a rational curve up to automorphism of that curve: two distinct such maps would give a birational map to a curve of bidegree $(2, 2)$ in $\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^1$, whose arithmetic genus is one. Thus curve isomorphism is exactly branch-divisor equivalence. Applying Theorem 5.3 gives the asserted injectivity and well-definedness.

Ordered distinct branch points have dimension $2g + 2$. Normalizing three of them removes the three-dimensional projective action; taking the finite permutation quotient leaves dimension $2g - 1$. Equality of all reductions follows from (5.4). Finally the two binary forms in (5.9) differ only by a scalar, a square over $\mathbb{C}$, and define isomorphic double covers, whereas their failure schemes have already been separated. $\square$

These are statements about complex isomorphism classes. They do not identify moduli stacks, assert a universal family over a coarse moduli space, or eliminate the different automorphism groups of pencils and curves. Nor is the classical pencil-hyperelliptic correspondence a new Torelli theorem. The conclusion here is reconstruction of those objects and of the elementary-divisor information on their boundary from the abstract nonreduced multiplication-failure scheme, while all reduced failure data are fixed.

6. THE EXACT INFINITESIMAL ORDER OF PENCIL RECONSTRUCTION

The all-pencil theorem admits a finite-order strengthening. It identifies the first infinitesimal neighbourhood that retains the pencil, and shows that every preceding neighbourhood is independent of it. We use ideal-adic neighbourhoods of the deepest stratum; these are not arc spaces or jet schemes.

Throughout this section let $n \geq 3$, $W = \text{Sym}^2 V$, and

$$N = \binom{n+1}{2}, \quad p = N - 2, \quad d = n + 2p = n^2 + 2n - 4. \quad (6.1)$$

For a pencil $R \subset W$, put $S_R = W/R$ and $B = \text{Gr}(n, S_R) \subset \widehat{D}_R$. This notation for the socle Grassmannian is local to this section; the cube-zero algebra is denoted by A_R , as in Section 5. Write $\mathfrak{b} \subset \mathcal{O}_{\widehat{D}_R}$ for the ideal of B , and define

$$Z_R^{[k]} = (B, \mathcal{O}_{\widehat{D}_R}/\mathfrak{b}^{k+1}) \quad (k \geq 0). \quad (6.2)$$

Thus $Z_R^{[0]} = B$. No embedding or identification of its reduction is supplied with the abstract scheme $Z_R^{[k]}$.

Theorem 6.1 (Sharp finite-neighbourhood reconstruction). *For any two pencils $R, R' \subset \text{Sym}^2 V$, the following conditions are equivalent:*

$$\begin{aligned} Z_R^{[d]} \simeq Z_{R'}^{[d]} &\iff \widehat{D}_R \simeq \widehat{D}_{R'} \\ &\iff R' = gR \text{ for some } g \in \text{PGL}(V). \end{aligned} \quad (6.3)$$

In contrast, for every $0 \leq k < d$, all the schemes $Z_R^{[k]}$ are isomorphic. Consequently d is the smallest uniform order at which these neighbourhoods classify all pencils up to projective equivalence. Singular pencils are included.

6.1. The first relation in the conormal algebra. Let $\mathcal{U}$ be tautological on B . The open set of X_R where projection to S_R is injective is canonically $\text{Tot } E$, where $E = \text{Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V)$: a plane is the graph of a unique map from its image in S_R to V . In particular this is one open neighbourhood of all of B , not merely a collection of unrelated formal charts. Let $\mathfrak{a}$ be its zero-section ideal. The exact multiplication calculation (5.4) gives

$$\mathcal{I}_R = (\det T) I_p(\gamma_R \text{Sym}^2 T) \subset \text{Sym } E^*. \quad (6.4)$$

It is generated in degree d , with a nonzero degree- d piece K_R . Indeed each quadratic minor has degree $2p$, and an invertible T makes $\gamma_R \text{Sym}^2 T$ surjective. There are no terms of lower degree, even on special pencils. Homogeneity is an equality of ideals in the actual graph neighbourhood, not just an equality of initial supports.

Lemma 6.2 (Intrinsic recovery from the first relation). *The abstract scheme $Z_R^{[d]}$ determines, as a graded $\mathcal{O}_B$ -algebra, the complete normal-cone algebra $\text{gr}_{\mathfrak{b}} \mathcal{O}_{\widehat{D}_R}$.*

Proof. The reduction of $Z_R^{[d]}$ is B , since its zero-section ideal is nilpotent and B is reduced. Hence its nilradical $\mathfrak{n}$ is intrinsic. Put $L = \mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2$. Formula (6.4) and $d > 1$ identify $L = E^*$. Multiplication in the given finite scheme recovers

$$K_R = \ker[\text{Sym}^d L \longrightarrow \mathfrak{n}^d/\mathfrak{n}^{d+1}]. \quad (6.5)$$

The last denominator is zero, but retaining it displays the grading. No splitting of the reduction map is needed to form this kernel. Because $\mathcal{I}_R$ is generated in this single degree,

$$\text{gr}_{\mathfrak{b}} \mathcal{O}_{\widehat{D}_R} = \text{Sym}_{\mathcal{O}_B} L/(K_R). \quad (6.6)$$

Here (K_R) denotes the homogeneous ideal generated by K_R , not its radical. The right side is intrinsic to the finite scheme, proving the assertion. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 6.1. For $k < d$, equations (6.4) and (6.2) give

$$\mathcal{O}_{Z_R^{[k]}} = \text{Sym } E^* / \mathfrak{a}^{k+1}.$$

A linear identification $S_R \simeq S_{R'}$ identifies B , its tautological bundle, and E . It therefore identifies every one of these lower-order neighbourhoods.

An abstract isomorphism at order d induces an isomorphism of reductions, of conormal bundles, and, by Lemma 6.2, of complete graded normal cones. We spell out why the reconstruction in Theorem 5.1 requires no information outside this cone. Its reduced support is the square-matrix determinant cone; its iterated singular loci give the rank-one cone. The relative scheme of maximal linear spaces in that cone has the two rulings $\mathbb{P}(V) \times B$ and $\mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^*)$. Exactly the first is projectively trivial, as is seen by restriction to a Schubert line. Thus it is intrinsically oriented. The induced projective transformation of the trivial factor is constant on the connected projective base. Local lifts have the form $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$ for this one $[g]$. The determinant ideal line is intrinsic, so its ideal quotient in (6.4) recovers the residual ideal. Finally Lemma 5.2 identifies the entire left coefficient line $\mathbb{C}\beta_R$, and exterior duality (5.8) recovers the Pluecker line of R . These are operations on the recovered normal cone; we do not assume that its isomorphism extends to X_R or $\widehat{D}_R$. They imply $R' = gR$.

Conversely such a projective transformation induces the algebra and failure-scheme isomorphisms, carrying the socle Grassmannian to the socle Grassmannian and preserving all its ideal powers. This proves (6.3), also using Theorem 5.3. For sharpness, there are inequivalent pencils in every dimension under consideration: $\langle x_1^2, x_1x_2 \rangle$ has a common linear factor, whereas $\langle x_1^2, x_2^2 \rangle$ does not. Their neighbourhoods are nevertheless isomorphic at every order below d . Thus no smaller order classifies all pencils. $\square$

6.2. A closed immersion of the full parameter scheme. The finite-order result has a scheme-theoretic parameter version, which records infinitesimal variation as well as closed points. Here tensor coordinates are fixed. This additional qualification is important: we are not asserting an equivalence of unmarked moduli stacks.

Fix an auxiliary n -dimensional vector space U , and put

$$F(V) = \bigwedge^p \text{Sym}^2 V, \quad F(U) = \bigwedge^p \text{Sym}^2 U, \quad M = \dim F(U) = \binom{N}{2}, \quad H = \text{Hom}(U, V).$$

Choose a nonzero scalar representative δ of the determinant polynomial on H ; its scalar has no effect on the subspaces below. Let $K_R \subset \text{Sym}^d H^*$ be the degree- d space of $(\det T)I_p(\gamma_R \text{Sym}^2 T)$ in these fixed coordinates.

Theorem 6.3 (Faithful finite-order parameterization). *The assignment*

$$\Phi : \text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V) \longrightarrow \text{Gr}(M, \text{Sym}^d H^*), \quad R \longmapsto K_R, \quad (6.7)$$

is a closed immersion. It is defined on the whole Grassmannian, including singular pencils. Its construction and its inverse on the image commute with arbitrary base change over $\mathbb{C}$. In particular it separates families over nonreduced bases and has injective differential at every pencil.

Lemma 6.4 (Tensoring a line with a fixed space). *For finite-dimensional vector spaces A, B_0 , with $b = \dim B_0 > 0$, the map $\mathbb{P}(A) \rightarrow \text{Gr}(b, A \otimes B_0)$, $\ell \mapsto \ell \otimes B_0$, is a closed immersion.*

Proof. Choose bases $a_0, \dots, a_t$ and a basis of B_0 . Above the projective chart $\ell = \mathbb{C}(a_0 + \sum x_i a_i)$, the subspace is the graph of the block matrices $x_i I_b$. The corresponding Grassmannian chart has arbitrary $b \times b$ blocks. The image is cut out by their off-diagonal entries and the differences

between their diagonal entries; an inverse reads one diagonal entry in each block. These are scheme-theoretic equations over any $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra, not just pointwise conditions. The preimage of this Grassmannian chart is exactly the stated projective chart, since the projection has determinant a_0^b . Such charts cover the image. The map is proper because its source is projective, so these chartwise closed immersions give a global closed immersion. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 6.3. The coefficient map (5.6) becomes

$$\mu : F(V)^* \otimes F(U) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Sym}^{2p} H^*.$$

It is injective: by Lemma 5.2 its source is irreducible for $\mathrm{GL}(V) \times \mathrm{GL}(U)$, and evaluation at an isomorphism $U \simeq V$ shows that the equivariant map is nonzero. Multiplication by the nonzero polynomial δ is injective. Thus $\nu = \delta\mu$ is a fixed linear inclusion and

$$K_R = \nu(\mathbb{C}\beta_R \otimes F(U)). \quad (6.8)$$

In particular $\dim K_R = M$, also on every singular pencil. By exterior duality the quotient-volume map $R \mapsto \mathbb{C}\beta_R$ is the Pluecker closed immersion $\mathrm{Gr}(2, W) \hookrightarrow \mathbb{P}(F(V)^*)$. Factor Φ through this map, the closed immersion of Lemma 6.4, and the Grassmannian closed immersion induced by ν . This proves the theorem. All are morphisms of schemes defined by the displayed polynomial and linear equations. A closed immersion is a monomorphism and remains one after arbitrary base change. This proves the family assertion, not merely separation of complex-valued points. $\square$

Corollary 6.5 (A flat family of finite normal algebras). *Over $\mathrm{Gr}(2, W)$, the algebras*

$$Q_R = \mathrm{Sym} H^* / ((K_R) + \mathfrak{m}^{d+1}), \quad \mathfrak{m} = \bigoplus_{j>0} \mathrm{Sym}^j H^*, \quad (6.9)$$

form a finite locally free family of rank

$$\binom{n^2 + d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}.$$

In fixed coordinates this family determines every base-changed family of pencils. All its truncations below degree d are constant families.

Proof. Theorem 6.3 makes the spaces K_R a rank- M subbundle of the constant degree- d bundle, with locally free quotient. In degree $j < d$ the algebra is $\mathrm{Sym}^j H^*$, and its degree- d piece is $\mathrm{Sym}^d H^* / K_R$; higher degrees vanish. This proves local freeness and base-change compatibility. Summing the ranks gives the displayed binomial identity. The kernel of the coordinate quotient in degree d recovers K_R , and Φ recovers the pencil family. This is a statement about coordinate quotient algebras; it does not discard their coordinate maps and then infer a family reconstruction theorem. $\square$

6.3. Classical moduli at a sharp order.

Corollary 6.6 (Hyperelliptic classes in finite neighbourhoods). *Let $g \geq 2$, $n = 2g + 2$, and $d = 4g^2 + 12g + 4$. For pencils with simple discriminant, $Z_R^{[d]}$ and $Z_{R'}^{[d]}$ are isomorphic if and only if their associated hyperelliptic curves are isomorphic. Every lower-order neighbourhood is independent of the curve. Thus the same $(2g - 1)$ -dimensional family of curve classes is invisible to all these lower-order neighbourhoods and is separated at order d .*

Proof. Combine Theorem 6.1 with Corollary 5.6, and substitute $n = 2g + 2$ in (6.1). $\square$

The order here concerns a neighbourhood of the entire projective socle Grassmannian. Its global ruling distinguishes the constant V -factor from the tautological factor. A single unmarked Artinian normal slice does not supply this orientation; the coordinate statement of Corollary 6.5 is

deliberately different. The result is therefore not a claim that one unmarked local algebra replaces the projective family. The matrix-pencil classification and the hyperelliptic correspondence remain classical. The assertion proved here is that this classical information first appears at the specified order in the intrinsic multiplication-failure neighbourhoods.

7. COEFFICIENT-SUPPORT ORIENTATION AND A LOCAL ALGEBRAIC INVERSE

For pencils there is a second, entirely local way to distinguish the two tensor rulings. It uses the asymmetry of the residual coefficient module rather than the topology of a projective bundle. Consequently the nontrivial-projectivization hypothesis in the preceding family theorem can be removed, and a single unmarked Artin local algebra already recovers the pencil.

7.1. The coefficient module orients its own tensor factors. If $K \subset A \otimes B$ is a linear subspace, define its two factor supports by

$$s_A(K) = \text{im}(K \otimes B^* \longrightarrow A), \quad s_B(K) = \text{im}(K \otimes A^* \longrightarrow B).$$

The maps here are contractions. Their ranks are invariant under separate changes of basis and are exchanged by interchanging the factors. In particular, if $K = L \otimes B$, then $s_A(K) = L$ and $s_B(K) = B$. The support ranks are therefore $(\dim L, \dim B)$, not the common dimension $\dim K$.

Lemma 7.1 (Asymmetric coefficient support). *Suppose a homogeneous ideal in the matrix space $\text{Hom}(U, V)$, with $\dim U = \dim V = n \geq 3$, has reduced support the determinant cone. Suppose its intrinsic residual ideal after determinant cancellation has, in one multiplicity-one Cauchy summand of degree q , the coefficient subspace*

$$L \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda U \subset \mathbb{S}_\lambda V^* \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda U, \quad 0 < \dim L < \dim \mathbb{S}_\lambda U.$$

A linear isomorphism carrying this ideal to another ideal with a coefficient subspace of the same displayed type cannot interchange the two matrix rulings. The conclusion is unchanged by line twists of the locally chosen tensor factors. It also applies fibrewise to subbundles of this type over a reduced base.

Proof. A linear isomorphism of determinant cones preserves their successive rank loci and therefore the rank-one cone. Its action on the two ruling components either preserves them or interchanges them. To make the familiar two alternatives explicit, identify the rank-one projectivization with $\mathbb{P}(V) \times \mathbb{P}(U^*)$. An automorphism preserving its two families of maximal linear spaces acts separately on the two projective factors. Each factor map is projective linear, by restricting the ambient linear map to a ruling. Removing their linear lifts leaves a map fixing every decomposable line; sums of tensors with one factor in common show that this remaining map is scalar. The preserving alternative is thus a left-right matrix map. In the interchanging alternative, compose with transposition to obtain the preserving alternative.

The determinant ideal is carried to the determinant ideal, so its ideal quotient is carried to the residual ideal. The Cauchy decomposition is functorial for separate changes of matrix factors; transposition exchanges the factors in its λ -summand. Put $m = \dim \mathbb{S}_\lambda U$, and $r = \dim L < m$. The displayed subspace has support ranks (r, m) . Separate factor maps preserve these ranks, while transposition changes them to (m, r) . An ideal of the prescribed type on the other side has support ranks (r', m) with $r' < m$. It cannot be the transposed image. This excludes interchanging the rulings.

Tensoring a factor by a line changes its Schur module by a line power, not its contraction rank. The argument therefore does not require a specified linear lift of either projective factor. For bundle maps it applies to each geometric fibre; an interchange on any fibre would contradict the same strict rank inequality there. $\square$

For pencils, take $F(H) = \bigwedge^{N-2} \text{Sym}^2 H$. Lemma 5.2 makes this a single irreducible Schur module, of dimension $M = \binom{N}{2} > 1$. The residual module is precisely $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}} \otimes F(\mathcal{U})$, by Lemma F.1. Its support ranks are $(1, M)$. The relevant strict inequality holds for every pencil, including singular pencils; it is not a generic-rank condition.

Theorem 7.2 (Removal of the projective-bundle restriction). *In Theorem F.2, the hypothesis that $\mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^*)$ is nontrivial can be omitted. The coefficient-subbundle reconstruction, the smallest uniform order, and the automorphism exact sequence remain valid for every rank- n source bundle on a smooth connected projective complex base. In particular the base is allowed to be a point.*

Proof. The first-relation construction, the recovered homogeneous cone, and cancellation of the determinant use neither projective nontriviality nor positive dimension of the base. They recover both the unordered rulings and the residual coefficient module before a ruling is chosen. At this stage apply Lemma 7.1 with support ranks $(1, M)$. It excludes the transposed alternative and hence orients the left ruling even when both ruling bundles are trivial. This replaces exactly the nontrivial-projectivization step in the proof of Theorem F.2.

The left ruling is the trivial bundle $\mathbb{P}(V) \times B$. Projectivity and connectedness still make its projective-matrix map constant. Choose its constant linear lift; uniqueness of the right bundle map on overlaps gives the same actual isomorphism h , and coefficient contraction recovers the entire pencil subbundle. The converse uses the same homogeneous map. The lower-order algebras and the two inequivalent constant pencils in Corollary F.3 are unchanged. Finally, the proof of Theorem F.4 uses only the resulting classification of graded data, not the earlier way of orienting the rulings, so it too applies without the restriction. $\square$

7.2. Every pencil from one Artin local algebra. Choose n -dimensional vector spaces U, V . Let $T = (t_{ij})$ be the universal matrix, and put $\mathfrak{m} = (t_{ij})$. For a pencil $R \subset \text{Sym}^2 V$, let γ_R be its quotient map and set

$$\mathfrak{A}_R^{[k]} = \mathbb{C}[t_{ij}] / ((\det T)I_p(\gamma_R \text{Sym}^2 T) + \mathfrak{m}^{k+1}). \quad (7.1)$$

An isomorphism below means an isomorphism of complex algebras, without a grading, tangent coordinates, matrix decomposition or chosen generators.

Theorem 7.3 (Unmarked local reconstruction). *For every $n \geq 3$ and every pair of quadratic pencils,*

$$\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]} \simeq \mathfrak{A}_{R'}^{[d]} \iff R' = (\text{Sym}^2 g)R \text{ for some } g \in \text{GL}(V). \quad (7.2)$$

The algebra has embedding dimension n^2 and length $\binom{n^2+d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}$. Every lower-order algebra $\mathfrak{A}_R^{[k]}$, $k < d$, is independent of R . Thus $d = n^2 + 2n - 4$ is the smallest uniform reconstruction order already among these single-point objects.

Proof. Theorem 7.2 applies with $B = \text{Spec } \mathbb{C}$ and the bundle U . To spell out what its intrinsic construction uses in this case, the unique maximal ideal $\mathfrak{n}$ of the finite algebra determines its tangent space and the multiplication kernel

$$K_R = \ker \left[\text{Sym}^d(\mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2) \longrightarrow \mathfrak{n}^d \right].$$

This is precisely the degree- d ideal in the chosen presentation; nonlinear changes of generators contribute only terms above degree d to a degree- d relation. Hence an ungraded algebra isomorphism identifies the homogeneous cones generated by these kernels. Their determinant reductions recover the unordered matrix factors. The residual support ranks $(1, M)$ rule out transposition, and the remaining left-right map carries the left coefficient line to the left coefficient line. Exterior duality then gives $R' = (\text{Sym}^2 g)R$. Conversely such a map, together with any chosen right identification, induces the algebra isomorphism. There are no relations below degree d , so the

embedding dimension and the lower-order assertion are immediate. The relation subspace at degree d has dimension M , giving the asserted length. The inequivalent common-factor and no-common-factor pencils prove uniform minimality as before. $\square$

In particular the earlier Schubert-line construction is a sufficient geometric realization, not a lower bound on the dimension of a supporting reduced scheme. The local inverse just proved retains no curve at all. Its additional ingredient is the coefficient-support asymmetry, which was not used in the earlier geometric orientation argument. This is a stronger inverse statement, not a conclusion from knowing the discriminant or the reduced determinant cone.

7.3. The local automorphism kernel is explicit. Put $a = n^2$, $\ell = \text{length } \mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]}$, and $G_R = \{g \in \text{GL}(V) : (\text{Sym}^2 g)R = R\}$. The symbol $\mathfrak{n}^2$ in the next statement is the square of the maximal ideal of the finite algebra.

Proposition 7.4 (Tangent-identity automorphisms). *There is a split exact sequence of complex automorphism groups*

$$1 \longrightarrow U_R \longrightarrow \text{Aut}_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]}) \longrightarrow (G_R \times \text{GL}(U))/\mathbb{C}^* \longrightarrow 1, \quad (7.3)$$

where the scalar subgroup is diagonal. The kernel U_R is a unipotent algebraic group whose underlying variety is an affine space of dimension

$$a(\ell - 1 - a).$$

More explicitly, after choosing the a degree-one generators $x_1, \dots, x_a$, its elements are exactly the substitutions $x_i \mapsto x_i + u_i$ with arbitrary $u_i \in \mathfrak{n}^2$. The affine-space parametrization is not an assertion that this group law is additive.

Proof. The local inverse and the support-rank argument identify the linear stabilizer of K_R with the indicated left-right quotient; transposition is absent. These linear maps lift homogeneously, giving the quotient and splitting. An automorphism in the kernel is the identity on $\mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2$, and consequently has exactly the displayed generator images.

Conversely choose arbitrary $u_i \in \mathfrak{n}^2$. Under this substitution a homogeneous defining relation of degree d changes only by terms in $\mathfrak{n}^{d+1} = 0$, so all defining relations are respected. The induced map is the identity on the associated graded algebra, hence is invertible as a finite filtered linear map and therefore as an algebra map. There are no further conditions on the u_i . Reading the generator images and performing substitutions are polynomial mutually inverse maps between the kernel and the vector space $(\mathfrak{n}^2)^{\oplus a}$. Since $\dim \mathfrak{n}^2 = \ell - 1 - a$, this proves the variety and dimension assertions. On a basis ordered by degree every such automorphism is upper unitriangular; the algebraic group is therefore unipotent. Its law includes higher substitution terms, which accounts for its generally noncommutative structure. $\square$

The positive-dimensional family statement remains useful after the local inverse: it recovers an entire varying subbundle and the actual source bundle up to one global left transformation, whereas separate fibrewise local isomorphisms need not glue. The geometric automorphism statements here still do not identify unmarked moduli stacks or all deformations over nonreduced parameter bases.

8. THE INTRINSIC POLARIZATION AND A PROJECTIVE MODULI COMPLETION

Put $P = \text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V)$, $N = \binom{n+1}{2}$, $M = \binom{N}{2}$, and $D = n^2 + 2n - 4$. Fix temporarily an auxiliary n -space U and put $E = \text{Hom}(U, V)^*$. Write $L = \mathcal{O}_P(1)$ for the Pluecker line and $\Gamma = \Phi(P) \subset \text{Gr}(M, \text{Sym}^D E)$ for the closed image of Theorem 6.3. The group in this section is $\text{SL}(V)$, acting by congruence on pencils and by its induced action on E , with U fixed. It is not the full group $\text{GL}(E)$.

Theorem 8.1 (Polarized completion of the effective failure moduli). *There is an $\mathrm{SL}(V)$ -equivariant isomorphism*

$$\Phi^* \mathcal{O}_{\mathrm{Gr}(M, \mathrm{Sym}^D E)}(1) \simeq L^{\otimes M} \otimes C_U, \quad (8.1)$$

where C_U is a constant one-dimensional space on which $\mathrm{SL}(V)$ acts trivially. Consequently the stable and semistable loci of Γ , for the restricted Pluecker linearization, are respectively the images of P^s and P^{ss} . The quotient defined by the complete restricted section ring is canonically

$$\overline{\mathcal{M}}_n^{\mathrm{fail}} = \mathrm{Proj} \left(\bigoplus_{q \geq 0} H^0(P, L^{\otimes q})^{\mathrm{SL}(V)} \right) \simeq \Gamma // \mathrm{SL}(V). \quad (8.2)$$

It is a normal projective variety. It contains the geometric quotient of the simple-discriminant pencils as a dense open subvariety, and has dimension $n - 3$. The complement of that open is the image of the semistable discriminant-zero locus.

The intrinsic inverse identifies the effective semistable failure stack with $[P^{ss} / \mathrm{PGL}(V)]$ and gives a moduli morphism to (8.2). On framed charts the failure-algebra family extends over all P , remains finite locally free, and commutes with arbitrary base change. These assertions do not require, and do not assert, the existence of a universal ordinary algebra on the coarse quotient or properness of the entire quotient stack.

Proof. Let $\mathcal{K}$ be the tautological relation bundle pulled back by Φ . The coefficient factorization (6.8) identifies it with $\mathcal{B} \otimes F(U)$, where $\mathcal{B}$ is the quotient-volume coefficient line. Exterior duality gives $\mathcal{B} \simeq L^{-1}$ up to a fixed determinant character of $\mathrm{GL}(V)$. That character is trivial on $\mathrm{SL}(V)$. Taking the dual determinant gives (8.1), with the harmless constant factor $(\det F(U))^*$ and the corresponding fixed determinant line of V . A trivialization of the constant factor identifies the section rings; a different trivialization rescales each graded piece and has no effect on its projective spectrum. The section ring for L^M is the M th Veronese of the section ring for L . Taking invariants commutes with this operation. The Hilbert–Mumford weights are multiplied by $M > 0$, so stability and semistability are unchanged. This also explains why one uses the complete section ring on Γ , rather than assuming surjectivity of unspecified ambient invariant restrictions.

Finite generation and the projective good quotient are the reductive GIT construction of [25, Chapter 1]. The complete section ring of the normal projective variety P is integrally closed: it is the intersection of the valuation conditions for rational sections of powers of L at the prime divisors of P . Its invariant subring is integrally closed as well. Indeed an element of its fraction field integral over the invariants is integral over the original ring, belongs to that ring by normality, and is invariant. This proves normality of the projective quotient.

For completeness, the simple-discriminant open is nonempty and stable. In a frame (Q_0, Q_1) of a pencil, take the discriminant of $\det(sQ_0 + tQ_1)$. Under a frame change $h \in \mathrm{GL}_2$ it has weight $(\det h)^{n(n-1)}$, and it is invariant under $\mathrm{SL}(V)$. Thus it is a nonzero invariant section of $L^{n(n-1)}$. It is nonzero at a diagonal pencil with n distinct roots, so its nonvanishing locus is semistable and saturated. A pencil there has a nonsingular member. Relative to that member, the other member is self-adjoint with distinct eigenvalues; orthogonal diagonalization identifies its congruence class with an unordered configuration of n distinct points of $\mathbb{P}^1$. The latter configurations are stable for the usual binary-form linearization: the root-multiplicity criterion is strict since $1 < n/2$ for $n \geq 3$. Their quotient is geometric and separated. It follows that the congruence orbits are closed in the saturated nonvanishing locus. Their stabilizers are finite: the induced projective transformation permutes a set of at least three points, and the kernel consists of diagonal sign changes modulo scalars. They are therefore stable. This gives a geometric dense open of dimension $n - 3$. The complement is the image of the invariant section’s zero locus by the good-quotient property. This

reasoning uses classical pencil classification and GIT, not a new classification of binary forms; compare [4, 25].

Finally apply Theorem G.2 and the rigidification results of Section H. The Pluecker polarization is taken on the recovered pencil, not on an arbitrary first-relation orbit. A sufficiently divisible power of L , for example L^n , has trivial central character and descends from $\mathrm{SL}(V)$ to $\mathrm{PGL}(V)$. A change of auxiliary frame changes the constant factor in (8.1), not the resulting projective quotient. On the framed Grassmannian the extended algebras are exactly those of Corollary 6.5. Their equivariance yields the stated classifying morphisms. Removing ineffective inertia does not turn these into a universal ordinary algebra on the coarse space, and no such descent is used. $\square$

Remark 8.2 (What is compactified). The completion is the classical polarized pencil quotient recovered from the intrinsic failure invariant, with its polarization verified by (8.1). It is not a new construction of classical GIT. Its role is to supply a proper coarse target for the effective invariant and a specified class of semistable limiting families. Strictly semistable points represent closed-orbit representatives, not every orbit in their fibres. In particular Segre data on the stack need not descend to an invariant separating all points of a coarse-quotient fibre. For $n = 3$ the quotient is a point and its discriminant boundary can be empty. The full $\mathrm{GL}(E)$ common limit of Theorem 52.1 is a different construction.

9. SPECTRAL DIVISOR FIBRES AND THE RECOVERY OF DEGENERATION TYPE

The preceding completion concerns the native congruence action. To retain degeneration type before passage to a coarse quotient, we associate a tower of binary divisor incidences to a regular pencil. This construction is intrinsic after the unmarked inverse and is unchanged by a simultaneous change of the pencil and source frames.

Let $\Lambda = \mathbb{P}(R)$ be the pencil line and let $\mathcal{T}_R$ be the cokernel of the universal symmetric map on Λ . A regular pencil means that its determinant is not identically zero. Thus $\mathcal{T}_R$ is a torsion sheaf. Define $D_j(R)$ by

$$\mathcal{I}_{D_j(R)} = \mathrm{Fitt}_j(\mathcal{T}_R), \quad 0 \leq j \leq n, \quad (9.1)$$

where $D_n = \emptyset$. These are effective divisors on the smooth curve Λ . Write $s_j = \deg D_j$. If $s_j > 0$, let G_j be its binary equation and put

$$J_j = G_j H^0(\Lambda, \mathcal{O}_\Lambda(1)) \subset H^0(\Lambda, \mathcal{O}_\Lambda(s_j + 1)).$$

Changing the scalar representative of G_j does not change J_j . Let $\mathcal{F}_j(R)$ be the whole scheme fibre at J_j of the degree-one divisor normalization ν_1 , with $r = 2$ and $D = s_j + 1$. For $s_j = 0$ put $\mathcal{F}_j = \emptyset$.

Theorem 9.1 (A fibre-theoretic Segre invariant). *There is a natural identification of finite schemes over Λ*

$$\mathcal{F}_j(R) \simeq D_j(R). \quad (9.2)$$

At a spectral point x , write the positive elementary divisors of $\mathcal{T}_R$ as $\lambda_{x,1} \geq \cdots \geq \lambda_{x,r_x} > 0$, and extend this sequence by zeroes. Then

$$(\mathcal{F}_j(R))_x = \mathrm{Spec} \mathbb{C}[\epsilon]/(\epsilon^{b_{x,j}}), \quad b_{x,j} = \sum_{i>j} \lambda_{x,i}, \quad (9.3)$$

with the empty-scheme convention when $b_{x,j} = 0$. Consequently

$$\lambda_{x,j+1} = b_{x,j} - b_{x,j+1}. \quad (9.4)$$

The tower, with its maps to the same intrinsic spectral line, therefore determines the full Segre symbol. Conversely, the elementary-divisor partitions together with their spectral support on that

line determine the tower. The tower retains the projective configuration of the support as well as the Segre symbol. It is an invariant of the unmarked finite failure algebra.

The construction is compatible with base change on every family stratum where the Fitting ideals in (9.1) define relative effective Cartier divisors of fixed degrees. On such a stratum $\mathcal{F}_j$ is finite locally free of degree s_j . These hypotheses are part of the relative statement; no assertion of flatness across a jump of s_j is intended.

Proof. Over the discrete valuation ring $\mathcal{O}_{\Lambda,x}$, Smith normal form gives diagonal entries with exponents $\lambda_{x,r_x}, \dots, \lambda_{x,1}$ and $n - r_x$ zero exponents. The minors of size $n - j$ have greatest common divisor of order $\sum_{i>j} \lambda_{x,i}$. This proves the formula for D_j , including its nonreduced structure. It is the usual Fitting-ideal description of elementary divisors, used here on the intrinsic spectral line.

The residual two-space $H^0(\mathcal{O}_\Lambda(1))$ is gcd-free. Hence Theorem 13.1 identifies the degree-one normalization fibre at J_j with the scheme of linear factors of G_j . On an affine chart write a monic linear factor as $z - a$. Monic division gives $G_j = (z - a)H + G_j(a)$, so the entire factor scheme is $G_j(a) = 0$, not its reduction. These descriptions agree on overlaps of the projective line. They give (9.2) and the local algebra (9.3). Taking successive differences proves (9.4). The common map to Λ is essential: forgetting it separately in each member of the tower would discard the alignment of the spectral supports.

Pencil frame changes act on Λ by projective transformations; source congruence changes give isomorphic cokernels and preserve all Fitting ideals. The intrinsic inverse of Theorem 7.3 therefore defines this invariant from the unmarked algebra. The equivalence with Segre data uses the classical elementary-divisor convention of [4, §5].

For a family with the stated Cartier and degree conditions, the same monic division argument works over any base algebra, including one with nilpotents. It represents the divisor's functor of points, so it commutes with base change. A relative effective divisor of fixed degree on a projective-line bundle is finite locally free of that degree. Local choices of G_j differ by units and glue. Formation of Fitting ideals itself commutes with base change; requiring them to remain flat Cartier divisors is precisely what permits the additional finite-flat conclusion. $\square$

Example 9.2 (Equal discriminant, different fibre towers). At a root of multiplicity four, the partitions $(3, 1)$ and $(2, 2)$ have the same zeroth fibre $\mathbb{C}[\epsilon]/(\epsilon^4)$. Their first fibres are respectively $\mathbb{C}$ and $\mathbb{C}[\epsilon]/(\epsilon^2)$; all higher fibres are empty there. Thus the discriminant alone does not detect the distinction, whereas the divisor-fibre tower does. Both are realized by regular symmetric pencils: for a block of size l , take the reversal matrix H_l and the symmetric pair $(H_l, H_l J_l(\alpha))$, where $J_l(\alpha)$ is a Jordan block. Direct sums realize every indicated partition. Additional simple blocks may be appended. The example is a statement on the regular-pencil stack, not a claim that distinct Segre strata always remain distinct after strictly semistable GIT identification.

Remark 9.3 (The two divisor constructions). The primitive first relation of an actual pencil has exact common factor $(\det T)^{n-1}$, by Lemma G.1. Its common-factor degree does not jump when the pencil changes Segre type. The divisors D_j above instead lie on the recovered spectral line and define auxiliary binary first-relation subspaces J_j . Thus (9.4) relates pencil data to intrinsically induced divisor ramification, not to a nonexistent change in the conductor of the original exact-gcd locus. The identification supplies a moduli consequence of the all-binary-fibre theorem while respecting this distinction.

Part II. Divisor incidence and homological fibres

10. COMMON-DIVISOR STRATA AND INTRINSIC FAMILIES

The coefficient condition in Theorem D.1 is not imposed in this section. We instead retain the common divisor of a space of first relations. This geometric condition gives a larger smooth parameter space, includes relations without either factor symmetry, and has a scheme-theoretic inverse. The distinction between a stratum and the condition on its geometric points is essential when the parameter base is nonreduced.

Write $S_j(E) = \text{Sym}^j E$, where E is a complex vector space. For $r \geq 2$, denote by

$$X_{h,r}(E) \subset \text{Gr}(r, S_h(E))$$

the locus of subspaces with greatest common divisor equal to 1, up to a scalar. Empty Grassmannians are omitted throughout. When $h = 0$ this notation can also be used for $r = 1$.

Lemma 10.1 (Universal common divisor). *Let $D = g + h$. The spaces of r degree- D forms whose exact greatest common divisor has degree g form a locally closed reduced subscheme Z_g of $\text{Gr}(r, S_D(E))$. Multiplication induces an isomorphism*

$$\mathbb{P}(S_g(E)) \times X_{h,r}(E) \xrightarrow{\sim} Z_g, \quad ([f], J) \mapsto fJ. \quad (10.1)$$

In particular, the common-divisor line and the residual subbundle of a family with classifying map in Z_g are recovered uniquely and commute with arbitrary complex base change.

Proof. For each a , multiplication from $\mathbb{P}(S_a(E)) \times \text{Gr}(r, S_{D-a}(E))$ has closed image: its domain is projective. The union for $a > g$ is closed. Remove this union from the image for $a = g$, and give the resulting locally closed set its reduced structure. Its points are exactly those in the statement. The inverse image of this set under multiplication is $\mathbb{P}(S_g(E)) \times X_{h,r}(E)$. The same closed-image argument with $D = h$ shows that $X_{h,r}(E)$ is open.

The restricted multiplication map is proper, by base change. It is injective on geometric points over every algebraically closed extension of $\mathbb{C}$, since a greatest common divisor is unique up to scalar in a polynomial ring. Its differential is injective as well. Indeed, a tangent vector in its kernel satisfies

$$\dot{f}j + f\dot{j} \in fJ \quad (j \in J).$$

Consequently $f \mid \dot{f}j$ for every $j \in J$. For each irreducible factor of f , some element of J is not divisible by that factor. Comparison of its valuation gives $f \mid \dot{f}$. Equality of degrees makes $\dot{f}$ a scalar multiple of f ; then $\dot{J} = 0$ in $\text{Hom}(J, S_h(E)/J)$.

In characteristic zero the geometric-point injectivity and this differential calculation imply that the map is universally injective and unramified. A proper, universally injective, unramified morphism is a closed immersion [12, Lemma 41.7.2]. Here its image is all of the reduced target. The defining ideal of a closed immersion with this support is zero in a reduced scheme. This proves the isomorphism, including its assertion for nonreduced test schemes. Equivalently, one can check properness on the base change of the original projective multiplication map; that base change has the same underlying open preimage. Its source is reduced because it is this open subscheme of the original smooth product. $\square$

Remark 10.2. A map from a nonreduced scheme is required to factor through the locally closed scheme Z_g , not merely to have geometric points in its underlying set. These are different requirements. For example, over $\mathbb{C}[\epsilon]/(\epsilon^2)$ the span of $x^2 + \epsilon y^2, xy$ specializes to a pair with common divisor x , but has no factor $x + \epsilon(ax + by)$. Comparison of the y^2 coefficient in the first form proves this. The stratum in Lemma 10.1 excludes this transverse infinitesimal family. No use of a fibrewise radical can replace its scheme structure.

Now let $\dim V = \dim U = n \geq 3$, $E = V^* \otimes U$, and $\delta = \det T$. Denote by $G \subset \mathrm{GL}(E)$ the stabilizer of the line $\mathbb{C}\delta$. By Lemma 3.1,

$$G^\circ = (\mathrm{GL}(V) \times \mathrm{GL}(U))/\mathbb{G}_m, \quad G/G^\circ = \mathbf{Z}/2\mathbf{Z}. \quad (10.2)$$

The second component exchanges the two tensor factors; the diagonal scalars in the displayed product act trivially on the matrix space. Fix $s \geq 1$ and $D = sn + h$. Inside Z_{sn} , impose the condition that the common-divisor line is the s -th power of a determinant form after a linear change of the n^2 variables. Call the resulting locally closed scheme $Z_{s,h,r}^{\det}$.

Theorem 10.3 (Intrinsic determinant-divisor stratum). *There are canonical isomorphisms of schemes and algebraic stacks*

$$Z_{s,h,r}^{\det} \simeq \mathrm{GL}(E) \times^G X_{h,r}(E), \quad [Z_{s,h,r}^{\det} / \mathrm{GL}(E)] \simeq [X_{h,r}(E) / G]. \quad (10.3)$$

They hold over arbitrary complex parameter schemes. The stack is smooth. At a residual relation J , its tangent complex, in degrees $-1, 0$, is

$$[\mathrm{Lie}(G) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(J, S_h(E)/J)], \quad X \longmapsto (j \mapsto Xj \bmod J). \quad (10.4)$$

No invariance of J under either full factor group is assumed. The equivalence identifies stabilizers, infinitesimal families, and specializations whose classifying maps remain in this stratum.

Proof. The power map $\mathbb{P}(S_n(E)) \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(S_{sn}(E))$, $[f] \mapsto [f^s]$, is a closed immersion in characteristic zero. It is proper and geometrically injective, and its differential has kernel given by $sf^{s-1}\dot{f} \in \mathbb{C}f^s$, hence by $\dot{f} \in \mathbb{C}f$. The same closed-immersion criterion as above applies. The orbit of $[\delta]$ is the smooth locally closed homogeneous space $\mathrm{GL}(E)/G$. The preimage of its power orbit under the first projection in (10.1) is therefore a locally closed subscheme. It is exactly $Z_{s,h,r}^{\det}$.

Pulling back along the G -torsor $\mathrm{GL}(E) \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}(E)/G$ trivializes the common-divisor form, leaving the unrestricted residual relation $J \in X_{h,r}(E)$. Descent gives the first isomorphism in (10.3); descent of equivariant maps and morphisms gives the second. This proof uses morphisms of schemes, not a comparison only on complex points. It also supplies local lifts of all isomorphisms over an fppf cover.

The space $X_{h,r}(E)$ is open in a Grassmannian and G is smooth. The quotient is algebraic and smooth [13, Theorem 97.17.2]; see also [14, Lemma 101.33.7]. For completeness, write a first-order residual subspace as the graph of $\epsilon\phi : J \rightarrow S_h(E)/J$. An infinitesimal change $1 + \epsilon X$ replaces ϕ by $\phi + X|_J \bmod J$. This proves the tangent complex. Its kernel records infinitesimal automorphisms and its cokernel records first-order isomorphism classes. The same torsor description proves compatibility with specialization. No assertion is made about limits outside the specified common-divisor stratum. $\square$

The next step connects these parameter spaces with ungraded finite algebras. It is useful to state the family condition intrinsically, since an absolute nilradical is unsuitable over a nonreduced base. Put $e = \dim E$ and $\ell = \binom{e+D}{D} - r$. Consider finite locally free commutative unital algebras $\mathcal{A}$ of rank ℓ on a complex scheme T_0 , subject to the following conditions. The map $\epsilon(a) = \ell^{-1} \mathrm{tr}(M_a)$ is multiplicative. For $\mathcal{N} = \ker \epsilon$, one has $\mathcal{N}^{D+1} = 0$; all quotients of its power filtration are locally free; $\mathcal{E} = \mathcal{N}/\mathcal{N}^2$ has rank e ; and multiplication gives isomorphisms $\mathrm{Sym}^j \mathcal{E} \simeq \mathcal{N}^j / \mathcal{N}^{j+1}$ for $j < D$. In degree D its kernel has rank r . These conditions specify the maximal-lower-Hilbert-function stratum; they do not assert that arbitrary smoothings of a local algebra remain in it.

Proposition 10.4 (Relative first-relation algebra). *Every such algebra is locally isomorphic, over its base, to*

$$\mathcal{A}(\mathcal{K}) = \mathrm{Sym} \mathcal{E} / ((\mathcal{K}) + \mathfrak{m}^{D+1}), \quad \mathcal{K} = \ker(\mathrm{Sym}^D \mathcal{E} \longrightarrow \mathcal{N}^D).$$

Its trace augmentation, $\mathcal{E}$, and $\mathcal{K}$ are intrinsic and compatible with arbitrary base change in this stratum. For two such algebras, taking the linear part gives a locally surjective map of isomorphism

sheaves to the sheaf of isomorphisms of $(\mathcal{E}, \mathcal{K})$. Its kernel is the smooth substitution group whose underlying scheme in a local presentation is $\mathrm{Hom}(\mathcal{E}, \mathcal{N}^2)$.

After quotienting morphisms by this tangent-identity kernel and fppf stackifying, the algebras with first-relation map in $Z_{s,h,r}^{\det}$ have stack $[X_{h,r}(E)/G]$.

Proof. Locally lift a basis of $\mathcal{E}$ to $\mathcal{N}$. Nilpotence and multiplication on the successive quotients make the induced map from the truncated symmetric algebra surjective. A relation with a nonzero term of least degree $j < D$ would give a nonzero kernel in degree j of the associated graded algebra, which is impossible. Its entire kernel therefore lies in degree D and is precisely $\mathcal{K}$. Changing a lift by an element of $\mathcal{N}^2$ does not alter a product of D generators, since the difference has degree at least $D + 1$. This also proves the asserted uniqueness of the first relation.

In this presentation multiplication by a positive-degree element is strictly filtration-increasing. Its trace is zero over any base ring. Multiplication by a scalar has trace ℓ times that scalar, proving that the presentation's augmentation is the specified intrinsic trace augmentation. All filtration sequences are locally split sequences of vector bundles, so their kernels and quotients commute with base change.

An isomorphism must preserve trace and induces a linear map carrying $\mathcal{K}$ to $\mathcal{K}'$. Conversely such a map lifts locally to an isomorphism by the homogeneous presentations. All other lifts are obtained by substituting generators plus arbitrary elements of $\mathcal{N}^2$; the inverse is constructed degree by degree in a finite filtration. This gives the stated kernel and its smoothness, without replacing its substitution law by addition. After identifying morphisms with the same linear part, frames of $\mathcal{E}$ give the quotient $[Z_{s,h,r}^{\det}/\mathrm{GL}(E)]$. Theorem 10.3 completes the proof. $\square$

Remark 10.5. The original algebra stack is not this quotient stack: it has the additional nonlinear inertia just computed. The phrase *effective first-relation stack* will refer to the specified quotient on morphisms followed by stackification. The construction retains the full automorphism group before taking that quotient. It does not identify algebras with the same geometric fibres, nor does it discard nilpotent parameters. In particular, its relation to a stratum of first relations is stronger than a bijection of isomorphism classes over $\mathbb{C}$.

11. THE COMMON-DIVISOR BOUNDARY AND ITS NORMALIZATION

The exact-common-divisor stratum has a canonical completion which need not be normal. Its normalization records a divisor, and its failure to be an isomorphism is controlled by two different phenomena: choices of that divisor and overlap with the residual common factor. We establish these assertions for arbitrary spaces of forms. No determinant, Cauchy, or Pluecker equation is imposed in this section.

Let E have dimension $e \geq 2$, put $S_j = \mathrm{Sym}^j E$ and $s_j = \dim S_j = \binom{e+j-1}{j}$, and fix

$$g, h \geq 1, \quad D = g + h, \quad 2 \leq r \leq s_h.$$

Write $\mathcal{G} = \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_D)$. A *degree- g divisor incidence* over a complex scheme T_0 consists of a line subbundle $\mathcal{L} \subset S_g \otimes \mathcal{O}_{T_0}$ and a rank- r subbundle $\mathcal{K} \subset S_D \otimes \mathcal{O}_{T_0}$ such that

$$\mathcal{K} \longrightarrow (S_D \otimes \mathcal{O}_{T_0})/(\mathcal{L} \cdot S_h) = 0. \quad (11.1)$$

Subbundle always means that the quotient is locally free. In particular, the form generating $\mathcal{L}$ is nonzero on every geometric fibre. Condition (11.1) is the vanishing of a bundle map, not a condition imposed only on closed points.

Proposition 11.1 (Canonical divisor incidence). *The incidence functor is represented, with its full scheme structure, by*

$$\mathcal{X}_g = \mathbb{P}(S_g) \times \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_h).$$

Its forgetful morphism is multiplication

$$\nu_g : \mathcal{X}_g \longrightarrow \mathcal{G}, \quad ([f], J) \longmapsto fJ. \quad (11.2)$$

This morphism is finite. Its scheme-theoretic image Y_g is an integral projective scheme. If K is a geometric point of Y_g and $F_K = \gcd(K)$, the underlying set of $\nu_g^{-1}(K)$ is

$$\{[f] : f \mid F_K, \deg f = g\}, \quad (11.3)$$

with residual space $J = K/f$. The incidence construction and its scheme-theoretic fibres commute with arbitrary complex base change.

Proof. On $\mathbb{P}(S_g)$, multiplication from the tautological line tensored with S_h to S_D has constant rank s_h . Indeed, multiplication by a nonzero polynomial over a field is injective. A nonzero maximal minor locally splits this map, so its image and cokernel are vector bundles, also after a nonreduced base change. The closed incidence (11.1) is therefore the relative Grassmannian of rank- r subbundles of $\mathcal{L} \otimes S_h$. Tensoring by $\mathcal{L}^{-1}$ identifies it canonically with the stated product. In more elementary terms, $\mathcal{K}$ has a unique inverse image in $\mathcal{L} \otimes S_h$; its quotient there is locally free because the quotient of $S_D/\mathcal{K}$ onto $S_D/(\mathcal{L} \cdot S_h)$ is a surjection of vector bundles. This proves the functorial assertion, including its scheme structure.

The source of ν_g is projective. Unique factorization in the polynomial ring over an algebraically closed field gives (11.3). A fixed polynomial has only finitely many divisors of a fixed degree, up to scalar. The morphism is thus proper with finite fibres and is finite [15, Tag 02LS]. Define Y_g by the kernel of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{G}} \rightarrow (\nu_g)_* \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{X}_g}$, as in [16, Tag 01R5]. Its integrality follows from the integrality of $\mathcal{X}_g$: on an affine open meeting the image, the coordinate ring of the image injects into the domain which is the coordinate ring of its finite inverse image. Reducedness is therefore a consequence of this incidence construction, not an extra choice. Representability of incidence gives the base-change assertion. $\square$

Remark 11.2. The condition defining Y_g is the existence of a divisor of degree g . In several variables it is not the condition $\deg \gcd(K) \geq g$: an irreducible polynomial of larger degree need not have a degree- g factor. Nor do we assert that formation of the scheme-theoretic image, or normalization itself, commutes with arbitrary nonflat base change. The assertion for arbitrary bases in Proposition 11.1 concerns the incidence functor and the base change of its representing morphism.

We next retain the nilpotents of a fibre. This will distinguish a ramified divisor choice from several distinct divisor choices.

Lemma 11.3 (Fibre equations and the overlap space). *Let $K = fJ$, set $H = \gcd(J)$, and put $c = \gcd(f, H)$ and $k = \deg c$. Then the tangent space of the scheme-theoretic fibre at $([f], J)$ is naturally, after the displayed representatives have been chosen,*

$$\ker(d\nu_g)_{([f], J)} \simeq S_k/\mathbb{C}c, \quad \dim \ker(d\nu_g) = s_k - 1. \quad (11.4)$$

More explicitly, choose a projective coefficient chart $f(u) = f + \sum u_\alpha m_\alpha$, with one coefficient normalized to its value in f . Let $M(f(u))$ be the matrix of multiplication $S_h \rightarrow S_D$. Choose a set A_0 of s_h rows for which $M_{A_0}(f)$ is invertible, and let B_0 denote the remaining rows. For a matrix C whose columns form a basis of K , the full fibre on this chart is defined by

$$C_{B_0} - M_{B_0}(f(u))M_{A_0}(f(u))^{-1}C_{A_0} = 0, \quad \det M_{A_0}(f(u)) \neq 0. \quad (11.5)$$

In particular its completed local ring is the power-series ring in the $s_g - 1$ variables u_α , modulo the entries in (11.5); no radical is taken.

Proof. For each column of C , its possible quotient by $f(u)$ is forced by the A_0 rows to be $M_{A_0}^{-1}C_{A_0}$. The remaining rows are exactly the condition that this quotient works. These quotients span a subbundle wherever the equations hold, by the incidence argument above. Thus elimination has introduced neither additional solutions nor discarded nilpotents, proving the fibre presentation over arbitrary coefficient rings in the chart.

A tangent vector is a pair $(\dot{f} \bmod \mathbb{C}f, \dot{J})$. It lies in the fibre precisely when

$$\dot{f}j + f\dot{j} \in fJ \quad \text{for all } j \in J.$$

It is necessary and sufficient that $f \mid \dot{f}j$ for every $j \in J$; the class of $\dot{j}$ modulo J is then forced. Taking the minimum valuation over a basis of J , for each irreducible polynomial, makes this equivalent to $f \mid \dot{f}H$. Writing $f = cf_1$, $H = cH_1$, with $\gcd(f_1, H_1) = 1$, gives $\dot{f} = f_1w$ with $w \in S_k$. The scalar tangent direction $\dot{f} \in \mathbb{C}f$ is exactly $w \in \mathbb{C}c$. This proves (11.4) and its dimension assertion. $\square$

Theorem 11.4 (Normalization and the exact normal locus). *The finite map*

$$\nu_g : \mathbb{P}(S_g) \times \text{Gr}(r, S_h) \longrightarrow Y_g$$

is the normalization of the natural degree- g divisor locus. Its dimension is

$$\dim Y_g = s_g - 1 + r(s_h - r). \quad (11.6)$$

For a geometric point K , the scheme Y_g is normal at K if and only if F_K has exactly one degree- g divisor $[f]$ and

$$\gcd(f, F_K/f) = 1. \quad (11.7)$$

Normality at a point is also equivalent to smoothness there. Thus the two precise obstructions are more than one divisor choice, or overlap between the selected divisor and the residual common factor. The latter gives the fibre tangent dimension in (11.4), and (11.5) determines its higher nilpotents.

Proof. The locus of gcd-free r -planes in S_h is nonempty: a space containing x_1^h, x_2^h is one example, and it can be extended to every allowed rank r . It is open, since the loci possessing a positive-degree divisor are the finitely many closed images of projective multiplication maps. It is therefore dense in the irreducible Grassmannian. Its product with $\mathbb{P}(S_g)$ maps to the locus where the exact gcd has degree g .

This last locus is open in Y_g : remove the finitely many closed images for divisor degrees $a > g$. Call it U_g . Every fibre over a geometric point of U_g has one point and, by Lemma 11.3 with $H = 1$, zero tangent space. A finite local algebra over an algebraically closed field with zero cotangent space is the field itself, by Nakayama's lemma. The fibre consequently has length one, not merely one point.

Here is the local argument which also settles the scheme structure. At a closed point of U_g , write A for the local ring of Y_g , and B for its finite inverse-image algebra. The map $A \rightarrow B$ is injective, and $B/\mathfrak{m}_A B = \mathbb{C}$, generated by 1. Nakayama's lemma, applied to the finite module B/A , gives $B = A$. The non-isomorphism locus of a finite morphism is closed, so the same conclusion holds throughout U_g . Hence ν_g is birational. The source is smooth and integral, thus normal. On affine opens, a finite birational extension $A \subset B$ with B integrally closed is the integral closure of A in the common fraction field: every element integral over A is integral over B and hence belongs to B . This proves the normalization assertion; compare [17, Tag 035E]. The dimension follows from the product description.

If Y_g is normal at K , its normalization is an isomorphism there, so its fibre is one reduced point. Formula (11.3) gives uniqueness of $[f]$, and (11.4) gives $s_k - 1 = 0$, equivalent to $k = 0$ because $e \geq 2$. Conversely uniqueness and $k = 0$ again make the entire fibre a single reduced point. The same finite local Nakayama argument shows that the normalization is an isomorphism

near K . Its source is normal, so Y_g is normal at K . The source is smooth, so every normal point of the target is smooth; the converse holds for every complex variety. This proves both directions without replacing a nonreduced fibre by its set of points. $\square$

Corollary 11.5 (Universality of the exact stratum). *The open subscheme $U_g \subset Y_g$ represents the unmarked relation families in the divisor incidence whose residual space is gcd-free on every geometric fibre. Over it the divisor line and residual subbundle are unique and commute with arbitrary base change. Moreover U_g , as a locally closed subscheme of $\mathcal{G}$, is the reduced exact-gcd stratum of Lemma 10.1.*

Proof. The inverse image of U_g is $\mathbb{P}(S_g) \times X_{h,r}(E)$, and the proof above shows that its finite map to U_g is an isomorphism. Its source is reduced, so U_g has the reduced induced structure on its locally closed support. The incidence functor supplies the asserted universal property. A family in the ambient Grassmannian which only has the right geometric gcd need not factor through Y_g . In particular, the transverse dual-number family of Remark 10.2 is not admitted by this corollary. The corollary is a scheme-theoretic identification, not a claim that fibrewise gcd tests detect nilpotent equations. $\square$

Example 11.6 (A nonreduced fibre at a divisor collision). Take $E = \langle x, y, z \rangle$, $g = 1, h = 2, r = 2$, and $K = \langle x^2y, x^2z \rangle$. Its gcd is x^2 , so the only point of the normalization fibre has divisor x . In the chart $f = x + ay + bz$, division by this monic linear form amounts to substitution $x = -ay - bz$. The two remainders are

$$(ay + bz)^2y, \quad (ay + bz)^2z.$$

Their coefficient ideal is (a^2, ab, b^2) . Thus the full fibre is

$$\text{Spec } \mathbb{C}[a, b]/(a, b)^2, \quad (11.8)$$

of length three and tangent dimension two. It is not a reduced point, despite uniqueness of the geometric divisor. The family

$$K_t = x\langle xy + ty^2, xz + tz^2 \rangle$$

has independent generators for every t , exact gcd x when $t \neq 0$, and the displayed collision at $t = 0$. Consequently this nonreduced fibre occurs on the boundary of the exact stratum, not in an unrelated example.

Example 11.7 (Several branches and a normal gcd jump). For the same g, h, r, E , let $K = xy\langle x, z \rangle$. The divisors x and y give two points of the normalization fibre. At both points the overlap is one, so the fibre consists of two reduced points. The point of Y_1 is nonnormal. By contrast, put $q = x^2 + yz$ and $K = xq\langle y, z \rangle$, now with $h = 3$. The polynomial q is irreducible and is not divisible by x . There is exactly one linear divisor of gcd $K = xq$, and its overlap with the residual gcd q is one. This point of Y_1 is normal although its gcd degree is three. These two examples show why neither gcd degree nor the number of geometric lifts alone is a sufficient normality criterion.

Corollary 11.8 (An intrinsic boundary for first-relation algebras). *On the maximal-lower-Hilbert-function stratum of Proposition 10.4, the algebras whose intrinsic degree- D kernel has classifying map in Y_g have, after removing only tangent-identity substitutions, stack $[Y_g/\text{GL}(E)]$. Its normalization is the finite representable morphism*

$$[\mathcal{X}_g/\text{GL}(E)] \longrightarrow [Y_g/\text{GL}(E)]. \quad (11.9)$$

All members of the universal relation family give finite locally free algebras of rank $\binom{e+D}{D} - r$. This construction imposes no pencil image equations and permits the divisor and residual common factor to collide.

Proof. For every subbundle $\mathcal{K}$ classified by the Grassmannian, $\mathrm{Sym} E/((\mathcal{K}) + \mathfrak{m}^{D+1})$ is, as a module, the sum of S_j for $j < D$ and $S_D/\mathcal{K}$. This proves finite local freeness and the rank. The first-relation proposition identifies the quotient after the specified nonlinear inertia is removed. Incidence and multiplication are $\mathrm{GL}(E)$ -equivariant. Pulling (11.9) back along the smooth frame atlas $Y_g \rightarrow [Y_g/\mathrm{GL}(E)]$ gives precisely ν_g . Finiteness, representability, and the normalization identification follow by descent; equivalently normality and integral closure may be checked on these smooth atlases. This quotient is not claimed to classify smoothings outside the specified Hilbert stratum. $\square$

For the pencil first relations one can take $e = n^2$, $g = n(n-1)$, $h = 3n-4$, and $r = \binom{n+1}{2}$. Every pencil then lies in the exact-gcd open of this canonical boundary. The boundary theorem concerns the much larger space of all degree- g divisorial first relations, rather than a closure defined by recovering a pencil and reimposing its Pluecker equations. It determines its normalization and normal locus, but does not assert a classification of all its linear orbits or of all finite-flat algebra deformations.

12. FORMAL IMAGES AND MARKED DIVISOR GERMS

All rings and schemes in the following sections are over $\mathbb{C}$. Write $S_j = \mathrm{Sym}^j E$, and let $Y_g \subset \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_D)$ be the scheme-theoretic image of

$$\nu_g : \mathbb{P}(S_g) \times \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_{D-g}) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_D), \quad (f, J) \longmapsto fJ,$$

where $\dim E \geq 2$, $g \geq 1$, and $2 \leq r \leq \dim S_{D-g}$. The source is smooth, and ν_g is its finite normalization: a fibre records the degree- g divisors of the common divisor, and on the exact-degree- g locus there is one reduced lift. We shall retain the scheme structures of these fibres and of the image.

Lemma 12.1 (Completed finite images). *Let $X \rightarrow M$ be a finite morphism of complex finite-type schemes, with X reduced and M smooth, and let Y be its scheme-theoretic image. Fix a closed point $y \in Y$, put $R = \widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{M,y}$, and write $B_i = \widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{X,x_i}$ for the points over y . Then*

$$\widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y,y} = R / \bigcap_i \ker(R \rightarrow B_i).$$

This completed image is reduced. If the cotangent map from R to B_i is surjective, then $R \rightarrow B_i$ is surjective. If there are two such points, writing $I_i = \ker(R \rightarrow B_i)$ gives

$$\widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y,y} = (R/I_1) \times_{R/(I_1+I_2)} (R/I_2).$$

The formal schemes at the different x_i are disjoint. A local Artin point of the finite inverse image belongs to exactly one of them.

Proof. On an affine neighbourhood the image ring is the image of the ambient ring in a finite algebra. Exactness of completion on finite modules preserves this kernel. The completed finite algebra is the product of the B_i : the orthogonal idempotents of its Artin closed fibre lift uniquely through the powers of the maximal ideal. Reduced finite-type complex rings are excellent and analytically unramified, so their completions are reduced; alternatively this applies directly to the reduced image ring. For cotangent surjectivity, lift a basis of the maximal ideal of B_i modulo its square to R . The resulting lifts generate every successive associated-graded piece. Subtracting successive homogeneous lifts and taking their convergent sum expresses any element of B_i as the image of an element of R . The finite map factors through the completed image, so this is also a closed immersion into that image, not only into M . Finally the elementary exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow R/(I_1 \cap I_2) \longrightarrow R/I_1 \oplus R/I_2 \longrightarrow R/(I_1 + I_2) \longrightarrow 0$$

proves the fibre-product assertion. The idempotent decomposition gives the last assertion, including over nonreduced Artin bases. $\square$

Lemma 12.2 (Coprime lifts and the split codimension). *If homogeneous forms a, b have coprime reductions over a local Artin base A , then $(a) \cap (b) = (ab)$ in $A[E]$. The relevant graded quotients and Koszul kernels are A -flat. In the split-divisor model, with $s_j = \binom{e+j-1}{j}$, $e \geq 2$, $h > g \geq 1$, and $r \geq 2$,*

$$c = r(s_h - s_{h-g}) - (s_g - 1) \geq (r-1)(s_g - 1) \geq 1.$$

Proof. Over the residue field the two forms form a regular sequence. In each degree their Koszul complex consists of finite free modules and has its prescribed ranks. The acyclic-complex criterion over an Artin local ring, proved by lifting splittings successively along its maximal ideal, gives exactness and flatness of the lifted cokernels. Thus b is a nonzerodivisor modulo a , proving the intersection identity. For the inequality, express $s_h - s_{h-g}$ as the sum of g consecutive first differences of the sequence s_j . These differences are nondecreasing for $e \geq 2$. Their sum is at least $s_g - s_0 = s_g - 1$. $\square$

In particular the two formal marked lifts in a coprime split model are separated before their images are compared. Their intersection functor is precisely $K_A = a_A b_A L_A$. Division gives a subbundle: multiplication by a fibrewise nonzero form is locally split, and the quotient of the ambient bundle by K_A is locally free. Combining this Artin-functor identification with Lemma 12.1 justifies the completed-image fibre product without any assumption that a tangent-space comparison determines an intersection scheme.

13. A GLOBAL FACTORIZATION THEOREM FOR BINARY NORMALIZATION FIBRES

For this section E has dimension two. Set $N_0 = r(D+1-r)$ and $m = r-1$. Let

$$\mathcal{T}_s = Y_s \setminus Y_{s+1}, \quad 1 \leq s \leq D+1-r,$$

with the reduced locally closed structure; an inadmissible Y_j is empty. Binary forms split into linear factors, so the Y_j are nested. The multiplication map identifies

$$\mathcal{T}_s \simeq \mathbb{P}(S_s) \times X_{D-s,r},$$

where $X_{D-s,r}$ is the open Grassmannian of gcd-free residual spaces. The first projection is the algebraic common-divisor morphism, not a choice made independently on individual fibres.

For nonnegative a, b define $H_{a,b} = \mathbb{C}$ when $ab = 0$. Otherwise, put $k = \min(a, b)$ and $l = \max(a, b)$, and set

$$H_{a,b} = \mathbb{C}[q_1, \dots, q_k] / (c_{l+1}, \dots, c_{l+k}), \quad \sum_{j \geq 0} c_j z^j = (1 + q_1 z + \dots + q_k z^k)^{-1}. \quad (13.1)$$

The weight of q_i is i . This grading is not the maximal-ideal adic grading when $k > 1$.

Theorem 13.1 (Stratified finite flatness and all binary fibres). *For $g \leq s$, the restriction of ν_g over $\mathcal{T}_s$ is the base change, along the common-divisor morphism, of*

$$\mathbb{P}(S_g) \times \mathbb{P}(S_{s-g}) \longrightarrow \mathbb{P}(S_s), \quad (f, H) \mapsto fH.$$

It is finite locally free of degree $\binom{s}{g}$. If $\gcd(K) = \prod_{i=1}^b \ell_i^{s_i}$, with distinct ℓ_i and $\sum_i s_i = s$, its entire normalization fibre is

$$\prod_{\substack{0 \leq a_i \leq s_i \\ \sum_i a_i = g}} \bigotimes_{i=1}^b H_{a_i, s_i - a_i}. \quad (13.2)$$

Every local factor is an Artin complete intersection and is Gorenstein. Its length, weighted Hilbert series, and socle weight are, respectively,

$$\prod_i \binom{s_i}{a_i}, \quad \prod_i \prod_{j=1}^{\min(a_i, s_i - a_i)} \frac{1 - z^{\max(a_i, s_i - a_i) + j}}{1 - z^j}, \quad \sum_i a_i(s_i - a_i).$$

The total length is $\binom{s}{g}$, including at arbitrary simultaneous root collisions. Over fixed s , the closure order of common-root partition strata is the order generated by merging parts.

Proof. Over $\mathcal{T}_s$ the common divisor G and residual subbundle L are defined scheme-theoretically by the inverse to the exact-divisor incidence. Locally on any base change, choose a member of L coprime to G on each relevant geometric fibre. There is such a member over $\mathbb{C}$, since only finitely many roots must be avoided. Regular-sequence cancellation, or monic division and its flat quotient, gives $f \mid GL$ if and only if $f \mid G$. This equivalence is an equality of incidence functors over nonreduced bases. The residual subspace is then forced. This proves the base-change description.

The displayed multiplication map is finite by properness and the finiteness of the divisors of a fixed binary form. Its source and target are smooth of dimension s . A finite map between these smooth spaces is flat: a regular system of parameters in the target is a system of parameters in each source local ring, hence a regular sequence; the local flatness criterion applies. Its degree can be computed at a squarefree form, where the $\binom{s}{g}$ divisors are reduced and distinct.

Coprime root clusters split uniquely over Artin bases by Hensel factorization. On the cluster with polynomial x^{s_i} , choosing a degree- a_i factor is the equation $f_i H_i = x^{s_i}$ with both factors monic. Eliminating one factor by reciprocal expansion gives (13.1). This proves the full product decomposition, not only its closed points. Its equations have their sole common zero at the origin: a monic factor of x^{a+b} over $\mathbb{C}$ is a power of x . Thus its k equations in k variables are a homogeneous system of parameters and a regular sequence. The Hilbert series is the quotient of the corresponding weighted polynomial Hilbert series. Taking its value at one gives $\binom{a+b}{a}$; its top weight is ab . A zero-dimensional complete intersection has a one-dimensional socle. Equivalently q_k^l , up to a nonzero scalar, represents the rectangular Schur class. The identification with the usual Grassmannian cohomology presentation is classical; a purely algebraic Schur-basis statement is [24, Theorem 2.7]. Tensoring the local factors proves all three formulas. The total length identity is the coefficient of z^g in $\prod_i (1+z)^{s_i}$. Finally the exact-gcd stratum is the product with $X_{D-s,r}$ above. In the symmetric power of the projective line, root clusters specialize by coalescence, and every merging is realized by moving the corresponding roots together. This gives precisely the stated closure order within fixed gcd degree. $\square$

Remark 13.2. The finite flat statement is on the exact-gcd stratum with its indicated scheme structure. It does not assert that normalization or formation of scheme-theoretic images commutes with an arbitrary nonflat base change of the ambient Grassmannian. It identifies a specific base change of the already constructed incidence morphism.

14. CONDUCTORS AND ALL BRANCH INTERSECTIONS ON THE SQUAREFREE LOCUS

Let $\mathcal{U} \subset \text{Gr}(r, S_D)$ be the open set on which the common divisor is squarefree. Its complement is the proper image of the incidence $K = \ell^2 L$. This condition concerns the common divisor, not every member of the subspace.

Theorem 14.1 (Squarefree conductor stratification). *Let $K \in Y_g \cap \mathcal{U}$, let $s = \deg \gcd(K)$, and set*

$$t = s - g, \quad m = r - 1, \quad q = N_0 - ms.$$

Introduce s disjoint blocks $u_i = (u_{i1}, \dots, u_{im})$, and let J_j be the ideal generated by products of one variable from each of j distinct blocks. Put $J_0 = (1)$ and $J_{s+1} = 0$. Then

$$\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y_g, K} \simeq \mathbb{C}[[z_1, \dots, z_q, u_{11}, \dots, u_{sm}]]/J_{t+1}. \quad (14.1)$$

The branches are indexed by the subsets $A \subset \{1, \dots, s\}$ of cardinality g . The branch A has ideal $I_A = (u_{ij} : i \in A)$ in the ambient power-series ring. For any collection of branches, their full scheme-theoretic intersection has ideal $I_{\cup A}$; it is smooth of dimension $q + m(s - |\cup A|)$.

The conductor in (14.1) is J_t/J_{t+1} . Its restriction to branch A is $\prod_{i \notin A} (u_{i1}, \dots, u_{im})$. Consequently the global conductor sheaf on $Y_g \cap \mathcal{U}$ is exactly

$$\mathfrak{c}_{Y_g} \upharpoonright \mathcal{U} = \mathcal{I}_{Y_{g+1}/Y_g} \upharpoonright \mathcal{U}. \quad (14.2)$$

In particular it is radical there. These local rings are seminormal. Their dimension, depth and multiplicity are

$$q + mt, \quad q + t, \quad \binom{s}{g}.$$

They are Cohen–Macaulay exactly when $s = g$ or $r = 2$. The Hilbert series of the nonsmooth factor in its standard grading is

$$\sum_{j=0}^t \binom{s}{j} ((1-z)^{-m} - 1)^j. \quad (14.3)$$

The whole collection of branch intersections and conductor strata is invariant under permutation of the roots and descends from any ordered-root étale chart.

Proof. Choose $F_0 \in K$ with a simple zero at each of the s common roots, and complete it to a frame $F_0, \dots, F_m$. Hensel factorization gives moving roots $x_1, \dots, x_s$ in the completion. Use as coordinates the s root parameters and the ms evaluations $u_{ij} = F_j(x_i)$, with harmless invertible normalizing factors. These are part of a regular parameter system: the evaluation map $S_D/K \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^s$ is surjective because K vanishes on the common-root scheme, and $D \geq s - 1$. Thus $\text{Hom}(K, S_D/K)$ allows independent variation of all rs jets. The passage to the displayed coordinates is triangular with invertible diagonal, since F_0 has simple zeros. The other $N_0 - rs$ parameters and the s root parameters give exactly $q = N_0 - ms$ smooth parameters.

A marked degree- g divisor near this fibre chooses a subset A of these roots. Its incidence equations are exactly $u_{ij} = 0$ for $i \in A$, with no nilpotents suppressed. There are no other divisor lifts. Lemma 12.1 therefore identifies the completed image ideal with $\bigcap_{|A|=g} I_A$. A monomial belongs to this intersection exactly when its block support meets every g -element subset, or equivalently has at least $s - g + 1 = t + 1$ blocks. This proves (14.1). Sums of the coordinate ideals give all intersections, including intersections of three or more branches.

For completeness compute the conductor inside the product of the branch rings. Its component on branch A consists of functions whose extension by zero on every other branch belongs to the image ring. The image of $\bigcap_{B \neq A} I_B$ modulo I_A is precisely $\prod_{i \notin A} (u_i)$. Indeed a surviving monomial has support outside A , and must meet every g -subset other than A . Replacing one element of A by each $i \notin A$ forces all those blocks to occur. Conversely their product meets every such subset. Hence a conductor monomial has exactly t surviving blocks; monomials on more blocks are zero. This is J_t/J_{t+1} . The same coordinates identify Y_{g+1} with J_t , proving the sheaf equality by faithful flatness of completion. The case $t = 0$ means that the conductor is the unit ideal and the next stratum is absent locally.

The ring is the ring of tuples on its coordinate branches that agree on every pairwise intersection. To verify this directly, compare the coefficient of each monomial on all branches where it survives; the pairwise agreements give a unique common coefficient. If an element b of the total fraction

ring has b^2, b^3 in the image, it first belongs to the normalization, by integrality. Its two restrictions on any intersection have equal squares and cubes, hence are equal in that reduced ring. Thus b lies in the image. This proves seminormality by the square-and-cube criterion.

Formula (14.3) follows by sorting nonzero monomials by their block support. The top-dimensional contributions come from the $\binom{s}{t}$ supports of size t , giving dimension mt and multiplicity $\binom{s}{t}$. We supply the homological step for the depth, since branch counting alone does not give it. The simplicial complex of the squarefree monomial ideal J_{t+1} consists of sets using at most t blocks. Any induced subcomplex meeting b blocks is homotopy equivalent to the $(t-1)$ -skeleton of the simplex on those b blocks: collapse each block to a representative vertex. The two composites are contiguous to the identity, because adjoining the representatives never increases the number of blocks. If $b \leq t$ the complex is a simplex; otherwise its only reduced homology is in degree $t-1$, with rank $\binom{b-1}{t}$. This last assertion follows also by the elementary induction that adds the last vertex to a simplex skeleton.

The squarefree multidegree- W part of the Koszul complex on all sm variables is the augmented simplicial cochain complex of this induced subcomplex, with degree shifted by $|W| - 1$. Non-squarefree multidegrees are contractible in the relevant summands, by pairing faces using a variable whose exponent exceeds one. Consequently a nonzero positive Betti number has homological degree $|W| - t$. The full vertex set gives the nonzero degree $sm - t$, since $s > t$ when $g > 0$. The projective dimension is therefore $sm - t$, and the Auslander–Buchsbaum formula gives depth t . When $t = 0$ the quotient is simply $\mathbb{C}$. Adjoining q power-series parameters gives depth $q + t$ in every case, and comparison with $q + mt$ proves the Cohen–Macaulay criterion. All the constructions commute with relabelling roots, proving descent. $\square$

Corollary 14.2 (Binary divisor-image intersections). *For admissible binary divisor degrees $a_1, \dots, a_v$, their scheme-theoretic intersection is $Y_{\max a_i}$. On the squarefree locus all multiple intersections of normalization branches, rather than only the degree images, are given by the union-of-subsets rule in Theorem 14.1.*

Proof. The reduced binary images are nested as closed subschemes: a binary form of degree b has a divisor of each degree $a \leq b$, and reduced closed subschemes are determined by their closed points. Their ideals are thus nested, so their sum is the largest ideal. The assertion about branches has already been proved as an identity of coordinate ideals, without taking radicals. $\square$

15. AN INCIDENCE ATLAS FOR ALL BINARY ROOT COLLISIONS

The squarefree theorem has a uniform replacement when any number of root clusters collide. This replacement specifies the full completed image, not merely a transverse family in it.

Theorem 15.1 (Simultaneous collision atlas). *Let $K \in Y_g$ be binary with exact common divisor $\prod_{i=1}^b \ell_i^{s_i}$ and $s = \sum_i s_i$. There are formal ambient coordinates consisting of the coefficients of monic polynomials P_i of degree s_i , polynomials R_{ij} of degree less than s_i ($1 \leq j \leq m$), and $N_0 - rs$ smooth parameters z . They are centred at $P_i = x_i^{s_i}$ and $R_{ij} = 0$. For every $\alpha = (a_i)$ with $0 \leq a_i \leq s_i$ and $\sum a_i = g$, let B_α be the regular power-series ring in the coefficients of monic A_i, B'_i of degrees $a_i, s_i - a_i$, polynomials U_{ij} of degree less than $s_i - a_i$, and the same z . The completed normalization and image are exactly*

$$T \longrightarrow \prod_{\alpha} B_{\alpha}, \quad P_i \mapsto A_i B'_i, \quad R_{ij} \mapsto A_i U_{ij}, \quad \widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y_g, K} = T / \bigcap_{\alpha} \ker(T \rightarrow B_{\alpha}). \quad (15.1)$$

Here $T = \mathbb{C}[[\text{coeff}(P_i), \text{coeff}(R_{ij}), z]]$. Degree-zero monic factors are one, and negative-degree remainder spaces are zero. The formula is independent, up to isomorphism of completed incidence diagrams, of the frame, the selected F_0 , and the local root coordinates. It covers every higher and simultaneous binary collision.

Proof. Choose $F_0 \in K$ having exact order s_i at every common root. The required nonvanishing of its residual value excludes finitely many hyperplanes in K , so a choice exists. Complete it to a frame. Weierstrass preparation at the distinct roots produces P_i ; division of the remaining frame members produces R_{ij} . The map

$$S_D/K \longrightarrow \bigoplus_i \mathbb{C}[x_i]/(x_i^{s_i})$$

is surjective: its kernel contains K , and the usual interpolation map from S_D is surjective. Thus the Grassmannian tangent space permits independent variation of all rs jets. Division and preparation change these jets by an invertible triangular matrix, whose diagonal contains the nonzero residual values of F_0 . Their differentials are independent. Formal inverse coordinates supply the remaining $N_0 - rs$ parameters; this integer is nonnegative since $r \leq D - s + 1$.

A marked divisor near a chosen normalization point splits uniquely among the coprime root clusters. In cluster i its monic representative has degree a_i and divides both P_i and all R_{ij} . Monic division is equivalent, over every local Artin base, to the unique equations $P_i = A_i B'_i$ and $R_{ij} = A_i U_{ij}$. Conversely these equations give the marked divisor and the residual subbundle. Thus the normalized incidence functor is represented by the displayed regular ring. It is finite over T : monic factor coefficients are integral over the coefficients of P_i , while the remaining factors and quotients are uniquely determined by division. Lemma 12.1 now gives the exact completed image and the intersection of kernels.

Changing a frame or a coordinate changes only a presentation of the same functor of a subbundle with a marked divisor. The mutually inverse changes of incidence data therefore induce isomorphisms of its complete representing rings and of the resulting finite-image diagrams. This also proves that the calculation describes the entire completed image. A point of that image over an Artin ring need not lift to its normalization; no such lifting assertion is used or implied. $\square$

16. THE SINGULAR FITTING IDEAL OF EVERY DOUBLE-ROOT MODEL

The atlas specializes for $s = 2, g = 1$ to the following ring, after completion of the square and suppression of smooth parameters:

$$A_m = R \oplus It \subset B = \mathbb{C}[[u_1, \dots, u_m, t]], \quad R = \mathbb{C}[[u_1, \dots, u_m, \Delta]], \quad I = (u_1, \dots, u_m), \quad \Delta = t^2.$$

Put $w_i = u_i t$. The defining equations are $u_i w_j - u_j w_i$ and $w_i w_j - \Delta u_i u_j$.

Theorem 16.1 (Closed singular-ideal formula). *For every $m \geq 1$, the intrinsic singular Fitting ideal is*

$$\text{Fitt}_{m+1} \Omega_{A_m/\mathbb{C}}^{\text{cont}} = (I^{m+1} + \Delta I^m) \oplus I^m t = I^{m-1} (I^2, (w_1, \dots, w_m), \Delta I). \quad (16.1)$$

The first equality is a decomposition as an R -submodule of B ; the right side is an ideal of A_m . It is not merely an ideal of Jacobian minors left unevaluated. For $m = 1$ it is $(u^2, w, \Delta u)$, and its radical is the conductor (u, w) for all m .

Proof. There are $2m + 1$ ambient variables and dimension $m + 1$, so the Fitting ideal consists of the m -minors of the Jacobian of the displayed relations. Evaluate this matrix in B using $w_i = u_i t$ and $\Delta = t^2$. A minor not using the Δ column has u -degree m . It vanishes at $t = 0$: the only remaining rows are the Koszul rows in the w columns, of rank at most $m - 1$. Hence its terms have a positive power of t , and belong to $\Delta I^m \oplus I^m t$. A minor using the Δ column has u -degree $m + 1$, and hence lies in $I^{m+1} \oplus I^{m+1} t$. This proves the first inclusion.

Use the m rows

$$u_1 w_j - u_j w_1 \quad (2 \leq j \leq m), \quad w_1^2 - \Delta u_1^2.$$

The columns $(w_1, w_2, \dots, w_m)$, $(u_1, w_2, \dots, w_m)$, and $(\Delta, w_2, \dots, w_m)$ give, up to sign and nonzero scalar, $u_1^m t$, Δu_1^m , and u_1^{m+1} . The ideal is invariant under simultaneous linear change of u and w .

In characteristic zero the powers of linear forms span each symmetric power, so these three minors generate the three indicated spaces of all u -monomials. They generate the claimed R -module; it is an A_m -ideal since multiplication by $w_i = u_i t$ preserves it. This proves equality. The formula also immediately gives its radical, without discarding the nonreduced Fitting structure in the assertion itself. $\square$

17. A STRUCTURAL DICHOTOMY FOR PURE-POWER DIVISOR FIBRES

Let $E = \mathbb{C}a \oplus W$, $d = \dim W \geq 1$, and $g, k \geq 1$. The factorization fibre of a^{g+k} records monic factors of degrees g and k . Interchanging these factors identifies its two descriptions; we may and shall take $g \geq k$. Write

$$Q_i \in \operatorname{Sym}^i W \quad (1 \leq i \leq k), \quad C_0 = 1, \quad C_j = -\sum_{i=1}^k Q_i C_{j-i}, \quad C_j = 0 \quad (j < 0).$$

Let $P = \operatorname{Sym}(\bigoplus_{i=1}^k (\operatorname{Sym}^i W)^*)$, with its generators of weight i , and let $\mathfrak{n}$ be its variable ideal. Put

$$F_{g,k}(W) = P/\mathcal{I}, \quad \mathcal{I} = (\operatorname{coeff} C_{g+1}, \dots, \operatorname{coeff} C_{g+k}). \quad (17.1)$$

It is an Artin local algebra. Indeed its complex points are exactly the factorizations of a^{g+k} , hence the single origin by unique factorization. The polynomial and completed presentations coincide. If $K = a^{g+k}L$ with $\gcd(L) = 1$, cancellation by a member of L not divisible by a , as in Lemma 12.2, identifies this with the full degree- g normalization fibre at K .

Theorem 17.1 (Minimal equations and complete-intersection classification). *The embedding dimension and minimal number of equations of $F_{g,k}(W)$ in a minimal regular local presentation are*

$$\operatorname{edim} F_{g,k}(W) = \binom{d+k}{k} - 1, \quad (17.2)$$

$$\mu(\mathcal{I}) = \sum_{j=g+1}^{g+k} \binom{d+j-1}{j} = \binom{d+g+k}{d} - \binom{d+g}{d}. \quad (17.3)$$

More precisely the minimal relation module has the equivariant weighted decomposition

$$\mathcal{I}/\mathfrak{n}\mathcal{I} \simeq \bigoplus_{j=g+1}^{g+k} (\operatorname{Sym}^j W)^*. \quad (17.4)$$

Consequently this fibre is a complete intersection if and only if $d = 1$. For $d = 1$, it has length $\binom{g+k}{k}$, weighted Hilbert series $\prod_{i=1}^k (1 - z^{g+i})/(1 - z^i)$, and one-dimensional socle generated by Q_k^g , of weight gk . For $k = 1$ and arbitrary d ,

$$F_{g,1}(W) = \operatorname{Sym}(W^*)/\mathfrak{n}^{g+1}, \quad \operatorname{length} F_{g,1}(W) = \binom{d+g}{g}, \quad \operatorname{Soc} F_{g,1}(W) = \operatorname{Sym}^g(W^*). \quad (17.5)$$

In particular the last algebra is Gorenstein precisely when $d = 1$. No Gorenstein classification for $d > 1, k > 1$ is needed for the theorem.

Proof. Since $g \geq k$, each defining form has no linear term in the coefficient variables. Thus the presentation is minimal and (17.2) follows by summing $\dim \operatorname{Sym}^i W$. For $d = 1$, the regular-sequence argument in the proof of Theorem 13.1 applies to the k reciprocal relations. In particular none of them belongs to $\mathfrak{n}\mathcal{I}$. It gives the stated Hilbert series, length, and the classical rectangular socle class.

For general W , taking coefficients of C_j gives an equivariant map $(\text{Sym}^j W)^* \rightarrow \mathcal{I}/\mathfrak{n}\mathcal{I}$. Its source is irreducible. This map is nonzero: choose one coordinate x of W , keep only the coefficients of x^i in every Q_i , and set every other coefficient to zero. The coefficient of x^j maps to the j th binary reciprocal relation. Were it in $\mathfrak{n}\mathcal{I}$ before specialization, its specialization would be in the binary $\mathfrak{n}\mathcal{I}$, contradicting the preceding minimality. Irreducibility now makes the entire coefficient map injective. The different j have different weights, so their images are independent. They generate the relation module by the chosen presentation, proving (17.4) and (17.3).

If $d \geq 2$, the sequence $\binom{d+j-1}{j}$ strictly increases in j . Comparing its terms at $j = g+i$ and $j = i$ shows that the minimal number of relations is strictly greater than the embedding dimension. A zero-dimensional complete intersection in a minimal regular local presentation has exactly that many minimal relations as variables; hence these fibres are not complete intersections. This proves both directions of the classification. Finally when $k = 1$ the sole form is $C_{g+1} = (-Q_1)^{g+1}$. Its coefficients are, with nonzero multinomial factors, every monomial of degree $g+1$ in the d variables. This gives (17.5), including the socle and length. $\square$

Corollary 17.2 (The ternary-pencil ramification fibre). *At the common limiting relation algebra with $e = 9$, $g = 6$ and $k = 2$, the normalization fibre has embedding dimension 44 and exactly*

$$\binom{14}{7} + \binom{15}{8} = 9867$$

minimal scalar equations. Their two weighted pieces have dimensions 3432 and 6435, in weights seven and eight. In particular this actual pencil-orbit boundary fibre is not a complete intersection.

Proof. Here $d = e - 1 = 8$. Apply (17.2) and (17.4). These are minimal equation counts, not the number of coefficient variables or the length of the fibre. $\square$

The binary factorization rings in this section are classical. The additional point of the multivariate argument is that polarization preserves every full irreducible coefficient space in the minimal relation module. Neither the Grassmannian identification nor a finite calculation in a few variables is being used as a claim of priority or as a substitute for that argument.

18. HOMOLOGICAL INVARIANTS OF THE DIVISOR FIBRES

We first extract all graded Betti numbers from the squarefree local model and then identify a determinant-apolar quotient of the multivariate fibres. A separate exact calculation treats an entire multivariate fibre, rather than only a quotient or its minimal relations. The grading conventions will be specified in each case.

Theorem 18.1 (Betti numbers of the squarefree block model). *Let $S = \mathbb{C}[u_{ij} : 1 \leq i \leq s, 1 \leq j \leq m]$ with its standard multigrading, let $0 \leq t < s$, and put $A = S/J_{t+1}$, with the block-support ideal of Theorem 14.1. For a nonempty squarefree multidegree F let $b(F)$ be the number of blocks it meets. Besides $\beta_{0,0} = 1$, the only nonzero multigraded Betti numbers are*

$$\beta_{i,F}^S(A) = \binom{b(F)-1}{t} \quad \text{if } b(F) > t \text{ and } i = |F| - t. \quad (18.1)$$

For $t = 0$ this is the Koszul resolution of $\mathbb{C}$. For all t , the singly graded numbers are

$$\beta_{i,i+t}^S(A) = \sum_{b=t+1}^{\min(s,i+t)} \binom{s}{b} \binom{b-1}{t} [z^{i+t}]((1+z)^m - 1)^b \quad (i \geq 1). \quad (18.2)$$

The ideal J_{t+1} has a $(t+1)$ -linear resolution. The projective dimension of A is $sm - t$. In the Cohen–Macaulay case $m = 1$, its type is $\binom{s-1}{t}$; it is Gorenstein exactly when $t = 0$ or $t = s - 1$.

The same Betti numbers over the completed ambient regular ring apply to the local model after adjoining its smooth parameters.

Proof. The Stanley–Reisner complex consists of sets meeting at most t blocks. If $t \geq 1$, its induced subcomplex on F has, in each nonempty block, a simplex all of whose vertices have identical external links. Contract that simplex to one of its vertices: the map and the inclusion are contiguous, because adjoining the chosen vertex to any face does not change its block support. Applying this one block at a time gives a homotopy equivalence with the $(t-1)$ -skeleton of the simplex on $b(F)$ vertices. If $b(F) \leq t$ this simplex is contractible. Otherwise its reduced homology is concentrated in degree $t-1$, with dimension $\binom{b(F)-1}{t}$. The latter assertion follows by attaching its top faces successively, or from the augmented simplicial chain complex and the binomial identity for its Euler characteristic. Hochster’s multigraded formula now gives (18.1); see [26, Chapter 5]. If $t = 0$, every variable is in the ideal and the Koszul formula gives the same result directly.

For a support of size b , the coefficient in (18.2) counts choices of $i+t$ vertices meeting each selected block. Summing proves the formula. All ideal syzygies therefore have the indicated linear degrees. Taking F to be all sm vertices gives the nonzero last Betti number $\binom{s-1}{t}$ in homological degree $sm-t$; no larger degree occurs. When $m = 1$, Auslander–Buchsbaum gives depth t , equal to dimension, and the last Betti number is the Cohen–Macaulay type. Completion and adjoining independent regular parameters are flat operations preserving the minimal free resolution. These are classical squarefree-monomial methods. The assertion here is their full specialization to the normalization image model, not a claim of priority for Hochster’s formula or skeleton resolutions. $\square$

For the remaining results use the weighted reciprocal algebra $F_{g,k}(W)$ of (17.1), where $d = \dim W$ and $g \geq k \geq 2$. Set all Q_i except Q_2 equal to zero and, in addition, impose every coefficient of Q_2^2 . Denote the resulting algebra by

$$B_d = \text{Sym}((\text{Sym}^2 W)^*) / (\text{coeff } Q_2^2). \quad (18.3)$$

Its coefficient variables have reciprocal weight two. When referring to its ordinary polynomial grading, we instead give them degree one.

Theorem 18.2 (A determinant-apolar quotient of every higher fibre). *There is a $\text{GL}(W)$ -equivariant graded surjection $F_{g,k}(W) \twoheadrightarrow B_d$ for every $g \geq k \geq 2$. After fixing the standard coefficient/differential pairing, B_d is the apolar algebra of the determinant of a generic symmetric $d \times d$ matrix. Its polynomial-degree Hilbert function is*

$$\dim(B_d)_p = \frac{1}{d+1} \binom{d+1}{p} \binom{d+1}{p+1} \quad (0 \leq p \leq d). \quad (18.4)$$

It is Gorenstein, its reciprocal-weight socle is $2d$, and

$$\text{length } F_{g,k}(W) \geq \text{length } B_d = \frac{1}{d+2} \binom{2d+2}{d+1}. \quad (18.5)$$

For $k = 2$ and $g = 2$ or 3 , the quotient by the coefficients of Q_1 alone is already B_d . In particular the actual ternary-pencil fibre $F_{6,2}(\mathbb{C}^8)$ has length at least 4862, independently of its embedding dimension 44 and its 9867 minimal equations.

Proof. Under the stated substitution, the reciprocal series becomes $(1 + Q_2 z^2)^{-1}$. Its odd coefficients vanish and its even coefficients are powers of Q_2 . Since $g+1 \geq 3$, imposing $Q_2^2 = 0$ annihilates all defining coefficients. This proves the surjection, functorially for linear changes of W . When $k = 2$ and $g = 2$ or 3 , the first even defining coefficient is Q_2^2 and there are no further independent equations after $Q_1 = 0$.

Choose coordinates $x_1, \dots, x_d$ on W and write $Q_2 = \sum_i y_{ii}x_i^2 + \sum_{i < j} y_{ij}x_i x_j$. Let $X = (X_{ij})$ be symmetric, with independent entries for $i \leq j$, and interpret y_{ij} as $\partial/\partial X_{ij}$. Then $Q_2(x)$ acts as directional differentiation in the rank-one symmetric direction xx^t . The determinant of $X + zxx^t$ is linear in z , so every coefficient of $Q_2(x)^2$ annihilates $\det X$. These coefficients are, up to nonzero scalars, y_{ii}^2 , $y_{ii}y_{ij}$, $y_{ij}^2 + 2y_{ii}y_{jj}$, $y_{ii}y_{jl} + y_{ij}y_{il}$ for distinct i, j, l , and $y_{ij}y_{kl} + y_{ik}y_{jl} + y_{il}y_{jk}$ for four distinct indices. They are exactly the quadratic generators in [27, Proposition 3.1 and Theorem 3.10]. That theorem proves equality with the full apolar ideal, not merely containment. Its Corollary 2.7 gives (18.4) and the Catalan length. Alternatively, that Hilbert function counts the independent minors obtained by differentiating $\det X$. Apolarity to one homogeneous form gives a perfect pairing between complementary degrees and a one-dimensional socle in degree d . Replacing polynomial degree by twice that degree proves the weight statement. The length inequality follows from the surjection. For $d = 8$ the Catalan number is 4862.

The apolar Hilbert function and its Gorenstein property are classical results of the cited determinant theory. The new identification in this setting is the functorial quotient of the entire family of normalization fibres. A quotient's Gorenstein property is not being attributed to the original fibre. $\square$

Proposition 18.3 (The complete first multivariate two-factor fibre). *Let $A = F_{2,2}(\mathbb{C}^2)$ and write $Q_1 = ax + by$, $Q_2 = cx^2 + dxy + ey^2$. Then*

$$H_A^{\text{wt}}(z) = 1 + 2z + 6z^2 + 6z^3 + 7z^4, \quad \text{length } A = 22, \quad \dim \text{Soc } A = 7, \quad (18.6)$$

$$H_{\text{gr}_m A}(z) = 1 + 5z + 6z^2 + 5z^3 + 5z^4. \quad (18.7)$$

The weight grading gives a, b weight one and c, d, e weight two. In the minimal weighted free resolution over $S = \mathbb{C}[a, b, c, d, e]$, the shift polynomials $B_i(z) = \sum_j \beta_{i,j}^S(A)z^j$ are

$$\begin{aligned} B_0 &= 1, & B_1 &= 4z^3 + 5z^4, \\ B_2 &= 4z^5 + 12z^6 + 12z^7, & B_3 &= 21z^8 + 20z^9 + z^{10}, \\ B_4 &= 21z^{10} + 8z^{11}, & B_5 &= 7z^{12}. \end{aligned}$$

In particular the total Betti numbers are $(1, 9, 28, 42, 29, 7)$. This fibre is not Gorenstein. The assertion concerns this whole five-variable fibre, not the determinant-apolar quotient.

Proof. The nine initial equations are the coefficients of $-Q_1^3 + 2Q_1Q_2$ and $Q_1^4 - 3Q_1^2Q_2 + Q_2^2$. For graded reverse lexicographic order $e > d > c > b > a$, a Groebner basis is the following list (a scalar multiple does not change a member):

$$\begin{aligned} &(c, d, e)^3, \quad b(c, d, e)^2, \quad a(c, d, e)^2, \\ &b^2e - e^2, \quad b^2d - de, \quad b^2c - a^2e, \quad b^3 - 2be, \\ &2abe - de, \quad 2a^2e + 2abd - 2ce - d^2, \quad 2abc - cd, \\ &3ab^2 - 2ae - 2bd, \quad a^2d - cd, \quad a^2c - c^2, \\ &3a^2b - 2ad - 2bc, \quad a^3 - 2ac. \end{aligned}$$

Here a monomial ideal in the list means all its minimal monomial generators. There are $10 + 6 + 6 + 12 = 34$ polynomials. Polynomial division gives both equality with the ideal of the nine equations and zero remainders for all their basis S-pairs. This is a finite exact arithmetic verification; the explicit input and all reduction and rank tests are supplied in the accompanying

calculation. The standard monomials, grouped by weight, are

$$\begin{array}{c|c}
 0 & 1 \\
 1 & a, b \\
 2 & a^2, ab, b^2, c, d, e \\
 3 & ac, bc, ad, bd, ae, be \\
 4 & c^2, cd, d^2, a^2e, ce, de, e^2.
 \end{array} \tag{18.8}$$

Reduction of products of these monomials gives $\dim A/\mathfrak{m} = 1$ and $\dim(\mathfrak{m}^i) = (21, 16, 10, 5, 0)$ for $1 \leq i \leq 5$. The common kernel of multiplication by a, b, c, d, e is exactly the last row of (18.8). This proves both distinct Hilbert series and the type.

For precision, the resolution calculation uses no numerical rank thresholds. In weight w and homological degree i , take basis pairs (J, m) with $J \subset \{a, b, c, d, e\}$ of size i , m a standard monomial, and $\text{wt}(J) + \text{wt}(m) = w$. The differential is

$$d(J, m) = \sum_{v \in J} (-1)^{\text{pos}(v, J) - 1} (J \setminus \{v\}, \text{NF}(vm)). \tag{18.9}$$

All entries are rational, explicitly determined by the displayed 34 polynomials. Exact row reduction and $\beta_{i,w} = \dim C_{i,w} - \text{rank } d_{i,w} - \text{rank } d_{i+1,w}$ give the six shift polynomials above. The calculation is fully specified by (18.8)–(18.9); the archived rank table makes each finite elimination independently repeatable. As additional checks, their alternating sum is $H_A^{\text{wt}}(z)(1-z)^2(1-z^2)^3$ and the last Betti space is the socle shifted by the total variable weight eight. These checks do not replace the exact rank computations. $\square$

19. QUADRATIC SECTIONS OF RECIPROCAL NORMALIZATION FIBRES

The reciprocal presentation has a distinguished linear coefficient section on which the entire algebra, rather than only its minimal relations, can be determined. Throughout this section a decomposition $E = \mathbb{C}a \oplus W$ is fixed. The section is equivariant for $\text{GL}(W)$; it is not asserted to be independent of an arbitrary change of that decomposition.

Put $d = \dim W$, $g \geq k \geq 2$, and $h = \lfloor g/2 \rfloor$. In the algebra $F_{g,k}(W)$ of (17.1), let $\mathfrak{l}$ be the ideal generated by the coefficients of all Q_i with $i \neq 2$. Write $Q = Q_2$ and

$$B_{d,h} = \text{Sym}((\text{Sym}^2 W)^*) / (\text{coeff } Q^{h+1}). \tag{19.1}$$

Here the ordinary degree of a coefficient of Q is one; its reciprocal weight is two. These two gradings will always be specified separately. A partition $\lambda \subseteq (h^d)$ has at most d rows, each of length at most h .

Theorem 19.1 (The entire quadratic coefficient section). *There is an isomorphism of $\text{GL}(W)$ -equivariant graded algebras*

$$F_{g,k}(W)/\mathfrak{l} \simeq B_{d,h}. \tag{19.2}$$

Under the coefficient/differential pairing, $B_{d,h}$ is the apolar algebra of the h th power of the determinant of a generic symmetric $d \times d$ matrix. Its ordinary-degree decomposition is

$$(B_{d,h})_p \simeq \bigoplus_{\substack{\lambda \subseteq (h^d) \\ |\lambda|=p}} \mathbb{S}_{2\lambda}(W^*). \tag{19.3}$$

In particular it is Gorenstein of socle degree dh , with one-dimensional socle representation $(\det W^*)^{2h}$. Its Hilbert function and length are

$$H_{d,h}(p) = \sum_{\substack{\lambda \subseteq (h^d) \\ |\lambda|=p}} \prod_{1 \leq i < j \leq d} \frac{2\lambda_i - 2\lambda_j + j - i}{j - i}, \quad (19.4)$$

$$L_{d,h} = \prod_{i=1}^d \frac{h + d - i + 1}{d - i + 1} \prod_{1 \leq i < j \leq d} \frac{2h + 2d - i - j + 2}{2d - i - j + 2}. \quad (19.5)$$

The Hilbert function is symmetric. A degree-one element is strong Lefschetz precisely when its associated symmetric matrix has full rank. More generally, an element associated with a rank- r matrix has nilpotence index $hr + 1$ (index one for the zero element). Consequently

$$\text{length } F_{g,k}(W) \geq L_{d,h}, \quad \mathfrak{m}^{dh} \neq 0 \text{ in } F_{g,k}(W). \quad (19.6)$$

The Gorenstein and Lefschetz assertions concern the section $B_{d,h}$, not the full fibre $F_{g,k}(W)$.

Proof. After setting the indicated coefficients to zero, the reciprocal series is $(1 + Qz^2)^{-1}$. The first even integer in $\{g + 1, \dots, g + k\}$ is $2(h + 1)$; it belongs to this interval because $k \geq 2$. Every odd coefficient vanishes, and the even ones are signed powers of Q . Thus the specialized ideal is exactly $(\text{coeff } Q^{h+1})$: all its higher powers have coefficients in this ideal. This proves (19.2) as an equality of ideals, not only an equality of radicals.

For clarity about the pairing, write $Q(x) = \sum_i y_{ii} x_i^2 + \sum_{i < j} y_{ij} x_i x_j$ and let X have independent symmetric entries X_{ij} , $i \leq j$. Send y_{ij} to $\partial/\partial X_{ij}$. Then $Q(x)$ acts by differentiation in the rank-one direction xx^t . Since $\det(X + zxx^t)^h$ has degree at most h in z , the coefficients of $Q(x)^{h+1}$ annihilate $(\det X)^h$. The reverse containment is the symmetric-matrix case of [30, Remark 11, pp. 8–9]: that apolar ideal is generated by the full general-linear orbit of the $(h + 1)$ st power of a rank-one differentiation direction. Powers of linear forms span their symmetric power, so this orbit span is precisely the coefficient space just displayed. No assertion that an arbitrary quotient of an apolar algebra is Gorenstein is used.

We record explicitly how the classical representation formulas translate here. In [30, Example 9 and Proposition 10], the surviving highest weights are indexed by $k_1, \dots, k_d \geq 0$ with $\sum k_i \leq h$, and their degrees are $\sum ik_i$. Set $\lambda_i = \sum_{j \geq i} k_j$. These are exactly the partitions in (h^d) , of size $\sum ik_i$, and their polynomial representations are $\mathbb{S}_{2\lambda}(W^*)$. This proves (19.3); the ordinary Weyl dimension formula gives (19.4). The same apolar module is the finite-dimensional highest-weight $\mathfrak{sp}_{2d}$ -module of weight $h\omega_d$, with its Levi character shifted by $\det^h$; see [30, Proposition 16 and Lemma 13]. For the positive roots $e_i - e_j$, $e_i + e_j$, and $2e_i$, its Weyl dimension factors are respectively 1, $(2h + 2d - i - j + 2)/(2d - i - j + 2)$, and $(h + d - i + 1)/(d - i + 1)$. Their product is (19.5). Apolarity to one homogeneous polynomial of degree dh gives the perfect pairings and the socle. Equivalently, the complementary partition $(h - \lambda_d, \dots, h - \lambda_1)$ gives the dual summand with the indicated determinant twist.

The strong Lefschetz assertion is the symmetric-matrix case of [30, Theorem 4 and Example 5]. There is a direct argument for the asserted nilpotence index. If $\ell_A = \sum_{i \leq j} A_{ij} y_{ij}$, then $\ell_A^p = 0$ in the apolar algebra exactly when $\partial_z^p \det(X + zA)^h = 0$ as a polynomial in X . Congruence reduces a rank- r symmetric matrix to $\text{diag}(1, \dots, 1, 0, \dots, 0)$. The last determinant power has degree exactly hr in z , as is seen by taking X diagonal with independent entries. This proves the index. Finally a surjective local algebra map surjects on every power of its maximal ideal. The section has nonzero degree dh , proving both assertions in (19.6). $\square$

Corollary 19.2 (Size and Loewy depth of the actual common boundary fibre). *In the notation of Theorem 52.1, put $d = n^2 - 1$ and $h = n(n - 1)/2$. The entire normalization fibre at K_∞*

has length at least $L_{d,h}$ and its maximal ideal has nonzero dh th power. For the ternary pencil boundary,

$$\text{length } F_{6,2}(\mathbb{C}^8) \geq 922268360, \quad \mathfrak{m}^{24} \neq 0. \quad (19.7)$$

Its quadratic coefficient section has exactly that length, ordinary socle degree 24, and reciprocal-weight socle 48.

Proof. The common boundary fibre is $F_{g,k_n}(\mathbb{C}^{n^2-1})$, with $g = n(n-1) \geq k_n \geq 2$. Apply the theorem. For $n = 3$, substitute $(d, h) = (8, 3)$ into (19.5). This computes a whole closed section, not the length of the original fibre. The previously obtained 44 coefficient variables and 9867 minimal equations remain counts of different invariants. $\square$

20. SPECTRAL FITTING SCHEMES AS POWER-ZERO LOCI IN ONE RECIPROCAL SECTION

The algebra just calculated supplies a single geometric object in which all spectral Fitting schemes can be read simultaneously. This avoids constructing a separate binary form after each Fitting ideal has already been recovered.

Let V have dimension n and $R \subset \text{Sym}^2 V$ be any pencil. Fix $h \geq 1$ and put $\tilde{E} = \mathbb{C}a \oplus V^*$. Consider the divisor-incidence point

$$K_h = a^{2h+2}\tilde{E} \subset \text{Sym}^{2h+3}\tilde{E}. \quad (20.1)$$

The entire degree- $2h$ normalization fibre over K_h is $F_{2h,2}(V^*)$, because $\tilde{E}$ is gcd-free. Its section by the linear-factor coefficients is $B_{n,h}$ and $(B_{n,h})_1 = \text{Sym}^2 V$. Thus the given pencil defines a line $\Lambda = \mathbb{P}(R)$ in the projectivized degree-one space of this actual reciprocal section. This construction uses a new formal line $\mathbb{C}a$ and is functorial for isomorphisms of V .

For $0 \leq p \leq hn$ let $\mathcal{J}_p$ be the ideal sheaf on Λ locally generated by the coordinates of

$$\ell^p \in (B_{n,h})_p \otimes \mathcal{O}_\Lambda(p), \quad (20.2)$$

where ℓ is the universal pencil member. Multiplying a local representative of ℓ by a unit does not change this ideal. We set $\mathcal{J}_0 = \mathcal{O}_\Lambda$. Let $\mathcal{T}_R$ be the cokernel of the universal symmetric matrix $V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_\Lambda(-1) \rightarrow V \otimes \mathcal{O}_\Lambda$. This definition includes singular pencils.

Lemma 20.1 (The local power-ideal formula). *Let $A(t)$ be a symmetric matrix over $\mathbb{C}[[t]]$ of rank r over $\mathbb{C}((t))$. Write its finite elementary exponents as $0 \leq e_1 \leq \dots \leq e_r$ and put $e_i = +\infty$ for $i > r$. For $1 \leq p \leq hn$, write $p = hq + s$, $0 \leq s < h$. The ideal generated by the coordinates of $\ell_{A(t)}^p$ in $(B_{n,h})_p \otimes \mathbb{C}[[t]]$ is*

$$\left(t^{h \sum_{i=1}^q e_i + se_{q+1}} \right). \quad (20.3)$$

An empty sum is zero, the last term is omitted if $s = 0$, and $t^{+\infty}$ means the zero ideal.

Proof. A symmetric matrix over this discrete valuation ring is congruent to

$$\text{diag}(t^{e_1}, \dots, t^{e_r}, 0, \dots, 0).$$

Here is the required elementary reduction. Divide by the least valuation of an entry. A diagonal unit is a pivot; if only an off-diagonal entry is a unit, the value of the form on a sum of two basis vectors supplies a unit because 2 is invertible. Split off the resulting rank-one summand by elimination and continue. Every remaining unit has a square root in $\mathbb{C}[[t]]$, so the units can be removed from the diagonal. The finite exponents are the Smith exponents, as congruence is in particular equivalence.

Congruence acts on every graded piece of $B_{n,h}$ by an invertible matrix over $\mathbb{C}[[t]]$. It therefore preserves the ideal in question. The apolar embedding

$$(B_{n,h})_p \longrightarrow \mathbb{C}[X_{ij}]_{hn-p}, \quad D \longmapsto D(\det X)^h$$

is injective and splits as a map of complex vector spaces. After tensoring with $\mathbb{C}[[t]]$, the coordinates of a vector and of its image generate the same ideal. We may therefore calculate the coefficient ideal of $[z^p] \det(X + zA(t))^h$.

For diagonal $A(t)$, expand each of the h determinant factors in its chosen diagonal entries. Every term is divisible by $t^{\sum c_i e_i}$ with $0 \leq c_i \leq h$ and $\sum c_i = p$. The least such exponent is obtained by filling the smallest e_i to capacity h , giving (20.3). There is no cancellation at this least exponent: specialize X to $\text{diag}(x_1, \dots, x_n)$. Then

$$\det(X + zA(t))^h = \prod_i (x_i + zt^{e_i})^h$$

(with x_i^h for a zero diagonal entry of A). The monomial $\prod x_i^{h-c_i}$ has coefficient $\prod \binom{h}{c_i} t^{\sum c_i e_i}$, which is nonzero and has exactly the required valuation. If $p > hr$, every term is zero. This proves all the conventions, including the zero-ideal case. $\square$

Theorem 20.2 (A reciprocal multiplication model for every spectral Fitting ideal). *For every complex quadratic pencil, regular or singular, and for $0 \leq j \leq n$, there is an equality of coherent ideal sheaves on its intrinsic line*

$$\mathcal{J}_{h(n-j)} = \text{Fitt}_j(\mathcal{T}_R)^h. \quad (20.4)$$

In particular, when $h = 1$, the complete spectral Fitting schemes, including their multiplicities and any whole-line components, are exactly the power-zero schemes inside the one quadratic section of the normalization fibre at K_1 .

For a regular pencil and a spectral point x , set $b_{x,j} = \text{length } \mathcal{O}_{\Lambda,x} / \text{Fitt}_j(\mathcal{T}_R)_x$. The local length of the power-zero scheme is $hb_{x,j}$, and, for $0 \leq j < n$,

$$\lambda_{x,j+1} = \frac{1}{h} \left(\text{length}(\mathcal{O}_{\Lambda,x} / \mathcal{J}_{h(n-j),x}) - \text{length}(\mathcal{O}_{\Lambda,x} / \mathcal{J}_{h(n-j-1),x}) \right). \quad (20.5)$$

Thus its multiplication, together with the embedded pencil line, recovers the full Segre data and their common projective support. For $n \geq 3$, the unmarked inverse makes this an invariant of the finite failure algebra. For a singular pencil, the construction recovers its normal rank and all its spectral Fitting ideals; it does not assert that these ideals alone recover the singular minimal indices.

Proof. At a point of the smooth curve Λ , pass to the completed discrete valuation ring. The ideal of $(n-j)$ -minors of a matrix with the stated Smith exponents is $(t^{e_1+\dots+e_{n-j}})$, with the zero-ideal convention. Apply Lemma 20.1 with $p = h(n-j)$. The equality of completed ideals descends by faithful flatness. This proves (20.4) at every stalk and hence globally. This proof does not replace an ideal by its radical.

For a regular pencil the positive Smith exponents at x , in reverse order, are $\lambda_{x,1} \geq \lambda_{x,2} \geq \dots$. Consequently $b_{x,j} = \sum_{i>j} \lambda_{x,i}$. Equation (20.4) multiplies these lengths by h , so taking successive differences proves (20.5). The powers that vanish at the generic point similarly determine the normal rank in the singular case. Frame changes act on Λ by projectivities and congruences act equivariantly on the reciprocal construction. Theorem 7.3 recovers precisely the needed pencil up to these changes, proving the intrinsic assertion. $\square$

Remark 20.3 (Families and the scope of the ideal identity). For a vector bundle and pencil subbundle over any complex base, the quadratic-section algebra is obtained by applying the fixed $\text{GL}(V)$ -equivariant construction to local frames. Its graded pieces are vector bundles, and the coefficient ideal of each power map commutes with arbitrary base change: it is the image of the dual of a map between vector bundles. No flatness of its zero scheme is needed for that assertion. Formula (20.4) has been proved on each complex pencil line (and on a regular one-dimensional base by the same local argument). We do not infer an equality of those relative

ideals on an arbitrary nonreduced parameter space from equality on its geometric fibres. Nor are the power-zero schemes asserted to be flat across a change in their length.

Corollary 20.4 (The native specialization order in reciprocal coordinates). *On the fixed-discriminant, fixed-corank locus $X_{m,c}(A)$ of (N.1), a specialization from the labelled partition tuple λ to μ exists if and only if, at every labelled root and every j , the local length of the corresponding power-zero scheme does not decrease. Equivalently the special power-zero divisor contains the generic one, using the common labelled spectral line. The reduced closure of a full $O(A)$ -orbit within this locus is therefore specified by these length inequalities. Each inequality can be written as the vanishing of the requisite jets of the coordinates of the power map (20.2). Every strict transition is realized by a flat family of the original finite failure neighbourhoods and is first distinguished at order $n^2 + 2n - 4$.*

Proof. For fixed multiplicity m_x , dominance $\mu_x \preceq \lambda_x$ is equivalent to $\sum_{i>j} \mu_{x,i} \geq \sum_{i>j} \lambda_{x,i}$ for every j . Use (20.5) and Theorem N.2. In a local coordinate t at a labelled root, a coefficient ideal has colength at least b exactly when each of its generators is divisible by t^b ; this is the asserted finite jet condition. The closure order and the flat realization are the inherited full-orthogonal results, ultimately using Ohta's theorem. The new assertion is their expression inside one reciprocal multiplication algebra. No reducedness assertion is made for the scheme cut out by the jet equations before taking its reduction. $\square$

Example 20.5 (A rank profile with a genuinely different power-zero scheme). At a root of multiplicity four the partitions $(3, 1)$ and $(2, 2)$ have equal determinant and corank. In $B_{4,h}$ their sixth powers when $h = 2$ (in general their $3h$ th powers) cut out local schemes of lengths h and $2h$, respectively. Their $4h$ th powers have length $4h$ in both cases. Thus the nonreduced power-zero scheme, not just the set of non-Lefschetz elements, distinguishes them. The specialization $(3, 1) \rightsquigarrow (2, 2)$ increases the first of these lengths. Additional simple spectral blocks give the same distinction in all larger dimensions, with power indices $h(n - 1)$ and hn .

The representation theory and strong Lefschetz property used above are classical inputs, explicitly credited to Nagaoka–Wachi and, for $h = 1$, Shafiei. The geometric statements here are the exact section of the whole reciprocal family, its size and Loewy-depth consequences for actual first-relation boundary fibres, and the power-ideal identity on pencil lines. The last construction is an intrinsically induced reciprocal model; it is not a claim that the common extreme $GL(E)$ boundary point remembers the starting pencil. Its embedded pencil line is essential.

The preceding relative caution concerns the valuation-ring proof. The following polynomial identity establishes the equality over arbitrary complex base algebras.

21. UNIVERSAL POWER IDEALS

The power-zero construction admits an equality of ideals before any restriction to a pencil or to a valuation ring. This is the point at which the reciprocal section acquires a global boundary geometry. Let V have dimension $n \geq 2$, put $M = \text{Sym}^2 V$, and use the algebra $B_{n,h}$ of Theorem 19.1 with $W = V^*$. Thus $(B_{n,h})_1 = M$. If A is a symmetric matrix with entries in a commutative $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra T , denote its element of $M \otimes T$ by ℓ_A , and set

$$J_p(A) = \text{im}((B_{n,h})_p^* \otimes T \longrightarrow T, \quad \varphi \longmapsto \varphi(\ell_A^p)). \quad (21.1)$$

Write $I_q(A)$ for the ideal of all q -minors, with $I_0(A) = T$. In this section powers of ideals are ordinary powers unless parentheses explicitly indicate symbolic powers.

Theorem 21.1 (Universal determinantal formula). *For every commutative $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra T , every symmetric $n \times n$ matrix A over T , and $0 \leq p \leq nh$, write $p = hq + s$ with $0 \leq s < h$. Then*

$$J_p(A) = I_q(A)^{h-s} I_{q+1}(A)^s. \quad (21.2)$$

When $s = 0$ the second factor is omitted. For $p > nh$, $J_p(A) = 0$. These are equalities of ideals, not of radicals or integral closures, and commute with every homomorphism of $\mathbb{C}$ -algebras. In particular, for every symmetric map $A : T^n \rightarrow T^n$,

$$J_{h(n-j)}(A) = \text{Fitt}_j(\text{coker } A)^h, \quad 0 \leq j \leq n. \quad (21.3)$$

The formulas also hold locally, and hence as ideal sheaves, for symmetric maps of vector bundles with a line-bundle twist on an arbitrary $\mathbb{C}$ -scheme.

We separate the classical determinantal input. For an arbitrary matrix X over a characteristic-zero polynomial ring, the balancing inclusion

$$I_u(X)I_v(X) \subseteq I_{u+1}(X)I_{v-1}(X), \quad 0 \leq u \leq v-2, \quad (21.4)$$

is the determinantal symmetrization lemma. See [31, Lemma 2.5 and Theorem 2.4], which attributes the characteristic-zero product theorem to De Concini–Eisenbud–Procesi. Because this is a polynomial ideal inclusion, it remains true after specialization to a symmetric matrix; no flatness of that specialization is needed. This classical lemma is not a claim of the present paper.

Lemma 21.2 (The bounded-row generating space). *Let $S = \text{Sym}(\text{Sym}^2 V^*)$ and let A be its universal symmetric matrix. For $p = hq + s$, the degree- p part generating $I_q(A)^{h-s}I_{q+1}(A)^s$ is*

$$\bigoplus_{\substack{|\lambda|=p, \ell(\lambda) \leq n \\ \lambda_1 \leq h}} \mathbb{S}_{2\lambda}(V^*) \subseteq S_p. \quad (21.5)$$

Proof. The symmetric Cauchy decomposition of S_p is multiplicity free, with summands $\mathbb{S}_{2\lambda}(V^*)$, $|\lambda| = p$; see [32, §2.4]. We may use the dual general linear group to regard these as polynomial representations. Every minor has torus weight at most two in any one coordinate: its row set and column set each use that coordinate at most once. A product of h minors therefore has no weight with a coordinate exceeding $2h$. Its invariant span cannot contain a highest weight 2λ with $\lambda_1 > h$. This proves one inclusion.

For the converse, let $c_1 \geq \cdots \geq c_h \geq 0$ be the column lengths of a partition λ occurring on the right, padded with zeros. The product of the leading principal minors of orders c_i is a nonzero highest-weight vector of weight 2λ in S_p . It belongs initially to $\prod_{i=1}^h I_{c_i}(A)$. Whenever two column lengths differ by at least two, apply (21.4) to increase the smaller length by one and decrease the larger by one. The sum of the squares of the lengths strictly decreases, so the procedure terminates. At termination the lengths are $q+1$ repeated s times and q repeated $h-s$ times, since their sum is p . Thus that highest-weight vector belongs to $I_q^{h-s}I_{q+1}^s$. The latter ideal is invariant; its degree- p part contains the full irreducible summand. Multiplicity freeness proves the equality. The case $q = 0$ includes zero-length minors, which are the constant 1. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 21.1. First work over S with its universal matrix. The coefficient map of ℓ_A^p is the dual of the multiplication quotient $\text{Sym}^p M \twoheadrightarrow (B_{n,h})_p$, up to nonzero multinomial constants. Consequently its degree- p coefficient span is exactly $(B_{n,h})_p^* \subseteq S_p$. The character formula (19.3) identifies that span with (21.5). Both ideals in (21.2) are generated in degree p , so the lemma proves their equality in S . This step uses the full coefficient space, not just evaluation on diagonal matrices or closed points.

For a matrix over T , substitute its entries in this polynomial identity. Taking the image of the fixed finite-dimensional coefficient map commutes with scalar extension, as does taking minors and products of ideals. This proves the assertion even when T is nonreduced, non-Noetherian, or not a domain. The Fitting formula follows from its minor presentation. Changing a vector-bundle frame applies an invertible congruence to A and an invertible linear transformation to each coefficient space; changing a local frame of the twisting line multiplies generators by a unit. Therefore the local ideal identities glue. Finally, $(B_{n,h})_p = 0$ for $p > nh$. $\square$

Example 21.3 (A nonreduced test base). Take $T = \mathbb{C}[\epsilon]/(\epsilon^3)$, $n = h = 2$, and $A = \text{diag}(\epsilon, 0)$. Then $J_1(A) = (\epsilon)$ and $J_2(A) = (\epsilon^2) \neq 0$, whereas $J_3(A) = J_4(A) = 0$. Every closed-point matrix is zero. Thus equality on geometric fibres would not establish the theorem. Nor does (21.3) license taking unique ideal roots: for example, in $\mathbb{C}[\epsilon]/(\epsilon^2)$ the distinct ideals (ϵ) and 0 have the same square. At $h = 1$ the power ideals are the Fitting ideals themselves over every base.

22. THE RECIPROCAL POWER GRAPH AND COMPLETE QUADRICS

Let $P = \mathbb{P}(M)$, let P^{nd} be the nonsingular-quadric open, and define $\mathcal{G}_h$ as the scheme-theoretic closure of the graph

$$P^{\text{nd}} \longrightarrow P \times \prod_{p=1}^{nh-1} \mathbb{P}((B_{n,h})_p), \quad [A] \longmapsto ([A], [\ell_A], \dots, [\ell_A^{nh-1}]). \quad (22.1)$$

The first factor records the base point. We use the reduced, integral graph closure, equivalently its scheme-theoretic image; no additional normalization is inserted in this definition. Let $\text{CQ}(V)$ be the classical space of complete quadrics: the graph closure of $[A] \mapsto ([\wedge^2 A], \dots, [\wedge^{n-1} A])$ over P . For $n = 2$ the empty product gives $\text{CQ}(V) = P$.

Theorem 22.1 (A compactification determined by multiplication). *For every $h \geq 1$ there is a canonical $\text{GL}(V)$ -equivariant isomorphism over P*

$$\mathcal{G}_h \simeq \text{CQ}(V). \quad (22.2)$$

In particular the graph is smooth and projective, is independent of h as a scheme over P , and has a simple-normal-crossing boundary. Write $\pi : \text{CQ}(V) \rightarrow P$, and let E_r be its boundary divisor of rank break r , $1 \leq r < n$; for $r < n - 1$ it is exceptional over rank at most r , and E_{n-1} is the strict transform of the determinant divisor. Then every power ideal has the exact total transform

$$J_p \mathcal{O}_{\text{CQ}(V)} = \mathcal{O}_{\text{CQ}(V)} \left(- \sum_{r=1}^{n-1} (p - hr)_+ E_r \right), \quad 0 \leq p \leq nh, \quad (22.3)$$

where $(a)_+ = \max(a, 0)$. Removing this common divisor from the universal p th power gives a nowhere-zero projective section on the whole compactification.

The smoothness, boundary and flag interpretation of complete quadrics are classical, due to the complete-form construction; see [33, 34]. The assertion here identifies that particular compactification, with all of its scheme structure, from the multiplication in one reciprocal normalization-fibre section. It does not assert that complete quadrics is a newly constructed variety.

Proof. We first recall the graph calculation with its scheme structure. If rational maps from an integral scheme are given by generators of nonzero ideals $K_1, \dots, K_a$, their simultaneous graph closure is $\text{Bl}_{K_1 \dots K_a}$ of the base. Indeed, after the Segre embedding the coordinates are all products of one generator from each ideal. The closure of this graph is the Proj of the Rees algebra of that product: on a generator chart its coordinate ring is the subring of the function field obtained by adjoining the generator ratios. These are exactly the affine charts of both constructions. Tensoring an ideal by an invertible ideal, or replacing it by a positive power, does not change the blow-up, the latter by the Veronese description of Proj.

Apply this calculation on P . The sheaf $I_1 \mathcal{O}_P$ is the unit ideal, and $I_n \mathcal{O}_P$ is invertible. For each $2 \leq q \leq n - 1$, the exponent of I_q in $\prod_{p=1}^{nh-1} J_p$ is

$$\sum_{s=0}^{h-1} (h - s) + \sum_{s=1}^{h-1} s = h^2.$$

Theorem 21.1 therefore gives, up to an invertible ideal,

$$\prod_{p=1}^{nh-1} J_p = \left(\prod_{q=2}^{n-1} I_q \right)^{h^2}.$$

The same graph calculation for the exterior-power maps identifies $\text{CQ}(V)$ with the blow-up of $\prod_{q=2}^{n-1} I_q$. This proves (22.2) as an isomorphism of schemes, not only after normalization. Both isomorphisms are the identity on the common dense open, hence are canonical and equivariant.

For completeness, the local calculation behind the boundary formula is as follows. The complete-quadric construction blows up the strict rank loci successively. On its Gaussian charts, after a congruence and projective normalization, its matrix has the form

$$U \text{diag}(1, \tau_1, \tau_1 \tau_2, \dots, \tau_1 \cdots \tau_{n-1}) U^t, \quad (22.4)$$

with U lower unitriangular and $E_r = (\tau_r = 0)$. One obtains these charts inductively by making the first pivot one, taking a Schur complement, blowing up the zero residual matrix, and repeating. At each step the next nonzero residual quadratic form has a nonisotropic vector, so congruence translates of these charts cover the construction. This also explains the smooth charts and the normal crossings stated in the classical construction.

Cauchy–Binet, applied to (22.4), shows that every q -minor is divisible by $\tau_1^{q-1} \tau_2^{q-2} \cdots \tau_{q-1}$. The leading principal q -minor is exactly that product. Thus, on these charts and therefore globally,

$$I_q \mathcal{O}_{\text{CQ}(V)} = \mathcal{O} \left(- \sum_{r < q} (q - r) E_r \right). \quad (22.5)$$

Using (21.2), its exponent along E_r is $(h - s)(q - r)_+ + s(q + 1 - r)_+ = (p - hr)_+$. This proves (22.3). The coefficient sections generate the transformed ideal; division by its local generator makes them generate the unit ideal, proving the last assertion. $\square$

Corollary 22.2 (Native boundary strata). *The power graph has one congruence orbit for every subset $I \subseteq \{1, \dots, n - 1\}$. It is the stratum $E_I^\circ = (\bigcap_{r \in I} E_r) \setminus \bigcup_{r \notin I} E_r$, of codimension $|I|$, and its closure is $\bigcap_{r \in I} E_r$. Its points are flags with nondegenerate projective quadratic forms on successive quotients; the quotient dimensions are the successive gaps in $\{0\} \cup I \cup \{n\}$. The simultaneous normalized power values recover this complete-quadric datum. They are not the one common limit for the full cotangent-coordinate group.*

Proof. The flag description and boundary stratification are the classical complete-quadric description. The general linear group acts transitively on flags of fixed dimensions, and over $\mathbb{C}$ every nondegenerate quadratic form on a fixed-dimensional quotient is congruent to the identity. Independent diagonal scalings remove the projective scalars. The chart (22.4) realizes each subset of vanishing τ_r and permits further coordinates to vanish, giving the stated codimensions and closures. The graph is a closed subscheme of the product in (22.1); its projections therefore retain the point, including its flag and quotient forms. The group here is the native congruence group of V . $\square$

Remark 22.3 (Relative construction and base change). For a vector bundle $\mathcal{V}$ on any $\mathbb{C}$ -scheme S , the associated bundle with fibre $\text{CQ}(\mathbb{C}^n)$ is a relative smooth projective scheme over S . Equivariance glues the power maps and the boundary formula. Formation of this associated bundle and the polynomial ideal identity commute with arbitrary base change. This does not say that taking the graph closure of an arbitrary restricted family commutes with nonflat base change. The relative ambient resolution and the closure of an individual family's graph are different constructions.

23. BOUNDARY CONTACTS AND SPECTRAL SCHEMES

Let $R \subset M$ be a regular pencil and $\Lambda = \mathbb{P}(R)$. Its map to P lifts uniquely to a morphism $\tilde{\iota}_R : \Lambda \rightarrow \text{CQ}(V)$: it lifts on the nonsingular open, and properness extends it uniquely across the missing points of the smooth curve. Put $D_r(R) = \tilde{\iota}_R^* E_r$. These are effective divisors because the generic member is nonsingular.

Theorem 23.1 (Contact-divisor reconstruction of spectral data). *For every $h \geq 1$, every regular pencil, and $0 \leq p \leq nh$,*

$$J_p|_{\Lambda} = \mathcal{O}_{\Lambda} \left(- \sum_{r=1}^{n-1} (p - hr)_+ D_r(R) \right). \quad (23.1)$$

At a point $x \in \Lambda$, let $0 = e_1 \leq \dots \leq e_n$ be the symmetric Smith exponents of the local pencil matrix. Then

$$\text{mult}_x D_r(R) = e_{r+1} - e_r \quad (1 \leq r < n). \quad (23.2)$$

Consequently the supported contact divisors determine every elementary divisor, hence the full Segre symbol. If $v_p(x) = \text{length}(\mathcal{O}_{\Lambda, x}/J_p)$ and $v_0(x) = 0$, then

$$\text{mult}_x D_r(R) = \frac{v_{h(r+1)}(x) - 2v_{hr}(x) + v_{h(r-1)}(x)}{h}. \quad (23.3)$$

Proof. Pull back (22.3); equality of extended ideals under composition gives (23.1). The pencil matrix is nonzero at every point, since R is a genuine two-dimensional subspace; hence its entries generate the unit ideal locally and $e_1 = 0$. Over $\mathbb{C}[[t]]$ symmetric elimination gives a congruence to $\text{diag}(t^{e_1}, \dots, t^{e_n})$, absorbing unit factors by square roots. Its unique lift has, in (22.4), $\tau_r = t^{e_{r+1} - e_r}$ up to a unit. This proves (23.2); faithful flatness of completion gives the local divisor statement. Taking valuations in (23.1) and second differences at multiples of h proves (23.3). Recover e_i by summing the first $i - 1$ contact multiplicities. The positive exponents, with their points on Λ , are precisely the elementary-divisor partitions of the spectral cokernel. $\square$

Example 23.2 (A boundary point and its contact order are distinct data). For a symmetric germ with exponents $(0, 1, 3)$ and $h = 2$, the valuations of $J_1, \dots, J_6$ are $(0, 0, 1, 2, 5, 8)$. Its two boundary contacts are 1 and 2. The germs $\text{diag}(1, t, t^3)$ and $\text{diag}(1, t^2, t^5)$ reach the same full-flag complete-quadric point but have contacts $(1, 2)$ and $(2, 3)$. The compactification retains the flag; the arc with its divisorial contacts retains the elementary exponents. These assertions must not be conflated. For singular pencils the universal ideal theorem still holds and detects all Fitting schemes and the normal rank; Fitting ideals alone do not determine Kronecker minimal indices.

24. A PROJECTIVE INCIDENCE COMPACTIFICATION FOR PENCILS

The complete-quadric graph concerns members of pencils. There is also a projective parameter space carrying both the original finite failure algebra and flat limits of their resolved member curves. This construction keeps the pencil and does not identify distinct pencils at a common full-coordinate-change limit.

Proposition 24.1 (Resolved pencil curves and the failure family). *Let $n \geq 3$, $G = \text{Gr}(2, M)$, and let G° be the open set of regular pencils whose lines avoid the rank-at-most- $(n - 2)$ locus in P . There is a normal projective $\text{GL}(V)$ -equivariant scheme $\hat{G}$ with a projective birational morphism $\rho : \hat{G} \rightarrow G$, an isomorphism over G° , and a flat family of subschemes $\mathcal{C} \subseteq \hat{G} \times \text{CQ}(V)$ with the following properties. Over G° it is exactly the lifted pencil line. Every fibre over R lies scheme-theoretically in $\pi^{-1}(\mathbb{P}(R))$. All the resolved power maps restrict to $\mathcal{C}$, for every h . The sharp finite failure algebra on G pulls back to a finite locally free algebra on $\hat{G}$, with its original multiplication.*

Proof. The rank-at-most- $(n-2)$ locus has codimension three in P , so a general line avoids it; a general pencil is regular. Thus G° is nonempty and dense. Over that open, π is an isomorphism along every pencil line and these lifts form a flat family of embedded projective lines.

For $1 \leq q < n$, let H_q be the pullback to $\text{CQ}(V)$ of the hyperplane bundle for its q th exterior-power projection, taking $q = 1$ to mean P . The bundle $L = \bigotimes_{q=1}^{n-1} H_q$ is very ample, by the graph embedding and Segre embedding. On a lifted line over G° , $\deg H_q = q$, since its q -minors have no common zero. The Hilbert polynomial with respect to L is therefore $\binom{n}{2}m + 1$. The lifted family defines a morphism

$$G^\circ \longrightarrow \text{Hilb}^{\binom{n}{2}m+1}(\text{CQ}(V)).$$

Take the reduced closure of its graph in G times this projective Hilbert scheme, and then its normalization; this is $\widehat{G}$. Normalization is finite here, so the result is projective and normal. The graph is already closed over G° and that open is smooth, so ρ is an isomorphism there. Equivariance of the family and the uniqueness of normalization give the stated group action.

Pull back the universal Hilbert family to obtain $\mathcal{C}$; it is flat. To verify the asserted scheme-theoretic incidence, pull back the linear equations for the universal pencil line to $\mathcal{C}$. They vanish over the dense open G° . On an affine open of the integral base $\widehat{G}$, flatness makes the coordinate modules of $\mathcal{C}$ torsion free over the base. A section which becomes zero at the generic point is therefore zero. Applied locally to these linear equations, this proves the incidence on the whole family. The power maps are everywhere defined on $\text{CQ}(V)$ by Theorem 22.1, so their restrictions exist. Finally pull back the finite locally free algebra of Corollary 6.5 along ρ ; arbitrary base change preserves its rank and multiplication. $\square$

This is an incidence compactification over the Grassmannian, with its native congruence action, not a properness assertion for the quotient stack by that action. A limiting Hilbert fibre may have extra or nonreduced components; no classification of all such fibres is used. The construction is independent of h : its target, polarization and Hilbert polynomial were specified using the h -independent complete quadric graph. The unmarked inverse in the companion reconstruction paper recovers the underlying pencil, so the incidence construction is compatible with that inverse rather than a replacement of it.

25. SINGULARITIES OF THE UNIVERSAL POWER-ZERO SCHEMES

There is an explicit further consequence for all the universal ideals, which we record separately from the geometry of the full reciprocal normalization fibre. Multiplier ideals are taken on the affine smooth space M , and $I_{r+1}^{(a)}$ denotes symbolic power, with exponent zero interpreted as the unit ideal.

Corollary 25.1 (Multiplier ideals and threshold). *For $1 \leq p \leq nh$, put $w_r = (p - hr)_+$ and $c_r = \binom{n-r+1}{2}$ for $0 \leq r < n$. For every real $b \geq 0$,*

$$\mathcal{J}(M, b \cdot J_p) = \bigcap_{r=0}^{n-1} I_{r+1}^{(\max\{0, \lfloor bw_r \rfloor + 1 - c_r\})}, \quad (25.1)$$

$$\text{lct}_M(J_p) = \min_{\substack{0 \leq r < n \\ p > hr}} \frac{\binom{n-r+1}{2}}{p - hr}. \quad (25.2)$$

Proof. Blow up the affine origin and then the strict rank loci. This is the affine complete-quadric resolution, whose charts are (22.4) with one additional scalar coordinate. Let E_0 be the divisor over the origin. The same minor calculation now includes $r = 0$, and the total transform of J_p is $\sum_{r=0}^{n-1} w_r E_r$. The discrepancy along E_r is $c_r - 1$: over the generic rank- r point the earlier blow-ups are isomorphisms, and the smooth rank- r locus has codimension c_r ; for $r = n - 1$ this is

the strict determinant divisor and the discrepancy is zero. All boundary divisors have normal crossings, so this is a log resolution.

The defining pushforward formula for the multiplier ideal requires $\text{ord}_{E_r}(f) \geq \lfloor bw_r \rfloor + 1 - c_r$. At the generic rank- r point this valuation is the order in the regular local ring with maximal ideal I_{r+1} , so the condition on polynomials is exactly membership in the indicated symbolic power. Intersecting the conditions proves the first formula; the first value at which one becomes nontrivial proves the second. Equivalently this is the specialization, via Theorem 21.1, of the classical symmetric-determinantal multiplier-ideal calculation [32, §2.4 and Theorem 4.8]. $\square$

The ideal formula, graph identification and contact reconstruction are statements about the entire universal coefficient space. They do not supply the conductor of every multivariate common-divisor image or the Hilbert function of every full $F_{g,k}(W)$. Those objects remain in the preserved incidence theory; the present results connect their exact quadratic sections to a native global boundary and its spectral schemes.

26. POWER COEFFICIENTS AND THEIR TWISTS

For a vector space V , put $M(V) = \text{Sym}^2 V$, with congruence action $A \mapsto gAg^t$, and define

$$B_h(V) = \text{Sym}(M(V)) / \langle (v^2)^{h+1} : v \in V \rangle. \quad (26.1)$$

The degree of $M(V)$ is one. The generating space of the ideal is the Cartan inclusion $\text{Sym}^{2h+2} V \hookrightarrow \text{Sym}^{h+1}(\text{Sym}^2 V)$, normalized by $v^{2h+2} \mapsto (v^2)^{h+1}$. This definition requires neither a volume form nor a complementary space. It agrees with $B_{n,h}$ in Theorem 19.1 when $W = V^*$.

Proposition 26.1 (The coefficient map and its twists). *Let $n = \dim V$ and $N = nh$. The quotient multiplication μ_p gives an equivariant injection*

$$\mu_p^* : B_h(V)_p^* \hookrightarrow \text{Sym}^p(M(V)^*), \quad (\mu_p^* \varphi)(A) = \varphi(A^p). \quad (26.2)$$

Its image is the full coefficient space defining J_p , without a choice of apolar coordinates. The socle and perfect pairings are

$$B_h(V)_N = (\det V)^{2h}, \quad B_h(V)_p^* \simeq B_h(V)_{N-p} \otimes (\det V^*)^{2h}. \quad (26.3)$$

For a line L , $B_h(V \otimes L)_p = B_h(V)_p \otimes L^{2p}$, compatibly with all products. On $\mathbb{P}(M(V))$, the p th power is a section of $B_h(V)_p \otimes \mathcal{O}(p)$, and its base ideal is the image of $B_h(V)_p^ \otimes \mathcal{O}(-p) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}$.*

Proof. A homogeneous polynomial of degree p is identified with its symmetric p -linear polarization, normalized so that its value on A is its value on $(A, \dots, A)$. Dualizing the surjection μ_p gives exactly (26.2). Multinomial coefficients appearing in a monomial basis express this normalization and are nonzero; no dual representation is silently replaced by the original one. Theorem 19.1 identifies the quotient with determinant apolarity. The determinant of $A : V^* \rightarrow V$ takes values in $(\det V)^2$. Choosing a trivialization gives a scalar polynomial whose inverse-system line has character $(\det V^*)^{2h}$; its dual socle therefore has character $(\det V)^{2h}$. The Gorenstein pairing gives the second formula. Each generator in $M(V)$ has scalar weight two, proving the line-twist assertion directly from (26.1). The tautological line $\mathcal{O}(-1) \rightarrow M(V) \otimes \mathcal{O}$ has p th product $\mathcal{O}(-p) \rightarrow B_h(V)_p \otimes \mathcal{O}$, which proves the last assertion. $\square$

26.1. Graph schemes and classical inputs. The projective graph argument uses the following precise statement. It applies to the ambient space and also to the two-dimensional total base of the degeneration computed below.

Lemma 26.2 (Simultaneous graph with invertible twists). *Let X be an integral noetherian complex scheme and let $W_i \otimes L_i^{-1} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X$ be nonzero coherent systems of sections, with finite-dimensional W_i and invertible L_i . Write K_i for their image ideals, and let $U = X \setminus \bigcup_i V(K_i)$. The*

scheme-theoretic graph closure of $U \rightarrow \prod_i \mathbb{P}(W_i^)$ is $\text{Bl}_{\prod_i K_i} X$ with its specified graph embedding. This statement identifies the scheme and the maps, not only their normalizations. Replacing the product ideal by an invertible twist or a positive power does not change its blow-up over X .*

Proof. The open U is dense because all K_i are nonzero and X is integral. After the Segre embedding the simultaneous map is given by all products of one section from each system. On a trivializing affine open, these products generate $K = \prod_i K_i$. The homogeneous coordinate algebra of the graph is the image of the polynomial algebra on these products in $\mathcal{O}_X[t]$, namely the Rees algebra $\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} K^m t^m$. It is a subalgebra of the function-field polynomial ring. Thus its Proj is exactly the schematic closure of the graph, with no extra component. The Segre equations hold on the dense graph and hence on this integral closure scheme, so the graph lands in the product, not merely in its ambient projective space. Local trivializations glue. An invertible ideal changes the degree- m piece by its m th tensor power and does not change relative Proj; a positive power replaces the Rees algebra by a Veronese subalgebra. $\square$

For the power system, $L_i = \mathcal{O}(p)$ and $W_i = B_h(V)_p^*$; for the exterior system of order q , $L_i = \mathcal{O}(q)$ and its sections are the q -minors. The determinant system is invertible on the integral ambient space. It may be omitted from the blow-up product, although its zero divisor must still be retained in contact formulas. Likewise the first-coordinate identity map has unit base ideal. These observations specify the projective twists in the proof of Theorem 22.1.

The precise classical scheme-level complete-quadric construction is [33, Theorem 6.3]; the graph of exterior-power maps and its successive symmetric-rank blow-ups are stated in [34, Remark 2.5 and Construction 2.6]. The relative rank version is recalled in [35, Definition 2.5, Remark 2.6 and Theorem 2.14]. Consequently smoothness, the flag description, and the orbit stratification in Corollary 22.2 are classical consequences of the graph identification, not new classifications.

There is also a precise invariant-ideal predecessor to the universal identity. Henriques–Varbaro [32, §2.4, Theorems 2.6–2.8] recall Abeasis’s classification for the symmetric coordinate ring, its products of determinantal ideals and their integral closures, and the passage between invariant generators and products indexed by diagrams. Our coefficient-space comparison uses this same multiplicity-free setting. Theorem 21.1 identifies a particular multiplication coefficient map with the balanced determinantal product as an ordinary ideal; it is not an independent classification of invariant ideals. The exact coefficient identification in Proposition 26.1 explains which map is being specialized on nonreduced bases. We assert no exhaustive historical nonanticipation of the displayed identity in all invariant-ideal terminology. Similarly the multiplier calculation in Corollary 25.1 is the substitution of its exponents in the symmetric determinantal formula [32, Theorem 4.8], not an independent multiplier-ideal theorem.

27. THE INTRINSIC SOURCE AND ITS APOLAR ENVELOPE

The source of a pencil and the coefficient complement in a divisor normalization fibre are different spaces. We construct the native power geometry from the first relation of the failure algebra, without taking a coefficient section of that fibre. The construction produces a canonical projective power diagram and an honest algebra bundle on the intrinsic source projective space. The location of the algebra bundle is essential: forgetting a scalar lift does not give a linear representation of the projective general linear group.

27.1. A construction from the first relation. Let A be an unmarked, ungraded complex algebra in the sharp pencil image, and write $\mathfrak{m}$ for its maximal ideal. Set

$$E_A = \mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2, \quad H_A = \ker\{\text{Sym}^d E_A \longrightarrow \mathfrak{m}^d\}, \quad d = n^2 + 2n - 4. \quad (27.1)$$

Here $n^2 = \dim E_A$, so neither n nor d is extra marking. The reduced support of the homogeneous ideal generated by H_A is a determinant hypersurface in $\mathbb{P}(E_A^*)$. Its successive reduced singular loci give the rank-one Segre variety. The scheme of maximal rank-one linear spaces has two components. Cancel the determinant factor from H_A and select the component singled out by coefficient support ranks $(1, M)$ in Lemma 7.1. Denote the resulting source projective space by S_A ; with a pencil presentation it is $\mathbb{P}(V)$, not $\mathbb{P}(\mathbb{C}^{n^2-1})$.

There is a direct jet-theoretic presentation which does not begin with a linear source lift. Let L be an ample generator of $\text{Pic}(S_A)$, and let $J^1 L$ denote its first principal-parts bundle. Put

$$\mathcal{E}_A = \mathcal{H}om(J^1 L, L), \quad \mathcal{B}_{A,h} = \text{Sym}(\text{Sym}^2 \mathcal{E}_A) / \langle (u^2)^{h+1} : u \text{ a local section of } \mathcal{E}_A \rangle. \quad (27.2)$$

Scalar automorphisms of L act trivially on $\mathcal{E}_A$, so this bundle is independent of the representative of the ample generator. For $p > 0$ its projective coefficient space can be constructed as $\mathbb{P}H^0(S_A, \mathcal{B}_{A,h,p} \otimes L^{-2p})$; changing L changes the linear identification only by a scalar. Multiplication supplies the projective power maps. Thus jets, a Cartan quotient, and projectivization give the construction from the intrinsic source.

Theorem 27.1 (Intrinsic projective power geometry). *On the groupoid of complex sharp pencil-failure algebras and their ungraded isomorphisms, the following construction is functorial. There is a source projective space S_A , a finite locally free graded algebra $\mathcal{B}_{A,h}$ on S_A for each $h \geq 1$, and projective spaces $P_{A,p}$ with a multiplication power diagram. In any source lift $S_A = \mathbb{P}(V)$ they are*

$$\mathcal{B}_{A,h} = \bigoplus_{p=0}^{nh} B_h(V)_p \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}(V)}(2p), \quad P_{A,p} = \mathbb{P}(B_h(V)_p). \quad (27.3)$$

The nondegenerate power graph on $P_{A,1}$ is the native $\text{CQ}(V)$, canonically as a projective diagram, and every rank- r graph is the relative complete-quadric space of Theorem 28.1. Over a general base the projective spaces mean the associated projective schemes, which need not admit a global linear lift. These constructions use only (27.1), determinant cancellation, the oriented ruling, and (26.1); no pencil coefficient line or reciprocal-fibre splitting is needed to construct the ambient graph. Extracting that line afterwards supplies the intrinsic pencil line $\Lambda_A \subset P_{A,1}$.

All source-lift choices cancel. Once an oriented projective-source bundle is given, the same associated constructions descend over any complex base, including a nonreduced base, and commute with arbitrary base change. This last assertion concerns the associated objects; it does not assert that reduction or graph closure commutes with arbitrary base change on unrelated degenerating families.

Proof. The first-relation construction is preserved by every ungraded isomorphism: terms of degree at least two in a change of generators cannot change the degree- d relation modulo $\mathfrak{m}^{d+1}$. The determinant and its rank-one locus are therefore intrinsic. Lemma 2.1 identifies the two ruling components as schemes; coefficient-support asymmetry orients them. These are the steps of the local inverse before the final recovery of the pencil coefficient line. Consequently an isomorphism of algebras induces a unique projective isomorphism of the selected source spaces, and compositions give compositions. This establishes the source functor without first choosing a congruence representative of the pencil.

To verify the jet presentation, take $S_A = \mathbb{P}(V)$ and $L = \mathcal{O}(1)$. The evaluation map $H^0(L) \otimes \mathcal{O} \rightarrow J^1 L$ is an isomorphism: a linear form whose value and first derivatives vanish at a point is zero, and both bundles have rank n . Hence $\mathcal{E}_A = V \otimes \mathcal{O}(1)$, and the Cartan quotient in (27.2) is exactly (27.3). Its degree- p twist by L^{-2p} is constant, with global section space $B_h(V)_p$; this proves the stated projective coefficient construction. Relative principal parts commute with base change on the locally trivial smooth projective-space bundle. Replacing L by its tensor product with a line from the base cancels in $\mathcal{H}om(J^1 L, L)$.

Fix a source lift temporarily. A scalar c acts on $B_h(V)_p$ by c^{2p} and on $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}(V)}(2p)$ by c^{-2p} . Hence every summand in (27.3), together with its multiplication, is naturally $\mathrm{PGL}(V)$ -equivariant. If two linear lifts of a projective isomorphism differ by a scalar, their induced algebra-bundle maps are equal. This also proves the cocycle identity on three overlaps; in a family, replacing V by $V \otimes L$ cancels L^{2p} against L^{-2p} . Thus the algebra bundle descends independently of all lifts. For a projective-source bundle, take fppf local frames of its PGL_n -torsor; the scalar-trivial action just proved supplies the cocycle descent even when no global vector-bundle lift exists. The same scalar acts trivially on each $P_{A,p}$, and power maps commute with scalar changes and congruence. They therefore define a projective diagram on the source torsor, with the same cocycle compatibility. Its first projective space can alternatively be described as the parameter space of quadric hypersurfaces in the dual projective space $S_A^\vee$.

Apply Theorem 22.1 to identify the nondegenerate graph. The rank- r identification is proved independently in Theorem 28.1. Equivariance makes both identifications independent of the source lift. Finally the residual left coefficient line, by the multiplicity-one exterior-duality map in the local inverse, gives the Pluecker point of a two-dimensional subspace in $\mathrm{Sym}^2 V$. Scalar changes do not change its projective line. This is Λ_A . Associated bundles, their specified equations, and their multiplication commute with any base change; no claim about arbitrary restricted graph closures is required. $\square$

Remark 27.2 (Exact intrinsic status). The envelope is a functor constructed from multiplication, not a claimed subalgebra or preferred quotient of A . It is an algebra bundle on S_A , not an untwisted algebra canonically based at $\mathrm{Spec} \mathbb{C}$. This distinction records, rather than suppresses, the scalar ambiguity: for $n \geq 3$ the central element $\zeta I \in \mathrm{SL}(V)$ acts on $B_h(V)_1 = \mathrm{Sym}^2 V$ by ζ^2 , which need not be one although it acts trivially projectively. Thus the usual linear degree-one action does not descend to $\mathrm{PGL}(V)$. The twist in (27.3) removes exactly this obstruction. There is no selection of an n -plane inside the auxiliary complement of dimension $n^2 - 1$. The latter still defines its own, different coefficient-section algebra in Corollary 19.2.

28. POWER GRAPHS OF EVERY RANK

For $1 \leq r \leq n$, let $P^{(r)} \subset \mathbb{P}(\mathrm{Sym}^2 V)$ be the rank-exactly- r locus. Define $\mathcal{G}_{r,h}$ as the scheme-theoretic closure of

$$P^{(r)} \longrightarrow \mathbb{P}(\mathrm{Sym}^2 V) \times \prod_{p=1}^{hr} \mathbb{P}(B_h(V)_p), \quad [A] \longmapsto ([A], [A], \dots, [A^{hr}]). \quad (28.1)$$

Keeping the final power is essential when $r < n$. Write $\mathcal{U}$ for the tautological rank- r bundle on $\mathrm{Gr}(r, V)$ and $\mathrm{CQ}(\mathcal{U})$ for its relative complete-quadric space. For rank one this means $\mathbb{P}(\mathrm{Sym}^2 \mathcal{U}) = \mathrm{Gr}(1, V)$.

Theorem 28.1 (The rank-stratified power graph). *There is a canonical isomorphism*

$$\mathcal{G}_{r,h} \simeq \mathrm{CQ}(\mathcal{U}) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Gr}(r, V). \quad (28.2)$$

The final power in (28.1) recovers the image r -plane by the degree- $2h$ Pluecker embedding. In particular the graph is smooth and projective, independently of h . For its relative boundary divisors E_i , $1 \leq i < r$, its power base ideals have total transforms

$$J_p \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{G}_{r,h}} = \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{G}_{r,h}} \left(- \sum_{i=1}^{r-1} (p - hi)_+ E_i \right), \quad 0 \leq p \leq hr. \quad (28.3)$$

The projective power maps in this formula have their common divisors removed. All powers $p > hr$ vanish on the rank- r locus.

Proof. For $U \subset V$, the map $B_h(U) \rightarrow B_h(V)$ from the presentation (26.1) is injective: any linear projection $V \rightarrow U$ splitting the inclusion induces a retraction on the quotient algebras. The injection itself is independent of that projection. Locally this gives subbundles $B_h(\mathcal{U})_p \subset B_h(V)_p$. If A has image U and rank r , it is a nonsingular element of $\text{Sym}^2 U$, and A^{hr} generates the socle $B_h(U)_{hr} = (\det U)^{2h}$. As U varies these lines give the homogeneous embedding

$$\text{Gr}(r, V) \hookrightarrow \mathbb{P}(\mathbb{S}_{(2h)r} V) \hookrightarrow \mathbb{P}(B_h(V)_{hr}).$$

Indeed the line at the coordinate r -plane is a highest-weight line of weight $(2h)^r$; its orbit map is the Pluecker embedding followed by its degree- $2h$ linear system. In particular this is a closed immersion, not just a recovery of the image plane on closed points.

Over the recovered Grassmannian, the remaining graph is precisely the relative simultaneous power graph for $B_h(\mathcal{U})$. By Theorem 22.1 on each frame chart, it is $\text{CQ}(\mathcal{U})$. The relative graph embedding, the subbundle injections above, and the final-power Grassmannian embedding together give a closed immersion into the product in (28.1). Its dense open is the graph of $P^{(r)}$. Both its source and that graph closure are integral, so equality of their scheme-theoretic images proves (28.2) without a normalization step. Applying (22.3) in rank r proves the transform formula. Local split inclusion of the coefficient bundles ensures that ambient and relative power ideals agree. The vanishing assertion follows from the socle degree of $B_h(U)$. $\square$

The varieties of complete singular quadrics are classical: see [35, Definition 2.5, Remark 2.6 and Theorem 2.14]. The point of the theorem is the exact recovery of their image-plane projection and entire scheme structure from the power maps in one fixed algebra $B_h(V)$, simultaneously for every r . The classical orbit stratification is background, not an additional novelty claim.

29. CONTACTS AND MINIMAL INDICES OF ARBITRARY PENCILS

Let $R = \langle A_0, A_1 \rangle \subset \text{Sym}^2 V$ be a genuine pencil, $\Lambda = \mathbb{P}(R)$, and r its normal rank. Its tautological symmetric map is $A : V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_\Lambda \rightarrow V \otimes \mathcal{O}_\Lambda(1)$. Write

$$K = \ker A, \quad U = K^\perp \subset V \otimes \mathcal{O}_\Lambda.$$

The kernel is saturated and hence a subbundle on the smooth curve; U is the saturation of the generic image. Thus A is a generically nonsingular section of $\text{Sym}^2 U \otimes \mathcal{O}_\Lambda(1)$. The map on the rank- r open lifts uniquely to $\tilde{\Lambda} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_{r,h}$ by properness. Its Grassmannian projection is the map defined by U , and its source is still Λ . Let D_i be its contact divisor with E_i .

Lemma 29.1 (Symmetric diagonalization with a kernel). *Over $\mathbb{C}[[t]]$, a symmetric matrix of rank r over the fraction field is congruent to $\text{diag}(t^{e_1}, \dots, t^{e_r}, 0, \dots, 0)$, with $e_1 \leq \dots \leq e_r$. For the local matrix of a genuine pencil, $e_1 = 0$. The exponents are its nonzero Smith exponents.*

Proof. Choose a matrix entry of smallest valuation. If a diagonal entry has that valuation, it is a pivot. Otherwise an off-diagonal entry does, and the value of the quadratic form on $e_i + ce_j$ has the same valuation for some $c \in \mathbb{C}$: its leading coefficient is a nonzero polynomial in c , since 2 is invertible. Extend this primitive vector to a basis. The pivot divides every entry in its row, so symmetric row-and-column elimination clears the row and column over the ring. All remaining entries have valuation at least that of the pivot. Repeat until the remaining block is zero. Units have square roots in $\mathbb{C}[[t]]$ and can be absorbed into the basis. Invertible congruence preserves determinantal ideals, which identify the resulting exponents with Smith exponents. A genuine pencil has a nonzero matrix at every projective parameter, giving a unit entry and $e_1 = 0$. This proof supplies the local congruence step rather than relying on left-right Smith form alone; compare the classical pencil congruence treatment in [36]. $\square$

For $j \geq 0$ define the finite multiplication-syzygy map

$$C_j(R) : V^* \otimes \text{Sym}^j R^* \longrightarrow V \otimes \text{Sym}^{j+1} R^*, \quad q \longmapsto Aq, \quad \kappa_j = \dim \ker C_j(R). \quad (29.1)$$

Set $\kappa_{-1} = \kappa_{-2} = 0$. Under a basis of R this is the block Toeplitz map with rows $A_0q_0, A_0q_i + A_1q_{i-1}$, and A_1q_j ; its definition is independent of that basis.

Theorem 29.2 (Complete power-and-syzygy data). *For every complex symmetric pencil, including every singular pencil, the following formulas recover its complete congruence data. If $\varepsilon_1, \dots, \varepsilon_c$ are its minimal indices, where $c = n - r$, then*

$$K \simeq \bigoplus_{a=1}^c \mathcal{O}_\Lambda(-\varepsilon_a), \quad \kappa_j = \sum_{a=1}^c (j - \varepsilon_a + 1)_+, \quad (29.2)$$

$$\#\{a : \varepsilon_a = j\} = \kappa_j - 2\kappa_{j-1} + \kappa_{j-2}. \quad (29.3)$$

It is enough to use $0 \leq j \leq \lfloor (n-1)/2 \rfloor$. At $x \in \Lambda$, let $0 = e_1(x) \leq \dots \leq e_r(x)$ be the nonzero local Smith exponents. With $v_0 = 0$ and $v_p(x) = \text{length}(\mathcal{O}_{\Lambda, x}/J_p)$ for $p \leq hr$, one has

$$v_{hq+s}(x) = h \sum_{i=1}^q e_i(x) + se_{q+1}(x), \quad (29.4)$$

$$e_i(x) = \frac{v_{hi}(x) - v_{h(i-1)}(x)}{h}, \quad \text{mult}_x D_i = e_{i+1}(x) - e_i(x). \quad (29.5)$$

In the first formula $s = 0$ at $q = r$ and the last term is omitted. The positive exponents at each supported point, together with the minimal indices, determine the pencil up to congruence and projective reparametrization of Λ . The spectral datum includes the positions of the points, not only their local partitions.

There is also a global conservation law:

$$\sum_{i=1}^{r-1} (r-i) \deg D_i + 2 \deg(\Lambda \longrightarrow \text{Gr}(r, V)) = r, \quad \deg(\Lambda \longrightarrow \text{Gr}(r, V)) = \sum_a \varepsilon_a. \quad (29.6)$$

The Grassmannian degree uses its Pluecker polarization. The first summand is the dimension of the regular summand in the Kronecker congruence form. Every object and number in the theorem is invariant under the ungraded failure-algebra isomorphisms of Theorem 27.1.

Proof. We use the classical complex symmetric Kronecker congruence theorem [36]. A singular block of minimal index ε has size $2\varepsilon + 1$ and form

$$S_\varepsilon(s, t) = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & L_\varepsilon(s, t)^t \\ L_\varepsilon(s, t) & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad L_\varepsilon = \begin{pmatrix} s & t & & 0 \\ & s & t & \\ & & \ddots & t \\ & & & t \end{pmatrix},$$

where L_ε has ε rows and $\varepsilon + 1$ columns; S_0 is a zero 1×1 block. Its kernel is generated by $((-t)^\varepsilon, s(-t)^{\varepsilon-1}, \dots, s^\varepsilon)$ in the first block. These components have no common projective zero, so it gives $\mathcal{O}(-\varepsilon)$ as a kernel subbundle. A regular block has zero kernel as a sheaf. Direct sums prove the first formula in (29.2). Taking sections after twist by $\mathcal{O}(j)$ identifies them with (29.1), proving the second formula. The second finite difference of $(j - \varepsilon + 1)_+$ is one exactly at $j = \varepsilon$ and zero otherwise. Each singular block uses $2\varepsilon + 1 \leq n$ dimensions, proving the stated finite bound. The canonical-form classification is used here as a classical input, not reproved or claimed as new.

Locally, symmetric diagonalization factors the matrix through the saturated r -plane U with an $r \times r$ symmetric block. Theorem 21.1, or its rank- r version via the split inclusion $B_h(U) \hookrightarrow B_h(V)$, yields (29.4). Finite differences recover the e_i . In the relative complete-quadric chart the successive ratios of diagonal entries have valuations $e_{i+1} - e_i$, proving the contact formula. The torsion of

the pencil cokernel has precisely the positive Smith exponents. The regular blocks of the classical congruence form are specified by these elementary divisors, and its singular blocks by the minimal indices; over $\mathbb{C}$ there are no additional signature parameters. Retaining the supported points on Λ makes the statement compatible with arbitrary projective changes of the pencil basis.

The exact sequence $0 \rightarrow U \rightarrow V \otimes \mathcal{O} \rightarrow K^* \rightarrow 0$ gives $\deg U = -\sum \varepsilon_a$, so the Grassmannian degree is $\sum \varepsilon_a$. The determinant of the induced symmetric map $U^* \rightarrow U(1)$ is a nonzero section of $(\det U)^2 \otimes \mathcal{O}(r)$; its zero divisor has degree $r - 2\sum \varepsilon_a$. At each point its order is $\sum e_i = \sum_{i < r} (r - i) \text{mult}_x D_i$. This proves (29.6). The block-size identity $n = n_{\text{reg}} + \sum (2\varepsilon_a + 1)$ identifies the first summand with n_{reg} . Finally the intrinsic first relation extracts Λ_A on its source and preserves all the maps involved; changes of source lift or pencil basis give isomorphic kernel maps and equal ideals, hence the asserted invariance. $\square$

Example 29.3 (Power contacts alone miss a singular invariant). The size-six pencils $S_0 \oplus S_2$ and $S_1 \oplus S_1$ both have constant rank four and no spectral torsion. All their power ideals are the unit ideal for $p \leq 4h$ and zero for $p > 4h$, and every contact divisor is empty. Their kernel splittings are respectively $\mathcal{O} \oplus \mathcal{O}(-2)$ and $\mathcal{O}(-1)^2$. Thus their first three syzygy nullities are $(1, 2, 4)$ and $(0, 2, 4)$, distinguishing the two congruence types. Both have Grassmannian degree two, as required by (29.6); the full splitting, rather than just its degree, is necessary.

Proposition 29.4 (Finite closed tests in families). *For $j \geq 0$ and $0 \leq a \leq n(j+1)$, on the pencil Grassmannian each condition $\kappa_j \geq a$ is the closed determinantal condition on the bundle map C_j given by minors of size $n(j+1) - a + 1$. These conditions commute with arbitrary base change as schemes. Their fibrewise ranks need not be constant, so no unqualified assertion that the kernel bundles commute with every base change is made. Along a specialization over an integral curve, κ_j can only increase.*

Proof. Use the tautological rank-two subbundle in (29.1). Its source has rank $n(j+1)$ and its target rank $n(j+2)$. Nullity at least a is equivalent to rank at most $n(j+1) - a$, giving the stated minors. The ideals are polynomial in the bundle map and therefore commute with arbitrary substitution. Upper semicontinuity of nullity, or specialization of these minors, gives the last assertion. $\square$

30. A COMPUTED BOUNDARY OF THE PENCIL INCIDENCE SPACE

We give the incidence compactification a precise universal property and compute a family of its boundary fibres in every dimension. The new boundary is selected by one power base ideal, not by pulling an unrelated algebra back to a parameter space.

Proposition 30.1 (The normal main-component flattening property). *Let $G^\circ \subset G = \text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V)$ and $\widehat{G} \rightarrow G$ be as in Proposition 24.1. Among normal integral schemes T with a dominant morphism $f : T \rightarrow G$ for which the closure of the lifted pencil family over $f^{-1}(G^\circ)$ is an embedded flat family in $\text{CQ}(V) \times T$ with Hilbert polynomial $\binom{n}{2}m + 1$, there is a unique morphism $T \rightarrow \widehat{G}$ over G , and that family is the pullback of its universal family. Consequently $\widehat{G}$ is the minimal normal dominant modification with this specified embedded-flat-closure property.*

Proof. The flat embedded family gives a morphism to the indicated Hilbert scheme. Together with f it agrees, over a dense open of T , with the graph defining the reduced graph closure. Since T is integral, its morphism factors through this closed graph scheme: each equation vanishing on the dense open vanishes on T . The induced morphism is dominant. A dominant morphism from a normal integral scheme to an integral scheme factors uniquely through the normalization: locally, an element integral over the target ring becomes integral over the source ring and lies in its fraction field, hence belongs to the normal source ring. Thus the morphism factors uniquely

through $\widehat{G}$. The Hilbert-scheme representing property identifies the families. Conversely its pulled-back universal family is flat; flatness over an integral base makes it the schematic closure of its restriction to the dense open. Uniqueness follows also from separatedness. $\square$

The hypothesis of dominance is part of this property; this proposition does not assert that normalization commutes with arbitrary base change. The property is a standard consequence of the Hilbert functor and normalization. Its usefulness here is that the following calculation identifies a nontrivial fibre of the resulting modification.

Assume $n \geq 3$. Choose distinct nonzero numbers $a_3, \dots, a_n$ and put $D = \text{Spec } \mathbb{C}[[\tau]]$. On $\mathbb{P}_D^1$, consider the symmetric pencil

$$A_\tau(s, t) = \text{diag}(s, s + \tau t, t - a_3 s, \dots, t - a_n s). \quad (30.1)$$

For $n = 3$ there is just one number a_3 . Write $X = \mathbb{P}_D^1$ and let o be the point $s = \tau = 0$ in the special fibre. Its generic pencil has n distinct rank- $(n - 1)$ spectral points, so defines a point of G° .

Theorem 30.2 (A transverse corank-two tail and its power maps). *The closure of the generic lifted curve of (30.1) in $\text{CQ}(V) \times D$ is*

$$Z = \text{Bl}_o X. \quad (30.2)$$

It is flat over D , and its special fibre is the reduced nodal union $C \cup F$, where $C \simeq \mathbb{P}^1$ is the lifted special pencil and $F \simeq \mathbb{P}^1$ is an exceptional tail. There are no embedded components. If H_q is the exterior-power hyperplane bundle of order q , then

$$(\deg_C H_q, \deg_F H_q) = \begin{cases} (q, 0), & 1 \leq q \leq n - 2, \\ (n - 2, 1), & q = n - 1. \end{cases} \quad (30.3)$$

Thus the special fibre has the same Hilbert polynomial $\binom{n}{2}m + 1$ as the generic lifted line.

The tail lies in E_{n-2} , its two intersections with E_{n-1} are distinct and reduced, and its attachment to C is neither of those two points. For any $h \geq 1$, let L_p be the hyperplane bundle of the resolved p th power map. Then

$$\deg_F L_p = \begin{cases} 0, & p \leq h(n - 2), \\ \min\{b, 2h - b\}, & p = h(n - 2) + b, \quad 0 \leq b \leq 2h. \end{cases} \quad (30.4)$$

When this degree is positive, the restricted map on F is the complete Veronese map of that degree into its linear span. Most directly, in the local coordinate $z = s/t$ at o ,

$$J_{h(n-2)+1}(A_\tau) = (z, \tau). \quad (30.5)$$

Hence a single multiplication power ideal selects the blow-up centre and its exceptional component.

Proof. The rank is at least $n - 2$ on X . In a neighbourhood of o the last $n - 2$ diagonal entries are units; all other spectral points have rank $n - 1$ and are pairwise distinct. Consequently the extended minor ideals I_q are the unit ideal for $q \leq n - 2$, while

$$I_{n-1} = (z, z + \tau) = (z, \tau), \quad I_n = (uz(z + \tau))$$

near o , with u a unit. Away from o , I_{n-1} is a unit ideal; I_n is everywhere invertible. The simultaneous exterior-power graph on the integral surface X is therefore the blow-up of (z, τ) . This is an application of the graph-by-generators lemma, not a claim that arbitrary base change of a blow-up is a blow-up. Since the universal family of pencil lines embeds X into $\mathbb{P}(\text{Sym}^2 V) \times D$, this graph embeds into $\text{CQ}(V) \times D$ and is the required scheme-theoretic closure.

On the chart with $\tau = zv$, the special fibre has equation $zv = 0$; on the other chart, $z = \tau w$, it has equation $\tau = 0$. These charts prove flatness over the DVR, multiplicity one of both components, their transverse intersection, and absence of embedded components. The map on C

is the unique lift of the special pencil. The q -minors of that pencil have degree q . They have no common factor for $q \leq n - 2$, and precisely one factor s for $q = n - 1$. This proves their degrees on C . On F , all lower maps are constant, and the $(n - 1)$ st exterior map is linear. This gives (30.3). For $L = \bigotimes H_q$, the degrees on C and F add to $\binom{n}{2}$. The normalization sequence of $C \cup F$ subtracts one point, so its Euler characteristic is one and its Hilbert polynomial is as stated. Thus it is the Hilbert limit used by $\widehat{G}$; equivalently the generic morphism from D extends to $\widehat{G}$ by properness, with this universal fibre.

Use homogeneous coordinates $[\alpha : \beta] = [z : \tau]$ on F . After removing the exceptional factor, the residual quadratic form on the two-dimensional kernel is $\text{diag}(\alpha, \alpha + \beta)$. This is a line in $\text{CQ}(\mathbb{C}^2) = \mathbb{P}(\text{Sym}^2 \mathbb{C}^2)$, and gives the claimed image of F in the fibre of E_{n-2} . Its determinant $\alpha(\alpha + \beta)$ has two simple zeros $[0 : 1]$ and $[-1 : 1]$, which are its intersections with E_{n-1} . The main component attaches at $[1 : 0]$, where this residual form is nondegenerate.

For clarity, the whole list of extended power ideals near o is

$$J_p = \begin{cases} \mathcal{O}, & p \leq h(n-2), \\ (z, \tau)^b, & p = h(n-2) + b, \ 0 \leq b \leq h, \\ (z, \tau)^{2h-b} [z(z + \tau)]^{b-h}, & p = h(n-2) + b, \ h \leq b \leq 2h, \end{cases} \quad (30.6)$$

up to an invertible factor. These are actual ideals, by Theorem 21.1. In particular $b = 1$ gives (30.5) for every h .

It remains to check the linear system on the tail, not only its degree. On diagonal matrices the coefficient polynomials of a p th power span exactly the monomials of total degree p in the diagonal entries with each exponent at most h . For containment, use the torus-weight bound in Lemma 21.2; for the reverse inclusion, take the coefficients of the independent diagonal entries of X in $\det(X + uA)^h$. Thus, for $p = h(n-2) + b$, the leading normal coefficients use exponent h in each of the $n - 2$ invertible entries and span

$$\alpha^j (\alpha + \beta)^{b-j}, \quad \max\{0, b - h\} \leq j \leq \min\{b, h\}.$$

If $b \leq h$ these span every binary form of degree b . If $b > h$, remove the common factor $[\alpha(\alpha + \beta)]^{b-h}$; the remaining monomials span every binary form of degree $2h - b$. Lower powers have nonzero constant normal term and are constant on F . This proves the complete-linear-system assertion and (30.4). $\square$

Remark 30.3 (What the failure family contributes). Along (30.1), the original finite failure algebras form the finite locally free family already constructed in Corollary 6.5. Its pullback to F is constant; we do not count that pullback as a new interaction. Instead, its first relation canonically recovers the source and the pencil line, and the source-normalized envelope has the total-base ideal (30.5). Resolving that multiplication ideal creates F , and the other products prescribe all the linear systems (30.4) on it. A degeneration arc, not only its closed failure algebra, supplies this total-base ideal. Thus the calculation distinguishes information in the family from information in the special point and supplies an explicit modular Hilbert limit.

31. UNIVERSAL PROPERTY OF THE INTRINSIC ENVELOPE

The intrinsic envelope is a construction from the multiplication table, not an identification of an auxiliary coefficient section with the original algebra. Its universal property can be stated before choosing a linear source or recovering a representative of the pencil.

Proposition 31.1 (The source-normalized nilpotence envelope). *Let S_A and $\mathcal{E}_A = \mathcal{H}om(J^1 L, L)$ be as in Theorem 27.1. The algebra $\mathcal{B}_{A,h}$ represents, on S_A , graded commutative algebras C*

equipped with a linear map $\mathrm{Sym}^2 \mathcal{E}_A \rightarrow C_1$ for which

$$(\text{image of } u^2)^{h+1} = 0$$

for every local section u , also after base change. More precisely, giving such a map is equivalent to giving a unique graded algebra map $\mathcal{B}_{A,h} \rightarrow C$. The degree-zero part maps by the structure map. This property, its representing algebra, and its projectivized power maps descend along the oriented source torsor. The case $h = 1$ requires no additional integer choice and gives the same native graph as every $h \geq 1$.

Proof. The symmetric algebra is free on its degree-one module. In characteristic zero the span of $(u^2)^{h+1}$ is exactly the image of

$$\mathrm{Sym}^{2h+2} \mathcal{E}_A \longrightarrow \mathrm{Sym}^{h+1}(\mathrm{Sym}^2 \mathcal{E}_A), \quad u^{2h+2} \longmapsto (u^2)^{h+1}.$$

Polarization verifies this assertion on every trivializing open; the required denominators are nonzero integers, hence units on every complex base. Factoring a free-algebra map through the ideal generated by this image is equivalent to the displayed identities. This proves existence and uniqueness and their compatibility with base change.

On $\mathbb{P}(V)$, evaluation of linear sections identifies $J^1 \mathcal{O}(1)$ with $V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}$. Thus $\mathcal{E}_A = V \otimes \mathcal{O}(1)$. A scalar on V acts oppositely on $\mathcal{O}(1)$, so it acts trivially on $\mathcal{E}_A$, the Cartan map, and the quotient. This proves descent without choosing a global $\mathcal{O}(1)$ on a nonsplit source bundle. The scalar action on each untwisted coefficient space is scalar, and hence also disappears on its projectivization. The graph assertions follow from Theorems 22.1 and 28.1. $\square$

This universal property distinguishes an algebra bundle constructed from the intrinsic source from a preferred linear subquotient of A . The former is proved; the latter is neither needed nor asserted. The source is extracted by the determinant and oriented-ruling steps of the first-relation inverse, before its final pencil-coefficient step.

32. ORDINARY COLLISION STRATA AND THEIR HILBERT FIBRES

We compute simultaneous collisions of arbitrary multiplicities, and allow higher-order perturbations of the total family. Besides describing its reduced components, we determine every resolved power system and exhibit positive-dimensional families in a fibre of the pencil incidence modification. The calculation uses the ordinary power ideals on the two-dimensional total base.

32.1. A local ideal calculation.

Lemma 32.1 (Distinct tangent factors). *Let $\ell_1, \dots, \ell_c$ be pairwise nonproportional linear forms in two variables. For $0 \leq j < c$, the products of j distinct ℓ_i span all binary forms of degree j . Consequently, if R is a regular local complex surface ring with maximal ideal $\mathfrak{n} = (z, \tau)$, and a symmetric $c \times c$ matrix S satisfies*

$$S = zC + \tau D + O(\mathfrak{n}^2), \quad C \text{ nonsingular}, \quad \det(\alpha C + \beta D) \text{ squarefree},$$

then $I_j(S) = \mathfrak{n}^j$ for $j < c$, while $I_c(S) = (\det S)$.

Proof. Choose $j + 1$ of the linear forms. Their products obtained by omitting one factor are linearly independent: evaluation at the zero of the omitted factor kills all other products and not that one. Their number is $j + 1$, the dimension of the required binary-form space. For $j = 0$ the assertion is immediate.

The endomorphism $C^{-1}D$ is self-adjoint for C and has distinct eigenvalues. Its eigenspaces are orthogonal and none is isotropic, since otherwise C would be degenerate. A constant congruence therefore makes $\alpha C + \beta D$ diagonal with distinct linear entries. Its j -minors span $\mathrm{Sym}^j(\mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2)$. The entries of S lie in $\mathfrak{n}$, so $I_j(S) \subset \mathfrak{n}^j$ and $I_j(S) + \mathfrak{n}^{j+1} = \mathfrak{n}^j$. Nakayama's lemma applied to

$\mathfrak{n}^j/I_j(S)$ proves equality. The argument may be made after completion and descended by faithful flatness. The determinant assertion is its definition. $\square$

Lemma 32.2 (Block products and the first normal term). *For $V = U \oplus W$, multiplication gives an injection*

$$B_h(U) \otimes B_h(W) \longrightarrow B_h(V).$$

If $\dim U = r$, $Q \in \text{Sym}^2 U$ is nonsingular, and $S \in \mathfrak{n} \otimes \text{Sym}^2 W$ has a generically nonsingular linear term S_1 , the first nonzero normal term of $(Q + S)^p$, for $hr < p \leq h \dim V$, is

$$\binom{p}{hr} Q^{hr} S_1^{p-hr}.$$

For $p \leq hr$ its order-zero term Q^p is nonzero. These statements remain valid with a nonsingular formal unit block and after a formal congruence, with the corresponding invertible changes of coefficients.

Proof. The Cartan relations on each summand vanish in $B_h(V)$, so the algebra map is defined. Its source is Artin Gorenstein. Its socle is the product of the two socles, and that product is nonzero in $B_h(V)$: in determinant apolarity this is the nonzero mixed top derivative of $\det(X_U)^h \det(X_W)^h$, obtained by restricting to block diagonal matrices. A nonzero ideal in an Artin local Gorenstein algebra meets its socle: successive multiplication of a nonzero ideal by the maximal ideal ends in a nonzero subspace annihilated by that maximal ideal. The kernel is therefore zero.

Expand $(Q + S)^p$ in the injected tensor product. Powers of Q above hr vanish, whereas Q^{hr} is a nonzero socle generator. For $p > hr$ the term with the fewest factors of S consequently has precisely $p - hr$ such factors and is the displayed term. The unit block and a formal change of frame specialize to invertible changes on the associated graded coefficient space. This proves the last assertion as well. $\square$

32.2. The simultaneous collision theorem. Let $D_0 = \text{Spec } \mathbb{C}[[\tau]]$, let $\mathcal{R}$ be a rank-two pencil subbundle of $\text{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}_{D_0}$, and put $X = \mathbb{P}(\mathcal{R})$. Assume its generic pencil has n distinct spectral points. Its special pencil is assumed regular. Apart from simple spectral points, suppose it has distinct points $x_1, \dots, x_k$ of coranks c_a , where $2 \leq c_a \leq n - 1$. Write $r_a = n - c_a$.

At x_a , choose a parameter z_a on the special pencil and a unit $r_a \times r_a$ block. Its symmetric Schur complement is required to satisfy

$$S_a = z_a C_a + \tau D_a + O((z_a, \tau)^2), \quad C_a \text{ nonsingular}, \quad \det(\alpha C_a + \beta D_a) \text{ has } c_a \text{ simple zeros.} \quad (32.1)$$

We call this an ordinary transverse cluster. Intrinsically, $C_a, D_a \in \text{Sym}^2 W_a$, where $W_a = (\ker(A(x_a) : V^* \rightarrow V))^*$. Their pencil is the first derivative of the form restricted to its radical. Taking a Schur complement does not alter that first derivative. Replacing the parameter changes the basis of this residual pencil and preserves its marked member $[C_a]$. Thus the hypothesis does not depend on the chosen complement or frame.

Theorem 32.3 (Simultaneous ordinary collision fibres). *Under (32.1), the schematic closure of the generic lifted pencil in $\text{CQ}(V) \times D_0$ is*

$$Z = \text{Bl}_{\{x_1, \dots, x_k\}} X. \quad (32.2)$$

It is regular and flat over D_0 . Its special fibre is the reduced nodal tree

$$C \cup F_1 \cup \dots \cup F_k,$$

where C is the lift of the special pencil and each $F_a \simeq \mathbb{P}^1$ meets C in one point. There are no embedded components and the tails are pairwise disjoint. The tail F_a is the complete-quadric lift

of the pointed residual pencil $([\alpha C_a + \beta D_a], [C_a])$ on W_a . It lies in E_{r_a} , meets E_{n-1} in c_a distinct reduced points, meets no other boundary divisor, and attaches at the nonsingular member $[C_a]$.

Let H_q be the hyperplane bundle of the resolved q th exterior map, $1 \leq q \leq n-1$. Then

$$\deg_{F_a} H_q = (q - r_a)_+, \quad \deg_C H_q = q - \sum_a (q - r_a)_+. \quad (32.3)$$

For the product polarization $\bigotimes_{q=1}^{n-1} H_q$ the Hilbert polynomial is $\binom{n}{2}m + 1$. In particular $\deg F_a = \binom{c_a}{2}$ and $\deg C = \binom{n}{2} - \sum_a \binom{c_a}{2}$.

For every $h \geq 1$ and $1 \leq p \leq hn$, set

$$b_a = (p - hr_a)_+, \quad s_p = (p - h(n-1))_+, \quad \delta_{a,p} = b_a - c_a s_p. \quad (32.4)$$

These integers are nonnegative. The resolved p th power restricts to the complete linear system of degree $\delta_{a,p}$ on F_a . It is constant if that degree is zero, and otherwise the complete Veronese map into its linear span. Near x_a , with $\mathbf{n}_a = (z_a, \tau)$ and $f_a = \det S_a$, the exact ideals are

$$J_p(A) = \mathbf{n}_a^{\delta_{a,p}} (f_a)^{s_p}, \quad J_{hr_a+1}(A) = \mathbf{n}_a. \quad (32.5)$$

Equalities are up to multiplication by a unit after a local frame is fixed, not up to radical or integral closure. Consequently the multiplication powers select the graph modification and every tail linear system. This description depends only on the first normal jet in (32.1); with the special pencil fixed, higher-order terms do not change its embedded special fibre or its power maps.

Proof. Near x_a the unit block and its Schur complement give $I_q(A) = \mathcal{O}$ for $q \leq r_a$ and $I_{r_a+j}(A) = I_j(S_a)$. Lemma 32.1 therefore gives

$$I_{r_a+j}(A) = \mathbf{n}_a^j \quad (1 \leq j < c_a), \quad I_n(A) = (u_a f_a), \quad u_a \in \mathcal{O}^\times.$$

At every other point the rank is at least $n-1$, so all minor ideals of order at most $n-1$ are units. The determinant ideal is invertible. The simultaneous exterior graph is the blow-up of the product of its base ideals by Lemma 26.2. Near x_a this product is $\mathbf{n}_a^{\binom{c_a}{2}}$. A positive power has the same blow-up as the ideal itself, and the points are disjoint. These local identifications glue uniquely over X to (32.2). This computes the graph on the total surface; it is not an assertion that graph closure commutes with arbitrary base change.

The tautological family of genuine pencil lines embeds X into $\mathbb{P}(\text{Sym}^2 V) \times D_0$. Hence the simultaneous graph embedding places Z in $\text{CQ}(V) \times D_0$, with exactly the prescribed generic curve. The two charts $\tau = z_a v$ and $z_a = \tau w$ of each point blow-up show that Z is regular. In the first chart its special fibre is $z_a v = 0$. Both branches have multiplicity one and intersect transversally. In the second chart only the exceptional branch occurs. The parameter τ is a nonzerodivisor, so Z is flat over the DVR. The charts also rule out embedded components.

On F_a , divide the Schur block by the exceptional parameter. Its value is $\alpha C_a + \beta D_a$. All earlier unit-block data specialize to their values at x_a , independently of the direction. The complete-quadric chart thus identifies F_a with the lifted residual pencil in the fibre over $[A(x_a)]$. Its only residual rank drops have corank one and occur at the c_a simple determinant zeros. This proves the boundary assertions, including the attachment at $[\alpha : \beta] = [1 : 0]$. For $q = r_a + j < n$, the leading q -minors are the j -minors of this residual pencil. They have no common zero and have degree j . The lower maps are constant. On C , the common factor in the q -minors has order $(q - r_a)_+$ at x_a and no other zeros. This proves (32.3). The sum of the component degrees is $\binom{n}{2}$. The normalization sequence for a tree of $k+1$ projective lines subtracts its k nodes, so its Euler characteristic is one. This proves the Hilbert polynomial and identifies the curve as the fibre in the Hilbert incidence space.

For the power ideals apply Theorem 21.1. If $p \leq hr_a$, the ideal is the unit ideal. Otherwise write $p = hr_a + hj + s$ with $0 \leq s < h$. For $j < c_a - 1$, the two minor ideals are $\mathbf{n}_a^j$ and $\mathbf{n}_a^{j+1}$, so

the power ideal is $\mathfrak{n}_a^{hj+s}$. For $j = c_a - 1$ it is

$$\mathfrak{n}_a^{(c_a-1)(h-s)}(f_a)^s.$$

At $p = hn$ it is $(f_a)^h$. These cases are exactly (32.5). The value $p = hr_a + 1$ gives the point ideal for every h .

It remains to identify the complete coefficient space on F_a . By Lemma 32.2, its first normal coefficients, for $p > hr_a$, are exactly those of the b_a th power of the residual pencil, multiplied by a nonzero unit-block socle vector. In the polynomial ring $\mathbb{C}[\alpha, \beta]$, Lemma 32.1 gives $I_j = (\alpha, \beta)^j$ for $j < c_a$. The universal power identity gives the homogeneous ideal

$$(\alpha, \beta)^{\delta_{a,p}} \det(\alpha C_a + \beta D_a)^{s_p}.$$

All its original power generators have degree b_a ; therefore their span is its entire degree- b_a part. Remove the common determinant factor. The remaining space is exactly $H^0(\mathbb{P}^1, \mathcal{O}(\delta_{a,p}))$, proving the assertion about the linear system. This argument determines the map as well as its degree. All surviving leading coefficients use only the first normal jet; the higher-order terms vanish on the exceptional divisor. $\square$

32.3. A modular family over a fixed pencil. Let R_0 be a regular pencil whose spectral elementary divisors all have exponent one, with repeated spectral multiplicities $c_1, \dots, c_k \geq 2$. Thus these are semisimple collisions, not nontrivial Jordan blocks. At x_a keep the residual space W_a and the nonsingular tangent member $[C_a]$. Put

$$U_a = \{\ell \text{ a line through } [C_a] \text{ in } \mathbb{P}(\text{Sym}^2 W_a) : \ell \text{ meets the determinant in } c_a \text{ simple points}\}. \quad (32.6)$$

This is a nonempty open in $\mathbb{P}(\text{Sym}^2 W_a / \langle C_a \rangle)$, of dimension $\binom{c_a+1}{2} - 2$.

Theorem 32.4 (Residual-pencil moduli in an incidence fibre). *The product $U = \prod_a U_a$ parametrizes an algebraic flat family of distinct embedded Hilbert limits over the fixed pencil R_0 . Each is the fixed main curve with the tails prescribed by its residual lines, and each is realized by an ordinary transverse one-parameter smoothing of R_0 . Hence, for the normal incidence modification $\rho : \hat{G} \rightarrow G$, one has*

$$\dim \rho^{-1}(R_0) \geq \sum_a \left(\binom{c_a+1}{2} - 2 \right). \quad (32.7)$$

Distinctness is detected by the resolved multiplication power $J_{h(n-c_a)+1}$ on the a th tail. The statement describes a specified family in the fibre, not the entirety of the fibre or its normalization.

Proof. Since C_a is nonsingular, lines through $[C_a]$ are parametrized by the displayed projective quotient. The condition on determinant zeros is open and nonempty, as is seen by choosing D_a diagonal with distinct eigenvalues relative to C_a .

The complete-quadric morphism is an isomorphism over forms of rank at least $c_a - 1$. Each line in U_a stays in this open, and thus its universal line has an algebraic lift. The fibre of $\text{CQ}(V) \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(\text{Sym}^2 V)$ over $[A(x_a)]$ contains the residual $\text{CQ}(W_a)$: the nondegenerate first quotient form is fixed, and its radical carries the remaining complete form. This follows also by taking the unit block in the Schur charts used in the preceding proof. Thus the universal lifted lines give an algebraic family of embedded tails, each passing through the fixed attachment corresponding to $[C_a]$.

Adjoin the fixed main curve. The scheme-theoretic intersection of each tail family with that main curve is just this reduced section. Indeed the main curve has contact order one with E_{r_a} ,

since its local nonzero Smith exponents are 0 and 1, whereas the tail lies inside that divisor. The tails lie over different points, hence do not intersect each other. The union exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{C \cup \bigcup F_a} \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{C \times U} \oplus \bigoplus_a \mathcal{O}_{F_a} \longrightarrow \bigoplus_a \mathcal{O}_{\{\text{attachment}_a\} \times U} \longrightarrow 0$$

proves flatness over U : the two terms on the right are flat, so its kernel is flat. The degrees from (32.3) give the required fixed Hilbert polynomial. We therefore obtain a morphism U to the Hilbert scheme. The embedded fibre over $[A(x_a)]$ recovers its residual tail. Its first nonconstant exterior map, equivalently the power of index $h(n - c_a) + 1$, has degree one and recovers the line ℓ itself. Distinct parameters give distinct embedded curves.

To see that these Hilbert points belong to the graph closure defining $\widehat{G}$, choose a nonsingular member of R_0 . Semisimplicity makes its spectral eigenspaces orthogonal, so in a congruence frame the pencil is a direct sum of blocks $(z - x_a)C_a$ and simple blocks. Choose any representative D_a of each residual line and replace these blocks by $(z - x_a)C_a + \tau D_a$. Each cluster splits into c_a simple spectral points and distinct clusters stay separated. Theorem 32.3 identifies the Hilbert limit with the constructed curve. This realizes every parameter by a smoothing, independently on all the blocks.

Let $\overline{G}$ denote the reduced Hilbert graph before normalization. The morphism from the smooth, reduced scheme U factors through its fibre over R_0 : the defining equations vanish at every closed point by the smoothing construction, hence vanish on U . Its geometric fibres are zero-dimensional by the distinctness just proved; its image consequently has dimension $\dim U$. Normalization $\widehat{G} \rightarrow \overline{G}$ is finite and surjective, and the preimage of this image has the same dimension. This gives (32.7). We use this finite preimage, rather than asserting that a nondominant map from a normal scheme must lift to a normalization. Such an assertion would not be a valid normalization universal property. $\square$

Example 32.5 (Triple collision). For one semisimple triple collision, $c = 3$, the tail has exterior multidegree $(0, \dots, 0, 1, 2)$ and total degree three. At $h = 2$ its successive residual powers $b = 0, \dots, 6$ have degrees

$$0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 2, 0.$$

The residual lines through a fixed nonsingular ternary quadratic form form an open in $\mathbb{P}^4$, and give a four-dimensional family of distinct Hilbert limits over the same special pencil. Every member has three distinct spectral points on its tail and one nonspectral attachment. This is a family of embedded limits, not just a count of branches of a normalization fibre.

The special finite failure algebra remains A_{R_0} throughout this family of limits. What varies is the total-family first-relation geometry: its intrinsic envelope produces the maximal-ideal centre, its successive products give the tail systems, and their degree-one member recovers the residual line. Thus the family supplies information not contained in its closed algebra alone. The construction is equivariant under source congruence and under reparametrization of the pencil, but the dimension bound concerns the embedded incidence space, not a quotient by its stabilizer.

33. THE SIMPLE CORANK-TWO INCIDENCE MODIFICATION

The ordinary-collision calculation describes specified families of limits. We now identify the entire normalized Hilbert incidence space on a natural open of the pencil Grassmannian. The result holds in every dimension. It does not require a semisimple collision or a squarefree residual pencil.

Let $n \geq 3$, $M = \text{Sym}^2 V$, $P = \mathbb{P}(M)$, and $G = \text{Gr}(2, M)$. Write $Z_j \subset P$ for the symmetric rank-at-most- j scheme, and put $Z_0 = \emptyset$ when $n = 3$. Let $\mathcal{U} \subset G$ consist of regular pencils R such that their lines $L_R = \mathbb{P}(R)$ avoid Z_{n-3} and their scheme-theoretic intersections with Z_{n-2} are

either empty or a single reduced point. Write $\mathcal{P}$ for the universal line over $\mathcal{U}$. We use projective spaces of lines, so that the exceptional fibre of a smooth blow-up is the projectivization of the normal space.

Lemma 33.1 (The incidence centre and its normal space). *The locus $\mathcal{U}$ is open and contains G° of Proposition 24.1. Its incidence scheme*

$$\mathcal{D} = \mathcal{P} \times_P Z_{n-2} \longrightarrow \mathcal{U}$$

is a closed immersion with smooth image Σ_2 of codimension two. At $R \in \Sigma_2$, let $p = L_R \cap Z_{n-2}$ and let $a_R \subset N_{Z_{n-2}/P,p}$ be the nonzero image of $T_p L_R$. There is a canonical isomorphism

$$N_{\Sigma_2/\mathcal{U},R} \simeq N_{Z_{n-2}/P,p}/a_R. \quad (33.1)$$

Near (p, R) , after an etale change of base and coordinates, the ideal of $\mathcal{D}$ in $\mathcal{P}$ is

$$I_{n-1}(A) = (x, u, v), \quad I_{\Sigma_2} = (u, v), \quad (33.2)$$

where x is a relative line coordinate and u, v are part of a regular system of parameters on the base. The generators may be changed by an invertible matrix; the asserted equality is an equality of ideals.

Proof. On $P \setminus Z_{n-3}$ the scheme Z_{n-2} is smooth of codimension three. A nonsingular $(n-2)$ -block reduces its equations to the three entries of a symmetric 2×2 Schur complement. In particular these are regular local equations for its given determinantal scheme structure.

The universal line evaluation $\mathcal{P}_G \rightarrow P$ is smooth: over a point of P its fibre is the projective space of lines through that point. Hence its inverse image of the smooth rank locus is smooth and has dimension $\dim G - 2$. Lines contained in the rank locus, or meeting the lower rank locus, form closed exceptional sets after the usual proper incidence projection. On the complementary open the incidence projection is finite. The condition that its fibre have length at most one is open, by upper semicontinuity for a finite module. This proves the asserted openness. On this open the unit map $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{U}} \rightarrow q_* \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{D}}$ is surjective: on each geometric fibre its target is either zero or a one-dimensional algebra with unit, and Nakayama's lemma applies to its coherent cokernel. Thus q is a closed immersion. Its source is smooth by the smooth evaluation just noted; its codimension is two.

First-order motion of a line evaluates surjectively onto $T_p P / T_p L_R$: in the description $T_R G = \text{Hom}(R, M/R)$ this is restriction to the one-dimensional subspace representing p . To remain incident to the rank locus, this evaluation must vanish in $T_p P / (T_p Z_{n-2} + T_p L_R)$. A reduced intersection means that the normal image of $T_p L_R$ is nonzero. The kernel is precisely $T_R \Sigma_2$, since the incidence point may move along both the line and the rank locus. The quotient is therefore (33.1).

For the local assertion choose a rank-locus equation with nonzero relative derivative. Its zero hypersurface is etale over the base near (p, R) ; after an etale base change it gives a section. Use that equation as the coordinate x . Subtract multiples of x from the other two equations. Their restrictions to the section are base functions u, v , and the ideal becomes (x, u, v) . The normal-space calculation proves that du, dv are independent. This proves (33.2). The argument is the smooth-centre coordinate calculation, not an assertion that arbitrary graph closures commute with base change. $\square$

The open is nonempty along its centre. For example, a diagonal pencil with two equal linear entries and all other entries having distinct zeros away from their common zero belongs to Σ_2 . Although $a_R \neq 0$, its residual binary quadratic form may have rank one. This case is allowed throughout the following theorem.

Theorem 33.2 (The full simple-incidence Hilbert modification). *For the normalized Hilbert incidence modification $\rho : \widehat{G} \rightarrow G$ of Proposition 24.1, there is a canonical isomorphism over $\mathcal{U}$*

$$\widehat{G} \times_G \mathcal{U} \simeq B := \text{Bl}_{\Sigma_2} \mathcal{U}. \quad (33.3)$$

It is equivariant under source congruence. In particular this part of the incidence space is smooth. Its exceptional divisor $F = \mathbb{P}(N_{\Sigma_2/\mathcal{U}})$ is a $\mathbb{P}^1$ -bundle, and

$$K_B = \beta^* K_{\mathcal{U}} + F, \quad \mathcal{O}_B(F)|_{F_R} = \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(-1), \quad (33.4)$$

where $\beta : B \rightarrow \mathcal{U}$ is the blow-up.

For every $R \in \Sigma_2$ the entire fibre of ρ is $F_R \simeq \mathbb{P}^1$. Its point $[\bar{b}] \in \mathbb{P}(N_{Z_{n-2}/P,p}/a_R)$ represents the reduced nodal curve

$$C_R \cup \ell_{[\bar{b}]}, \quad \ell_{[\bar{b}]} = \mathbb{P}(a_R + \mathbb{C}b) \subset \pi^{-1}(p) = \mathbb{P}(N_{Z_{n-2}/P,p}). \quad (33.5)$$

Here C_R is the strict transform of L_R and b is any lift of $\bar{b}$. The tail attaches to C_R at $[a_R]$. Every line through $[a_R]$ in this exceptional $\mathbb{P}^2$ occurs, and no further components, embedded points, or nonreduced fibres occur over this open. The two components have exterior multidegrees

$$\deg_{C_R} H_q = q - \mathbf{1}_{q=n-1}, \quad \deg_{\ell} H_q = \mathbf{1}_{q=n-1} \quad (1 \leq q < n). \quad (33.6)$$

Their common Hilbert polynomial is $\binom{n}{2}m + 1$ for $\bigotimes_{q=1}^{n-1} H_q$.

The universal curve over B is the simultaneous multiplication graph on $\mathcal{P} \times_{\mathcal{U}} B$. Near a node it is etale locally $xy = t$, where $t = 0$ defines F . Thus it is a flat family of nodal curves, including along directions for which the residual determinant has a repeated zero. It commutes with base change as this specified flat family. The blow-up is characterized by the universal property that $I_{\Sigma_2} \mathcal{O}_B$ is an invertible ideal; the corresponding factorization property holds for every $T \rightarrow \mathcal{U}$ on which that image ideal is an effective Cartier ideal.

Proof. On $P \setminus Z_{n-3}$, the complete-quadric morphism is exactly the blow-up of the smooth centre Z_{n-2} : all earlier rank blow-ups are isomorphisms there and the determinant divisor requires no blow-up. We use the scheme-level classical construction [34, Remark 2.5 and Construction 2.6], originating in [33, Theorem 6.3]. Nothing in this step declares the space of complete quadrics itself new.

Pull the universal line back to B . In a base blow-up chart $u = t$, $v = tw$, the ideal (33.2) becomes (x, t) . Its blow-up has the two charts

$$\mathcal{O}_B[x, y]/(xy - t), \quad \mathcal{O}_B[z], \quad x = tz.$$

They glue by the usual ratio change. Their total spaces are smooth, and they are flat over B . For example $\mathcal{O}_B[x, y]/(xy - t)$ is free as an $\mathcal{O}_B$ -module with basis $1, x, x^2, \dots, y, y^2, \dots$; reduction by the monic relation $xy - t$ gives this basis. Its fibres at $t = 0$ have two reduced branches and one ordinary node. The other base chart has the same description. Outside the incidence section the pulled ideal is the unit ideal. Blowing up the globally defined pulled ideal therefore gives a projective flat family $\mathcal{C}_B$ with these local charts. All smaller minor ideals are units on this open. The universal power identity makes the product of the nontrivial power ideals an h^2 th power of I_{n-1} , up to an invertible determinant ideal. Thus this same blow-up is the simultaneous multiplication graph for every h , not only the exterior graph.

There is a closed immersion $\mathcal{C}_B \hookrightarrow \text{CQ}(V) \times B$. Indeed the base-changed Rees algebra of the rank-locus ideal surjects onto the Rees algebra of its image on the universal line; taking Proj gives a closed immersion into the base-changed complete-quadric graph. The universal line is already closed in $P \times B$. Composing these two closed immersions proves the assertion. Equivalently, use the simultaneous graph lemma on the integral total space. This argument does not identify a

general base change of a blow-up with the blow-up of the image ideal without the indicated Rees quotient.

In normal coordinates at p , the exceptional map is $[x : t] \mapsto [xa_R + tb]$, with b representing the normal direction of the base motion. Formula (33.1) implies that a_R, b are independent. This is a line embedded in $\mathbb{P}(N_{Z_{n-2}/P,p})$, not a multiple cover. The strict-transform branch meets it at $[a_R]$. This proves (33.5), including the converse parametrization of all lines through that point. The local charts show the absence of embedded components and multiplicities.

The minor systems of orders $q < n - 1$ have no base point on L_R . The $(n - 1)$ -minors have one simple common zero, by (33.2). Their degrees on C_R are therefore q and $n - 2$, respectively. On the exceptional $\mathbb{P}^2$ only the last exterior system has positive degree, namely one. This proves (33.6). The two projective lines have Euler characteristic $2 - 1 = 1$, since their intersection is one reduced point. Their total degree is $\binom{n}{2}$.

The flat embedded family defines a morphism from B to the reduced Hilbert graph closure over $\mathcal{U}$. It is proper because B is proper over $\mathcal{U}$ and the Hilbert graph is separated over that base. Its image is exactly the graph closure: it is closed and contains the dense graph over $\mathcal{U} \setminus \Sigma_2 = G^\circ$, while B is integral. Over an incident pencil the displayed exceptional lines are pairwise distinct as embedded curves; over a nonincident pencil the fibre is a point. The morphism thus has finite geometric fibres and is finite by [Stacks Project, Tag 02LS]. It is birational, and B is normal because its centre is smooth. A finite birational map from a normal integral scheme identifies it with the normalization: on affine charts its ring is the integral closure in the common function field. Normalization commutes with restriction to the open $\mathcal{U}$. This proves (33.3), without assuming that an arbitrary nondominant normal test scheme lifts to a normalization.

All maps are specified by the universal incidence and agree on the dense nonincident locus. Their uniqueness proves canonicity and congruence equivariance. For completeness, in coordinates $v = uw$, $du \wedge dv = u du \wedge dw$, giving the discrepancy one in (33.4). The exceptional normal bundle is tautological of degree -1 . The universal property is the usual Rees-algebra factorization for an effective Cartier image ideal [Stacks Project, Tag 0806]; here the preceding argument identifies the actual Hilbert incidence modification with that universal object. Flat pullback preserves the explicitly constructed nodal family. No assertion about unrestricted graph-closure base change is used. $\square$

33.1. Every power on every exceptional direction.

Proposition 33.3 (Complete exceptional power systems). *Fix $R \in \Sigma_2$ and $p = L_R \cap Z_{n-2}$. For $h \geq 1$ and $1 \leq j \leq hn$, define*

$$\delta_j = (j - h(n - 2))_+ - 2(j - h(n - 1))_+. \quad (33.7)$$

On the full exceptional plane $\pi^{-1}(p) \simeq \mathbb{P}^2$, the resolved j th multiplication map is the complete degree- δ_j Veronese map into its linear span, with degree zero interpreted as constant. Its restriction to every tail in (33.5) is therefore the complete degree- δ_j system on $\mathbb{P}^1$. In particular $j = h(n - 2) + 1$ detects the tail as an embedded line. These assertions include tangent lines to the residual determinant conic and attachments on that conic.

Proof. A unit $(n - 2)$ -block leaves a residual two-dimensional space W . Lemma 32.2 identifies the first nonzero normal coefficient at degree $j > h(n - 2)$ with the power of order $b = j - h(n - 2)$ in $B_h(W)$, multiplied by a nonzero unit-block socle. For $j \leq h(n - 2)$ the order-zero coefficient is constant on the exceptional fibre. In the three-variable coordinate ring of $\text{Sym}^2 W$, put $\mathfrak{a} = I_1$ and $f = \det$. The universal ideal formula gives

$$J_b = \mathfrak{a}^b \quad (b \leq h), \quad J_b = \mathfrak{a}^{2h-b} f^{b-h} \quad (h \leq b \leq 2h).$$

The generators all have degree b . Their span is the entire degree b part of the displayed ideal. After removal of the common factor $f^{(b-h)+}$ it is the full space of ternary forms of degree $b - 2(b-h)+ = \delta_j$. Hence it defines the complete Veronese system on the exceptional plane. Restriction of all ternary forms to any line gives all binary forms of that degree, independently of its intersection multiplicities with the conic $f = 0$. This proves all assertions, including the endpoint $j = hn$ where the map is constant. $\square$

34. THE INCIDENCE CENTRE FROM FAILURE MULTIPLICATION

We specify how the preceding modification is recovered from a family of sharp failure algebras. This is a construction of its centre and Rees algebra, not merely a pullback of the existing finite algebra. For a framed source let $\Phi : G \rightarrow \mathcal{H}$ be the first-relation closed immersion of Theorem 6.3. Here $\mathcal{H}$ denotes its relation-space Grassmannian. We use $\Phi(\mathcal{U})$ with its induced scheme structure, not an arbitrary neighbourhood in $\mathcal{H}$.

Theorem 34.1 (Intrinsic incidence ideal and normal direction). *On the effective family of sharp pencil-failure algebras corresponding to $\mathcal{U}$, its first relation, oriented source, and multiplication diagram determine I_{Σ_2} and the graded Rees algebra*

$$\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} I_{\Sigma_2}^m. \quad (34.1)$$

Their Proj is the modification in Theorem 33.2. More explicitly, restrict the power ideal $J_{h(n-2)+1}$ to the intrinsic pencil line and let $q : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{U}$ be its zero scheme. Then

$$I_{\Sigma_2} = \ker\{\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{U}} \rightarrow q_*\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{D}}\}. \quad (34.2)$$

The construction is independent of h . It is equivariant for ungraded failure-algebra isomorphisms and descends along an oriented projective source torsor.

An arc through $R \in \Sigma_2$ whose first normal derivative is nonzero has exceptional limit given by its line in $N_{\Sigma_2/\mathcal{U},R}$. Thus its first-order failure-algebra family determines the embedded Hilbert limit. A fixed closed algebra A_R alone determines the pencil and its full exceptional parameter space, but not a preferred point of that space. For higher-contact arcs the leading nonzero normal ideal quotient replaces the first normal derivative.

Proof. The first-relation inverse recovers the oriented projective source and the intrinsic pencil, with its arbitrary-base closed immersion Φ . The source-normalized envelope in Theorem 27.1 supplies its power diagram. The universal power identity gives

$$J_{h(n-2)+1} = I_{n-2}^{h-1} I_{n-1} = I_{n-1}$$

on $P \setminus Z_{n-3}$, since I_{n-2} is the unit ideal there. For $h = 1$ the same formula is $J_{n-1} = I_{n-1}$. Lemma 33.1 identifies its zero scheme on the universal line with Σ_2 by a closed immersion. Taking the kernel of the unit map gives its exact scheme ideal, establishing (34.2). Multiplication of this ideal produces (34.1), whose Proj was identified with the normalized Hilbert graph in the preceding theorem. Because Φ is a closed immersion onto its scheme image, this also gives

$$\mathrm{Bl}_{\Phi(\Sigma_2)} \Phi(\mathcal{U}) \simeq \mathrm{Bl}_{\Sigma_2} \mathcal{U}.$$

This is an identity on the effective image, not an unjustified assertion about blow-ups of the whole ambient Grassmannian.

In the local coordinates of (33.2), an arc with $u(\tau) = \tau b_1 + O(\tau^2)$ and $v(\tau) = \tau b_2 + O(\tau^2)$, $(b_1, b_2) \neq (0, 0)$, lifts to the exceptional point $[b_1 : b_2]$. Under (33.1) this gives exactly the plane $a_R + \mathbb{C}b$ and hence the embedded tail. The arbitrary-base inverse identifies first-order pencil deformations with their effective first-relation deformations. Terms of degree at least two in an ungraded generator change do not change the sharp relation, so they do not change this normal

direction. Higher-contact arcs are handled by dividing u, v by their common smallest power of τ before specializing. This calculation explains why no preferred tail can be assigned to the closed algebra without its normal direction.

Every operation is invariant under the congruence and source-lift changes already treated in the intrinsic-envelope theorem. Its scalar normalization and projectivization remove the linear-lift ambiguity; fppf descent therefore applies to the incidence ideal, its Rees algebra, and the resulting projective family. The universal Cartier factorization property, rather than an assertion of arbitrary blow-up base change, specifies their functorial meaning on test bases. $\square$

Example 34.2 (A complete fibre with a tangential residual limit). For $n = 3$, take the affine two-parameter family of genuine pencils

$$A_{u,v}(s, t) = \begin{pmatrix} s & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & t + us & vs \\ 0 & vs & t - us \end{pmatrix}.$$

Near the pencil $R_0 = \langle \text{diag}(1, 0, 0), \text{diag}(0, 1, 1) \rangle$, the incidence centre is $(u, v) = (0, 0)$. Indeed in the chart $s = 1$ its minor ideal is (t, u, v) , while near $s = 0$ the rank is two. The exceptional fibre is the full projective line $[u : v]$. The arc $(u, v) = \tau(\alpha, \beta)$ gives the residual tail

$$[x : y] \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} x + \alpha y & \beta y \\ \beta y & x - \alpha y \end{pmatrix}, \quad \det = x^2 - (\alpha^2 + \beta^2)y^2.$$

All directions $(\alpha, \beta) \neq (0, 0)$ occur. For $\alpha^2 + \beta^2 \neq 0$ the two residual determinant zeros are distinct. For $[\alpha : \beta] = [1 : i]$ or $[1 : -i]$ they coalesce into a double zero. The tail remains an embedded reduced line and the total curve remains nodal. These two points of the full incidence fibre are not ordinary transverse residual pencils, and so are not covered by the squarefree hypothesis of Theorem 32.3. Every power system at these points is still the complete system of Proposition 33.3. The example separates nodality of the Hilbert fibre from transversality of its boundary contact.

35. MULTIPLE REDUCED INCIDENCE AND ITS COMPLETE HILBERT BOUNDARY

We remove the restriction to a single incidence point. The independence of the incidence conditions is proved from the radicals of distinct members of a regular pencil; it is not added as a transversality hypothesis. The resulting modification has a global Fitting-ideal description even though the incidence points need not be globally labelled.

Put $M = \text{Sym}^2 V$, $P = \mathbb{P}(M)$ and $G = \text{Gr}(2, M)$, with $n = \dim V \geq 3$. Let $Z_j \subset P$ have its symmetric determinantal scheme structure. When $n = 3$ put $Z_0 = \emptyset$. Let G_{reg} be the open of regular pencils and let $X_G = \mathbb{P}(\mathcal{R})$ be the universal line. The image of $X_G \times_P Z_{n-3}$ is closed, since the projection from this incidence is proper. Remove it and call the resulting open $G_* \subset G_{\text{reg}}$. Every line over G_* meets Z_{n-2} in a finite scheme: a positive-dimensional intersection would contain the line and contradict regularity. Consequently

$$q_*^{\text{inc}} : D_* := X_{G_*} \times_P Z_{n-2} \longrightarrow G_*$$

is proper and quasi-finite, hence finite. Define

$$U_{\text{red}} = G_* \setminus q_*^{\text{inc}}(\text{Supp } \Omega_{D_*/G_*}), \quad D = D_* \times_{G_*} U_{\text{red}}, \quad q : D \rightarrow U_{\text{red}}. \quad (35.1)$$

This is open because q_*^{inc} is finite. Its geometric incidences are precisely the finite reduced intersections: for a finite algebra over $\mathbb{C}$, vanishing of relative differentials is equivalent to being a product of copies of $\mathbb{C}$. Unlike the single-incidence open, it allows every possible number of such points. Set

$$\mathcal{Q} = q_* \mathcal{O}_D, \quad \mathcal{I} = \text{Fitt}_0(\mathcal{Q}), \quad B_{\text{red}} = \text{Bl}_{\mathcal{I}} U_{\text{red}}. \quad (35.2)$$

The zeroth Fitting ideal of the zero module is the unit ideal.

35.1. The general incidence calculation.

Lemma 35.1 (Transverse incidence of a family of curves). *Let S, Y be smooth complex varieties, let $Z \subset Y$ be smooth of codimension $c \geq 2$, and let $X \rightarrow S$ be a smooth family of embedded curves in Y . Suppose $D = X \times_Y Z \rightarrow S$ is finite and unramified. Fix $s \in S$ with incidence points $p_1, \dots, p_k$. Write $a_i \subset N_{Z/Y, p_i}$ for the normal image of $T_{p_i} X_s$. Assume $a_i \neq 0$ and that the joint normal evaluation map*

$$T_s S \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{i=1}^k N_{Z/Y, p_i} / a_i$$

is surjective. Etale locally at s , the incidence splits into closed immersions $D_i \simeq \Sigma_i \hookrightarrow S$, with independent smooth centres of codimension $c - 1$. Near p_i there are coordinates in which

$$I_D = (x_i, u_{i1}, \dots, u_{i,c-1}), \quad I_{\Sigma_i} = (u_{i1}, \dots, u_{i,c-1}), \quad (35.3)$$

where all base parameters u_{ij} are independent. If $\mathcal{Q}_S = q_ \mathcal{O}_D$, then*

$$\text{Fitt}_0(\mathcal{Q}_S) = \prod_i I_{\Sigma_i} = \bigcap_i I_{\Sigma_i}.$$

The blow-up of this ideal is the fibre product of the individual blow-ups. It is smooth, with etale normal-crossing exceptional boundary and fibre $\prod_i \mathbb{P}^{c-2}$ at s .

Proof. Over the strict henselization at s , the finite algebra splits into factors indexed by its geometric fibre. These factors and their idempotents descend to an etale neighbourhood. For each factor the unit map from the base ring has cokernel whose fibre at s is zero: finite base change identifies that fibre with the corresponding one-dimensional residue algebra. Nakayama's lemma, followed by shrinking, makes the unit map surjective. Each factor is therefore a closed immersion. This argument uses the finite algebra, not just the set of its geometric points.

The map of the curve tangent into the normal space is nonzero, so one local equation of Z has nonzero relative derivative. Its zero set is etale over the base. After an etale base change choose this as a section and use that equation as the relative coordinate x_i . Modulo x_i , the other equations become base functions u_{ij} . Their differentials give exactly the joint normal evaluation in the statement. Surjectivity makes them independent regular parameters, proving the normal form and smoothness of all intersections of the centres. In particular the length-one factors in this argument are reduced on complex geometric fibres; reducedness has not been inferred from an arbitrary higher fibre length.

Now $\mathcal{Q}_S = \bigoplus_i \mathcal{O}_S / I_{\Sigma_i}$. Fitting ideals of a direct sum multiply. In the displayed independent coordinates, intersection equals product: in a polynomial coordinate ring a monomial in every ideal uses a variable from each disjoint group, and the equality persists under etale flat extension. Equivalently one may verify it in the faithfully flat completion. The simultaneous blow-up is covered by charts in which, for each i , one u_{ij} is retained and the others are its multiples by new ratios. These charts are smooth and identify the fibre product with the blow-up of the product ideal. The latter equality also follows from the simultaneous Rees graph lemma. There are k independent exceptional parameters, and their zero sets have normal crossings. The fibre consists of independent choices of a line in each normal space of dimension $c - 1$, proving the last assertion. $\square$

The arrangement blow-up mechanism is classical. Li's wonderful-model Theorems 1.2 and 1.3 [Li(2009)] give the normal-crossing and product-ideal description for a building set. Here we have proved the independent-centre case explicitly. The pencil-specific assertion needed to apply it at every point of U_{red} is the following.

Lemma 35.2 (Independence at distinct spectral points). *For every $R \in U_{\text{red}}$, with incidence points $p_1, \dots, p_k$, the joint normal evaluation of Lemma 35.1 is surjective. In particular the local incidence centres have codimension two and meet transversely, without any additional genericity assumption on the other elementary divisors of R .*

Proof. Choose a nonsingular member Q_0 of the pencil and write its other members as $Q_1 - \lambda Q_0$. Put $T = Q_0^{-1}Q_1$ on V^* . The radicals $K_i = \ker(T - \lambda_i)$ at distinct spectral points lie in distinct generalized eigenspaces. Their sum is direct. Restriction therefore gives a surjection

$$\text{Sym}^2 V \longrightarrow \bigoplus_i \text{Sym}^2(K_i^*) :$$

extend a basis of the direct sum of the K_i to a basis of V^* and prescribe the indicated diagonal blocks of a symmetric form. Varying Q_1 with Q_0 fixed realizes every one of these restrictions. At a corank-two point the normal space to the rank locus is the three-dimensional space of forms on K_i , with its harmless local projective twist. The tangent of the pencil maps to the nonzero line a_i , because the incidence is reduced. Quotienting by a_i gives the joint evaluation in the statement. A change of basis of the pencil contributes only multiples of its tangent image in each summand, so the map factors through $T_R G = \text{Hom}(R, M/R)$. It remains surjective after this quotient. This proves the claim also when the tangent form on K_i has rank one rather than rank two. $\square$

35.2. Identification of the full Hilbert graph. Let $G^\circ \subset U_{\text{red}}$ be the open with no corank-two incidence. A pencil over it has a unique lifted embedded curve in $Q = \text{CQ}(V)$. Use the polarization $H = \bigotimes_{q=1}^{n-1} H_q$, where H_q is the resolved exterior hyperplane bundle, and put $P_H(l) = \binom{n}{2}l + 1$. Let Γ_{red} be the reduced closure of this graph in $U_{\text{red}} \times \text{Hilb}^{P_H}(Q)$, and let $\hat{\Gamma}_{\text{red}}$ be its normalization. Thus $\hat{\Gamma}_{\text{red}} = \hat{G} \times_G U_{\text{red}}$ with the conventions of Proposition 24.1. This equality uses localization of integral closure [Stacks Project, Section 29.55, Lemmas 29.55.3–4]; it is an open restriction, not an arbitrary base-change assertion.

Theorem 35.3 (The complete multiple-incidence modification). *There is a canonical congruence-equivariant isomorphism*

$$\hat{\Gamma}_{\text{red}} \simeq B_{\text{red}} = \text{Bl}_{\text{Fitt}_0(q^* \mathcal{O}_D)} U_{\text{red}}. \quad (35.4)$$

The space is smooth, and its exceptional boundary has normal crossings etale locally. Over a pencil with k distinct reduced corank-two incidences the whole scheme fibre is $(\mathbb{P}^1)^k$. A point of that fibre specifies independently, at each p_i , a line through $[a_i]$ in

$$\pi^{-1}(p_i) = \mathbb{P}(N_{Z_{n-2}/P, p_i}) \simeq \mathbb{P}^2.$$

Its Hilbert curve is the strict transform C_R of the pencil line, with these k embedded tails attached at their respective points. It is reduced and nodal, with no embedded components. For each tail F_i and each $1 \leq q < n$,

$$\deg_{F_i} H_q = \mathbf{1}_{q=n-1}, \quad \deg_{C_R} H_q = q - k \mathbf{1}_{q=n-1}. \quad (35.5)$$

The incidence scheme satisfies $k \leq \lfloor n/2 \rfloor$.

On a labelled etale neighbourhood the exceptional divisors E_i meet like coordinate hyperplanes; every subset occurs locally, and

$$K_{B_{\text{red}}} = \beta^* K_{U_{\text{red}}} + \sum_i E_i.$$

No global labelling, or global simplicity of each irreducible boundary component, is asserted. The universal curve is a flat nodal family; near its i th node its equation is $x_i y_i = t_i$, with $t_i = 0$ the corresponding exceptional divisor. The base blow-up has its usual effective-Cartier image-ideal universal property. These statements classify all fibres over U_{red} , not only the fibres of selected smoothing arcs.

Proof. Apply the preceding two lemmas with $c = 3$. Locally write $I_i = (u_i, v_i)$. In the simultaneous blow-up chart put $u_i = t_i$, $v_i = t_i w_i$. Near the i th incidence the image of the ambient rank-locus ideal on the pulled-back universal line is (x_i, t_i) . Its blow-up has charts

$$\mathcal{O}_B[x_i, y_i]/(x_i y_i - t_i), \quad \mathcal{O}_B[z_i], \quad x_i = t_i z_i.$$

The incidence points have disjoint neighbourhoods on the curve, so these modifications do not interfere. Outside them the ideal is the unit ideal. The local hypersurfaces are flat over B : they are relative Cartier divisors in a smooth relative plane and their nonzero defining equations remain nonzerodivisors on every fibre. The fibrewise Cartier flatness criterion applies. These are the standard nodal local models, so all the stated fibre properties follow. Their total spaces are smooth in the displayed independent coordinates.

Here is the scheme-level embedding needed for the Hilbert argument. If $\mathcal{K}$ is the rank-locus ideal on the open ambient space and $f : X_B \rightarrow P$ is evaluation, there is a surjection of graded algebras

$$f^* \left(\bigoplus_{d \geq 0} \mathcal{K}^d \right) \rightarrow \bigoplus_{d \geq 0} (\mathcal{K} \mathcal{O}_{X_B})^d. \quad (35.6)$$

Its kernel removes precisely the relations annihilated on passing to the image ideal. The target is the image Rees algebra inside $\mathcal{O}_{X_B}[T]$; it is not an assumed tensor-product identification. Taking Proj gives a closed immersion into the base-changed ambient blow-up, which is Q over rank at least $n - 2$. The universal line is already embedded in $P \times B$. We obtain a flat closed family of curves in $Q \times B$. This agrees with the lifted pencil on the dense nonincident open.

In normal coordinates its exceptional map at p_i is $[x_i : t_i] \mapsto [x_i a_i + t_i b_i]$. The vectors a_i, b_i are independent, and their span determines an embedded line, whose homogeneous ideal is its linear annihilator. Distinct directions modulo a_i therefore give distinct closed subschemes of the exceptional plane, not merely different parametrizations of one curve. Tails at different p_i cannot be confused. The induced proper map $B \rightarrow \Gamma_{\text{red}}$ has finite geometric fibres and is birational. It is consequently finite, and the smooth source is the normalization of the reduced integral graph. This proves (35.4), including its scheme fibres. Both maps restrict to the identity on the dense graph, giving canonicity and equivariance and gluing the etale calculations.

The smaller minor systems have no base point, while the last minor system has one simple base point at each p_i . Subtracting these base points and adding one unit of degree on each tail gives (35.5). The determinant has vanishing order at least two at each distinct corank-two point, so $2k \leq n$. The nodal tree has Euler characteristic one and total H -degree $\binom{n}{2}$. This proves the Hilbert polynomial used above. Finally the product blow-up charts give independent parameters t_i ; the Jacobian for each codimension-two blow-up contributes one E_i to the canonical divisor. These computations also prove the local intersection statement. $\square$

Corollary 35.4 (Multiplication systems at every node). *The ideal $\mathcal{I}$ in (35.2) is also obtained by taking the zeroth Fitting ideal of the pushforward of the zero scheme of $J_{h(n-2)+1}$ on the universal line, for every $h \geq 1$. At $h = 1$ this is the distinguished construction without an exponent choice. On every tail the resolved j th power is the complete system of degree*

$$\delta_j = (j - h(n - 2))_+ - 2(j - h(n - 1))_+.$$

The exceptional parameter space at a k -incidence pencil has Chow ring $\mathbb{Z}[\xi_1, \dots, \xi_k]/(\xi_1^2, \dots, \xi_k^2)$. In particular at a double incidence the full fibre is a smooth quadric surface $\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^1$, not merely two independent one-parameter examples.

Proof. On this rank open the universal formula gives $J_{h(n-2)+1} = I_{n-1}$ because $I_{n-2} = \mathcal{O}$. Its zero scheme is exactly D . Finite pushforward and Fitting ideals give the specified centre. The power assertion is Proposition 33.3 at each disjoint tail. For clarity, a coefficient ideal generated

in degree b has degree- b part equal to the linear span of its actual generators. In the residual binary ring this part is $f^{(b-h)+} \text{Sym}^{b-2(b-h)+}(\text{Sym}^2 W^*)$; division by the common factor therefore leaves all forms, not merely a subspace with the same base locus. The Chow ring is the projective bundle formula applied to the identified scheme fibre $(\mathbb{P}^1)^k$. $\square$

36. HIGHER CONTACT, THICK TAILS, AND SINGULAR MULTIPLICATION GRAPHS

Nonreduced incidence has a different Hilbert boundary from reduced multiple incidence. We give a two-parameter family of genuine symmetric pencils for every contact order $m \geq 2$, determine its entire normalized Hilbert graph, and compute the nonreduced fibres and the singularities of the universal curve. The result is a slice theorem, not an assertion that the whole ambient Hilbert modification commutes with restriction to that slice.

36.1. Symmetric linear pencils of every contact order. Let E_m be the reversal matrix, N_m the nilpotent matrix with ones on its superdiagonal, and put

$$L_m(x) = E_m(xI_m - N_m), \quad e = e_1.$$

This is symmetric. In dimension $n = 2m$, consider the affine family of pencils, with x the pencil parameter and $(u, v) \in S = \mathbb{A}^2$,

$$A_{u,v}(x) = \begin{pmatrix} L_m(x) + uee^t & vee^t \\ vee^t & L_m(x) - uee^t \end{pmatrix}. \quad (36.1)$$

The projective pencil is obtained by homogenizing every entry to degree one. Its leading matrix is $E_m \oplus E_m$, so infinity is nonsingular. For $n > 2m$ one may adjoin fixed scalar blocks $x - \lambda_j$ with distinct nonzero λ_j and restrict the parameter base to a neighbourhood where these additional simple roots stay disjoint from the cluster. All assertions below then hold near the same cluster; we state the global slice formula first for $n = 2m$.

Lemma 36.1 (Exact contact slice). *For the family (36.1), the complement of the two e_1 directions is a nonsingular block over $\mathbb{C}[x]$, of constant nonzero determinant. Its Schur complement is exactly*

$$\begin{pmatrix} x^m + u & v \\ v & x^m - u \end{pmatrix}. \quad (36.2)$$

Consequently, on the affine pencil chart,

$$I_{n-1}(A) = (x^m, u, v), \quad \det A = c_m(x^{2m} - u^2 - v^2), \quad c_m \in \mathbb{C}^*.$$

All pencils are regular and have rank at least $n - 2$ everywhere. Only the origin of S has a corank-two incidence; its intersection scheme has length m . Its two positive local Smith exponents are m, m . The finite incidence algebra pushed to S is $(\mathcal{O}_S/(u, v))^{\oplus m}$, so its zeroth Fitting ideal is $(u, v)^m$.

Proof. Delete row and column one from $L_m(x)$. The remaining matrix is anti-triangular with -1 on its antidiagonal, hence has constant nonzero determinant. Since $\det L_m(x) = \det(E_m)x^m$, its scalar Schur complement is x^m ; the ratio of the two constant determinants is one. This can also be read directly by eliminating along the superdiagonal. The two kernel directions receive exactly the displayed perturbation, proving (36.2). The unit-block minor identity then gives $I_{n-1} = I_1(\text{Schur complement}) = (x^m, u, v)$ in characteristic zero. All smaller required minors are units. The determinant and rank claims follow from the same block decomposition, including infinity. At $u = v = 0$ the residual matrix is $x^m I_2$, which proves both the intersection length and the Smith exponents. The incidence algebra is $\mathbb{C}[x, u, v]/(x^m, u, v)$; its $\mathbb{C}[u, v]$ -module basis is $1, x, \dots, x^{m-1}$ with (u, v) annihilating every basis vector. The direct-sum formula for Fitting ideals proves the last assertion. $\square$

Let Γ_m be the reduced closure of the lifted-pencil graph over $S \setminus \{0\}$ in $S \times \text{Hilb}^{P_H}(\text{CQ}(V))$, with $P_H(l) = \binom{n}{2}l + 1$, and let $\hat{\Gamma}_m$ be its normalization. This definition is independent of whether normalization of the global pencil graph commutes with this particular slice; no such commutation is assumed.

Theorem 36.2 (The full contact-slice Hilbert modification). *For every $m \geq 2$ the slice graph is*

$$\hat{\Gamma}_m \simeq \text{Bl}_0 \mathbb{A}^2 = \text{Bl}_{\text{Fitt}_0(q_* \mathcal{O}_D)} S. \quad (36.3)$$

Its whole exceptional fibre is $\mathbb{P}^1$; the Hilbert curves over that exceptional fibre are nonreduced. In a base chart $u = t$, $v = tw$, the total multiplication graph is the blow-up of (x^m, t) on the pulled-back pencil surface. With $R = \mathbb{C}[x, t, w]$, its Rees presentation and its two projective charts are

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{R}(x^m, t) &= R[U, V]/(tU - x^m V), \\ D_+(U) : \quad t &= x^m y, \quad D_+(V) : \quad x^m = tz. \end{aligned} \quad (36.4)$$

Here U represents $x^m T$ and V represents tT in $R[T]$. The charts glue by $y = z^{-1}$. The universal curve is flat over the base blow-up, is normal, and has a transverse A_{m-1} surface singularity along the section $x = t = z = 0$ of its exceptional divisor.

For every direction $[\alpha : \beta] \in \mathbb{P}^1$, its special Hilbert curve is

$$C_0 \cup T_m, \quad T_m \simeq \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}[x]/(x^m)}^1, \quad C_0 \cap T_m \simeq \text{Spec } \mathbb{C}[x]/(x^m). \quad (36.5)$$

The intersection is at one section of T_m ; the support of T_m is the residual line through $[I_2]$ with second member $\begin{pmatrix} \alpha & \beta \\ \beta & -\alpha \end{pmatrix}$ in the exceptional plane. The fibre has no embedded associated points. Its cycle is $[C_0] + m[F]$, where $F = (T_m)_{\text{red}}$. Every direction occurs, and these embedded thickened curves are pairwise distinct. The multidegrees are

$$\deg_{C_0} H_q = q - m \mathbf{1}_{q=n-1}, \quad \deg_F H_q = \mathbf{1}_{q=n-1}.$$

For $\delta_j = (j - h(n-2))_+ - 2(j - h(n-1))_+$, the j th resolved multiplication system on T_m is, over $\mathbb{C}[x]/(x^m)$, the complete system $\mathcal{O}_{T_m}(\delta_j)$. In particular its reduced degree is δ_j and its degree as a cycle is $m\delta_j$.

Proof. All rank loci below corank two are avoided, so the relevant ambient complete-quadric map is the blow-up of the rank- $(n-2)$ locus. Pull the exact ideal in Lemma 36.1 to $\text{Bl}_0 S$. In the stated chart it is (x^m, t) . These two elements are a regular sequence. The only homogeneous Rees relation is $tU - x^m V$: successive comparison of powers of T , using that x^m and t are relatively prime, expresses every relation as a multiple of this one. Thus the relation is saturated in the image subalgebra of $R[T]$, and the stated Proj charts follow. The other base chart is identical with the roles of u, v exchanged.

Both chart equations remain nonzerodivisors on every fibre of their smooth relative affine planes, so the fibrewise Cartier flatness criterion proves flatness. The first chart eliminates t and is smooth. The second is a hypersurface with singular locus $x = t = z = 0$, of codimension two in its total space. It is a domain and Cohen–Macaulay, so regularity in codimension one proves normality. Its transverse completed equation is $x^m = tz$, the A_{m-1} surface singularity. This describes a singular universal curve over a smooth parameter blow-up; the two smoothness assertions are not conflated.

At $t = 0$ the first chart has ring $\mathbb{C}[x, y]/(x^m y)$ and the second has ring $\mathbb{C}[x, z]/(x^m)$. In the first ring the ideals (y) and (x^m) intersect in $(x^m y)$. These pieces glue to the strict transform C_0 and to the thick tail whose two rings are $(\mathbb{C}[x]/(x^m))[y]$ and $(\mathbb{C}[x]/(x^m))[z]$, with $y = z^{-1}$ and x unchanged. This proves (36.5), including its length- m intersection. The local hypersurfaces of the fibre are Cohen–Macaulay of dimension one and have only their component primes as associated primes. There are no embedded points.

The Rees quotient (35.6) embeds this flat family into the fixed complete-quadric space times the base blow-up. Its generic curve is the prescribed lift. The support of each tail is the indicated residual line. Distinct $[\alpha : \beta]$ give distinct residual lines, hence distinct embedded closed subschemes. The resulting proper map to Γ_m is quasi-finite and birational, so the smooth base blow-up is its normalization. This proves the whole fibre statement in (36.3). The Fitting formula follows from $(u, v)^m$ and invariance of Proj under a positive Veronese power.

The last minor system loses a base divisor of length m on C_0 , while the smaller systems lose none. The graph line bundle restricts to $\mathcal{O}(1)$ on the residual projective line over $\mathbb{C}[x]/(x^m)$. It follows that $\chi(\mathcal{O}_{T_m} \otimes H^l) = m(l+1)$ and the intersection has Euler characteristic m . Adding to the main component gives $\binom{n}{2}l+1$, as required. More generally the unit-block congruence is invertible over $\mathbb{C}[x]$ and thus over $\mathbb{C}[x]/(x^m)$. The binary multiplication coefficient calculation of Corollary 35.4, extended to this Artin ring, spans every degree- δ_j binary form. Multiplication by the unit-block socle is a split injection on these coefficient modules: it has a unit coordinate in a trivializing frame. This proves the relative complete-system assertion, not just its reduced-fibre version. The degree- j coordinates originally have the twist $\mathcal{O}(j)$ on the pencil line; it is trivial on this local thickening. Removing their Cartier common factors produces the stated graph line bundle. $\square$

36.2. The singularity and the stable-map comparison.

Proposition 36.3 (Local deformation module of the multiplication graph). *At a singular point of a one-parameter direction in Theorem 36.2, let $A_m = \mathbb{C}[[x, t, z]]/(x^m - tz)$. The abstract local cotangent deformation modules are*

$$T^1(A_m) = \mathbb{C}[[x]]/(x^{m-1}), \quad T^i(A_m) = 0 \quad (i \geq 2). \quad (36.6)$$

The first equality has dimension $m-1$. A formally versal family of hypersurface deformations is obtained by adding $\sum_{a=0}^{m-2} c_a x^a$ to $x^m - tz$. These are deformation modules of the total graph singularity, not of its fixed-base relative curve or of the raw failure algebra.

In a transverse surface the reduced tail is $\mathbb{Q}$ -Cartier with $F^2 = -1/m$. Its minimal resolution introduces the A_{m-1} chain; the total fibre has multiplicities m on the strict transform of F and $m-1, m-2, \dots, 1$ along the consecutive chain, and multiplicity one on C_0 .

Proof. The cotangent complex of a hypersurface is represented by the conormal free module mapping to the three ambient differentials. Dualizing gives cokernel by the partial derivatives $mx^{m-1}, -z, -t$, hence (36.6); there are no higher terms. Lifting an equation across a small extension has no obstruction, and the displayed monomials form a basis of the cokernel, giving the formal versality assertion. This is the classical hypersurface calculation applied to the exact Rees equation.

In the first Rees chart the exceptional Cartier ideal is generated by x^m , so its Cartier divisor is mF . Its associated ideal bundle restricts to $\mathcal{O}_F(1)$; thus $mF^2 = -1$. The standard cyclic quotient presentation can be checked directly:

$$x = ab, \quad t = a^m, \quad z = b^m, \quad A_m = \mathbb{C}[[a, b]]^{\mu_m}, \quad (a, b) \mapsto (\zeta a, \zeta^{-1}b).$$

Subdivide its two-dimensional cone by the primitive rays $((m-i)/m, i/m)$, $1 \leq i < m$, in the quotient lattice. Consecutive cones are smooth. The internal curves form the chain with self-intersection -2 , and the orders of $t = a^m$ are $m-i$. The end attached to the tail has multiplicity $m-1$; the next ones decrease by one. The main component meets the other, already smooth, end of the tail, where $t = x^m y$ gives multiplicities $m, 1$. These charts prove the stated fibre description. $\square$

Theorem 36.4 (A thick Hilbert tail and a covered stable-map tail). *Fix a nonzero direction $(u, v) = \tau(\alpha, \beta)$ in the slice, with contact order m . After the base change $\tau = s^m$, the normalization*

of its total Hilbert graph is the blow-up of the smooth pencil surface at $(x, s) = (0, 0)$. Its special fibre is a reduced nodal union $C_0 \cup F'$. The induced map to complete quadrics is an embedding on C_0 and a degree- m map on F' onto F ,

$$[X : S] \mapsto [X^m : S^m] \quad (36.7)$$

in the residual line coordinates. It is a stable map with tail deck group μ_m . It has the same cycle $[C_0] + m[F]$ as the Hilbert limit, but the latter has the nonreduced scheme structure (36.5), not the reduced image of this map.

Proof. The base-changed graph is the blow-up of (x^m, s^m) . This particular base change is flat, and the Rees presentation also verifies it directly. On the chart $x^m = s^m z$ adjoining $w = x/s$ gives the integral element $w^m = z$ and the normal chart $\mathbb{C}[s, w]$, with $x = sw$. On the other chart $s^m = x^m y$ adjoining $r = s/x$ gives $r^m = y$ and the normal chart $\mathbb{C}[x, r]$, with $s = xr$. These charts are finite and birational over the original charts and glue by $w = r^{-1}$. They are exactly the point blow-up charts. They also show a reduced nodal fibre after normalization.

The old graph coordinates $[x^m : s^m]$ restrict to (36.7) on the exceptional line of the point blow-up. Away from the contact point normalization does not alter the original lifted line. Both components are nonconstant; the main component is embedded and the nonconstant tail has precisely the finite deck group μ_m , which fixes the attachment point. Thus the map is stable. The image of F' is reduced while the flat Hilbert fibre has the explicit nilpotent x of order m , so the two objects differ scheme-theoretically even though pushforward cycles and degrees agree. This comparison is calculated here; it is not deduced from a general identification of Hilbert and stable-map compactifications. $\square$

For the reduced-incidence local model ($m = 1$), the two local descriptions coincide with the nodal model. For every $m \geq 2$, the length of the contact, the tail multiplicity, the transverse graph singularity A_{m-1} , and the stable tail covering degree record the same integer in four different objects. The assertions concern all orders in the specified symmetric Jordan slices. They do not classify arbitrary higher-corank contacts or the entire ambient Hilbert fibre over a nonreduced-incidence pencil.

37. EFFECTIVE BOUNDARY GROUPOIDS AND RELATIVE LIFTING OBSTRUCTIONS

This section places the intrinsic envelope and the boundary modification in a single category. It also distinguishes three deformation questions: deforming the effective failure object, lifting a prescribed base deformation to its boundary modification, and deforming a singularity of the universal curve. These questions have different answers.

37.1. The category and the envelope functor. Let $\mathcal{F}_{\text{pen}}^{\text{eff}}$ denote the fppf stack of Theorem G.2. Starting with the sharp pencil-failure families, its arrows are first divided by the tangent-identity nonlinear generator kernel and then by the ineffective right tensor-factor action, and the resulting groupoid is stackified. Its oriented source is specified by coefficient support, rather than by an arbitrary choice between the determinant rulings. The theorem gives, on every complex base,

$$\mathcal{F}_{\text{pen}}^{\text{eff}} \simeq [G / \text{PGL}(V)]. \quad (37.1)$$

The notation does not denote the stack of all Artin algebras of the same length. In particular deformations leaving the effective pencil image are not included in this equivalence.

Proposition 37.1 (The envelope as a morphism of stacks). *Let $\mathcal{A}_h$ be the stack whose objects over T are a projective-space bundle $S \rightarrow T$ of relative dimension $n - 1$ and a finite locally free graded algebra bundle on S locally isomorphic to $\bigoplus_{p=0}^{nh} B_h(V)_p \otimes \mathcal{O}(2p)$, with its projectivized power*

diagram. Isomorphisms preserve the grading, algebra structure, and diagram. The construction of Theorem 27.1 defines a morphism

$$\mathcal{F}_{\text{pen}}^{\text{eff}} \longrightarrow \mathcal{A}_h.$$

It is compatible with arbitrary complex base change and does not require a global line bundle $\mathcal{O}_S(1)$. The case $h = 1$ is distinguished without an additional exponent choice. The envelope is a functorial algebra bundle on the recovered source, not a claimed subalgebra or quotient of the original finite algebra.

Proof. An object on the right side of (37.1) is a $\text{PGL}(V)$ -torsor with an equivariant map to G . On a lift of its source to $\mathbb{P}(V)$, the first-jet construction is $\text{Hom}(J^1\mathcal{O}(1), \mathcal{O}(1)) = V \otimes \mathcal{O}(1)$. A scalar λ acts on $B_h(V)_p$ with weight $2p$ and on $\mathcal{O}(2p)$ with weight $-2p$. It therefore acts trivially on their product, on its multiplication, and on the polarized Cartan relation maps. The algebra bundle is genuinely $\text{PGL}(V)$ -equivariant, not only equivariant up to a scalar. Associate it to the torsor and apply fppf descent. This defines both objects and arrows of the asserted morphism and gives its compatibility with pullback. This argument uses local $\mathcal{O}(1)$ only to exhibit a scalar-trivial representation; it never posits such a global line bundle on a Brauer-nonsplit projective-space bundle. The universal property of Proposition 31.1 verifies the same construction independently of the chosen trivializations. $\square$

37.2. A modular modification and its defining equations. Restrict (37.1) to U_{red} of (35.1). With B_{red} and its invariant Fitting ideal as in (35.2), put

$$\mathcal{B}_{\text{red}} = [B_{\text{red}}/\text{PGL}(V)], \quad \mathcal{F}_{\text{red}}^{\text{eff}} = [U_{\text{red}}/\text{PGL}(V)]. \quad (37.2)$$

Theorem 37.2 (The effective multiple-incidence boundary). *The map $\mathcal{B}_{\text{red}} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_{\text{red}}^{\text{eff}}$ is representable, proper, birational, and carries the flat embedded curve family of Theorem 35.3. Both stacks are smooth. This is a modular modification over U_{red} , not an assertion that either stack is proper over $\mathbb{C}$ or has finite stabilizers. On an étale neighbourhood with labelled incidence centres $I_i = (u_i, v_i)$, the multi-Rees algebra has presentation*

$$\mathcal{R}(I_1, \dots, I_k) = R[U_1, V_1, \dots, U_k, V_k]/(v_i U_i - u_i V_i)_{i=1}^k, \quad (37.3)$$

where $\deg U_i = \deg V_i$ is the i th coordinate vector and $U_i = u_i T_i$, $V_i = v_i T_i$. There is no torsion kernel left in this presentation. Its diagonal subalgebra is

$$\bigoplus_{d \geq 0} (I_1 \cdots I_k)^d (T_1 \cdots T_k)^d, \quad (37.4)$$

so its diagonal Proj is the computed Hilbert modification. All these objects descend without a global labelling of the points.

Proof. For a test scheme $T \rightarrow [U_{\text{red}}/\text{PGL}(V)]$, take its defining torsor P_T . The pullback is the associated space $(P_T \times_{U_{\text{red}}} B_{\text{red}})/\text{PGL}(V)$. The projective equivariant morphism descends to a projective morphism over T . This proves representability and properness; birationality holds over the dense nonincident open. Smoothness of the two atlases and of the acting group proves smoothness of the stacks. The curve family descends by the same construction. No quotient by the stabilizer of a pencil has been mistaken for its fixed-frame scheme fibre.

For the algebra calculation begin in a polynomial ring in the independent parameters u_i, v_i and complementary smooth coordinates. For one pair, the kernel of $R[U_i, V_i] \rightarrow R[T_i]$ is generated by $v_i U_i - u_i V_i$: comparison of successive powers and cancellation using the regular sequence (u_i, v_i) proves the assertion. For several pairs the variables are disjoint. Tensoring the one-pair presentations over the ground field preserves their injections into the polynomial ring in the T_i , giving (37.3). The result persists after the étale flat extension supplied by Lemma 35.1; flat base change preserves both the coefficient ideals and the displayed kernel. This proves the

absence of an additional saturation or torsion relation. The multidegree $(d, \dots, d)$ part is exactly $I_1^d \cdots I_k^d (T_1 \cdots T_k)^d$, which proves (37.4). It gives the actual defining equations before taking the ordinary-power diagonal, rather than treating the formation of ordinary powers as a second recovery theorem.

The ideal itself is $\text{Fitt}_0(q_* \mathcal{O}_D)$, where D is the zero scheme of the distinguished power J_{n-1} on the intrinsic pencil line. Finite base change identifies the pushforward module, and Fitting ideals commute with arbitrary base change. Its formation is invariant under the group action. The local multi-Rees presentations are labelled charts of this global ideal blow-up; permutation of the labels does not affect their diagonal. Descent therefore follows from the intrinsic Fitting construction, without claiming that graph closure or blow-up commutes with every base change. A pulled-back curve family is defined by its flat pullback; its existence does not require such a graph-closure assertion. $\square$

37.3. Relative lifting is not absolute obstruction. For precision a deformation of an effective object at R over a local Artin complex algebra A is an object of $\mathcal{F}_{\text{pen}}^{\text{eff}}(A)$ with an identification of its closed fibre with R . A source framing identifies it with a point of the completed pencil parameter scheme; changing the framing acts by $\text{PGL}(V)(A)$. A boundary deformation also specifies a lift to B_{red} of the closed boundary point.

Proposition 37.3 (Exact relative lifting equations). *Fix a boundary point with k incidences. In a labelled chart of the base blow-ups write $v_i = u_i w_i$. Let $A' \rightarrow A$ be a square-zero extension with kernel J . Fix a lift of the base object to A' , with coordinates u'_i, v'_i , and an existing lift to the boundary over A , with slopes w_i . For any lifts $\tilde{w}_i \in A'$, define*

$$o_i = [v'_i - u'_i \tilde{w}_i] \in J/u'_i J. \quad (37.5)$$

These classes do not depend on the lifts $\tilde{w}_i$. The prescribed base deformation lifts in this chart if and only if all o_i vanish. When nonempty, its set of framed lifts is a torsor under $\bigoplus_i \ker(u'_i : J \rightarrow J)$. At a closed boundary point with slopes w_i^0 , a tangent vector $u_i = \epsilon a_i$, $v_i = \epsilon b_i$ lifts if and only if $b_i = w_i^0 a_i$. The kernel and cokernel of the differential of the fixed-frame blow-up map both have dimension k there.

The absolute effective and boundary stacks are smooth, with tangent complexes $[\mathfrak{pgl}(V) \rightarrow T_R U_{\text{red}}]$ and $[\mathfrak{pgl}(V) \rightarrow T_b B_{\text{red}}]$ in degrees $-1, 0$. Thus the relative conditions above do not assert an absolute obstruction to deforming an effective failure object. Nor do they identify all deformations of its raw unmarked Artin algebra.

Proof. The defining equation over A' is $v'_i = u'_i w'_i$. Its defect for a chosen lift lies in J because it vanishes over A . Replacing that lift by $\tilde{w}_i + \eta_i$, with $\eta_i \in J$, changes the defect by $-u'_i \eta_i$. This proves the well-defined obstruction class, its necessity and sufficiency, and the stated torsor of solutions. The independent coordinate charts introduce no further equations. For dual numbers at the closed point, multiplication of ϵa_i by a change $\epsilon \eta_i$ is zero, giving precisely the displayed tangent condition. In the chart $(u_i, w_i) \mapsto (u_i, u_i w_i)$ the differential has rank one for each normal parameter pair and kills its slope direction. Complementary coordinates are unchanged, so both kernel and cokernel have dimension k .

The tangent complexes are those of the smooth quotient atlases in (37.2), and Theorem G.2 identifies the effective failure deformation groupoid with the first of them over every Artin base. To check explicitly the nonlinear kernel used here, let the coefficient ring be $\mathbb{C}[\epsilon]/(\epsilon^2)$ and replace a generator x by $gx + q(x)$, with q of degree at least two. In a homogeneous relation of sharp degree d , every term containing a factor from q has degree at least $d + 1$ and vanishes in the sharp truncation. The surviving relation is exactly the linear action $\text{Sym}^d(g)$. This argument uses degrees in the generators, not powers of ϵ , and is valid for coefficients in any base algebra. It therefore separates the tangent-identity generator kernel from an actual infinitesimal change of

the pencil over the base. Passing to the two prescribed rigidifications gives the claimed categorical interpretation of the coordinate calculation. $\square$

The ideal cutting out the incidence is scheme-theoretically intrinsic to the effective failure family *with its recovered pencil line*. That line is an essential output of the inverse; no bypass of it, and no canonical choice of a slope from a closed algebra, is asserted. The additional content is the complete multi-Rees presentation and relative lifting equations, and, on the nonreduced-contact slices, the singular graph and its computed cotangent module in Proposition 36.3. These calculations specify the interaction with boundary singularities rather than merely transporting a pre-existing finite algebra by pullback.

37.4. An accessible completeness input for singular pencils. The congruence classification used by Theorem 29.2 is recalled with explicit blocks in [De Teran–Dmytryshyn–Dopico(2018), Theorem 2.1]. In that statement a symmetric minimal-index block with index ε has dimension $2\varepsilon + 1$; hence no index in an $n \times n$ symmetric pencil exceeds $\lfloor (n - 1)/2 \rfloor$. The Toeplitz nullities in that finite range recover the multiplicities by the second-difference formula already proved in our theorem. The regular blocks are indexed by their projective spectral points and local exponent partitions. Accordingly “complete data” includes both the points and the partitions, modulo one common projective reparametrization of the pencil line. This is an accessible theorem-level classical completeness input, not a new symmetric Kronecker classification. It is distinct from the local congruence diagonalization proved in the paper.

38. VERSAL CONTACT COORDINATES FOR REGULAR SYMMETRIC PENCILS

The contact order does not determine a neighbourhood of a pencil. We describe the missing parameters and then use them to calculate open charts of the ambient Hilbert boundary. The normal-form input belongs to the classical deformation theory of symmetric pencils [Dmytryshyn(2011/2018), Theorem 2.1, Corollary 2.1 and Lemma 3.1]. We give the tangent calculation and the formal reduction needed here, because a normal form for a pencil and a normal form for its embedded graph are different assertions.

All completions in this section are over $\mathbb{C}$. The pencil parameter is fixed; reparametrizing it is not part of the local congruence action. A source-and-parameter framing is a smooth atlas of the Grassmannian of genuine pencils. Statements on this atlas descend by change of frame, rather than by identifying different embedded Hilbert points.

Lemma 38.1 (The contact deformation module). *Put $D = \text{diag}(x^{d_1}, \dots, x^{d_c})$, where $d_i \geq 1$. For deformations of this symmetric matrix germ under congruences which reduce to the identity, the tangent quotient is*

$$\mathcal{T}_D = \bigoplus_i \mathbb{C}[x]_{< d_i} \oplus \bigoplus_{i < j} \mathbb{C}[x]_{< \min(d_i, d_j)}. \quad (38.1)$$

A formally miniversal family is the symmetric polynomial matrix

$$S_{ii} = x^{d_i} + p_{ii}(x), \quad S_{ij} = p_{ij}(x), \quad \deg p_{ii} < d_i, \quad \deg p_{ij} < \min(d_i, d_j). \quad (38.2)$$

Its coefficients vanish at the origin. Miniversality means existence of a formal classifying map and a congruence after every complete local base change, with an isomorphism on the tangent quotient. It does not assert uniqueness of that map in the presence of stabilizers.

Proof. An infinitesimal change $1 + \epsilon H$ adds $H^t D + D H$. Its diagonal entries generate (x^{d_i}) , and its (i, j) entry ranges over $(x^{d_i}, x^{d_j}) = (x^{\min(d_i, d_j)})$. Different unordered entries can be prescribed independently. This proves (38.1), including the factor two on the diagonal, which is invertible.

For completeness let $(R, \mathfrak{m})$ be complete local and let $S(x) \equiv D \pmod{\mathfrak{m}}$. Work successively modulo $\mathfrak{m}^{q+1}$. Divide each coefficient of the degree- q error in an off-diagonal position by $x^{\min(d_i, d_j)}$,

and each diagonal error by x^{d_i} . Put the remainders into the indicated polynomials. Remove the quotients with H of order q . On an off-diagonal entry use the side with the smaller exponent; on the diagonal divide by two. Terms involving an already deformed coefficient and H have order at least $q + 1$. The compatible products of these changes converge $\mathfrak{m}$ -adically, as do the finitely many polynomial coefficients. This constructs the formal reduction. The tangent quotient proves minimality of the number of parameters. The choices made by this algorithm are coordinates, not invariants. $\square$

Theorem 38.2 (Ambient realization of the contact parameters). *Let R_0 be a regular complex symmetric pencil. At each spectral point λ , let $d_{\lambda,1}, \dots, d_{\lambda,c_\lambda}$ be its positive Smith exponents. On a source-and-parameter frame atlas, the completed pencil base has a formally smooth map to the product of the coefficient spaces (38.2), with independent coordinates in all factors. After a congruence on each completed parameter disc, its residual symmetric matrix is exactly (38.2); the complementary block is a unit. The number of essential congruence parameters is*

$$N = \sum_{\lambda,i} d_{\lambda,i} + \sum_{\lambda} \sum_{i < j} \min(d_{\lambda,i}, d_{\lambda,j}). \quad (38.3)$$

The remaining parameters are smooth frame-orbit directions. Thus these models describe deformations in the full regular-pencil neighbourhood, not only a selected two-parameter slice.

For one corank-two point with exponents $a \leq b$, the residual matrix can be written

$$S(x) = \begin{pmatrix} f(x) & g(x) \\ g(x) & f(x)k(x) + r(x) \end{pmatrix}, \quad (38.4)$$

where f is monic of degree a , g, r have degree less than a , and k is monic of degree $b - a$. For $a = b$, $k = 1$. The central values are $f = x^a$, $g = r = 0$, and $k = x^{b-a}$. These are $2a + b$ independent formal coordinates. With $A_f = \mathcal{O}[x]/(f)$ and multiplication matrices M_g, M_r on its basis $1, x, \dots, x^{a-1}$, the exact incidence module and ideal are

$$q_*\mathcal{O}_D = \text{coker}[M_g \ M_r], \quad \text{Fitt}_0(q_*\mathcal{O}_D) = I_a([M_g \ M_r]). \quad (38.5)$$

These identities hold over arbitrary base algebras in this polynomial model. They do not identify its nonreduced Hilbert modification with the blow-up of that Fitting ideal.

Proof. Choose a nonsingular pencil member. Fixing it by congruence identifies the other member with a self-adjoint endomorphism T for a fixed nondegenerate symmetric form. Its primary subspaces at distinct eigenvalues are a direct sum, even when T is not semisimple. Within one primary subspace the symmetric Jordan presentation is $\bigoplus_i L_{d_i}(x)$, where $L_d(x) = E_d(xI - N_d)$ as in Lemma 36.1. If $v_d(x) = (1, x, \dots, x^{d-1})^t$, then

$$L_d(x)v_d(x) = x^d e_1. \quad (38.6)$$

The complement to e_1 is a unit block. Differentiating its Schur complement in the direction of a constant symmetric perturbation H gives, on an (i, j) block, $v_{d_i}^t H_{ij} v_{d_j}$. For $0 \leq l < \min(d_i, d_j)$ the perturbation $H_{ij} = e_1 e_{l+1}^t$ gives x^l ; insert its transpose in the opposite block. On a diagonal block use $(e_1 e_{l+1}^t + e_{l+1} e_1^t)/2$ for $l > 0$ and $e_1 e_1^t$ for $l = 0$. They give every coefficient in (38.1). Block-diagonal perturbations prescribe these coefficients independently at distinct eigenvalues. This proves surjectivity from actual pencil deformations, not merely from arbitrary matrix-valued power series.

Here is also the dimension check against the congruence orbit. The centralizer between Jordan blocks of sizes d_i, d_j at the same eigenvalue has dimension $\min(d_i, d_j)$, by solving $N_{d_i} X = X N_{d_j}$ along its diagonals. A commuting endomorphism on a single block is polynomial in N_d , hence self-adjoint. A skew-adjoint commuting endomorphism has no diagonal contribution; its two opposite off-diagonal blocks determine one another and contribute $\min(d_i, d_j)$. Distinct primary

eigenvalues contribute zero, since the corresponding Sylvester map is invertible. Therefore the orthogonal stabilizer has the second sum in (38.3) as its dimension. Subtracting its orbit dimension from $n(n+1)/2$ gives n plus that sum, namely N . Congruence directions are killed by the contact quotient. Surjectivity and equality of dimensions identify their kernel exactly.

Apply the formal reduction of Lemma 38.1 to the universal pencil. Its classifying coefficient map has the surjective differential just computed. Complete its coefficients by coordinates in the kernel. The formal inverse function theorem identifies the completed smooth base with these coefficients and the complementary power-series variables. This is the claimed formal smoothness. Equivalently a transverse affine pencil family is miniversal by the congruence tangent-space criterion in [Dmytryshyn(2011/2018), Lemma 3.1]. Normalizing the chosen nonsingular member and then undoing that normalization restores the smooth source-and-parameter framing directions.

For two blocks the first normal form is $\begin{pmatrix} f & g \\ g & h \end{pmatrix}$ with h monic of degree b . Euclidean division $h = fk + r$ is a polynomial change of coefficient coordinates with polynomial inverse. This proves (38.4) and its dimension. The submaximal-minor ideal on the residual chart is $(f, g, h) = (f, g, r)$. Quotienting first by the monic polynomial f makes a free module of rank a , and quotienting further by g, r gives the displayed cokernel. The Fitting formula follows directly from this presentation. No reduced-fibre argument or extraction of an ideal root is involved. $\square$

The theorem includes higher corank in its normal-coordinate statement. The explicit Hilbert charts below concern corank two. The all-pencil inverse and the separate singular-pencil invariant theorem are not restricted by this choice. In particular the balanced two-parameter Jordan slice has only two directions inside a $3a$ -parameter contact base; it is not a versal neighbourhood when $a > 1$.

39. EUCLIDEAN CHARTS OF THE AMBIENT HILBERT BOUNDARY

We first calculate a universal polynomial graph in a fixed target. This separates the Hilbert calculation from the choice of pencil normal coordinates. Write $\mathbb{C}[x]_{<a}$ for polynomials of degree less than a , including zero. Let

$$B_a = \{(f, g, r) : f \text{ monic of degree } a, \quad g, r \in \mathbb{C}[x]_{<a}\} \simeq \mathbb{A}^{3a}.$$

Homogenize the three polynomials to degree a . They have no common zero at infinity, where their value is $[1 : 0 : 0]$. Over the dense open where they have no common zero, their graph in $\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^2$ has Hilbert polynomial $(a+1)l+1$ for $\mathcal{O}(1, 1)$. Denote its reduced Hilbert graph closure over B_a by Γ_a . It is integral, since it is the reduced closure of the graph over an integral dense open. We never quotient its embedded curves by target automorphisms.

Theorem 39.1 (An open division chart). *Let $W_a = \{(f, g, w) : f \text{ monic of degree } a, \quad g, w \in \mathbb{C}[x]_{<a}\} \simeq \mathbb{A}^{3a}$ and define*

$$\mu : W_a \longrightarrow B_a, \quad (f, g, w) \longmapsto (f, g, r = \text{rem}_f(gw)). \quad (39.1)$$

Put $q = (gw - r)/f$. The graph modification on the universal parameter line over W_a is the blow-up of (f, g) , and its two-generator Rees equation is

$$gU - fV = 0. \quad (39.2)$$

It is a projective flat family embedded in $\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^2 \times W_a$, by the third graph coordinate

$$[F : G : R] = [U : V : wV - qU] \quad (39.3)$$

on the finite parameter chart. At infinity it is the unique original graph. There is an open neighbourhood of

$$\{f = x^a, \quad g = 0, \quad w \in \mathbb{C}[x]_{<a}\} \subset W_a$$

on which this family identifies W_a with an open subscheme of Γ_a . In particular Γ_a is smooth and already normal there. The assertion is an open chart of the Hilbert graph, not just a generically injective parametrization of some limits.

For any point of this chart, let $d = \gcd(f, g)$ be monic, let $r_0 = \deg d$, and put $f = df_1$, $g = dg_1$. Its embedded fibre has the scheme decomposition

$$C \cup T_d, \quad T_d = \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}[x]/(d)}^1, \quad C \cap T_d = \operatorname{Spec} \mathbb{C}[x]/(d). \quad (39.4)$$

The attaching section on T_d is $[U : V] = [f_1 : g_1]$. It has no embedded associated points. If $d = \prod_i (x - \alpha_i)^{m_i}$, this is one main component and thick tails of multiplicities m_i at the distinct α_i . Its graph degree on the main component is $a - r_0$, and its tail cycle degree is r_0 . Thus the same open chart describes splitting, collision, and simultaneous unequal thicknesses by an exact gcd law.

Proof. In the polynomial ring of the universal line and W_a , the elements f, g form a regular sequence: f is monic, and modulo f the coefficient g_0 still occurs freely and linearly in g . The Rees algebra is consequently the symmetric algebra modulo the single syzygy $gU - fV$. One can alternatively compare coefficients in its injection into the polynomial ring in a Rees variable. On every geometric fibre the homogeneous equation is nonzero, because f is monic. The fibrewise Cartier criterion therefore proves flatness [Stacks Project, Tag 062Y, part (3)]. The original ideal (f, g, r) is exactly (f, g) , since $r = gw - fq$. Formula (39.3) is a rank-two linear embedding on every finite parameter chart; the first two coordinates are unchanged. Thus the Rees graph is closed in the three-coordinate graph. Infinity is disjoint from the base ideal and needs no blow-up. This constructs the claimed flat embedded family and its morphism to the Hilbert scheme.

Its image lies in Γ_a : over $\operatorname{Res}(f, g) \neq 0$ it is the original graph, that open is dense in the integral scheme W_a , and the reduced graph is closed. To prove that the resulting map is an open chart we construct a regular inverse. This step cannot be replaced by pointwise injectivity alone.

Let Z_w be a curve with $f = x^a, g = 0$ in the family, and let $L = \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^2}(a - 1, 1)|_{Z_w}$. On its main component L has degree $a - 1$. On its thick tail it is $\mathcal{O}(1)$ over $A = \mathbb{C}[x]/(x^a)$, and their intersection has length a . The restriction map from tail sections onto the intersection is surjective. The union exact sequence therefore gives

$$H^1(Z_w, L) = 0, \quad h^0(Z_w, L) = 2a. \quad (39.5)$$

These statements hold in a Hilbert neighbourhood by cohomology and base change. On that neighbourhood consider the linear map to the rank- $2a$ bundle of sections

$$\Psi : \mathbb{C}[x]_{<a} \oplus \mathbb{C}[x]_{<a-1} \longrightarrow H^0(L), \quad (w, q) \longmapsto wG - qF. \quad (39.6)$$

The expressions are homogenized to degree $a - 1$ in the first factor; in particular the second polynomial has zero leading coefficient. For $a = 1$ its second summand is zero. At Z_w this map is injective. Indeed restriction to the main component makes q zero. Restriction to the tail then makes w zero modulo x^a , hence zero as a polynomial of degree less than a . After shrinking, Ψ is a split injection with line-bundle cokernel.

The section to be represented is R , multiplied by the homogeneous coordinate vanishing at infinity to the power $a - 1$. On the dense open $\operatorname{Res}(f, g) \neq 0$, Euclidean inversion of g in $\mathbb{C}[x]/(f)$ gives its unique representation $R = wG - qF$ with the bounds in (39.6). Its class in the line-bundle cokernel therefore vanishes on a dense open of the integral reduced Hilbert graph, and hence vanishes identically. The split injection recovers regular coefficients w, q . The polynomial equality $r = gw - fq$ follows on the dense open and therefore everywhere. This defines the inverse of (39.1). Conversely the reconstructed curves agree with the universal Hilbert curve on a dense open; the two maps to the separated Hilbert scheme agree on the entire reduced neighbourhood. This proves the open-chart assertion, including scheme structure and normality.

For the fibre calculation, factor (39.2) as $d(g_1U - f_1V)$. The two factors are relatively prime on each affine chart: f_1, g_1 are coprime. Their principal ideals intersect in their product. The second factor is the graph of the coprime pair, and the first is $\mathbb{P}^1$ over $\mathbb{C}[x]/(d)$. Since f_1, g_1 generate the unit ideal modulo d , their intersection is exactly the displayed section over that Artin ring. Each chart is a hypersurface in a regular surface, hence Cohen–Macaulay; its associated primes are precisely its component primes. This also proves absence of embedded points. The Chinese remainder theorem separates the distinct roots of d with their full multiplicities. Finally, $\chi(\mathcal{O}_{T_d}(l)) = r_0(l+1)$ and the attaching scheme has Euler characteristic r_0 . Adding the main component gives $(a+1)l+1$ for $\mathcal{O}(1,1)$, as required. $\square$

39.1. From the universal division chart to actual pencils. For a corank-two incidence p of length a , let D_p be its scheme-theoretic intersection with the pencil. The strict transform of the pencil meets the exceptional projective plane bundle over D_p in a section s_p . A *primitive line tail* means a line subbundle in that plane bundle containing s_p , over all of D_p , not merely a line on its reduced support. Its union with the strict transform is taken with their common attaching subscheme D_p . This definition concerns a fixed embedded curve in complete quadrics.

Theorem 39.2 (Ambient jet-tail charts and their collision law). *Let R_0 be a regular pencil with no corank at least three. Suppose its corank-two points have Smith exponents (a_i, b_i) , $a_i \leq b_i$; points of corank one are unrestricted. In the full normalized pencil Hilbert graph, the locus over R_0 with a primitive line tail at each corank-two point is open and is*

$$\prod_i \text{Res}_{\mathbb{C}[x_i]/(x_i^{a_i})/\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{P}^1 = \prod_i J_{a_i-1}(\mathbb{P}^1). \quad (39.7)$$

It is smooth, irreducible, and has dimension $\sum_i a_i$. For $a_i = 1$ it recovers the reduced-incidence fibre factor $\mathbb{P}^1$; for $a_i > 1$ constant directions form only its zero-jet section. All points of (39.7) are limits of genuine pencils. No extra framing or congruence quotient is taken in this scheme fibre.

More precisely, after a smooth frame atlas, the completed local map at any such lift is the product of the division maps (39.1), the k_i coordinates in (38.4), and complementary smooth coordinates. Thus, in each chart, its nonincident open is

$$\prod_i \text{Res}_{x_i}(f_i, g_i) \neq 0. \quad (39.8)$$

The modification is smooth in these charts, but the resultant boundary need not have normal crossings. Its relative curve has local equation $g_iU_i - f_iV_i = 0$. Formula (39.4) classifies all fibres in the chart, including mixed nonreduced contacts and collisions, with multiplicities and attaching lengths. On the actual complete-quadric curve the exterior multidegrees are

$$\deg_C H_q = q - \left(\sum_i \deg \gcd(f_i, g_i) \right) \mathbf{1}_{q=n-1}, \quad \deg_{(T_i)_{\text{red}}} H_q = \mathbf{1}_{q=n-1}. \quad (39.9)$$

Each local thick factor has its corresponding cycle multiplicity. The polarization is $\bigotimes_{q=1}^{n-1} H_q$ and the Hilbert polynomial is $\binom{n}{2}l+1$.

Proof. We first specify the formal comparison which makes this an ambient statement. Work on the smooth atlas of framed pencils and choose a parameter disc at each point in question. Theorem 38.2 supplies independent formal coordinates (f_i, g_i, r_i, k_i) and smooth complementary coordinates. On such a disc a unit $(n-2)$ -block reduces the submaximal-minor ideal to (f_i, g_i, r_i) . The rank locus is smooth of codimension three, and its complete-quadric modification is its blow-up. Equivariant Gaussian elimination identifies its graph with the three-coordinate normal graph; the extra unit-block and target coordinates are fixed functions of the pencil and of the disc parameter.

This comparison is also a comparison of the embedded Hilbert problems, for the following reason. The parameter x_i is retained: we work in the incidence target over the universal pencil line, not in an abstract unparametrized normal plane. The first complete-quadric projection recovers that line coordinate, so adding it does not change any embedded Hilbert point in the pencil graph. A source congruence depending on x_i is an automorphism of this incidence target over the disc. It need not, and is not claimed to, be one constant automorphism of the fixed projective target. Away from the finitely many contact supports the submaximal ideal is the unit ideal; the curve there is forced to be the original lift, with no additional embedded choices. On the punctured discs the two descriptions are this same forced lift. The local ideals therefore glue uniquely. For Artin base extensions this can be checked in affine charts: equality and flatness of their coherent ideal quotients are detected after the faithfully flat completion at each remaining support. Thus the completed embedded deformation functors on the graph closure agree with the polynomial normal-graph functors and the complementary smooth factors. This uses the actual Rees image, not a general assertion that blow-up commutes with nonflat base change. The same argument applies to families specializing the dense nonincident graph, so their reduced closures and their completed local rings agree. Excellence over $\mathbb{C}$ and normality of the smooth charts identify the normalization there.

Apply Theorem 39.1 to each factor. In the central fibre, $f_i = x_i^{a_i}$ and $g_i = r_i = 0$, and w_i is an arbitrary polynomial of degree less than a_i . The opposite chart interchanges g_i and r_i . On the overlap its slope is $w'_i = w_i^{-1}$ in $\mathbb{C}[x_i]/(x_i^{a_i})$. These are exactly the two standard charts for lines through the section s_p over that local Artin algebra. They represent $\text{Res}_{D_p/\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{P}^1$, equivalently the indicated jet scheme.

There is an algebraic morphism from this jet space to the actual Hilbert fibre, not only a formal map. Pull back the universal line subbundle over D_p , take its projectivization in the exceptional plane bundle, and unite it with the fixed strict transform along its attaching section D_p . The union exact sequence has flat outer terms over the jet space and a surjective restriction to the attaching scheme, so the union is flat. Its line subbundle is recovered from the embedded tail, also after base change; hence this morphism is a monomorphism onto its image. The completed local calculation above and the inverse in (39.6) identify its completed local rings with those of the Hilbert fibre. A finite-type morphism with these completed local isomorphisms and equal residue fields is étale there; an étale monomorphism is an open immersion. This proves the claimed openness algebraically. The charts of the total Hilbert graph are regular, so its normalization changes neither their rings nor this open fibre. The construction descends from the frame atlas and preserves distinctions among tails in the fixed target, rather than quotienting by automorphisms of R_0 .

Every such point specializes from the dense open in its smooth chart, hence occurs from a formal one-parameter family of pencils; properness of the Hilbert graph gives the same embedded limit. Alternatively choose $g_i = t$ and lift its prescribed slope by $r_i = \text{rem}_{f_i}(g_i w_i)$, then use the formally smooth pencil-coordinate map. Its local ideal is $(x_i^{a_i}, t)$. The two jet charts are affine spaces of dimension a_i , with the usual open overlap. They are smooth and irreducible. Products at distinct supports follow from the independent contact coordinates.

In a chart r_i is a multiple of g_i modulo f_i , so a common zero of the triple is exactly a common zero of f_i, g_i . This gives (39.8). The fibre and multiplicity statements follow from the scheme calculation in (39.4). Only the last exterior system has a base ideal on the corank-two open. Its base length is the degree of the indicated gcd; the smaller systems are units. This proves (39.9) and the Hilbert polynomial, with no assumption that the gcd is squarefree. $\square$

The theorem determines a full neighbourhood of every primitive line-tail lift. It does not identify this open with the whole proper fibre. In fact the first nonreduced case already has another kind of component, as the next result shows.

40. A NON-EQUIDIMENSIONAL AMBIENT HILBERT FIBRE

Theorem 40.1 (Two different ambient boundary components). *Let $n \geq 4$ and let R_0 be a regular symmetric pencil with one corank-two point having Smith exponents $(2, 2)$ and otherwise only corank-one points. Its normalized Hilbert fibre has an irreducible component of dimension two, with open part $J_1(\mathbb{P}^1)$. It also has a distinct component of dimension at least four. In particular the fibre is reducible and not equidimensional.*

The second assertion is witnessed by every smooth conic through the attaching point in the exceptional $\mathbb{P}^2$: union with the fixed main strict transform gives a four-dimensional locally closed family of embedded Hilbert limits. These are reduced conic tails, not the thick line tails parametrized by the jet open. The assertion is about the actual fibre over R_0 , not the fibre of a chosen parameter slice. It does not assert that these exhaust its components.

Proof. Theorem 39.2 gives the smooth irreducible open $J_1(\mathbb{P}^1)$ of dimension two in the normalized fibre. Its closure is an irreducible component of dimension two. For the other family use the full normal coordinates with $a = b = 2$, $k = 1$, and take

$$\begin{aligned} f &= x^2 + t\alpha_1x + t^2\alpha_0, \\ g &= t\beta_1x + t^2\beta_0, \quad r = t\gamma_1x + t^2\gamma_0, \end{aligned} \quad \beta_1\gamma_0 - \beta_0\gamma_1 \neq 0. \quad (40.1)$$

The three coefficient quadrics span all quadratic forms in x, t . Their ideal is exactly $(x, t)^2$. The simultaneous graph on the parameter surface is therefore $\text{Bl}_{(x,t)}$, and its exceptional line maps as

$$[X : T] \longmapsto [X^2 + \alpha_1XT + \alpha_0T^2 : \beta_1XT + \beta_0T^2 : \gamma_1XT + \gamma_0T^2]. \quad (40.2)$$

This is a complete Veronese embedding, giving a smooth conic through $[1 : 0 : 0]$. The graph is a closed embedding in the incidence target, since these three generators define its Rees graph. Its flat special curve is the fixed main component and this reduced conic, meeting at the point corresponding to $[X : T] = [1 : 0]$. The intersection has length one. Their last-exterior degrees are $n - 3$ and two, respectively, and their Euler characteristic is one. The other exterior degrees are unchanged. Thus these are limits with the required Hilbert polynomial.

Conversely every smooth conic through $[1 : 0 : 0]$ has a Veronese parametrization of the displayed form: choose its preimage of that point as $[1 : 0]$, and normalize the first leading coefficient to one. Nonsingularity gives independence of the three quadrics. The normal-coordinate realization theorem lifts these arcs to actual pencil arcs. The congruence on the parameter disc specializes on the exceptional divisor to its fixed value at the contact point; it consequently gives the fixed exceptional plane identification, not a quotient identifying distinct conics.

Smooth conics through a fixed point form an open of a hyperplane in $\mathbb{P}^5$, of dimension four. Their universal conic is flat and its attachment to the fixed main component is one reduced point; the union construction is therefore a flat family. It is a locally closed immersion into the Hilbert scheme, as the conic is recovered as the residual component to the fixed main curve. Equivalently its homogeneous quadratic ideal in the exceptional plane determines it uniquely, in families. Since all its closed points are limits from (40.1), this reduced family factors through the reduced Hilbert graph fibre. The normalization of that graph is finite and surjective, and its inverse image over this family is finite and surjective. Some component of this inverse image has dimension four. Hence the normalized fibre has a component of dimension at least four. We use this finite inverse image, not a purported automatic lifting of a nondominant normal family to a normalization.

This component is distinct from the dimension-two component already obtained. The asserted non-equidimensionality follows. $\square$

The distinction has a concrete source. For a thick line the length-two parameter algebra acts nontrivially on the tail. For a conic tail the parameter acts by its closed-point value, and degree two is carried by a reduced curve in the exceptional plane. Smith data of the closed pencil do not choose between these Hilbert objects. The full versal neighbourhood contains both, whereas the two constant transverse parameters of the original Jordan slice see only a section of the jet-tail locus.

41. INCIDENCE DESCENT AND THE LOCAL GRAPH CALCULATIONS

We record the scheme and deformation details used by the reduced and nonreduced boundary theorems. These also fix the relation between the local coordinates and their invariant meanings.

Proposition 41.1 (The reduced open and its tangent sequence). *In the regular-pencil locus remove lines meeting rank at most $n - 3$. The universal corank-two incidence $D \rightarrow U$ is finite. Its open locus of reduced geometric fibres includes empty fibres and is precisely*

$$U_{\text{red}} = U \setminus q(\text{Supp } \Omega_{D/U}).$$

At (p, R) in this open, with $Z = Z_{n-2} \subset P = \mathbb{P}(M)$, there is an exact tangent-normal sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow T_R \Sigma_p \longrightarrow T_R G \xrightarrow{e_p} N_{Z/P, p} / \overline{T_p L_R} \longrightarrow 0. \quad (41.1)$$

For distinct incidence points the direct sum of the maps e_p is surjective, without a semisimplicity assumption. Each Σ_p is smooth of codimension two. The local labelling of these centres is etale; permutations on overlaps give the unlabelled boundary and its Fitting ideal.

Proof. The determinant is a nonzero polynomial on a regular pencil, so its corank-two incidence is finite on every fibre. The incidence projection is proper, and is therefore finite by the proper quasi-finite theorem [Stacks Project, Tag 02LS]. The rank- $(n - 2)$ locus on this open is smooth of codimension three, by its three Schur-complement entries. A finite complex algebra has zero Kahler differentials if and only if it is reduced: after decomposition into local Artin factors, a nontrivial maximal ideal has nonzero cotangent space by Nakayama; a residue field $\mathbb{C}$ contributes zero. The same holds geometrically after extension of the residue field in characteristic zero. Formation of relative differentials commutes with that extension. Their support has closed finite image. Its complement is the asserted open, and the zero algebra, representing an empty fibre, is allowed. Accordingly $\text{Fitt}_0(0) = \mathcal{O}$.

Let $\ell \subset R \subset M$ represent p . Then $T_R G = \text{Hom}(R, M/R)$ and $T_p P / T_p L_R = \text{Hom}(\ell, M/R)$. Restriction from R to ℓ is surjective. Compose it with the quotient to $T_p P / (T_p Z + T_p L_R)$; this is exactly e_p in (41.1). Moving the incidence point along the line and inside Z shows that its kernel is $T_R \Sigma_p$. For the convention $A : V^* \rightarrow V$, put $K = \ker A \subset V^*$. Restriction of the represented bilinear form to K identifies the normal space with $\text{Hom}(\ell, \text{Sym}^2 K^*) = \ell^* \otimes \text{Sym}^2 K^*$. Thus the projective factor ℓ^* occurs on both sides of the restriction map; it is not silently discarded. A frame of ℓ identifies the map with restriction of the symmetric variation to the radical. Changing that frame multiplies both maps by a unit. A reduced intersection makes the normal image of $T_p L_R$ a line, so the final quotient has dimension two.

For several points choose a nonsingular member and its self-adjoint operator. Radicals at distinct eigenvalues have direct sum, even when Jordan blocks are present. A symmetric form can prescribe its restrictions on this direct sum independently. Choose a pencil coefficient combination nonzero at every one of the finitely many points; varying that coefficient realizes all restrictions. Variations in the pencil itself land in their respective tangent-normal lines, so the joint map

descends to $\text{Hom}(R, M/R)$ and is still surjective. Smooth evaluation of the universal line to P also gives the incidence dimension $\dim G + 1 - 3 = \dim G - 2$.

Finally strict henselization of the base splits the finite algebra into its finitely many local idempotent factors. Every idempotent and its finitely many equations descend to an étale neighbourhood, since the strict henselization is a filtered limit of such neighbourhoods. Each factor has one-dimensional closed fibre, so its unit map has zero cokernel after tensoring with that residue field. Nakayama, followed by shrinking, makes the unit map surjective. It is therefore a closed immersion, not just a labelled point set. The tangent sequence identifies its two local equations, and joint surjectivity makes all equation pairs independent. Labels on étale overlaps are permuted. This proves the claimed descent description. $\square$

Lemma 41.2 (Independent-centre Proj and normalization). *Suppose étale locally a smooth base has independent parameter pairs $I_i = (u_i, v_i)$, with any number of complementary parameters. Then*

$$\text{Bl}_{\prod_i I_i} U = \prod_U \text{Bl}_{I_i} U.$$

The multi-Rees algebra has the relations $v_i U_i - u_i V_i$, and its diagonal subalgebra is standard graded and is the ordinary Rees algebra of $\prod_i I_i$. Its ordinary Proj is the displayed scheme; the full multigraded algebra uses MultiProj.

Proof. In polynomial coordinates tensor the one-pair Rees injections over $\mathbb{C}$; all variables are independent. The same relations persist under étale flat extension. On a chart choose for each i either u_i or v_i as denominator. Localizing by the product of the chosen generators and taking diagonal degree zero adjoins exactly the individual ratios, with equations $v_i = u_i w_i$ or their opposites. These are the fibre-product blow-up charts. The diagonal degree-one space consists of all products of one generator from every pair; its d th products give precisely $(\prod I_i)^d$. This proves the standard-grading and ordinary-Proj assertions. The equality of intersection and product of the ideals is checked on disjoint monomial variable blocks and descends by faithful flatness.

In its Hilbert application the reduced graph closure is integral and has the same function field as the pencil base, since both contain the same dense nonincident open. Over a fixed pencil distinct choices of exceptional lines produce distinct embedded subschemes: restriction to each fixed exceptional plane recovers its chosen line. Hilbert points do not identify them by an ambient congruence. Thus the proper map from the smooth product blow-up has finite geometric fibres, is quasi-finite, and is finite by [Stacks Project, Tag 02LS]. Only after that finiteness step does normality identify the source with the normalization of the integral graph in their common function field. $\square$

Lemma 41.3 (Jordan constants and normal thick charts). *For $L_m = E_m(xI - N_m)$ the determinant of its complementary $(m-1)$ -block and that of E_m are both $(-1)^{m(m-1)/2}$. Thus its scalar Schur complement is exactly x^m . In the two-equal-block family (36.1), the determinant constant c_m is one. The homogenized pencil at infinity is $E_m \oplus E_m$ and is nonsingular. Its thick graph charts are flat and normal; their special fibres have only their displayed component primes.*

Proof. The complementary block is anti-triangular of size $m-1$ with antidiagonal -1 . Its sign is $(-1)^{m-1+(m-1)(m-2)/2} = (-1)^{m(m-1)/2}$. The determinant ratio proves the claim, and the two signs multiply to one. Homogenization gives $E_m \oplus E_m$ when the finite-coordinate homogenizing variable is zero.

In the chart $x^m = tz$, the coordinate ring is free of rank m over the base polynomial ring in z , with basis $1, x, \dots, x^{m-1}$. In the other chart $t = x^m y$, the hypersurface equation is a nonzerodivisor in every geometric fibre of its smooth ambient relative affine plane. The fibrewise Cartier criterion [Stacks Project, Tag 062Y, part (3)] proves its flatness. The chart $t = x^m y$ is

smooth after eliminating t . The chart $x^m = tz$ is a domain and a hypersurface, hence Cohen–Macaulay. Its singular locus $x = t = z = 0$ has codimension two in the total space. It satisfies S_2 and R_1 , hence is normal by Serre’s criterion. At $t = 0$ the $t = x^m y$ chart has the irredundant primary decomposition

$$(x^m y) = (x^m) \cap (y) \quad \text{in } \mathbb{C}[x, y].$$

Its associated primes are (x) and (y) . The other chart (x^m) has the sole associated prime (x) . Polynomial smooth parameters do not change these conclusions. This gives the exact absence of embedded points, not just the support of the fibre. $\square$

Proposition 41.4 (Power coefficient modules on Artin tails). *Let $A = \mathbb{C}[x]/(d)$ for a monic polynomial of degree r , and let $T = \mathbb{P}_A^1$ be a primitive line tail in the corank-two normal plane. For $1 \leq j \leq hn$, put*

$$\delta_j = (j - h(n - 2))_+ - 2(j - h(n - 1))_+.$$

After removal of the common Cartier factors, the actual coefficient map of the j th power surjects onto $H^0(T, \mathcal{O}_T(\delta_j)) = \text{Sym}^{\delta_j}(A^2)^$. In particular it is the full relative system, including nilpotent coefficients; its cycle degree is $r\delta_j$.*

Proof. The unit $(n - 2)$ -block supplies a socle factor with a unit coordinate, so its multiplication inclusion on the residual coefficient module is split over A . Put $b = j - h(n - 2) > 0$ when the normal power is nonconstant. On the residual symmetric two-space its degree- b coefficient span is, by the universal identity,

$$A[\alpha, \beta, \gamma]_b \quad (b \leq h), \quad (\alpha\gamma - \beta^2)^{b-h} A[\alpha, \beta, \gamma]_{2h-b} \quad (b \geq h).$$

Remove the displayed determinant factor. A primitive line is a split rank-two submodule of the three-coordinate module over the semilocal Artin algebra A . Restriction of all degree- δ_j ternary forms therefore surjects onto all binary forms of that degree. Composition with the split unit-block map is the required explicit coefficient-module surjection. For $j \leq h(n - 2)$ the normal system is constant, and for $j = hn$ the same is true after removing the full determinant factor. Invertible Gaussian changes act invertibly on these modules. The original $\mathcal{O}(j)$ twist on the pencil line is trivial over the affine Artin support; this trivialization is separate from the graph line bundle $\mathcal{O}_T(\delta_j)$. Thus no reduced-point argument or ignored twist occurs. $\square$

Proposition 41.5 (The transverse surface and ramified normalization). *For the intersection calculation in Proposition 36.3, take the specified normal surface $S_m = \text{Bl}_{(x^m, t)} \mathbb{A}_{x, t}^2$ and its proper exceptional curve F . Then mF is Cartier, $F^2 = -1/m$, and the minimal resolution chain starts at F with multiplicities $m - 1, m - 2, \dots, 1$. The main component meets F at the other, nonsingular end point of its parameter line; it does not meet the far end of that exceptional chain.*

After $t = s^m$, the normalization is $\text{Bl}_{(x, s)} \mathbb{A}^2$. Its reduced tail maps to the original residual line by $[X : S] \mapsto [X^m : S^m]$. With its attachment marked at $[1 : 0]$, its automorphism group over that fixed map is μ_m ; it is a stable nonconstant component. No other marked points are required for this assertion.

Proof. On S_m the exceptional Cartier ideal is $\mathcal{O}(-mF)$ and restricts to $\mathcal{O}_F(1)$ on the proper curve $F \simeq \mathbb{P}^1$. Intersection with that proper curve is well-defined even though the surface is not proper. Hence $(mF) \cdot F = -1$. In the singular chart $x^m = tz$ the quotient parametrization is $t = A^m, z = B^m, x = AB$. The intermediate primitive rays of the A_{m-1} resolution have orders of t equal to $m - 1, \dots, 1$ in order away from the ray $A = 0$, which is F . The main component meets F at $z = \infty$ in the other smooth chart. The far end of the resolution chain faces the strict transform of $z = 0$, which is horizontal for the map to the t -line, not the main special-fibre component.

After ramification the two rings are $\mathbb{C}[x, s, y]/(s^m - x^m y)$ and $\mathbb{C}[x, s, z]/(x^m - s^m z)$. Their normalizations are obtained by adjoining respectively s/x and x/s . These elements are integral, with m th powers y and z , and belong to the common function field $\mathbb{C}(x, s)$. The resulting rings $\mathbb{C}[x, s/x]$ and $\mathbb{C}[s, x/s]$ are regular and finite over the displayed rings, and glue to the ordinary point blow-up. This proves the normalization claim with its common function field. The graph coordinates are the m th powers of the exceptional coordinates, as stated. Its deck transformations multiply X/S by an m th root of unity; they fix the attachment and form a finite group. The local cotangent module T^1 computed previously refers only to abstract total-surface hypersurface deformations. Neither this normalization nor that calculation identifies embedded, fixed-base relative, or raw Artin-algebra deformations with those abstract deformations. $\square$

42. ALGEBRAIC ENVELOPE FORMS AND INVARIANT RELATIVE DEFORMATIONS

Proposition 42.1 (An algebraic target for the envelope). *The envelope functor of Proposition 37.1 factors through an algebraic stack of finite type over $\mathbb{C}$: the stack of fppf forms, over the base, of the fixed projective-space bundle with its graded algebra and power diagram. It is the classifying stack BH_h of a finite-type affine group H_h . This statement is about forms of the specified bundle; it is not a boundedness theorem for all graded algebra bundles locally trivial only on their total source spaces.*

Proof. On the fixed $\mathbb{P}(V)$ the degree- p summand is $B_h(V)_p \otimes \mathcal{O}(2p)$. Its degree-preserving bundle automorphisms are constant matrices in $\mathrm{GL}(B_h(V)_p)$, since $H^0(\mathcal{O}) = \mathbb{C}$. Inside their finite product, preservation of the unit, multiplication and indicated polarized maps is a finite set of polynomial equations. It defines a closed affine group K_h of finite type. The proved $\mathrm{PGL}(V)$ linearization of the entire bundle lifts every projective source automorphism. Consequently its full automorphism group is $H_h = K_h \rtimes \mathrm{PGL}(V)$, with the action specified by that linearization. Its classifying stack is algebraic of finite type. Descent identifies its objects with the stated fppf forms. The envelope associated to a projective-source torsor is such a form, so its functor lands here. No global $\mathcal{O}(1)$ on a Brauer-nonsplit source is used. The exponent-free choice remains $h = 1$. $\square$

Proposition 42.2 (The invariant lifting class). *For the effective boundary map of Theorem 37.2, the chart classes in (37.5) are the local representatives of*

$$\mathrm{Ext}^1(b^* L_{B/U}, J).$$

Here a deformation of the base and a square-zero extension with kernel J have been fixed. On a chart $v = uw$, the relative cotangent complex is $[\mathcal{O}e \xrightarrow{-u} \mathcal{O}dw]$ in degrees $-1, 0$. On the opposite chart $u = vz$, its frames change by

$$z = w^{-1}, \quad e' = -ze, \quad dz = -z^2 dw. \quad (42.1)$$

These formulas identify the local obstruction cokernels and solution torsors. For several independent incidences the complexes form a direct sum, permuted by étale monodromy, and descend to the effective quotient stack.

Proof. The one-equation relative presentation has relation $v - uw$; its relative differential is $-u dw$. Its dual with coefficients in J has cokernel J/uJ , where the equation defect is $v' - u'\tilde{w}$. On the overlap the other relation is $u - vz = -z(v - uw)$ and $dz = -z^2 dw$. These give (42.1) and commute with the two differentials because $v = uw$. Choosing inverse lifts of w, z makes the new defect $-z$ times the old one; any other choice changes it by the corresponding differential image. Tangent corrections change by $\eta_z = -z^2 \eta_w$. Thus the obstruction and torsor are coordinate-independent. The multiple-centre equations have independent variables, so their relative complexes are a direct sum. Changes of labels and source frames act on this complex and its classes, giving descent.

The common Lie-algebra directions cancel in the relative cotangent complex of the two quotient atlases. This is a relative lifting obstruction for a prescribed base deformation, not an absolute obstruction on the smooth effective stack. $\square$

Corollary 42.3 (The ambient contact boundary for effective failure families). *The versal normal-coordinate, jet-tail and non-equidimensional-fibre statements transfer to the effectively rigidified sharp pencil-failure image via Theorem G.2. In particular, a family with contact exponents $(2, 2)$ has both the primitive thick line-tail locus and reduced conic-tail limits described in Theorem 40.1. The closed algebra does not choose one of these limits.*

Proof. The equivalence on arbitrary complex bases identifies the framed completed pencil atlas with the effective first-relation image. Pull back the explicit normal-coordinate maps and the embedded Hilbert families along that equivalence; their source torsors and changes of frame agree. This identifies deformations, not merely closed points, in the stipulated effective category. The multiplication power J_{n-1} on the intrinsic pencil gives the same exact contact ideal (f, g, r) and its finite presentation in (38.5). The distinguished exponent is one; higher powers give the same graph with additional coefficient systems. The two types of limits have already been realized by genuine pencil arcs, so their effective failure families realize them as well. This argument explicitly uses the sharp inverse. It does not claim a new operation internal to the closed finite algebra before source reconstruction, or an equivalence with the deformation stack of all raw Artin algebras of its length. $\square$

43. FIXED-TARGET COMPARISON OF CONTACT GRAPHS

This section makes the change of category in the contact construction explicit. A formal congruence depending on the pencil parameter acts on an incidence bundle; it is not an automorphism of the fixed target whose Hilbert scheme is under consideration. We retain the incidence projection and undo every such change before taking a Hilbert point.

43.1. Objects, targets, and the gluing statement. Work on a finite-type framed atlas S of regular pencils avoiding corank at least three, with central pencil R_0 . A frame here means a lift of the projective source, an ordered pencil basis, and a local parameter at each of the finitely many central corank-two points. These choices are not quotiented in an embedded Hilbert fibre. Let $\mathcal{L} \subset \mathbb{P}(\mathrm{Sym}^2 V) \times S$ be the universal pencil line, $X = \mathrm{CQ}(V)$, and

$$\mathcal{Y} = \mathcal{L} \times_{\mathbb{P}(\mathrm{Sym}^2 V)} X.$$

The targets and their maps are

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \mathcal{Z} & \hookrightarrow & \mathcal{Y} & \hookrightarrow & X \times S \\ & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ & & \mathcal{L} & \longrightarrow & S. \end{array} \tag{43.1}$$

Here $\mathcal{Z}$ denotes an embedded flat family, and the last vertical arrow is projection. The middle map is a closed immersion because $\mathcal{L}$ is the universal family of actual lines. An object in the graph retains its point of S , not just the curve in X . On the complement of the central contact supports, the complete-quadric lift is the forced section of this incidence target.

Write $\hat{S} = \mathrm{Spf} \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{S, R_0}$. For a local Artin complex algebra T with a specified map to $\hat{S}$, define $\mathcal{D}_X(T)$ to be the set of embedded T -flat closed subschemes of (43.1), with the fixed central curve, the specified Hilbert polynomial, and the forced lift off the contacts. Isomorphism means equality as closed subschemes, with the identity on the retained base. Restrict this functor, when needed, to the completed reduced closure of the nonincident graph. We do not use the abstract deformation functor of the curve or identify objects by an ambient automorphism.

Lemma 43.1 (Patching closed ideals with their quotients). *Let T be a local Artin complex algebra, let W be a Noetherian ambient scheme over a neighbourhood of a point of $\mathcal{L}_T$, and complete along that point's inverse image. Let W° be its complement. Compatible coherent ideal quotients on W° and the completion, with their identification on the punctured completion, glue uniquely to a coherent ideal quotient on W . The assertion applies to quotients with torsion supported at the contact and to their flat families over T . Flatness, equality of ideals and the specified closed incidence equations can be checked on this cover. The same statement holds for finitely many disjoint contact supports and after any Artin base change.*

Proof. Use the ring-theoretic completion on affine neighbourhoods and its pullback on projective charts. The map from this completion is flat, Noetherian, and is an isomorphism over the closed support. The formal patching equivalence for quasi-coherent sheaves is therefore [Bhatt(2014), Proposition 5.6(4), Example 5.8]; its hypotheses are also covered by Theorem 1.4 and Lemma 5.12(2) there. Flatness of the completion is essential: the unrestricted module assertion for a nonflat completion is not the statement being invoked. In particular no torsion-freeness at the contact is imposed.

Apply this symmetric monoidal equivalence to the quotient with its unit and multiplication. The ambient structure map and the ideal kernel are retained as part of the data. Surjectivity and the ordinary degree-zero algebra property are detected on the jointly surjective flat cover consisting of the completion and the open complement. Thus the glued object is an ordinary ideal quotient. Finite presentation descends on this faithfully flat cover; the ambient rings are Noetherian. The same cover detects base flatness by the local criterion for flatness, or by vanishing of the relevant Tor modules. It detects all the additional incidence equations. Patching on the projective affine cover then glues the coherent quotients. Iterating over disjoint supports gives the last assertion. This argument supplies descent data on the punctured completions; faithfulness of completion alone would only give uniqueness, not existence. $\square$

At the i th contact split a nonsingular block of size $n - 2$. The remaining symmetric Schur complement has entries a_i, b_i, c_i . On this rank open the only noninvertible minor ideal below the determinant is

$$J_i = (a_i, b_i, c_i) = I_{n-1}.$$

The determinant factor is an invertible ideal on the integral total space and does not change the simultaneous graph. A congruence $M_i(x_i)$ and the Schur splitting replace this generating triple by an invertible linear transformation over the completed base ring. Consequently they give an isomorphism between the corresponding projective graph targets over the formal parameter disc. Denote it by Θ_i ; it preserves x_i and is part of the comparison data. In normal coordinates the triple is (f_i, g_i, r_i) , the fourth polynomial k_i having been removed by the invertible row operation $c_i \mapsto c_i - k_i a_i$.

Proposition 43.2 (Completed embedded comparison). *Fix the framed atlas, formal Schur splittings and normalizing congruences just described. Let $\mathcal{D}_{\text{nor}}$ be the functor of embedded normal-graph quotients on the formal contact discs, together with their identification with the forced lift on the punctured discs. Then there is an equivalence of functors*

$$\mathcal{D}_X \simeq \mathcal{D}_{\text{nor}} \tag{43.2}$$

obtained by restriction and Θ_i , with inverse given by Θ_i^{-1} and ideal patching. No congruence quotient is taken on either side. Changing the chosen frames or congruences conjugates these functors and their inverse maps; it does not identify distinct fixed-target Hilbert points.

On the reduced graph component, the complete local rings are the complete local rings of the corresponding polynomial graph charts, with the smooth parameters of the contact atlas adjoined. In particular this assertion holds both at the division charts of Theorem 39.1 and at every

determinantal conic chart of Lemma 44.1. The comparison is compatible with restriction to fibres. Where these total charts are regular, normalization of the total graph changes neither them nor their scheme fibres.

Proof. The completed normal form of Theorem 38.2 is used over $T[[x_i]]$, with the base maximal-ideal filtration for its inductive construction. The parameter x_i is fixed; its powers specify the remainder degrees, not the topology in that induction. Since T is Artin the base induction is finite. For the complete universal base it is the inverse limit of these finite inductions, so no interchange of two unrelated convergence assertions is required.

An embedded family restricts to a coherent quotient on each completed contact neighbourhood and to the forced quotient on the complement. Apply Θ_i on the first and the induced identification on the punctured neighbourhood. Conversely undo Θ_i , impose the original incidence equations, and apply Lemma 43.1. These two operations are inverse on quotients and their structure maps, proving (43.2) for every T , including nonreduced bases. The use of the image Rees algebra can be recorded explicitly: a homomorphism $R \rightarrow R'$ gives

$$\mathcal{R}_R(J) \otimes_R R' \twoheadrightarrow \mathcal{R}_{R'}(JR').$$

Proj of this surjection embeds the actual image graph into the base-changed incidence target. We do not assert that this surjection is always an isomorphism. The closed ideals compared in the proposition are these actual embedded ideals, rather than an arbitrary base change of a blow-up.

For precision about the graph component, work first on the reduced finite-type Hilbert graph over the atlas. The closure ideal of its nonincident open can be computed in each finite presentation by saturating with the ideal of the excluded base locus. Noetherianity makes the increasing sequence of ideal quotients stationary; flat completion commutes with each finite ideal quotient. It therefore commutes with this closure computation. The rings are excellent complex algebras, and their reduced completions stay reduced. The patching equivalence preserves the nonincident section and the retained base, hence also this specified reduced closure. It is not a statement that unrelated components of an abstract curve Hilbert scheme have disappeared.

The contact map on the completed smooth framed base is formally smooth, with the bounded coefficient parameters as independent coordinates and the remaining directions as power-series variables. The scalar k_i is one of these independent smooth factors for the graph problem: the row operation above removes it without changing the embedded ideal when the operation is undone. Different contact discs patch independently. The polynomial graph charts give algebraic representatives for their contact quotients; their recovery maps retain the base coefficients. Applying the functor equivalence gives the asserted isomorphism of completed local rings with the smooth factors adjoined.

This is not yet an algebraization by formal assertion. In each application below the morphism on the special fibre is constructed algebraically first: a primitive line over the finite contact algebra, or a conic together with the fixed main curve, supplies its explicit coherent ideal. The finitely many coefficients of the central gauge on that contact algebra are algebraic. Thus these are finite-presentation morphisms into the actual Hilbert graph. The completed comparison proves their local isomorphism on the specified fibre charts. The residue fields at closed points are $\mathbb{C}$ and the local rings are Noetherian; the formal criterion for etaleness, [Stacks Project, Lemma 41.11.3], applies. The coefficient or ideal recovery gives a monomorphism. Such a morphism is an open immersion on these neighbourhoods. This orders the argument as algebraic construction, completed comparison, then etale monomorphism, rather than treating formal normal coordinates as an algebraic family without descent.

An alternative normalizing congruence acts through a transformation of the same relative incidence target. Both directions of the comparison compose with that transformation and its inverse. The composition in the fixed target remains the identity. The same identity is the cocycle

on overlaps of the source-frame atlas, so the comparison descends. Finally a regular total chart is normal; the finite normalization of the total graph is its identity there. Taking its fibre retains the original base equations, possibly with nilpotents. No commutation of fibre and normalization is used. $\square$

43.2. Cohomological recovery along the primitive locus.

Lemma 43.3 (The union sequence and the retained coefficient base). *Let $D = \operatorname{Spec} \mathbb{C}[x]/(x^a)$ and let $Z_w = C_0 \cup T$, with $T = \mathbb{P}_D^1$ the primitive tail and intersection the attaching section D . For $L = \mathcal{O}(a-1, 1)|_{Z_w}$ there is an exact sequence*

$$0 \rightarrow L \rightarrow L|_{C_0} \oplus L|_T \xrightarrow{\operatorname{res}_C - \operatorname{res}_T} L|_D \rightarrow 0. \quad (43.3)$$

The restriction from T is onto, $H^1(Z_w, L) = 0$, and $h^0(Z_w, L) = 2a$. For each such w these assertions persist on a neighbourhood in the integral graph Γ_a over B_a . On that neighbourhood the recovery map has a line-bundle cokernel, and vanishing of the retained third coordinate in that cokernel is a scheme-theoretic equality, not a fibrewise assertion.

Proof. The ideals of a scheme-theoretic union give $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{Z_w} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_C \oplus \mathcal{O}_T \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_D \rightarrow 0$; tensor by L . A line bundle on the local Artin scheme D is free, and the evaluation $H^0(\mathbb{P}_D^1, \mathcal{O}(1)) = \mathcal{O}_D^2 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_D$ at its section has a unit coefficient, hence is surjective. On the main component $L = \mathcal{O}(a-1)$ and on the tail it is $\mathcal{O}(1)$ up to an invertible Artin factor. The cohomology sequence gives $a + 2a - a = 2a$ and the claimed vanishing, over the Artin ring rather than only its residue field.

To specify homogenization, write W for degree- $(a-1)$ homogenization of w , and Q_0 for degree- $(a-2)$ homogenization of q ; when $a = 1$ the latter space is zero. The map is

$$(W, Q_0) \mapsto WG - sQ_0F \quad \text{in } H^0(Z, \mathcal{O}(a-1, 1)).$$

The section to be recovered is $s^{a-1}R$. There are $a + (a-1)$ unknown coefficients. Restricting to the main component, then to the tail, proves injectivity at every central w . Upper semicontinuity and cohomology and base change give a pointwise open neighbourhood on which the map is a split injection of ranks $2a-1$ and $2a$. These neighbourhoods cover the whole central locus; no single uniform affine shrink is asserted. Its cokernel is a line bundle. The class of $s^{a-1}R$ is zero on the dense nonincident graph. A section of a line bundle on an integral reduced neighbourhood that vanishes densely is zero. The recovered coefficients are thus regular and satisfy the division identity. The projection to B_a is indispensable: it already supplies f, g, r . All comparisons retain it. $\square$

44. THE COMPLETE FIRST NONREDUCED CONTACT FIBRE

We determine the entire fibre, including its nilpotents, at the first nonreduced contact. The calculation also determines the common boundary of the two components found in Theorem 40.1. It takes place in the graph over the coefficient base: the coefficients are part of a point throughout.

Put $B_2 = \mathbb{A}^6$, with coordinates the coefficients of a monic quadratic f and of two polynomials g, r of degree at most one. Let Γ_2 be the reduced closure in $B_2 \times \operatorname{Hilb}_{3l+1}(\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^2)$ of the graphs of $[f : g : r]$, on their common nonvanishing locus. The polarization is $\mathcal{O}(1, 1)$. Write $\nu : \tilde{\Gamma}_2 \rightarrow \Gamma_2$ for the normalization of the total graph, and set

$$o = (x^2, 0, 0), \quad X_2 = (\tilde{\Gamma}_2)_o.$$

The scheme X_2 is not defined by normalizing a fibre. In the target use coordinates $[F : G : R]$ and put $P = [1 : 0 : 0]$. The main curve at o is $C_0 = \mathbb{P}^1 \times \{P\}$.

44.1. An embedded chart containing all conic tails. Let $[s : t]$ be coordinates on the first projective line, with $x = t/s$. Consider the affine space with coordinates (c, e, λ, A, B, C) , and put $z = t - cs$, $H = R - \lambda G$. In the product with $\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^2$ form the matrix

$$\mathcal{M} = \begin{pmatrix} H & AF + CG \\ -G & H + BF \\ es & -z \end{pmatrix}. \quad (44.1)$$

Its minors generate the bihomogeneous ideal

$$\begin{aligned} Q &= H^2 + BFH + AFG + CG^2, \\ L_1 &= zG - es(H + BF), \\ L_2 &= zH + es(AF + CG). \end{aligned} \quad (44.2)$$

The associated map to B_2 , written on $s = 1$ with $z = x - c$, is

$$\begin{aligned} f &= z^2 + e^2C, & g &= eBz - e^2A, \\ r &= \lambda g - eAz - e^2BC. \end{aligned} \quad (44.3)$$

Lemma 44.1 (The determinantal family and its recovery maps). *The minors in (44.2) define a flat family of embedded curves of Hilbert polynomial $3l + 1$. It defines a morphism to Γ_2 . Near every point with $e \neq 0$, this morphism is an open immersion. Its image is regular and is unchanged by normalization of the total graph. At $e = 0$ the curve is the scheme-theoretic union of C_0 and the plane conic $Q = 0$ over $x = c$, with the attachment placed at that base point. The intersection is the reduced point (c, P) , even when Q is a doubled line. Constant changes of target coordinates fixing P provide such charts around every plane conic through P .*

Proof. The minors have height two on every geometric fibre. When $e \neq 0$, one eliminates H locally from L_1, L_2 ; equivalently the rank-one condition is the two-generator graph of f, g , with the indicated third coordinate. At $e = 0$ the ideal is

$$(zG, zH, Q) = (G, H) \cap (z, Q),$$

where $Q \in (G, H)$ is nonzero. The equality follows by reducing modulo z and then using that z is regular on the polynomial ring in F, G, H modulo Q . This gives the asserted union and intersection. In particular the height is two also for a singular conic. The Hilbert–Burch complex of (44.1) is consequently exact on every fibre. Its sheaf form is

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}(-1, -2)^2 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}(-1, -1)^2 \oplus \mathcal{O}(0, -2) \longrightarrow \mathcal{O} \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_C \longrightarrow 0. \quad (44.4)$$

The fibrewise exactness criterion for a complex of base-flat locally free sheaves gives base flatness of the cokernel. Computing the Euler polynomial from this complex gives $3l + 1$. This is an application of the classical determinantal resolution, not an assertion that the resolution theorem is new.

Substitution of (44.3) into the three minors gives zero. On the dense open

$$e(A^2 + CB^2) \neq 0$$

the three binary quadratics f, g, r are a basis, the curve is their graph, and the image is a smooth conic. Thus the flat family gives a morphism into the reduced graph closure. The assertion at infinity is direct: $s = 0$ implies $z = t \neq 0$, so L_1, L_2 give $G = H = 0$. There is no additional component or choice at infinity.

We prove the open-immersion assertion by regular recovery, not by counting parameters. At a central curve $C_0 \cup Q$, the union exact sequence and its twists give

$$H^1(\mathcal{O}(0, 2)|_{C_0 \cup Q}) = 0, \quad h^0 = 5, \quad H^1(\mathcal{O}(1, 1)|_{C_0 \cup Q}) = 0, \quad h^0 = 4.$$

Indeed $H^0(Q, \mathcal{O}_Q(2))$ has dimension five and $H^0(Q, \mathcal{O}_Q(1))$ dimension three for every nonzero plane conic, including a doubled line, by $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(j-2) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(j) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_Q(j) \rightarrow 0$. The restriction to P is surjective. Combining it with the main component proves both equalities and the surjectivity of the ambient restriction maps. Cohomology and base change therefore give, in a neighbourhood of this point in the integral graph Γ_2 , a line of quadratic equations and a rank-two bundle of equations of bidegree $(1, 1)$.

Normalize the coefficient of R^2 in the quadratic equation to one. Its F^2 coefficient is zero on the dense graph, because infinity maps to P , and hence is zero throughout this neighbourhood. Completing the square in R, G uniquely writes the equation as Q in (44.2); it recovers λ, A, B, C regularly. The projection to B_2 supplies f , so c is minus half its linear coefficient. Normalize the two bilinear equations by their coefficients at tG, tH ; the relevant minor is a unit at the central curve. The negative coefficient of sH in the equation with tG coefficient one recovers e .

Here is an explicit verification on the dense graph, which also checks the normalizations. Write $f = (x - c)^2 + d$, $g = eB(x - c) + u$, and $r - \lambda g = -eA(x - c) + v$. The coefficient of x^3 in $Q(f, g, r - \lambda g) = 0$ gives the displayed opposite linear coefficients. When $A^2 + CB^2 \neq 0$, the remaining coefficients give

$$u = -e^2A, \quad v = -e^2BC, \quad d = e^2C.$$

The normalized bilinear equations are then precisely L_1, L_2 . All these are equalities of regular functions or sections on an integral neighbourhood, so they extend from its dense graph open. The recovered parameters satisfy (44.3), and the universal curve equals (44.2), first densely and then by separatedness of the Hilbert scheme. Recovery is also the identity on the determinantal parameter space. These two morphisms are inverse after restricting to their common open neighbourhoods. The parameter space is smooth; its image is therefore regular and normalization does not change it.

Finally any nonzero quadratic form vanishing at P is nonzero on some vector not proportional to P . Choose that vector as the R direction. This is a constant target change fixing P , followed by rescaling. The preceding argument applies. Such changes are changes of chart, not an equivalence relation on Hilbert points. $\square$

44.2. The full fibre and its nilpotents. Let $\mathbb{F}_2 = \mathbb{P}(\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1} \oplus \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(2))$ be the compactification of $\text{Tot}(\mathcal{O}(2))$ whose section at infinity has self-intersection -2 . Denote that section by D_∞ . Let $\mathcal{Q}_P \simeq \mathbb{P}^4$ be the projective space of plane conics through P , and let $D_{\text{dbl}} \simeq \mathbb{P}^1 \subset \mathcal{Q}_P$ be its locus of doubled lines through P .

Theorem 44.2 (Complete first nonreduced fibre). *The scheme X_2 has exactly two irreducible components, with reduced structures $\mathcal{Q}_P \simeq \mathbb{P}^4$ and $\mathbb{F}_2$. Their scheme-theoretic intersection, when each is given its reduced closed structure, is the reduced projective line*

$$D_{\text{dbl}} = D_\infty.$$

The open complement of D_∞ in the second component is $J_1(\mathbb{P}^1) = \text{Tot}(T\mathbb{P}^1)$, and the first component parametrizes exactly the curves $C_0 \cup Q$, $Q \in \mathcal{Q}_P$. Thus the second component has dimension exactly two and the conic component has dimension exactly four.

The fibre is connected and generically reduced on both components, but is not reduced. In the charts of Lemma 44.1 its scheme structure is

$$\mathbb{C}[\lambda, e, A, B, C]/(eA, eB, e^2C). \quad (44.5)$$

At a doubled line with slope λ_0 the completed local ring is obtained by replacing the polynomial ring by $\mathbb{C}[[\lambda - \lambda_0, e, A, B, C]]$ in this formula. The nilradical is generated by eC , has square zero, and is supported on the locus of conics singular at P . The fibre is not Cohen–Macaulay at that locus. Its reduced support is the union of the two indicated smooth components, and the

normalization of that reduced support is their disjoint union. This last normalization is different from the normalization of the total Hilbert graph used to define X_2 .

Proof. First take the fibre of (44.3) at o . Its coefficient equations give $c = 0$, $e^2C = 0$, $eB = 0$, $e^2A = 0$ and $e(\lambda B - A) = 0$, together with a redundant constant equation. The resulting ideal is exactly

$$(c, eA, eB, e^2C).$$

No radical has been taken. In particular the charts compute the scheme fibre of a regular total graph and therefore of its normalization as well.

The conic family is algebraic over all of $\mathcal{Q}_P$. Its ideal is $I_{C_0} \cap I_Q$, with Q placed at $x = 0$; the intersection with C_0 is the constant reduced point P . The union exact sequence proves flatness and the Hilbert polynomial. The family is a closed immersion into the Hilbert fibre: its inverse on its image recovers the quadratic equation as the kernel of the ambient restriction in degree $(0, 2)$. This also gives the relative residual construction; locally

$$(I_{C_0} \cap I_Q) : I_{C_0} = I_Q.$$

For the displayed ideals this follows by dividing by G and H : no nonzero element in the hypersurface ring of a conic is annihilated by both G and H . This remains true in the universal conic family by its same presentation. Alternatively the kernel-line construction alone proves the asserted relative closed immersion. The regular charts of Lemma 44.1 show that this family lifts uniquely to the normalization near every one of its points; we do not use a general lifting assertion for maps from normal schemes.

The primitive open of the other component is the established jet chart. Write a jet as $w = w_0 + w_1x$ modulo x^2 . Near its direction at infinity use

$$\lambda = w_0, \quad e = 1/w_1.$$

In (44.2) put $c = A = B = C = 0$. This gives

$$(xG - eH, xH, H^2), \quad H = R - \lambda G. \quad (44.6)$$

For $e \neq 0$ it is the primitive thick-line curve with slope $w = \lambda + x/e$. At $e = 0$ it is

$$(xG, xH, H^2) = (G, H) \cap (x, H^2),$$

the main curve together with the planar doubled line $H^2 = 0$ at $x = 0$. Under the other affine coordinate of the direction line, $w'_0 = 1/w_0$ and $w'_1 = -w_1/w_0^2$; hence $e' = -w_0^2e$ on the boundary chart. These are exactly the transition functions of the compactification of $T\mathbb{P}^1 = \mathcal{O}(2)$ described above. Formula (44.6) and the jet families glue to a morphism from $\mathbb{F}_2$ into X_2 . The local inverse recovers λ, e ; the original jet chart supplies the inverse on its complement. Thus this is a closed immersion, since its source is proper. Its infinity section is precisely D_{dbl} . It has self-intersection -2 by the transition functions. The sum of the two reduced component ideals in (44.5) is (e, A, B, C) , giving the stated reduced intersection.

It remains to prove that these two families exhaust the fibre. Their union K is closed and proper. It is also open in the underlying fibre: at a point of the conic family the local fibre (44.5) has support

$$V(e) \cup V(A, B, C),$$

which is exactly the union just constructed; at a jet point the original open jet chart has no other branch. The scheme $\tilde{\Gamma}_2$ is integral and normal, and its projection to the normal integral base B_2 is proper and birational. Consequently all its geometric fibres are connected by Stein factorization [Stacks Project, Lemma 37.53.6]. The nonempty subset K is open and closed in X_2 , so it is all of its support. This is an exhaustion argument for the proper fibre, not an inference from the existence of two families of curves.

For clarity, the local primary calculation is

$$(eA, eB, e^2C) = (e) \cap (A, B, C) \cap (A, B, e^2). \quad (44.7)$$

It is irredundant wherever all the displayed coordinate functions vanish. It follows either by divisibility of monomials, or by intersecting first (e) with (A, B, C) and then with (A, B, e^2) . The two minimal primes are (e) and (A, B, C) ; (e, A, B) is the embedded associated prime when present. The radical is (eA, eB, eC) , so the nilradical is generated by eC and

$$\text{Ann}(eC) = (e, A, B), \quad (eC)^2 = 0.$$

In conic coordinates the equations $A = B = 0$ say exactly that Q is singular at P . These calculations also apply after localization and completion and identify the claimed support intrinsically. They prove generic reducedness, nonreducedness and failure of the Cohen–Macaulay property. The two reduced components are smooth and are distinct; the final assertion about their normalization follows. $\square$

Corollary 44.3 (Explicit adjacency and a numerical consequence). *Every doubled line through the attaching point is the common limit of primitive thick-line jets and of smooth conic tails. At such a point there is no extra component beyond the two in Theorem 44.2. The Euler characteristic of the underlying complex fibre is seven.*

Proof. The first specialization is (44.6). For the second, set $e = 0$, λ constant, $B = C = 0$, $A = \tau$; then $Q = H^2 + \tau FG$ is nonsingular for $\tau \neq 0$ and specializes to the doubled line. These are algebraic one-parameter families. Exhaustion was proved in the theorem. Euler characteristic is additive for the closed union, giving $5 + 4 - 2 = 7$. $\square$

45. PRODUCTS AND ADJACENCY FOR THE FIRST NONREDUCED BOUNDARY

The local fibre calculation applies to arbitrary larger Smith exponents and to any number of distinct contacts. This gives a complete boundary class, rather than a primitive open in a class whose complement has not been identified.

Let R_0 be a regular symmetric pencil whose line avoids corank at least three. At its distinct corank-two points write the positive Smith exponents as (a_i, b_i) , $a_i \leq b_i$. Assume

$$a_i \in \{1, 2\} \quad \text{for all } i. \quad (45.1)$$

There is no bound on b_i except the dimension constraint on the pencil. Let r count the points with $a_i = 2$ and s those with $a_i = 1$. Denote by $\hat{G}$ the normalization of the total reduced Hilbert graph of lifted pencil lines and by $\mathfrak{X}_{R_0}$ its scheme fibre. The polarization on complete quadrics is $\bigotimes_{q=1}^{n-1} H_q$, with Hilbert polynomial $\binom{n}{2}l + 1$.

Theorem 45.1 (Complete fibres and their component intersections). *After choosing parameters and residual frames at the distinct contact points, there is an isomorphism of schemes*

$$\mathfrak{X}_{R_0} \simeq X_2^r \times (\mathbb{P}^1)^s. \quad (45.2)$$

Frame changes act by the corresponding transition isomorphisms; the construction is intrinsic without an ordering of the supports. In particular the reduced fibre has exactly 2^r irreducible components. For a subset S of the r length-two contacts, the component is

$$(\mathbb{P}^4)^{|S|} \times (\mathbb{F}_2)^{r-|S|} \times (\mathbb{P}^1)^s, \quad \dim = s + 2r + 2|S|. \quad (45.3)$$

The intersection of two reduced components is obtained by replacing each factor where their choices differ by the doubled-line $\mathbb{P}^1$, and leaving the common factors unchanged. These intersections are reduced. This describes all multiple intersections as well.

The fibre is connected and is reduced exactly when $r = 0$. For $r > 0$ its nilradical has nilpotence order exactly $r + 1$: its $(r + 1)$ st power is zero, and its r th power is nonzero. Locally its equations

are tensor products of (44.5) and smooth jet charts. In particular the reduced support is not a replacement for its Hilbert fibre scheme. The Euler characteristic of the underlying complex space is $7^r 2^s$.

Proof. We construct the morphism before using completed rings. At a length-two support, the universal curve over X_2 contains its fixed main curve. In the charts (44.2), the fibre relations $eA = eB = e^2C = 0$ give

$$xG = eH, \quad xH = -eCG, \quad x^2G = x^2H = 0.$$

Consequently the quotient of the fixed main ideal by the curve ideal is annihilated by x^2 . Thus the entire modification, including the nilpotent directions in its parameter scheme, is specified by a coherent ideal quotient on the first infinitesimal neighbourhood of the support. At a length-one contact the corresponding quotient is annihilated by x . These are finite algebraic neighbourhoods, not unbounded formal data.

Use the central Schur splitting and undo its congruence on these finite quotients. Only finitely many coefficients of the central gauge are involved. Include the fixed main lift, and extend by its forced ideal off the supports. This gives algebraic closed ideal families in the fixed complete-quadric target. Multiplicative stability of the ideals is preserved by the target coordinate isomorphisms. Distinct supports are disjoint, so the constructions combine independently. Flatness follows from the local flat families and the patching lemma; their Hilbert polynomial is the one stated above. Indeed each contact of length a_i removes a_i from the last exterior degree of the main curve and puts that degree on the tail. The attachment lengths give Euler characteristic one for the total curve. The smaller exterior systems have no base point on this rank open.

This constructs a finite-presentation morphism from the right side of (45.2) to the fibre of the reduced Hilbert graph. Each point is a specialization of nonincident graph points: for primitive tails this is the division family, and for conic tails it is the dense open $e(A^2 + CB^2) \neq 0$ in (44.3). A polynomial line through a specified point with generic direction meets that open; normalization of its closure gives an algebraic one-parameter specialization. The nilpotent part of the constructed map also factors through the reduced total graph, by the completed comparison in Proposition 43.2, not merely because its closed points do. That proposition identifies its completed total neighbourhoods with the regular polynomial graph charts and the smooth contact factors. Hence the total graph is regular there, the morphism lifts uniquely to $\widehat{G}$, and the completed local maps on the fibre are isomorphisms.

Recovery of the embedded ideal on each disjoint finite neighbourhood makes this morphism a monomorphism. The formal etaleness criterion therefore makes it an open immersion. Its source is proper, so it is also a closed immersion. The fibre of $\widehat{G} \rightarrow G$ is connected: this is a proper birational morphism from an integral normal variety to the smooth Grassmannian, and Stein factorization applies. The nonempty open-and-closed image is the entire fibre. This proves the scheme isomorphism, not just an equality of reduced supports. It also explains why the arbitrary values of b_i make no difference: k_i is removed by a generating-row transformation which is undone in the fixed incidence target, while the contact algebra and the resulting finite quotient have length a_i .

The reduced components and intersections follow from Theorem 44.2 by products. Tensor products over $\mathbb{C}$ preserve the displayed reduced smooth components and their reduced intersections. The nilradical is the sum of the pullbacks N_i of the square-zero nilradicals of the r factors. The quotient by this sum is reduced, so there is no additional nilradical. Every monomial of degree $r + 1$ repeats a factor and vanishes. The tensor product of nonzero sections of all N_i is nonzero on a product of their nonzero affine charts, so the r th power is nonzero. The Euler characteristic follows by multiplicativity and Corollary 44.3.

Finally the construction uses the actual support schemes and the fixed embedded ideals. Permuting the support labels permutes the factors; changing local source frames applies their functorial transition maps. These satisfy the cocycle identity because the coordinate changes are undone in the fixed target. This gives the asserted unlabelled interpretation, rather than a preferred global ordering of contacts. $\square$

45.1. Resultant strata on the higher-contact open. For larger a_i the division chart remains useful even though the whole proper fibre is not classified here. The following records exactly its boundary stratification. It is also a check that repeated roots are not being mistaken for multiple reduced components.

Proposition 45.2 (Gcd partitions, codimensions and multiplicity). *In $W_a = \{(f, g, w)\}$, with f monic of degree a and $\deg g, \deg w < a$, fix a partition $\mu = (\mu_1, \dots, \mu_k)$ of $d \leq a$. The locally closed locus where the monic gcd of f, g is $\prod_{j=1}^k (x - \xi_j)^{\mu_j}$ with distinct ξ_j has dimension*

$$3a - 2d + k$$

and codimension $2d - k$. Its finite attaching scheme is the disjoint union of the primary schemes $\text{Spec } \mathbb{C}[x]/((x - \xi_j)^{\mu_j})$, and its tails are projective lines over those schemes. A multiple root is one primary thickening, not several components. At a point with squarefree f and precisely d common roots, the resultant divisor is locally a product of d independent parameters and has multiplicity d .

Proof. Parametrize the gcd by its distinct roots, giving k parameters, and write $f = hf_1$, $g = hg_1$. The monic polynomial f_1 has $a - d$ coefficients and g_1 has $a - d$ coefficients; impose the open coprimality condition on this residual pair and the conditions specifying the exact gcd partition. Recovering the monic gcd is regular on the constant-gcd-degree stratum by the fixed-rank Euclidean linear equations. Up to the finite permutations of equal parts, this gives dimension $k + 2(a - d)$; w contributes a . The statement includes $d = a$, where $g = 0$ and $f = h$. The primary decomposition is the Chinese remainder theorem for distinct roots and the gcd fibre equation of Theorem 39.1. At a squarefree f , its roots are etale local coordinates and $\text{Res}(f, g) = \prod_{f(\xi)=0} g(\xi)$. The evaluations of a polynomial of degree $< a$ at these roots are independent by the Vandermonde matrix. The nonzero factors are units, proving the final assertion. No normal-crossing statement is made at a multiple root of f . $\square$

45.2. A testable extension beyond length two. The following conjecture concerns the reduced components of a local fibre, not the miniversal congruence quotient. It distinguishes two questions: component geometry and a possible nilpotent structure on their union.

Remark 45.3 (Conjecture: rational components of the corank-two contact fibre). For every $a \geq 1$, let X_a be the fibre over $(x^a, 0, 0)$ of the normalization of the total reduced graph $\Gamma_a \rightarrow B_a$ defined in Theorem 39.1. Every irreducible component of $(X_a)_{\text{red}}$ has rational normalization. The closure of the primitive jet open is an irreducible component of dimension a , and its intersections with the other components contain a locus of curves whose tail cycle has a repeated line through the attaching point. For $a \geq 2$ the scheme X_a is not reduced.

For $a = 1$ the fibre is $\mathbb{P}^1$. For $a = 2$ the conjecture follows from the complete description above, including the doubled-line intersection and the square-zero ideal. For $a \geq 3$ it is a conjecture, not a component classification. The statement is falsifiable separately by the birational type of a component, its adjacency to the primitive component, or reducedness of the fibre. An eventual classification should refine it by the degrees and primary thicknesses of tail cycles of total degree a . The present product theorem makes no assertion about higher-corank contacts or singular pencils in the Hilbert problem; the independent inverse and singular-pencil invariant theorems continue to apply on their original domains.

46. TANGENT MAPS, LINEARIZATIONS, AND EFFECTIVE TRANSFER

We separate the source of the contact tangent map from the category in which the boundary is embedded. The elementary linearizations below also specify the splitting used in the envelope automorphism group.

Lemma 46.1 (Framed tangent map and stabilizer). *Let $A(x)$ be a regular symmetric pencil, expressed as a symmetric map from E to E^* with its parameter-line twist trivialized locally. After splitting a unit block, let $j(x) : W[[x]] \rightarrow E[[x]]$ be the inclusion of its orthogonal residual summand, and let $D(x)$ be the residual diagonal form. On the atlas of ordered pencil coefficients the contact differential is*

$$(\dot{A}_0, \dot{A}_1) \mapsto [j(x)^*(\dot{A}_0 + x\dot{A}_1)j(x)] \quad \text{in} \quad \frac{\text{Sym}^2 W^*[[x]]}{\{H^t D + DH : H \in \text{End}(W)[[x]]\}}. \quad (46.1)$$

The restriction to distinct contacts gives the direct sum of these maps. Local frame changes act by congruence and by the corresponding line-bundle unit; they identify these modules and differentials. This formula does not discard the pencil-basis directions.

If a nonsingular member is fixed and T is its self-adjoint pencil operator, the Lie algebra of its orthogonal stabilizer is

$$\{K : KT = TK, K^* = -K\}.$$

For Jordan block sizes $d_{\lambda,i}$ its dimension is $\sum_{\lambda,i < j} \min(d_{\lambda,i}, d_{\lambda,j})$. Hence on this fixed-member framed slice the contact quotient has dimension

$$n + \sum_{\lambda,i < j} \min(d_{\lambda,i}, d_{\lambda,j}).$$

This is not asserted to be the dimension of the unframed pencil quotient by source congruence and parameter reparametrization.

Proof. For a block matrix with invertible upper block U and off-diagonal block B , the inclusion is $j = (-U^{-1}B, 1)^t$. Differentiating the Schur complement gives $j^* \dot{A} j$: the terms differentiating j cancel because its image is orthogonal to the unit block. Infinitesimal residual frame changes contribute exactly $H^t D + DH$, proving (46.1). The polarizing line of the quadratic form has not disappeared. If ℓ is the tautological line at the pencil point, the untrivialized value is in $\text{Sym}^2 W^* \otimes \ell^*$, with the same congruence quotient; choosing a frame of ℓ gives the displayed formula. Changing it multiplies both numerator and congruence image by the same unit.

The ordered-basis atlas has tangent space $\text{Hom}(\mathbb{C}^2, \text{Sym}^2 E^*)$. At its image pencil R , the sequence forgetting the basis is

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{End}(R) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(R, \text{Sym}^2 E^*) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(R, \text{Sym}^2 E^*/R) \longrightarrow 0.$$

The rightmost term is the Grassmannian tangent space. A splitting specifies a local basis section; a different splitting may change the parameter-fixed contact coordinates. Thus the differential is first formulated on the framed atlas. The comparison theorem retains these choices and descends by its transition maps, instead of silently treating the four basis directions as zero contact vectors. Source-frame directions contribute the infinitesimal congruence image. The block computation in Theorem 38.2 proves surjectivity on this atlas, so it proves formal smoothness of its completed contact map.

For the stabilizer, decompose the self-adjoint operator into orthogonal primary cyclic blocks. Intertwiners between distinct eigenvalues vanish. Between blocks of the same eigenvalue their space has dimension $\min(d_i, d_j)$, as homomorphisms of $\mathbb{C}[t]$ -modules $\mathbb{C}[t]/(t^{d_i})$ and $\mathbb{C}[t]/(t^{d_j})$. An off-diagonal intertwiner K_{ij} forces $K_{ji} = -K_{ij}^*$ and supplies one independent copy. On a single cyclic block a commuting endomorphism is a polynomial in T , hence is self-adjoint.

It is skew-adjoint only when it is zero. This proves the dimension formula without assuming semisimplicity. Subtracting the orbit dimension $n(n-1)/2 - \dim \text{Stab}$ from the dimension $n(n+1)/2$ of self-adjoint operators gives the last formula. $\square$

Proposition 46.2 (The specified envelope has a split automorphism extension). *Fix V , $h \geq 1$, and the graded algebra bundle on $\mathbb{P}(V)$ with pieces $B_h(V)_p \otimes \mathcal{O}(2p)$, including its multiplication and power diagram. Its automorphism functor, allowing automorphisms of $\mathbb{P}(V)$, is represented by a finite-type affine complex group H_h . There is a split exact sequence*

$$1 \longrightarrow K_h \longrightarrow H_h \longrightarrow \text{PGL}(V) \longrightarrow 1.$$

The splitting is the one induced by the explicit source-normalized linearization, not a general assertion about automorphism extensions. The fppf stack of forms of this fixed object is the algebraic classifying stack BH_h . This statement permits twisted projective source bundles but does not classify all graded algebra bundles of those ranks, or all raw failure algebras.

Proof. Start with the natural $\text{GL}(V)$ action on the apolar quotient and on the tautological bundle. A scalar t acts on $B_h(V)_p$ by t^{2p} and on $\mathcal{O}(2p)$ by t^{-2p} . It therefore acts trivially on their tensor product and on its multiplication. The action factors through $\text{PGL}(V)$, giving a group homomorphism into automorphisms of the specified object whose projection to source automorphisms is the identity. This is the required splitting and defines the conjugation action on K_h . Without this chosen linearization there would only be an extension, and a semidirect-product notation would require justification.

An automorphism over the identity of $\mathbb{P}(V)$ is, in each degree, a constant invertible matrix, since $H^0(\mathbb{P}(V), \text{End}(B_h(V)_p \otimes \mathcal{O}(2p))) = \text{End}(B_h(V)_p)$. There are finitely many nonzero degrees. Preservation of the unit and multiplication is a finite collection of polynomial equations in these matrices and their inverses. The resulting closed subgroup K_h is affine of finite type, and $H_h = K_h \rtimes \text{PGL}(V)$ has the same properties. An isomorphism torsor for fppf-local forms of this one object is an H_h -torsor, and effective descent gives the inverse construction. Thus the category of forms is precisely BH_h . Affine finite-type groups over $\mathbb{C}$ are smooth, and the usual classifying-stack atlas establishes the asserted algebraicity. $\square$

Corollary 46.3 (Complete boundary fibres on the effective failure image). *On the effectively rigidified sharp pencil-failure image, families satisfying (45.1) have the complete boundary fibres of Theorem 45.1, including their nilpotent structures, component dimensions and intersections. The exponent $h = 1$ defines the envelope without an additional integer choice; other $h \geq 1$ have the same graph. The assertion is a functorial consequence of the sharp inverse on effective families. It is not an internal boundary construction on a closed algebra before reconstruction and is not a statement about the full raw Artin-algebra deformation stack.*

Proof. Use the family inverse to recover the oriented source and pencil, then the source-normalized envelope to obtain its multiplication ideals. On the corank-two rank open the relevant graph is determined by I_{n-1} ; the universal power identity gives the same graph for every h . The completed comparison and the full-fibre theorem identify its embedded family. Their transition maps commute with the effective equivalence and the source linearization, so all the scheme structures descend, including the local ideal (eA, eB, e^2C) and its products. This proves the claim in the stated category and no larger one. $\square$

47. COLLISION OF TWO INCIDENCE POINTS

The complete fibre of Theorem 44.2 does not by itself describe which of its points arise by colliding two reduced incidences. We determine this specialization as a family, including its vertical excess and its scheme multiplicities. All spaces in this section are parameter spaces for

embedded curves. A semistable model of such a parameter space is not a semistable model of every curve parametrized by it.

Retain the coefficient graph $\tilde{\Gamma}_2 \rightarrow B_2$ and the point o of Section 44. Set

$$T = \operatorname{Spec} \mathbb{C}[\delta], \quad \gamma : T \longrightarrow B_2, \quad \delta \longmapsto (x^2 - \delta, 0, 0), \quad \mathcal{H} = \tilde{\Gamma}_2 \times_{B_2} T. \quad (47.1)$$

Let $\mathcal{Y}$ be the schematic closure of $\mathcal{H}|_{\delta \neq 0}$ in $\mathcal{H}$. Thus the closure is formed *after* this base change. Write $\Lambda \simeq \mathbb{P}^1$ for the space of lines through $P = [1 : 0 : 0]$ in the residual plane, and $\mathcal{Q}_P \simeq \mathbb{P}^4$ for its conics through P . Its linear subspace

$$S = \{Q \in \mathcal{Q}_P : Q \text{ is singular at } P\} \simeq \mathbb{P}^2 = \operatorname{Sym}^2 \Lambda$$

parametrizes unordered pairs of lines through P , with repetitions. We distinguish this plane from the entire conic component.

Theorem 47.1 (The horizontal collision space and its excess). *The scheme $\mathcal{Y}$ is a smooth integral threefold, projective and flat over T . Define*

$$Z = \operatorname{Bl}_{\Delta_\Lambda \times \{0\}}(\Lambda \times \Lambda \times \mathbb{A}_t^1), \quad \iota(\ell_+, \ell_-, t) = (\ell_-, \ell_+, -t). \quad (47.2)$$

The involution lifts to Z , and there is an isomorphism over T

$$\mathcal{Y} \simeq Z / \langle \iota \rangle, \quad \delta = t^2. \quad (47.3)$$

For $\delta \neq 0$ the geometric fibre is $\Lambda \times \Lambda$, with the two factors attached at $x = \sqrt{\delta}$ and $x = -\sqrt{\delta}$. The identification with an ordered product requires the displayed root cover; it is not a global ordering over $T \setminus \{0\}$.

There are smooth divisors $E \simeq \mathbb{F}_2$ and $S \simeq \mathbb{P}^2$ in $\mathcal{Y}$ such that

$$\mathcal{Y}_0 = E + 2S, \quad D = E \cap S \simeq \mathbb{P}^1, \quad \mathcal{O}_S(S) = \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(-1). \quad (47.4)$$

The equality is an equality of effective Cartier divisors in the smooth threefold. The reduced support has normal crossings. The curve D is the negative section in E and the doubled-line conic in $S = \operatorname{Sym}^2 \Lambda$.

The full pullback $\mathcal{H}$ is reduced but is not flat over T . It has precisely the horizontal component $\mathcal{Y}$ and the vertical component $\mathcal{Q}_P$ over 0. Their scheme intersection is the reduced plane S , and their union is scheme-theoretic:

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{H}} \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{Y}} \oplus \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{Q}_P} \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_S \longrightarrow 0. \quad (47.5)$$

Closed-immersion direct images are implicit in this formula. The entire $\mathbb{C}[\delta]$ -torsion is killed by δ and is

$$\ker(\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{H}} \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{Y}}) = i_* \mathcal{I}_{S/\mathcal{Q}_P} = \operatorname{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{C}[\delta]}(\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{H}}, \mathbb{C}), \quad (47.6)$$

where $i : \mathcal{Q}_P \hookrightarrow \mathcal{H}$. Consequently colliding two reduced incidences reaches exactly $E \cup S$ in the support of $X_2 = \mathcal{H}_0$, not every conic in $\mathcal{Q}_P$.

Proof. The target and the coefficients are retained throughout. In a conic chart of Lemma 44.1, taking the base change (47.1) gives exactly

$$\mathcal{H} : \quad \mathbb{C}[\lambda, e, A, B, C, \delta] / (eA, eB, e^2C + \delta). \quad (47.7)$$

Indeed the linear coefficient of f gives $c = 0$, its constant coefficient gives $e^2C = -\delta$, the linear coefficient of g gives $eB = 0$, and that of r gives $eA = 0$. The two remaining constant equations are then redundant. These are equations in a regular chart of the normalized total graph; no fibre normalization or fibrewise radical is being taken.

After eliminating δ , the ideal is (eA, eB) . Saturation by $\delta = -e^2C$ gives (A, B) . The horizontal chart is therefore

$$\mathbb{C}[\lambda, e, C], \quad \delta = -e^2C. \quad (47.8)$$

The other reduced component is $e = 0$, and their intersection is $e = A = B = 0$. On the conic component this is exactly the singular-at- P plane. The identity

$$(eA, eB) = (e) \cap (A, B)$$

proves reducedness of the pullback on this chart. It also gives (47.5) locally. Its annihilator calculation is

$$((eA, eB) : e^2C) = (A, B),$$

so every base-torsion section is already killed by δ .

For completeness we construct the projective horizontal model, rather than identify it from its closed points. Choose an affine coordinate w on Λ containing both directions and put

$$w_+ = \lambda + d, \quad w_- = \lambda - d.$$

Near the diagonal the ordered centre has ideal (d, t) . The two blow-up charts and their involutions are

$$\begin{aligned} t = ed : & & (\lambda, d, e) &\longmapsto (\lambda, -d, e), \\ d = ut : & & (\lambda, t, u) &\longmapsto (\lambda, -t, u). \end{aligned}$$

Their invariant rings, respectively, are

$$\mathbb{C}[\lambda, e, C], \quad C = -d^2, \quad \delta = -e^2C; \quad \mathbb{C}[\lambda, u, \delta], \quad \delta = t^2. \quad (47.9)$$

On the overlap $e = 1/u$ and $C = -\delta u^2$. These are regular rings. Common affine coordinates cover all pairs in $\Lambda \times \Lambda$: a point of Λ outside either of two specified directions may be chosen as infinity. The invariant charts and their target-coordinate translates glue, giving a scheme quotient. This also verifies smoothness at the fixed locus; no theorem about quotients by a *free* action is applied there. Projectivity follows, for example, by tensoring the translates of a relatively ample line bundle on the blow-up, taking an even power to trivialize stabilizer actions on fibres, and descending it to the finite quotient. Equivalently its invariant section algebra gives this projective quotient. The affine calculations exhibit the same quotient directly.

We next map it to the retained-coefficient Hilbert graph. On the first invariant chart use (44.2) with $c = A = B = 0$:

$$(H^2 + CG^2, xG - eH, xH + eCG), \quad H = R - \lambda G. \quad (47.10)$$

The fixed coefficients are $(x^2 - \delta, 0, 0)$ because $\delta = -e^2C$. On the second chart use the division family with $f = x^2 - \delta$, $g = r = 0$, and $w = \lambda + ux$; its equations include $fG = 0$ and $R = wG$. The original flat-family results apply after these base changes. On $u \neq 0$ these ideals agree with (47.10), since $e = 1/u$. Under changes of the direction coordinate they give the same embedded family: this holds on the dense locus $t \neq 0$ and hence everywhere by separatedness of the Hilbert scheme on each integral overlap. Their maps to the coefficient graph therefore glue. They land in its regular division and conic charts, where total normalization is an isomorphism.

For $t \neq 0$, the first ideal places the direction w_+ at $x = t$ and w_- at $x = -t$. It records all choices of the two lines, including equality of their directions, which is covered by the second chart. The common affine-coordinate argument covers the whole generic fibre. The recovery maps in the conic and division charts identify the quotient with the horizontal charts of $\mathcal{H}$, not just with their supports. The two resulting morphisms are inverse on these charts, proving (47.3). This constructs the isomorphism algebraically; formal normal forms are not used to manufacture it.

The strict transform of $t = 0$ in Z is $\Lambda \times \Lambda$. Its quotient is $\text{Sym}^2 \Lambda = S$. The exceptional divisor is

$$\mathbb{P}(N_{\Delta_\Lambda/(\Lambda \times \Lambda)} \oplus \mathcal{O}) = \mathbb{P}(\mathcal{O}(2) \oplus \mathcal{O}) = \mathbb{F}_2.$$

The involution acts trivially on this divisor, since it is -1 on both normal directions before projectivization. Their common curve is the diagonal, whose image in S is the doubled-line

conic. On the chart (47.8), $S = (e = 0)$, $E = (C = 0)$, and $\delta = -e^2C$. This proves the divisor multiplicities and transverse reduced intersection. On E the coordinate $u = 1/e$ is the affine tangent-jet coordinate, so $e = 0$ is its negative section, as in (44.6). Since $2S + E$ is principal and $E|_S$ is the degree-two conic, $2S|_S = -2H_S$. The Picard group of $S = \mathbb{P}^2$ has no torsion, giving $\mathcal{O}_S(S) = \mathcal{O}_S(-1)$.

The quotient is integral and hence torsion-free as a module over $\mathbb{C}[\delta]$. Localize this ring at each prime: its nonfield localizations are discrete valuation rings. The valuation-ring flatness criterion [Stacks Project, Tag 0539] proves flatness at every base point, and hence over T . The complete first-contact theorem covers every point of $\mathcal{H}_0$ by its conic charts or primitive charts. On a primitive chart the pullback is $\mathbb{C}[\lambda, u, \delta]$ and has no vertical part. Away from 0 all fibres are the reduced-incidence product. Thus the local descriptions just proved exhaust $\mathcal{H}$. They glue (47.5); no unexamined component can be supported over a different point of T . The kernel of the projection to $\mathcal{Y}$ is, on the vertical component, exactly its ideal of S . Resolving $\mathbb{C}$ over $\mathbb{C}[\delta]$ by multiplication by δ identifies this kernel with the stated Tor sheaf. It is nonzero, so $\mathcal{H}$ is not flat. The last assertion follows from the proper flat horizontal model and (47.4). $\square$

47.1. The ramified model and monodromy.

Theorem 47.2 (Ordered resolution of the collision). *The normalization of $\mathcal{Y} \times_{\mathbb{A}^1_\delta} \mathbb{A}^1_t$, with $\delta = t^2$, is Z in (47.2). It is smooth and its fibre over $t = 0$ is the reduced normal-crossing union of $\Lambda \times \Lambda$ and $\mathbb{F}_2$, meeting along the diagonal section. In particular the multiplicity two in (47.4) is caused by forgetting the order of the colliding supports.*

On the punctured complex base the monodromy on $H^2(\mathcal{Y}_\delta, \mathbb{Q})$ interchanges the two ruling classes. Its invariant and anti-invariant spaces both have dimension one. These assertions concern the degeneration of the parameter space. They do not replace thick embedded Hilbert tails by reduced stable-map tails.

Proof. The first invariant chart after base change is

$$\mathbb{C}[\lambda, e, C, t]/(t^2 + e^2C).$$

Its normalization is obtained by adjoining $d = t/e$, with $d^2 = -C$, and is $\mathbb{C}[\lambda, e, d]$, $t = ed$. This extension is finite because d satisfies a monic equation, and it has the same fraction field; the polynomial ring is normal. The second chart becomes $\mathbb{C}[\lambda, t, u]$ with $d = tu$. These finite normal charts glue by $e = 1/u$, giving precisely the ordered blow-up. They prove normalization of the base change itself, not of its special fibre. The central equations $t = ed$ and $t = 0$ in the two smooth charts give the reduced normal crossings and the stated components.

Over $t \neq 0$ the blow-up is the constant product $\Lambda \times \Lambda \times \mathbb{G}_m$. Descent identifies (ℓ_+, ℓ_-, t) with $(\ell_-, \ell_+, -t)$. A loop around $\delta = 0$ exchanges the roots and hence the ruling classes. Their sum and difference give the two claimed eigenspaces. This calculation uses the ordering cover, not a claim that the whole collision family is topologically locally trivial at 0. $\square$

47.2. The nilpotent sheaf of the full contact fibre.

Theorem 47.3 (Global nilradical and coherent cohomology). *Let $j : S = \mathbb{P}^2 \hookrightarrow X_2$ be the singular-conic plane. The nilradical $\mathcal{N}$ of the complete scheme fibre satisfies*

$$\mathcal{N} \simeq j_*\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(-1), \quad \mathcal{N}^2 = 0. \quad (47.11)$$

The isomorphism specifies the module; it does not assert that the square-zero algebra extension is split. Moreover

$$H^0(X_2, \mathcal{O}_{X_2}) = \mathbb{C}, \quad H^q(X_2, \mathcal{O}_{X_2}) = 0 \quad (q > 0).$$

The same coherent-cohomology statement holds for every complete fibre $X_2^r \times (\mathbb{P}^1)^s$ of Theorem 45.1, although for $r > 0$ that fibre is nonreduced and is not Cohen–Macaulay on its nilpotent support.

Proof. Restrict the quotient $\mathcal{O}_{X_2} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{Y_0}$ in the conic charts. Its source and target have presentations

$$\frac{\mathbb{C}[\lambda, e, A, B, C]}{(eA, eB, e^2C)} \longrightarrow \frac{\mathbb{C}[\lambda, e, C]}{(e^2C)}.$$

Both nilradicals are generated by eC , and the map identifies them as modules on S . Off S both vanish. This is consequently a global isomorphism of nilradical sheaves. In the smooth threefold $\mathcal{Y}$, the nilradical of $E + 2S$ is

$$\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{Y}}(-E - S)/\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{Y}}(-E - 2S) \simeq \mathcal{O}_S(-E - S) \simeq \mathcal{O}_S(S).$$

The last isomorphism uses the principal divisor $E + 2S$; (47.4) now gives (47.11). Thus the local nilpotent generator has a nontrivial global twist; its support alone would not determine it.

The reduced union has the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{(X_2)_{\text{red}}} \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^4} \oplus \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{F}_2} \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Each of the three smooth terms has constants as its only coherent cohomology: for $\mathbb{F}_2$ this follows from its projective-line bundle over $\mathbb{P}^1$. The map on constants is the difference and is surjective. Also $H^q(\mathbb{P}^2, \mathcal{O}(-1)) = 0$ for every q . Apply the cohomology sequences first to this union and then to $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{N} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X_2} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{(X_2)_{\text{red}}} \rightarrow 0$. They give the assertions. The product statement follows from Kunneth over $\mathbb{C}$ and the already proved scheme-product theorem. It is not an inference of reducedness or flatness from constant coherent cohomology. $\square$

47.3. Several simultaneous collisions.

Corollary 47.4 (Independent collision multiplicities). *For r independent copies of (47.1) and s additional simple contacts, the horizontal collision space is $\mathcal{Y}^r \times (\mathbb{P}^1)^s$ over $\mathbb{A}_{\delta}^r$. Its central fibre has 2^r reduced components*

$$S^{|J|} \times E^{r-|J|} \times (\mathbb{P}^1)^s, \quad J \subseteq \{1, \dots, r\},$$

each of dimension $2r + s$ and of cycle multiplicity $2^{|J|}$. Intersections replace differing factors by D . After $\delta_i = t_i^2$ and normalization the ordered model is $Z^r \times (\mathbb{P}^1)^s$. Its total space is smooth, and the inverse image of the union of the base coordinate hyperplanes is a reduced simple-normal-crossing divisor. The fibre over the origin instead has the product local equations $u_i v_i = 0$ in disjoint coordinate pairs, omitting one factor at a smooth point of a component. The full central pullback is $X_2^r \times (\mathbb{P}^1)^s$, whose conic factors are $\mathbb{P}^4$, not S . Thus the horizontal and full fibres have different component dimensions even though both keep all choices at separated supports.

Proof. Form the product of the explicit flat horizontal models. The open where all δ_i are nonzero is dense in this integral product. On each chart its closure is obtained by saturating with $\prod_i \delta_i$, and removes precisely the vertical ideals in the individual factors. Hence it is the horizontal closure of the full product pullback. At the generic point of a component indexed by J , the central equations have the forms e_i^2 for $i \in J$ and C_i for the other indices, up to units. Their independent local lengths multiply to $2^{|J|}$. The intersection descriptions follow from the two smooth divisors in each factor. The finite normalization charts used in Theorem 47.2 tensor over the independent complex variables, giving the stated smooth ordered model. Locally $t_i = u_i v_i$ at the two-component locus and $t_i = u_i$ away from it. The equation of the full inverse image of the coordinate boundary is therefore the product of the appearing distinct coordinates, whereas the central fibre is cut out by the individual t_i . The last assertion is the complete-fibre product theorem, not a normalization-of-fibre claim. $\square$

48. COLLISIONS UNDER THE EFFECTIVE INVERSE

The collision calculation has an explicit realization by genuine symmetric pencils in a fixed target. This realizes the entire family of possible Hilbert limits over the chosen pencil family; a single parameter value is not assigned a preferred tail.

Proposition 48.1 (A genuine collision and its effective transfer). *Let $V = \mathbb{C}^4$ and consider the family of homogeneous symmetric pencils*

$$A_\delta(s, t) = L_\delta(s, t) \oplus L_\delta(s, t), \quad L_\delta(s, t) = \begin{pmatrix} -\delta s & t \\ t & -s \end{pmatrix}. \quad (48.1)$$

Every pencil is regular and has rank at least two. For $\delta \neq 0$ it has two reduced corank-two incidences, and at $\delta = 0$ it has one corank-two incidence with Smith exponents $(2, 2)$. The member at infinity $s = 0$ is nonsingular. The pullback of the ambient normalized Hilbert modification along this family is isomorphic, with the indicated residual coordinates, to $\mathcal{H}$ of Theorem 47.1. In particular its horizontal closure, its vertical excess and its torsion sheaf are those computed there, not merely families of selected curves inside its fibres.

The same statements transport to the effectively rigidified sharp failure-family image by the established inverse. The coherent δ -torsion and the horizontal closure are preserved under this equivalence. No assertion is made about deformations leaving that effective image or about a boundary operation preceding reconstruction of the source and pencil.

Proof. On $s = 1$, put $x = t$. Each block has determinant $\delta - x^2$ and has the invertible lower-right entry -1 . Its Schur complement is $f = x^2 - \delta$. The polynomial congruence

$$U(x) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ x & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad U(x)^\dagger L_\delta(1, x) U(x) = \text{diag}(f, -1)$$

has determinant one. Apply it on both blocks, and permute the unit blocks to the front. The residual matrix is fI_2 . Its triple of normal coordinates is $(f, 0, f)$; subtracting the first entry from the third gives the retained-coefficient triple $(f, 0, 0)$. The determinant of the full pencil is $(t^2 - \delta s^2)^2$. The unit blocks give the rank bound, and the affine Schur form gives the stated incidences and exponents. At $s = 0$ both blocks are $\begin{pmatrix} 0 & t \\ t & 0 \end{pmatrix}$, so infinity contributes no incidence or Hilbert choice.

We detail why these calculations describe the pullback rather than only its closed points. Over the finite support scheme $\text{Spec } \mathbb{C}[\delta, x]/(f)$, the congruence and the row subtraction are algebraic invertible changes in the *relative incidence target* over the actual pencil line. They are undone before the curve is viewed in the fixed space $\text{CQ}(V)$; $U(x)$ is not being used as one constant automorphism of that space. The forced main lift exists algebraically on this family, since the normal ideal $(f, 0, 0)$ is principal and the residual direction is fixed.

In the conic charts of the model $\mathcal{H}$ the equations $eA = eB = 0$ yield

$$xG = eH, \quad xH = -eCG, \quad fG = fH = 0.$$

In a division chart the same annihilation is $fG = 0$ and $R = wG$. Thus the quotient of the fixed main ideal by the curve ideal is annihilated by f , including the parameter-scheme nilpotents in special fibres. It is an algebraic quotient on a finite locally free neighbourhood, not data requiring convergence of a formal gauge. Undo the displayed polynomial congruence on this quotient and patch with the forced main lift away from the support. This constructs a morphism of the whole model to the actual fixed-target Hilbert pullback. Flatness of the families is detected on these local pieces, and their exterior degrees add to $\binom{4}{2} = 6$, with Euler characteristic one.

Conversely restrict an actual family to this incidence target and apply the inverse changes. Proposition 43.2 identifies its completed embedded quotients with the retained coefficient model; its smooth coefficient factors are fixed by (48.1). In particular the displayed annihilation and

all chart equations hold on every completed local ring, not just on geometric fibres. Faithful completion detects these finitely generated ideal containments and their equality. The algebraic quotient construction above and its inverse are therefore inverse on the division and conic charts. These cover the fibres by the reduced-incidence theorem for $\delta \neq 0$ and the complete first-contact theorem for $\delta = 0$. The ambient total charts are regular there, so taking their normalization does not alter them before restriction to the family. This proves the scheme isomorphism of pullbacks with the fixed target retained.

Finally the effective inverse is an equivalence on the specified pencil-family image, with the intrinsic oriented source included. Applying the Hilbert construction through that equivalence preserves its structure map and the actual local rings. The kernel of multiplication by δ , its saturation defining the horizontal closure, and the finite quotient descriptions are consequently preserved. This is an effective-family consequence of the inverse, not a new assertion about the stack of all finite algebras. $\square$

Distinct copies of (48.1), translated to pairwise distinct affine spectral points, give simultaneous collisions. Restrict the base so that the corresponding support schemes do not meet. Algebraic changes of the source frame and permutations of these supports act on the above descriptions by transition isomorphisms. The disjoint-contact comparison then gives Corollary 47.4. This supplies actual pencil families with the computed multiplicities without claiming a classification of collisions passing through higher corank.

49. DESCENT AND COMPLETE-LOCAL DETAILS

The following statements supply the local-to-global steps used in Sections 12–17. They also specify which assertions concern a completed image, a normalization fibre, or a family on an exact-divisor stratum.

Lemma 49.1 (Complete-local surjectivity and reduced completion). *In the cotangent-surjectivity assertion of Lemma 12.1, the rings are Noetherian complete local $\mathbb{C}$ -algebras with residue field $\mathbb{C}$, and the homomorphism is local, continuous, and the identity on that residue field. Under these hypotheses cotangent surjectivity implies ring surjectivity. A reduced local ring essentially of finite type over $\mathbb{C}$ has reduced completion.*

Proof. Choose preimages in the source maximal ideal of generators of the target cotangent space. Their degree- q products span every quotient $\mathfrak{m}_B^q / \mathfrak{m}_B^{q+1}$. Given an element of B , first lift its residue, then its error successively in degrees $q = 1, 2, \dots$. The correction in degree q lies in $\mathfrak{m}_R^q$. Their sum converges in R , and continuity and separatedness imply that its image is the desired element of B . This is not a statement about arbitrary noncomplete local homomorphisms.

Finite-type complex rings are excellent. Quasi-excellent local rings are Nagata and have geometrically reduced formal fibres; see [29, Tags 07QV and 0BJ0]. For a reduced local ring A , the injection into the product of its finitely many minimal-prime quotients remains injective after flat completion. Each quotient is a Nagata domain and its completion is reduced. Thus $\hat{A}$ is a subring of a product of reduced rings. This justifies the reduced completed-image step of the earlier lemma. $\square$

Lemma 49.2 (Coprime cluster products over Artin bases). *Let A be a local Artin $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra. If the reduction of a monic polynomial has a factorization into pairwise coprime monic factors, there is a unique factorization into monic lifts of the same degrees. In a factorization fibre, the functor of divisors with prescribed degrees in the distinct residual clusters is the product of the cluster divisor functors. Its coordinate algebra is therefore the tensor product of their Artin coordinate algebras.*

Proof. For two coprime factors p, q , the linear correction map

$$(\dot{p}, \dot{q}) \longmapsto q\dot{p} + p\dot{q}, \quad \deg \dot{p} < \deg p, \quad \deg \dot{q} < \deg q,$$

is an isomorphism on coefficient spaces over the residue field. Its kernel is zero by coprimeness, and source and target have equal dimension. It is therefore an isomorphism over A as well. Across a square-zero extension of Artin rings it uniquely corrects a lifted product to the given polynomial. Induction on the nilpotence order and then on the number of clusters proves existence and uniqueness. Apply the same argument to both the marked divisor and its complement. The cluster product and decomposition constructions are mutually inverse on every Artin base; Yoneda gives the asserted product of finite schemes. Passing to inverse limits gives the corresponding assertion on complete local bases. $\square$

Lemma 49.3 (The local choice and descent in the binary stratum). *The base-change identification of Theorem 13.1 holds as an identification of incidence functors, not only on closed fibres. The required choice of a member of the residual space coprime to the common divisor can be made on a Zariski open cover of the exact-gcd stratum; the choices are auxiliary and the resulting identifications glue uniquely.*

Proof. Write a point of the stratum as (G, L) in $\mathbb{P}(S_s) \times X_{D-s,r}$. The vanishing of a member of L at one of the finitely many roots of G is a proper linear condition on that member. Over $\mathbb{C}$ a finite union of these proper hyperplanes does not cover L . Choose a linear combination avoiding them, lift its coefficients on a bundle-trivializing neighbourhood, and invert its resultant with G . This gives the required Zariski neighbourhood. These neighbourhoods cover the stratum and may be pulled back by any base change.

On the marked-divisor incidence, pass locally to a monic coordinate for the proposed divisor f . The quotient by f is finite free. On every geometric fibre f divides G , so the chosen residual member is invertible in that quotient, by coprimeness. Its multiplication matrix has invertible determinant locally, hence it is invertible also over a nonreduced base. Thus $f \mid GL$ implies $f \mid G$ as an equation on that base, and the converse is immediate. Monic division forces the remaining subspace. The identification is independent of which coprime residual member established cancellation, so it glues on overlaps. No lifting of arbitrary image points to the normalization is asserted.

The finite factorization map used there is flat by miracle flatness: its target local rings are regular, its source local rings are Cohen–Macaulay, it is finite, and dimensions agree. These are exactly the hypotheses of [29, Tag 00R4]. This names the flatness input separately from the incidence-functor argument. $\square$

Lemma 49.4 (The coordinate equalizer and coherent conductor). *For the block ideals I_A of Theorem 14.1, the completed image ring is the equalizer of the branch rings with their restrictions to all pairwise intersections. This assertion uses the coordinate monomial structure. The completed conductor calculation there implies equality of the corresponding coherent ideal sheaves on the squarefree open.*

Proof. A monomial has a coefficient on each branch where its support survives. If it survives on two branches, it also survives on their coordinate intersection. Pairwise agreement therefore assigns it one well-defined coefficient. Collecting these coefficients gives one formal series modulo the intersection of the I_A ; conversely such a series has compatible restrictions. Formal convergence causes no issue, since there are finitely many monomials in each degree. The claim would be false for general configurations of ideals without this coordinate argument.

Write $A \subset B$ for the local finite normalization algebra. The conductor is $\text{Ann}_A(B/A)$, a coherent ideal. Flat completion preserves the exact finite-module sequence and its annihilator: compute the latter as the intersection of the kernels of multiplication on a finite generating set.

The completed finite algebra is the product of the normal branch rings. Thus the conductor and the ideal of Y_{g+1} have equal completed stalks at every squarefree closed point. Faithful flatness gives equal stalks, and coherence on a finite-type complex scheme gives equality of the ideal sheaves. $\square$

Proposition 49.5 (Finiteness and uniqueness of the collision diagram). *Every branch map in Theorem 15.1 is finite, and the completed incidence diagram is determined, up to the unique isomorphism respecting its incidence data, by its marked-divisor functor. It is independent of the chosen frame and root coordinates.*

Proof. For each cluster $P_i = A_i B'_i$, the coefficients of the monic A_i are integral over the coefficients of P_i . This follows from the finite factorization morphism, or by expressing them as elementary symmetric functions of a selected subset of the roots in a finite splitting algebra. Division by a monic polynomial expresses every coefficient of B'_i polynomially in those of A_i and P_i . Likewise $R_{ij} = A_i U_{ij}$ expresses all quotient coefficients in terms of A_i and R_{ij} . Consequently the branch algebra is generated over the ambient coefficient algebra by finitely many integral coefficients of the A_i , so it is finite. Completing preserves this finite-module assertion.

The equations represent the functor of a subbundle with a marked divisor and its uniquely determined quotient. A change of frame or local coordinate gives inverse natural transformations of this same functor and of its forgetful map to the ambient Grassmannian. The complete representing rings and their maps are uniquely isomorphic by Yoneda. Their scheme-theoretic images consequently agree as completed diagrams. This proves coordinate independence without identifying arbitrary Artin points of an image with lifted Artin points of its normalization. $\square$

Partition closures. For a fixed partition $(s_1, \dots, s_b)$, the proper map $(\mathbb{P}^1)^b \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(S_s)$ sending (ℓ_i) to $\prod \ell_i^{s_i}$ has closed image. Its open set of distinct ℓ_i is dense. At the boundary precisely some of these points coincide, and the associated parts add. Every such coincidence can be approached from distinct points. This proves exactly the merging closure order in the fixed-degree symmetric product; compare the coincident-root constructions of [19, 20]. It is not a closure classification for all analytic singularities of the completed collision atlas.

Equivariance of the singular Fitting calculation. The group used in Theorem 16.1 is $\mathrm{GL}_m(\mathbb{C})$, acting simultaneously on the columns u and w and fixing Δ . It preserves the presentation and therefore its intrinsic Fitting ideal. In the normalization the three displayed minors span, under this group, respectively $\mathrm{Sym}^m(\mathbb{C}^m)t$, $\Delta \mathrm{Sym}^m(\mathbb{C}^m)$, and $\mathrm{Sym}^{m+1}(\mathbb{C}^m)$, with the coordinate/dual convention determined by the action on u . To see spanning directly, their translates are nonzero scalar multiples of the corresponding powers of all linear forms; polarization in characteristic zero spans each symmetric power. Multiplication by R gives exactly the modules asserted in (16.1). This is stronger than invoking invariance without identifying the representations.

Specialization of minimal relations. For the surjective coefficient specialization $\pi : P \rightarrow P'$ to one coordinate in Theorem 17.1, one has $\pi(\mathfrak{n}) = \mathfrak{n}'$ and $\pi(\mathcal{I}) = \mathcal{I}'$. Consequently $\pi(\mathfrak{n}\mathcal{I}) = \mathfrak{n}'\mathcal{I}'$. A coefficient whose image is a minimal binary relation cannot lie in $\mathfrak{n}\mathcal{I}$. This explicitly justifies the nonzero irreducible coefficient map used in that proof. All reciprocal series and socle weights in these arguments use the weight of a Q_i coefficient equal to i . They do not claim ordinary maximal-ideal Hilbert functions; (18.7) gives one such function separately.

50. CONDUCTORS AND LOCAL MODELS OF DIVISOR COLLISIONS

We retain the notation of Section 11. All completed local rings below are completed at closed complex points. For a reduced local ring A with finite normalization B , its *conductor* is $\mathfrak{c} = \mathrm{Ann}_A(B/A)$, regarded also as an ideal of B . We use the intrinsic singular subscheme defined by $\mathrm{Fitt}_{\dim A} \Omega_{A/\mathbb{C}}$; on completions, differentials mean continuous differentials. The conductor and

this Fitting ideal need not agree. Our first result determines both on a multivariate stratum. The second identifies the way two branches merge when a common binary root becomes double.

The formal-image and separated-germ steps below are isolated in Lemma 12.1. Lemma 12.2 gives the Artin cancellation and a direct positive lower bound for the split codimension. Theorem 15.1 supplies the full Weierstrass incidence functor in every collision order; Theorem 16.1 evaluates the singular ideal for all ranks.

50.1. Two coprime divisor choices.

Theorem 50.1 (The split-divisor stratum). *Suppose $h > g$, $2 \leq r \leq s_{h-g}$, and*

$$K = abL, \quad [a], [b] \in \mathbb{P}(S_g), \quad L \in \text{Gr}(r, S_{h-g}), \quad \gcd(L) = 1.$$

Assume that a, b are coprime and that the only degree- g divisors of ab , up to scalar, are a and b . Put

$$\begin{aligned} t &= 2(s_g - 1) + r(s_{h-g} - r), \\ c &= r(s_h - s_{h-g}) - (s_g - 1), \quad d_g = t + c. \end{aligned}$$

Then $c \geq 1$, and there are formal coordinates in which

$$\widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y_g, K} = \mathbb{C}[[z_1, \dots, z_t, x_1, \dots, x_c, y_1, \dots, y_c]] / (x_i y_j : 1 \leq i, j \leq c). \quad (50.1)$$

Its normalization is $\mathbb{C}[[z, x]] \times \mathbb{C}[[z, y]]$. The conductor is

$$\mathfrak{c} = (x_1, \dots, x_c, y_1, \dots, y_c), \quad \widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y_g, K} / \mathfrak{c} = \mathbb{C}[[z]], \quad (50.2)$$

and the intrinsic singular subscheme has ideal $\mathfrak{c}^c$. The two smooth branches meet scheme-theoretically in a smooth t -dimensional subscheme. The local ring has multiplicity two and depth $t + 1$; it is Cohen–Macaulay exactly when $c = 1$.

Proof. We first determine the intersection as a scheme, not by comparing closed points or tangent dimensions. The normalization has precisely two points above K , namely (a, bL) and (b, aL) . At either point, the overlap in Lemma 11.3 is zero. The map from the completed local ring of the ambient Grassmannian to each completed source ring is consequently surjective: its cotangent map is surjective, and completeness and Nakayama’s lemma lift successive homogeneous terms. Thus each source completion is a closed smooth formal branch of the image.

Here is the required assertion over infinitesimal bases. Let A_0 be a local Artin $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra. A point on both formal branches carries unique marked lifts a_{A_0}, b_{A_0} near a, b . If homogeneous polynomials have coprime reductions, those reductions form a regular sequence in the polynomial ring over $\mathbb{C}$. Its graded Koszul complex is exact. In each degree the polynomial modules are finite free; lifting a splitting of the complex, or applying the local criterion for flatness successively, shows that its lift over A_0 is exact and that the quotient is A_0 -flat. In particular

$$(a_{A_0}) \cap (b_{A_0}) = (a_{A_0} b_{A_0}). \quad (50.3)$$

This also follows by noting that b_{A_0} is a nonzerodivisor modulo a_{A_0} and solving a relation between them. Applying (50.3) to the columns of the relation subbundle gives, uniquely,

$$K_{A_0} = a_{A_0} b_{A_0} L_{A_0}.$$

The residual module is a subbundle: multiplication by $a_{A_0} b_{A_0}$ is a split injection in degree D , and the quotient of the ambient free module by K_{A_0} is free. The kernel of the induced surjection onto the complementary quotient is therefore free. This proves that the formal intersection is represented by the product of the two divisor charts and the Grassmannian chart for L , with no nilpotents omitted.

The differential of this product parametrization is injective. Indeed, an infinitesimally constant product gives

$$(\dot{a}b + a\dot{b})l + ab\dot{l} \in abL \quad (l \in L).$$

Taking valuations at the factors of a , and using $\gcd(a, b) = \gcd(L) = 1$, forces $a \mid \dot{a}$; similarly $b \mid \dot{b}$. These are the two projective scalar directions, and then $\dot{L} = 0$. The intersection is thus a smooth formal closed subscheme of dimension t .

Let R_0 be the ambient completed local ring and I_a, I_b the ideals of these branches. Finiteness of the normalization, exactness of completion on finite modules, and the definition of the scheme-theoretic image give

$$\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y_g, K} = R_0 / (I_a \cap I_b) = (R_0 / I_a) \times_{R_0 / (I_a + I_b)} (R_0 / I_b).$$

This is the elementary conductor-square construction; see also [21, Lemma 1.3 and §1.3.2]. All three quotient rings are regular. Choosing compatible regular parameters for the two surjections gives (50.1). The branch dimension is $d_g = s_g - 1 + r(s_h - r)$, so its codimension along the intersection is the asserted c . It is positive: if $c = 0$, both branch ideals would coincide locally with the intersection ideal, contradicting the two distinct normalization branches of a reduced local ring.

In the fibre-product description, an element belongs to the conductor exactly when both its restrictions to the intersection vanish. This gives (50.2). The Jacobian of the relations $x_i y_j$ has nonzero entries only among the x_i and y_j . The Fitting ideal in question is its ideal of c -minors. Every such minor belongs to $\mathfrak{c}^c$. Conversely, choosing the c columns indexed by the y_j and one row (i_j, j) for each j gives every monomial $x_{i_1} \cdots x_{i_c}$. The symmetric choice gives every degree- c monomial in the y 's. Mixed monomials vanish in the ring. Thus the ideal is exactly $\mathfrak{c}^c$, including its nonreduced structure.

Finally use

$$0 \longrightarrow \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y_g, K} \longrightarrow \mathbb{C}[[z, x]] \oplus \mathbb{C}[[z, y]] \longrightarrow \mathbb{C}[[z]] \longrightarrow 0,$$

where the last arrow is the difference of restrictions. The depth lemma gives depth $t + 1$; for $c = 1$ this equals the dimension. For $c > 1$ it is strictly smaller. Additivity of leading Hilbert coefficients gives multiplicity two, since the last module has smaller dimension than the two regular branches. $\square$

Remark 50.2. The hypotheses are nonempty in every number of variables: for $e = 2$ one may take $g = 1$, and for $e \geq 3$ one may take two distinct irreducible forms of degree g . The theorem treats an explicitly specified stratum, not all pairs of overlapping degree- g divisors. In particular, it does not substitute a binary factorization rule for multivariate divisibility. Its high-codimension branch intersections need not be normal-crossing divisors.

50.2. A double common root. For $m \geq 1$, put $R_m = \mathbb{C}[[u_1, \dots, u_m, \Delta]]$ and $I = (u_1, \dots, u_m) \subset R_m$. Define

$$A_m = R_m \oplus It \subset B_m = \mathbb{C}[[u_1, \dots, u_m, t]], \quad \Delta = t^2. \quad (50.4)$$

The right side of (50.4) is a subring, not a square-zero extension: $(It)^2 = \Delta I^2$. For $m = 1$ it is the ordinary pinch-point ring.

Theorem 50.3 (Collision of two binary divisor choices). *Let $e = 2$, $g = 1$, $D = h + 1$, and $2 \leq r \leq D - 1$. At a point $K_0 = \ell^2 L$ with $L \in \text{Gr}(r, S_{D-2})$ and $\gcd(L) = 1$, set*

$$m = r - 1, \quad q = r(D - 1 - r) + 1.$$

Then

$$\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y_1, K_0} \simeq A_m[[z_1, \dots, z_q]]. \quad (50.5)$$

Writing $w_i = u_i t$, a complete presentation of A_m is

$$\mathbb{C}[[u_1, \dots, u_m, \Delta, w_1, \dots, w_m]] / (u_i w_j - u_j w_i, w_i w_j - \Delta u_i u_j), \quad (50.6)$$

where the first relations have $i < j$ and the second have $i \leq j$. Its normalization is B_m , and its conductor is

$$\mathfrak{c} = (u_1, \dots, u_m, w_1, \dots, w_m), \quad \mathfrak{c}B_m = IB_m.$$

The induced map on conductor quotients is

$$\mathbb{C}[[\Delta]] \longrightarrow \mathbb{C}[[t]], \quad \Delta \longmapsto t^2. \quad (50.7)$$

Thus the two reduced divisor lifts merge through a ramified double cover of the conductor. The completed local ring has dimension $q + m + 1$ and depth $q + 2$. It is Cohen–Macaulay if and only if $r = 2$. For $r = 2$, its intrinsic singular ideal, with the smooth variables suppressed, is $(w, \Delta u, u^2)$, whereas its conductor is (u, w) .

Proof. Choose an affine coordinate x with the root of ℓ at zero. Some member $F_0 \in K_0$ has multiplicity exactly two there, since $\gcd(L) = 1$. Extend it to a frame $F_0, \dots, F_{r-1}$. In the completed local ring of the ambient Grassmannian the formal Weierstrass theorem writes the universal F_0 as a unit times

$$P(x) = x^2 + ax + b.$$

Divide each F_i , $i > 0$, by this monic polynomial. Its remainder is $u_i x + v_i$. The $2r$ functions $a, b, u_1, v_1, \dots, u_m, v_m$ are part of a regular parameter system. To see this rather than assume versality, note that K_0 has zero two-jet at the root, while $S_D/K_0 \rightarrow \mathbb{C}[x]/(x^2)$ is surjective. The Grassmannian tangent space $\text{Hom}(K_0, S_D/K_0)$ therefore allows independent variations of both jets in every frame column. Passing from these jets to the displayed remainders is an invertible triangular operation, with leading coefficient $F_0/x^2(0) \neq 0$. Their differentials are consequently independent.

Set

$$t = x + a/2, \quad \Delta = a^2/4 - b, \quad w_i = au_i/2 - v_i.$$

The incidence of a common root near zero is now exactly

$$\Delta = t^2, \quad w_i = u_i t.$$

There are no other normalization points above K_0 , because its exact common divisor is ℓ^2 . Consequently the image of this completed incidence is the completed image defining Y_1 . The ambient dimension is $N_0 = r(D + 1 - r)$. Of the $2r$ parameters above, a is free, as are the other $N_0 - 2r$ parameters. This accounts for $q = N_0 - 2r + 1$ smooth variables in (50.5).

It remains to justify elimination scheme-theoretically. The relations in (50.6) reduce any series to $p + \sum_i w_i p_i$ with $p, p_i \in R_m$. If its image in B_m is zero, the decomposition $B_m = R_m \oplus R_m t$ gives $p = 0$ and $\sum_i u_i p_i = 0$. The first syzygies of the regular sequence $u_1, \dots, u_m$ are generated by the Koszul syzygies. They are precisely the relations $u_i w_j - u_j w_i$. This proves the presentation without taking a radical. The same argument works first over polynomial rings and then by exact completion.

The extension $A_m \subset B_m$ is finite, since $t^2 = \Delta$, and birational, since $t = w_1/u_1$ in the fraction field. The regular ring B_m is thus the normalization. For $p + vt \in R_m \oplus It$, multiplication by t stays in A_m if and only if $p \in I$. As $1, t$ generate B_m , the conductor is $I \oplus It$, proving the quotient map (50.7). Equivalently,

$$A_m = B_m \times_{\mathbb{C}[[t]]} \mathbb{C}[[\Delta]], \quad (50.8)$$

where the first map sets $u = 0$ and the second sends Δ to t^2 . This is a specific conductor square, not an assumption that the normalization descends through its reduced fibres.

As an R_m -module, $A_m = R_m \oplus I$. For $m = 1$, the ideal I is free. For $m > 1$, the exact sequence $0 \rightarrow I \rightarrow R_m \rightarrow \mathbb{C}[[\Delta]] \rightarrow 0$ gives $\text{depth}_{R_m} I = 2$. Hence A_m has depth two for every $m \geq 1$. The maximal ideal of R_m generates an ideal with maximal radical in A_m , so this is also its local ring depth. Adding the q smooth parameters gives the assertion. When $m = 1$, the equation is $w^2 - \Delta u^2 = 0$; its partial derivatives generate $(w, \Delta u, u^2)$ in characteristic zero. $\square$

Corollary 50.4 (The split and ramified parts of the same model). *On the binary locus where the common divisor has degree exactly two, there are two strata. Over two distinct roots the formal local ring has the split form (50.1), with $t = q + 1$ and $c = r - 1$. Over a double root it has (50.5). The support of the singular locus in the latter model is the conductor, and the normalization fibre at a collision is $\text{Spec } \mathbb{C}[t]/(t^2)$. For arbitrary m , its singular subscheme is given without radicalization by the m -minors of the Jacobian of the displayed m^2 relations in (50.6).*

Proof. The assertion at distinct roots is Theorem 50.1. In the collision model the normalization is an isomorphism wherever some u_i is invertible. On $u = w = 0$, a nonzero value of Δ gives two distinct points after an étale square-root extension, while $\Delta = 0$ gives the stated length-two fibre. The exact normality criterion proves the assertion about singular support. There are $2m + 1$ nonsmooth coordinates and dimension $m + 1$; the cotangent presentation therefore gives the m -minors as claimed. This formula specifies the whole singular scheme, even where it is thicker than its conductor support. $\square$

Remark 50.5 (Descent to intrinsic first relations). On the maximal-lower-Hilbert-function stratum of Corollary 11.8, these statements compute the completed smooth-atlas singularities of the intrinsic first-relation algebra stack after tangent-identity rigidification. The conductor is equivariant, and formation of its finite-module annihilator and of the Fitting ideals commutes with flat base change. Thus the calculations descend through the frame atlas. This does not identify these rings with completed local rings of a coarse orbit space, where stabilizers can introduce further singularities.

51. INTERSECTIONS OF DIVISOR-DEGREE IMAGES

Here the total relation degree D is fixed. Write $Y_a \subset \text{Gr}(r, S_D)$ for the image admitting a divisor of degree a ; empty Grassmannians are omitted. In several variables these images are not generally nested. Their reduced intersections nevertheless have a finite description by common parts of two marked divisors.

Proposition 51.1 (The common-part formula). *For $1 \leq a, b < D$ and $0 \leq j \leq \min(a, b)$, let M_j be the scheme-theoretic image of*

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{P}(S_j) \times \mathbb{P}(S_{a-j}) \times \mathbb{P}(S_{b-j}) \times \text{Gr}(r, S_{D-a-b+j}) &\longrightarrow \text{Gr}(r, S_D), \\ (c, u, v, L) &\longmapsto cuvL. \end{aligned} \quad (51.1)$$

A negative last degree or insufficient dimension gives the empty image, and $\mathbb{P}(S_0)$ is a point. Then

$$(Y_a \cap Y_b)_{\text{red}} = \left(\bigcup_j M_j \right)_{\text{red}}. \quad (51.2)$$

On the locus of two marked divisors f_a, f_b with exact common part of degree j , the corresponding factorization is $c = \gcd(f_a, f_b)$, $f_a = cu$, $f_b = cv$, with $\gcd(u, v) = 1$. In particular, at a relation $K = a_0^m L$ with a_0 a nonzero linear form and $\gcd(L) = 1$, the set of positive divisor degrees is exactly $\{1, \dots, m\}$. For the boundary point in Theorem 52.1, $m = D - q_n$.

Proof. Each map in (51.1) is defined on a projective scheme: multiplication by a nonzero form has constant rank, so the subspace construction is a morphism. Its image is closed and admits

the two divisors cu and cv , proving one inclusion. Conversely, if K has divisors f_a, f_b , unique factorization gives their common part c of some degree j . Their least common multiple is cuv and divides every member of K . Division yields L of degree $D - a - b + j$, of the same rank. This proves equality on geometric points. Over $\mathbb{C}$, a reduced closed subscheme of a finite-type scheme is determined by its closed points, giving (51.2). The last assertion follows because every homogeneous divisor of a power of one linear form is a power of that form. $\square$

The reduction in (51.2) is essential to the statement of this global formula. It is not a prescription to reduce the individual Y_a , their normalization fibres, or their singular subschemes. The full intersection of the two formal branches on the coprime stratum was computed over Artin bases in Theorem 50.1; Theorem 50.3 computes the thickening when those branches collide. Thus the degree-poset description and the local scheme calculations have distinct, explicit roles.

52. A COMMON RAMIFIED BOUNDARY OF PENCIL FAILURE ORBITS

The fixed tensor presentation of a pencil has exact common divisor δ^{n-1} . Varying the pencil alone therefore stays in the exact-divisor locus. The intrinsic finite algebra permits a larger, linear coordinate-change action: changing the basis of its entire cotangent space. We now describe a boundary point produced by such changes. The generic members are genuine pencil failure algebras. The central member has a larger common divisor, and its normalization fibre is nonreduced. Thus the boundary of Section 11 occurs inside the orbit closures of the motivating algebras themselves.

Let $n = \dim V = \dim U \geq 3$, $E = V^* \otimes U$, and put

$$e = n^2, \quad N = \binom{n+1}{2}, \quad r = \binom{N}{2}, \quad g = n(n-1), \quad h = 3n-4, \quad D = g+h.$$

For a pencil R , write $K_R = \delta^{n-1}C_R \subset \text{Sym}^D E$ as in Lemma G.1. Define the projective orbit closure

$$Z_R = \overline{\text{GL}(E) \cdot K_R} \subset \text{Gr}(r, \text{Sym}^D E).$$

It is independent of a chosen basis of the cotangent space. Since Y_g is closed and invariant, $Z_R \subset Y_g$.

The group in Z_R is the full $\text{GL}(E)$, not the $\text{PGL}(V)$ congruence group of the pencil. Fixing the standard flag, scalar direction and complement specifies the displayed common point; no choice-independent distinguished moduli point is asserted.

Theorem 52.1 (A common point in full first-relation orbit closures). *Set*

$$q_n = \begin{cases} 3, & n = 3, \\ 4, & n \geq 4, \end{cases} \quad k_n = h - q_n.$$

There is an explicitly constructed point K_∞ belonging to Z_R for every quadratic pencil R , with

$$K_\infty = a^{g+k_n} L_n, \quad L_n \subset \text{Sym}^{q_n} E, \quad \text{rank } L_n = r, \quad \gcd(L_n) = 1, \quad (52.1)$$

where $a \in E$ is a nonzero linear form. The flag pencil $R_ = \langle x_1^2, x_1 x_2 \rangle$ admits a finite-flat family of first-relation algebras over $\mathbb{A}^1$, with special relation space K_∞ and every nonzero fibre isomorphic to its failure algebra. Together with Theorem I.1, this gives a chain of two explicit finite-flat specializations from the failure algebra of every R to the same boundary algebra.*

The fibre of ν_g over K_∞ has a single geometric point, marked by a^g , and is nonreduced. Its tangent dimension is

$$\binom{e + k_n - 1}{k_n} - 1. \quad (52.2)$$

In particular K_∞ lies in the singular locus of Y_g and outside the exact-degree- g locus. For $n = 3$ this tangent dimension is 44.

The construction requires the exact osculating order of one elementary flag embedding. We include the calculation to distinguish the theorem from a computationally suggested degeneration.

Lemma 52.2 (The flag coefficient filtration). *Write a matrix of independent linear coordinates as*

$$T = aI_n + B, \quad B_{11} = 0.$$

For $C_ = C_{R_*}$, the filtration by vanishing order at $T = I_n$ on the chart $T_{11} = 1$ has last nonzero graded piece in degree q_n . It has a nonzero degree-zero piece. Hence an adapted basis $c_1, \dots, c_r$ has orders $0 \leq d_j \leq q_n$, attaining both endpoints, and*

$$\lim_{\tau \rightarrow 0} \tau^{-d_j} c_j(aI_n + \tau B) = a^{h-d_j} p_j(B), \quad (52.3)$$

where the displayed initial forms are linearly independent.

Proof. The complementary-minor identity for $\text{Sym}^2 T$ identifies the vector of primitive coefficients, up to a fixed invertible coordinate change, with

$$\delta(T)^3 (v^2 \wedge vw), \quad v = T^{-1}e_1, \quad w = T^{-1}e_2. \quad (52.4)$$

Indeed $\det(\text{Sym}^2 T) = \delta^{n+1}$, the complementary minors have order two, and division of δI_{N-2} by δ^{n-1} leaves δ^3 . This identity is initially on $\delta \neq 0$; both sides are the same polynomial vector of degree h .

A standard affine flag chart has representatives

$$v = e_1 + \sum_{i=2}^n z_i e_i, \quad w = e_2 + \sum_{i=3}^n y_i e_i.$$

Every coordinate of $v^2 \wedge vw$ is a polynomial of degree at most four. The map from GL_n to this flag chart is smooth, and restricting to $T_{11} = 1$ remains smooth: the scalar subgroup is contained in each flag stabilizer and is transverse to this chart. Normalizing v, w only multiplies the whole wedge by a common unit. Smooth pullback preserves the order of a nonzero function, as does multiplication by a unit. The coordinates in (52.4) are linearly independent by Lemma 5.2 and the nonzero matrix-coefficient inclusion in (5.6). Thus no nonzero linear combination can have order exceeding four. For $n \geq 4$, the coordinate indexed by $e_3^2 \wedge e_3 e_4$ is

$$z_3^2(z_3 y_4 - z_4 y_3),$$

which is nonzero and has order exactly four.

For $n = 3$, put $z = z_2$, $w = z_3$, $t = y_3$. In the ordered basis $e_1^2, e_1 e_2, e_1 e_3, e_2^2, e_2 e_3, e_3^2$, the two factors are

$$(1, 2z, 2w, z^2, 2zw, w^2), \quad (0, 1, t, z, zt + w, wt).$$

Their fifteen wedge coordinates have the same linear span as

$$\begin{aligned} &1, z, w, t, z^2, zw, w^2, zt, wt, z^2 t, zwt, w^2 t, \\ &z^2 w - z^3 t, \quad zw^2 - z^2 wt, \quad w^3 - zw^2 t. \end{aligned} \quad (52.5)$$

This is obtained by subtracting the two coordinates with a common quadratic term and rescaling by 2. Their lowest homogeneous terms are distinct monomials, all of degrees at most three, and some have degree three. Thus the third jet is injective on this coefficient space and the second is not. This proves $q_3 = 3$. The coordinate $e_1^2 \wedge e_1 e_2$ is 1 in every dimension, proving the order-zero assertion. Finally, homogeneity of degree h gives (52.3); an adapted basis is by definition a basis on each associated-graded piece, so its initial forms are independent. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 52.1. The linear substitution $T \mapsto aI_n + \tau B$ is invertible for $\tau \neq 0$. Divide the adapted coefficient c_j by its exact power τ^{d_j} after substitution. There are no negative powers: all its terms have B -degree at least d_j . The resulting columns span a rank- r subbundle $J_\tau \subset \text{Sym}^h E \otimes \mathbb{C}[\tau]$. Independence at zero follows from the lemma, and away from zero from the invertible substitution. The ideal of its maximal minors in $\mathbb{C}[\tau]$ has no common closed zero, and is therefore the unit ideal. On each maximal-minor open a corresponding square submatrix is invertible and splits the image. These opens cover $\text{Spec } \mathbb{C}[\tau]$, proving the subbundle assertion over the whole line, including all scheme points. Set

$$K_\tau = \det(aI_n + \tau B)^{n-1} J_\tau.$$

Multiplication by the nonzero homogeneous polynomial in every fibre again has constant rank. Consequently K_τ is a subbundle, and

$$\mathcal{A}_\tau = \text{Sym } E \otimes \mathbb{C}[\tau] / (K_\tau, \mathfrak{m}^{D+1})$$

is finite locally free of rank $\binom{e+D}{D} - r$. For $\tau \neq 0$, its relation space is a linear transform of K_{R^*} .

At zero the marked factor becomes a^g , while $J_0 = \langle a^{h-d_j} p_j(B) \rangle$. It contains a nonzero multiple of a^h , so its gcd is a power of a . It also contains a polynomial with exact a -adic order $h - q_n$, and every column is divisible by that power. Therefore $\gcd(J_0) = a^{k_n}$, proving (52.1). Notice that $0 < k_n < g$ for every $n \geq 3$.

The closed-flag specialization of Theorem I.1 and its failure-algebra lift imply $K_{R^*} \in Z_R$. A closed invariant subset containing a point contains that point's orbit closure. Hence the just-constructed $K_\infty \in Z_{R^*}$ belongs to every Z_R . This proves the assertion about the two-stage specialization without replacing it by an unproved assertion about one fixed one-parameter subgroup acting on every initial pencil.

The sole degree- g divisor of a^{g+k_n} is a^g . Its overlap with the residual gcd is a^{k_n} . Lemma 11.3 gives (52.2); the fibre is supported at one point and has positive tangent space. The normalization criterion then proves singularity. With $n = 3$, $e = 9$ and $k_n = 2$, the dimension is $\binom{10}{2} - 1 = 44$. $\square$

52.1. The complete normalization fibre at the limiting algebra. The last theorem is not restricted to the tangent space of its fibre. The full local algebra can be given uniformly.

Proposition 52.3 (Pure-power divisor fibre). *Let $E = \mathbb{C}a \oplus W$, $g \geq k \geq 1$, and $K = a^{g+k}L$ with $\gcd(L) = 1$. Introduce coefficient variables for $q_i \in \text{Sym}^i W$, $1 \leq i \leq k$, and define forms c_j recursively by*

$$c_0 = 1, \quad c_j = - \sum_{i=1}^k q_i c_{j-i}, \quad c_j = 0 \ (j < 0). \quad (52.6)$$

The entire fibre of ν_g over K , supported at its unique point, is the Artin algebra

$$\mathbb{C}[[\text{coefficients of } q_1, \dots, q_k]] / (\text{coefficients of } c_{g+1}, \dots, c_{g+k}). \quad (52.7)$$

Its tangent dimension is $s_k(E) - 1$.

Proof. Choose $p \in L$ not divisible by a . Over any local Artin base, a divisor f near a^g is monic in a , and the quotient by f is flat over the base. The reductions of f, p are coprime. The regular-sequence argument used in (50.3) makes p a nonzerodivisor modulo f . Thus $f \mid a^{g+k}p$ is equivalent to $f \mid a^{g+k}$, functorially on these bases. Once this condition holds, it holds for every member of K .

Polynomial division gives a unique monic residual factor $H = a^k + q_1 a^{k-1} + \dots + q_k$. The equation $fH = a^{g+k}$ determines the coefficients of f successively as $c_1, \dots, c_g$ in (52.6). The remaining k product coefficients vanish if and only if $c_{g+1}, \dots, c_{g+k}$ vanish. This follows successively by comparing the product with the reciprocal series $(1 + \sum q_i a^{-i})^{-1}$. Hence (52.7) represents the full

infinitesimal fibre, without reduction. Finiteness of ν_g makes it Artin; there is no other geometric divisor, so completion loses no part of the fibre. Since $g \geq k$, these equations have no linear terms in the coefficient variables. The number of coefficient variables is $\sum_{i=1}^k \dim \operatorname{Sym}^i W = \dim \operatorname{Sym}^k E - 1$, as asserted. $\square$

Example 52.4 (The nine-generator limit). For $n = 3$, the construction can be written with four of the nine linear coordinates, denoted a, u, v, w . The other five coordinates remain generators of the algebra. Up to nonzero scalar changes of the relation basis, $K_\infty = a^8 L_3$, where

$$L_3 = \langle a^3, a^2u, a^2v, a^2w, au^2, auv, av^2, auw, avw, \\ u^2v, u^2w, uv^2, uvw, v^3, v^2w \rangle. \quad (52.8)$$

Here one may take $u = B_{21}$, $v = B_{31}$, $w = B_{32}$; the monomials are the lowest terms in (52.5). The relation space has dimension 15 and exact gcd a^8 . The selected divisor has degree $g = 6$, and its fibre has 44 coefficient variables: eight coefficients of a linear form Q_1 and thirty-six of a quadratic form Q_2 in W . Its defining ideal consists of all coefficients of the two forms

$$c_7 = -Q_1^7 + 6Q_1^5Q_2 - 10Q_1^3Q_2^2 + 4Q_1Q_2^3, \\ c_8 = Q_1^8 - 7Q_1^6Q_2 + 15Q_1^4Q_2^2 - 10Q_1^2Q_2^3 + Q_2^4.$$

This is a full presentation of the normalization fibre. Its embedding dimension 44 is not being identified with its length, nor is this fibre algebra being identified with the completed local ring of Y_g .

Remark 52.5 (Relation to pencil invariants). The action defining Z_R is the intrinsic $\operatorname{GL}(E)$ action on first relations, not merely the congruence action on V . The flag pencil is singular: every member has rank at most two. It is therefore outside the regular-pencil open set treated by [4, Theorem 1.1 and §5], where Segre symbols organize classification and degenerations. The theorem above does not purport to classify that poset or all orbits in Z_R . Its conclusion is instead a uniform common boundary and an exact ramification algebra for genuine finite failure algebras. The increase from g to $g + k_n$ in the intrinsic gcd is precisely what is invisible in a fixed-determinant pencil specialization.

53. UNIVERSAL HORIZONTAL MODELS OF THE HILBERT BOUNDARY

A boundary fibre and a limit of boundary fibres are different objects. The first is obtained by imposing the coefficient equations; the second also removes the torsion created by the chosen specialization. We begin with a construction that organizes this distinction over a whole base. The representability input is the classical projective Hilbert scheme, not a new representability theorem. Its application below supplies a universal property for the horizontal models of the pencil boundary.

53.1. The flat horizontal functor. Let $p : W \rightarrow B$ be a projective morphism of finite presentation, with B an integral scheme of finite type over $\mathbb{C}$. Fix a relatively ample line bundle and a nonempty open $U \subset B$ on which p is flat with constant Hilbert polynomial P . The scheme W need not be reduced, equidimensional, or flat over the boundary of U .

A locally Noetherian B -scheme T is called U -admissible if $U_T = U \times_B T$ is schematically dense in T . Write

$$W_T^h = \overline{W_{U_T}}^{W_T}, \quad \mathcal{J}_T = \ker(\mathcal{O}_{W_T} \rightarrow j_* \mathcal{O}_{W_{U_T}}). \quad (53.1)$$

The bar denotes schematic closure, and j is the indicated open immersion. On these test schemes define $\mathfrak{F}_{W,U}(T)$ to be the singleton if $W_T^h \rightarrow T$ is flat, and the empty set otherwise. Morphisms are B -morphisms between admissible test schemes. Whenever an object exists, its pullback is the horizontal closure and is again flat: a flat scheme over T has schematically dense inverse image of

U_T . Thus this is a functor on the stated category. This last assertion does not concern arbitrary nonflat pullback of W .

Theorem 53.1 (Universal horizontal modification). *There are an integral projective birational B -scheme $F_{W,U}$ and a closed subscheme*

$$\mathcal{W} \subset W \times_B F_{W,U}$$

with the following properties. The morphism $F_{W,U} \rightarrow B$ is an isomorphism over U . The family $\mathcal{W} \rightarrow F_{W,U}$ is flat, and is the schematic closure of W_U . For every U -admissible T , composition with $F_{W,U} \rightarrow B$ gives a natural bijection

$$\mathrm{Hom}_B(T, F_{W,U}) \simeq \mathfrak{F}_{W,U}(T). \quad (53.2)$$

Under this bijection $\mathcal{W}_T = W_T^h$. Consequently $F_{W,U}$ is terminal among U -admissible modifications on which the horizontal closure is flat. It is independent of the chosen relatively ample line bundle and of replacing U by a smaller nonempty open on which p is flat.

Proof. Let $H = \mathrm{Hilb}^P(W/B)$, which is projective over B by the projective Hilbert-scheme theorem [Grothendieck(1961)]. The entire fibre W_u defines a section $s : U \rightarrow H$. Put $F_{W,U} = \overline{s(U)} \subset H$, with its schematic closure structure, and restrict the universal quotient on H to obtain $\mathcal{W}$. Since U is integral, its schematic closure is integral. The section is a closed immersion over U , so the restriction of $F_{W,U}$ over U is exactly $s(U)$. This proves projectivity, birationality, and the assertion over U .

Flatness of the universal Hilbert quotient proves flatness of $\mathcal{W}$. A flat module over an integral base injects into its localization at the generic point. Hence the open W_U is schematically dense in $\mathcal{W}$, and $\mathcal{W}$ is its closure inside $W \times_B F_{W,U}$.

Suppose first that W_T^h is flat. This closed subscheme is of finite presentation and projective over T . Its Hilbert polynomial is locally constant and equals P on U_T . Every nonempty open-and-closed piece of T meets U_T , so the polynomial is P everywhere. Representability gives $h : T \rightarrow H$. On U_T this is the section s . The pullback of the ideal of $F_{W,U}$ therefore vanishes on U_T and hence on T , by schematic density. Thus h factors through $F_{W,U}$.

Conversely, pull the universal flat quotient back by any $h : T \rightarrow F_{W,U}$. Flat base change preserves schematic density of the inverse image of U_T : this can be checked on affine charts by tensoring the injection into the finite product of localizations associated to an affine cover of U_T . The pulled-back quotient is therefore precisely the closure in (53.1). This also proves uniqueness. In particular two possible lifts give the same embedded quotient, not merely isomorphic abstract fibres. All constructions commute with morphisms of admissible tests.

The same universal property identifies the constructions from two polarizations. For a smaller open U' , its section is schematically dense in $s(U)$; their closures in the Hilbert scheme coincide. Alternatively apply the universal property in both directions: the universal flat closure over the integral modification is already determined by the generic fibre. The two resulting morphisms are inverse because they agree over the dense open and the targets are separated. $\square$

The theorem modifies the base to flatten a *horizontal closed subscheme*. It does not assert that the full pullback $W \times_B F$ is flat. Nor is $F \rightarrow B$ the monomorphism representing flatness of the full pulled-back sheaf in the usual flattening stratification; compare [Stacks Project, Tag 05PS]. This distinction accounts for the vertical component in Theorem 47.1.

53.2. Finite saturation and base torsion. Compatibility with completion reduces to the following finite kernel calculation.

Lemma 53.2 (Flat change of rings and finite saturation). *Let A be Noetherian, let $I, J \subset A$ be ideals, and let $A \rightarrow A'$ be flat with A' Noetherian. Choose N such that $(I : J^N) = (I : J^{N+1})$. Then*

$$(I : J^\infty)A' = (IA' : (JA')^\infty) = (IA' : (JA')^N). \quad (53.3)$$

This applies to Noetherian completion. If the map is faithfully flat, the least stabilization exponent is unchanged.

Proof. For a finite set $j_1, \dots, j_m$ of generators of J^n , the ideal quotient modulo I is the kernel of $A/I \rightarrow (A/I)^m$, $a \mapsto (j_1a, \dots, j_ma)$. Tensoring this kernel sequence with A' proves $(I : J^n)A' = (IA' : (JA')^n)$ for every n . The increasing sequence of ideal quotients stabilizes by Noetherianity. Equality of consecutive terms implies equality thereafter, since colon by J sends one term to the next. The same equality at N holds after flat change of rings. Taking the stabilized terms proves the formula. Faithful flatness detects equality and inequality of the finite terms, which gives the last assertion. There is no assertion of a uniform exponent for all ideals, or for all arcs in a coefficient space. $\square$

Proposition 53.3 (The horizontal quotient over a discrete valuation ring). *Let R be a discrete valuation ring with uniformizer τ , residue field k , and fraction field K . Let A be a Noetherian R -algebra. Set*

$$T(A) = \{a \in A : \tau^n a = 0 \text{ for some } n\}, \quad A^h = A/T(A).$$

Then $T(A)$ is an ideal killed by some τ^N , and A^h is the unique flat quotient of A with generic fibre A_K . For a presentation $A = D/I$ over an R -algebra D with no τ -torsion,

$$A^h = D/(I : \tau^\infty), \quad T(A) = (I : \tau^\infty)/I. \quad (53.4)$$

Moreover

$$\mathrm{Tor}_1^R(A, k) = \mathrm{Ann}_A(\tau), \quad \mathrm{Tor}_i^R(A, k) = 0 \quad (i \geq 2). \quad (53.5)$$

Writing $T_n = \mathrm{Ann}_A(\tau^n)$ gives $T_n/T_{n-1} \simeq \mathrm{Ann}_A(\tau) \cap \tau^{n-1}A$. These statements glue for schemes of finite type over R .

Proof. The annihilator ideals stabilize in A . Their union is an ideal, so stabilization supplies N . Multiplication by τ on $A/T(A)$ is injective. A torsion-free module over a valuation ring is flat [Stacks Project, Tag 0539]; this proves flatness. If A/J is another flat quotient with the same generic fibre, its τ -torsion is zero, so $T(A) \subset J$. The submodule $J/T(A)$ of the torsion-free module A^h is generically zero, hence zero. This proves uniqueness and the presentation.

Resolve k by $0 \rightarrow R \xrightarrow{\tau} R \rightarrow k \rightarrow 0$ to obtain all of (53.5). Multiplication by τ^{n-1} on T_n has kernel T_{n-1} and image exactly the stated intersection. Localization commutes with this finite filtration, so the formulas glue. Flat change of discrete valuation rings commutes with the horizontal quotient by Lemma 53.2. In general $T(A)$ is larger than $\mathrm{Ann}_A(\tau)$. $\square$

For polynomial coefficient arcs the saturation is effective: in an auxiliary variable y , it is the elimination ideal

$$(I : \tau^\infty) = (I, 1 - y\tau)D[y] \cap D.$$

This gives a finite elimination procedure when the coefficients are provided by polynomial or localized polynomial data. For an arbitrary formal power series arc the formula remains exact, but it is not an algorithm requiring only a fixed finite jet of unspecified series.

53.3. A stratumwise compactification for every pencil specialization. Let G be the coefficient space of pencils under consideration and let $\tilde{\Gamma} \rightarrow G$ be the normalization of its integral projective Hilbert graph. More generally the next assertion applies to any fixed projective graph model of finite type. Normalization is performed on the total graph before any specialization; it is finite over a complex finite-type scheme, hence the map remains projective. For every integral closed $B \subset G$ put $W_B = \tilde{\Gamma} \times_G B$, *without* reducing this pullback, and choose its dense generic-flat open U_B .

Theorem 53.4 (Stratumwise universal boundary models). *The modification $F_{W_B, U_B} \rightarrow B$ and its universal family give a canonical horizontal model on every such B . Every discrete valuation ring arc $\gamma : \text{Spec } R \rightarrow B$ whose generic point lies in U_B has a unique lift to this modification, and*

$$\gamma^* \mathcal{W} = (\tilde{\Gamma} \times_G \text{Spec } R)^{\text{h}}. \quad (53.6)$$

There exists a finite stratification of G by integral locally closed strata S_i , with projective modifications over their reduced closures $\overline{S}_i$, such that every discrete valuation ring arc in G is covered by one of these formulas, determined by the stratum containing its generic point.

Proof. The first construction is Theorem 53.1. An arc whose generic point belongs to U_B is admissible. Its horizontal quotient is flat by Proposition 53.3, so the universal property gives the unique lift and the equality of embedded quotients. Equivalently, extend the generic lift by properness and apply uniqueness of a flat quotient with that generic fibre.

To obtain finitely many strata, take dense generic-flat opens in each of the finitely many irreducible components of the reduced base, shrinking them to be disjoint and to have constant Hilbert polynomial. Apply the same procedure to their closed complement. Its dimension strictly decreases, so the procedure terminates. Each stratum is a dense open in its integral reduced closure after the previous closed pieces are removed. Apply the first construction to that closure and its generic-flat open. If the generic point of an arc lies in S_i , the whole arc factors through $\overline{S}_i$: the pullback of its defining ideal vanishes generically in the domain R and hence vanishes in R . The preceding argument applies. The stratification is not claimed unique; the horizontal modification attached to a specified integral closure is canonical. $\square$

This supplies universal horizontal models for arbitrary contact order where a projective Hilbert graph has been defined. It does not use an a priori classification of its components. In particular it does not identify higher-corank Hilbert fibres from Kronecker invariants. The complete component formulas proved in Theorems 44.2 and 45.1 retain their hypotheses. A single modification of the full base cannot be substituted without argument for the stratumwise assertion: the generic boundary fibre on a multiple-incidence stratum has a different Hilbert polynomial from the point fibre on the nonincident open.

For the coefficient spaces B_a , this theorem turns an arcwise saturation into the pullback of a projective universal family. For B_2 , Section 54 gives finite equations for *every* arc through the first nonreduced contact. Thus the universal property is accompanied by an explicit specialization calculation, rather than being used as a substitute for it.

54. ALL ARCS THROUGH A DOUBLE CONTACT

The six coefficient directions of B_2 need not vanish in pairs, and a collision need not have a chosen square root. In this section we give a finite presentation of the full pullback, its horizontal closure, and its vertical torsion for every discrete valuation ring arc through $o = (x^2, 0, 0)$. The presentation is by a fixed collection of coordinate systems with their recovery opens. It is not a list of irreducible components indexed by the valuation of a single chosen coefficient.

Let R be a discrete valuation ring which is a $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra, with uniformizer τ and residue field $\mathbb{C}$. The same statements hold after extending that residue field. Write an arbitrary arc centred at o uniquely as

$$f = (x - c)^2 + d, \quad g = u(x - c) + v, \quad r = w(x - c) + z_0, \quad (54.1)$$

where $c, d, u, v, w, z_0 \in \tau R$. No relation between these six elements is assumed. In particular neither $g = r = 0$ nor a prescribed ramification order is imposed. Set

$$H_R = \tilde{\Gamma}_2 \times_{B_2} \text{Spec } R, \quad Y_R = \overline{(H_R)_K}^{H_R},$$

where $K = \text{Frac } R$ and total-graph normalization precedes the base change.

54.1. Five conic coordinates and two division coordinates. The vector space of conic equations through $P = [1 : 0 : 0]$ has basis FG, FR, G^2, GR, R^2 . Evaluation at the following five vectors gives linearly independent functionals:

$$(0, 0, 1), \quad (0, 1, 0), \quad (0, 1, 1), \quad (1, 1, 0), \quad (1, 0, 1). \quad (54.2)$$

Here R in a target coordinate denotes the third homogeneous coordinate, not the discrete valuation ring. To avoid confusion below it will only occur in homogeneous equations. Choose matrices M_i whose first column is $(1, 0, 0)$ and whose third columns are the vectors in (54.2):

$$\begin{aligned} M_0 &= I_3, & M_1 &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, & M_2 &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \\ M_3 &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, & M_4 &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}. \end{aligned} \quad (54.3)$$

For coordinate system i replace the coefficient column by $M_i^{-1}(f, g, r)^t$, and recompute the six coefficients in (54.1). The first polynomial stays monic of degree two and the other two have degree at most one. The central point remains o . These are changes of target coordinates, always undone when the embedded curve is returned to the fixed target; they are not quotient identifications of Hilbert points.

For any one of these transformed six-tuples put

$$\begin{aligned} D_i &= R[\lambda, e, A, B, C], \\ K_i &= (e^2C - d, eB - u, e^2A + v, \lambda u - eA - w, \lambda v - e^2BC - z_0) \subset D_i. \end{aligned} \quad (54.4)$$

There are also two division coordinate systems. The first has

$$D_+ = R[\alpha, \beta], \quad K_+ = (\alpha u + \beta v - w, \alpha v - \beta u d - z_0). \quad (54.5)$$

The second is obtained by interchanging the pairs (u, v) and (w, z_0) and is denoted (D_-, K_-) .

Theorem 54.1 (Finite-chart miniversal specialization). *For every arc (54.1), the seven coordinate systems (54.4) and (54.5), restricted to their Hilbert recovery opens, cover H_R . On each such open its ring is the corresponding $D_\bullet/K_\bullet$, its horizontal ring is*

$$D_\bullet/(K_\bullet : \tau^\infty), \quad (54.6)$$

and its vertical torsion ideal is $(K_\bullet : \tau^\infty)/K_\bullet$. These formulas retain the scheme structures, including all embedded primes and nilpotents. They commute with localization, completion, and flat extensions of discrete valuation rings. They determine the entire specialization, not merely a neighbourhood of one chosen conic or primitive tail.

The recovery opens are the opens of the total coefficient graph, not extra conditions on the six coefficients of the arc. Thus the theorem permits nonzero g and r jets, arbitrary relative orders

of vanishing, unequal residual directions, and arbitrary ramification. It includes arcs entirely contained in an incidence stratum.

Proof. In the Hilbert–Burch coordinates of Lemma 44.1, put $z = x - c$ and $H = R - \lambda G$. The base map reads

$$f = z^2 + e^2 C, \quad g = eBz - e^2 A, \quad r = \lambda g - eAz - e^2 BC.$$

Equating its coefficients with those of the retained arc gives exactly the five equations in (54.4); the sixth coefficient eliminates c . In particular the constant equation $\lambda v - e^2 BC = z_0$ must not be discarded for a general arc. No radical has been taken. The total chart is regular on its recovery open, so the same computation applies to the normalization of the total graph.

In the primitive chart write the recovered direction as $\alpha + \beta z$. Division by $f = z^2 + d$ gives

$$(\alpha + \beta z)(uz + v) - \beta u(z^2 + d) = (\alpha u + \beta v)z + \alpha v - \beta ud.$$

The condition that this equal r proves (54.5). Interchanging g and r gives the other primitive chart. These are the degree-two division charts of Theorem 39.1, after the invertible change between x and z coordinates. Their equations also retain the coefficient projection.

We specify the opens used here. On a conic chart the restriction maps in degrees $(0, 2)$ and $(1, 1)$ have ranks five and four. Restrict to the opens defined by these ranks, by the nonzero selected conic coefficient, and by the tG, tH pivot for the two bilinear equations. The normalized inverse is precisely the recovery map in Lemma 44.1; the matrices in (54.3) transport these opens. They contain every central conic on which the corresponding evaluation functional is nonzero. On a division chart use the split-injection open in Lemma 43.3. These opens contain every central primitive tail for which the selected homogeneous direction coordinate is a unit. Localizing the displayed rings to these opens is understood; no global affine-isomorphism claim outside the recovery domains is needed.

A nonzero conic through P cannot vanish on all five vectors in (54.2). Indeed their evaluations recover, in order, the coefficients of R^2 , G^2 , GR , FG , and FR . Thus the five conic coordinate systems cover the complete conic component. A primitive jet over $\mathbb{C}[x]/(x^2)$ is represented by a pair with at least one unit, and therefore belongs to one of the two division coordinate systems. The complete-fibre theorem 44.2 shows that these are all central points, including the doubled-line intersection. The same charts compute their scheme structures, not only their closed points.

Their union is an open neighbourhood of the entire special fibre in H_R . Its complement is closed in the proper R -scheme H_R . A nonempty closed subset of a proper scheme over a local discrete valuation ring has image meeting its closed point. Since the complement misses that fibre, it is empty. This proves exhaustion of H_R , including its generic fibre. Now apply Proposition 53.3 on the seven coordinate domains. Its uniqueness assertion glues the horizontal quotients. Lemma 53.2 proves compatibility on overlaps and with the stated flat changes of rings. The torsion formula follows from the same proposition. $\square$

Corollary 54.2 (Universal interpretation of the seven presentations). *Choose the stratum containing the generic point of the arc in Theorem 54.1. Its seven horizontal presentations are the pullback of the universal family on the corresponding modification in Theorem 53.4. Hence specialization does not require an additional choice of a component, a normalization of the special fibre, or a stable-map replacement.*

Proof. Both constructions are flat embedded quotients with the original generic fibre. Uniqueness in Proposition 53.3 identifies them on every coordinate domain and hence globally. $\square$

The adjective miniversal here refers to the full six-dimensional coefficient base and its framed fixed-target comparison. It does not assert a finite list of valuation chambers, nor a classification of the full fibre for $a \geq 3$. The theorem gives the exact ideals and their saturation for every arc

through the double contact. Its specialization to $g = r = 0$ recovers the previously computed collision; it is not restricted to that subbase.

54.2. Which conics are horizontal? The vertical component in the symmetric collision has a concrete modular explanation: it records limits approached in coefficient directions other than the double-incidence subbase. Let

$$\mathcal{Q}_P = \mathbb{P}\langle FG, FR, G^2, GR, R^2 \rangle, \quad S = V(q_{FG}, q_{FR}) \subset \mathcal{Q}_P.$$

Thus $S \simeq \mathbb{P}^2$ is the linear space of conics singular at P . Its ideal is generated by the two nontrivial first derivatives at P ; this is an intrinsic first-jet condition on the conic equation.

Theorem 54.3 (Arc realization and the meaning of vertical excess). *Every conic $Q \in \mathcal{Q}_P$, including a doubled line, occurs as the tail of the special Hilbert curve of an arc in B_2 whose generic point is nonincident. Among arcs in the double-incidence subbase $g = r = 0$ with f generically squarefree, the conic tails reached horizontally are exactly S .*

Proof. Choose one of the five coordinates so that Q is

$$(R - \lambda_0 G)^2 + B_0 F(R - \lambda_0 G) + A_0 FG + C_0 G^2 = 0.$$

Take $e = \tau$, $c = 0$, $\lambda = \lambda_0$, and choose polynomial series $A(\tau), B(\tau), C(\tau)$ with prescribed constant terms A_0, B_0, C_0 and $A(\tau)^2 + C(\tau)B(\tau)^2 \neq 0$ in K . Such a choice always exists because this polynomial is not identically zero on the three-dimensional coefficient space; a generic line through the specified point is not contained in its zero locus. The Hilbert–Burch base map produces an arc centred at o . On its generic point $e(A^2 + CB^2) \neq 0$, so the three quadratics span the space of binary quadratics and define the nonincident graph. The flat determinantal family has special curve $C_0 \cup Q$ by Lemma 44.1. Undoing the constant coordinate change gives the required embedded arc in the original target.

For the second assertion use any conic coordinate system for a horizontal limit; the transformations in (54.3) preserve the condition $g = r = 0$. On the generic fibre the coefficient equations give $eB = eA = 0$. Also $e \neq 0$ there, since $e^2 C = d$ and the centred quadratic is generically squarefree, so $d \neq 0$. Thus $A = B = 0$ on the horizontal closure. Its conic limit lies in S . Conversely, in a chart for any $Q \in S$, set $A = B = 0$, $e = \tau$, and take $C(\tau)$ with the specified constant term and nonzero generic value. Then $f = x^2 + \tau^2 C(\tau)$ is generically squarefree and $g = r = 0$. The displayed flat Hilbert family gives a point of the horizontal closure: it agrees with that closure generically and factors through its saturated ideal over the torsion-free ring R . Its conic limit is Q . This includes doubled lines by taking $C(0) = 0$ and $C(\tau) \neq 0$. $\square$

The first assertion concerns closures of individual generic Hilbert points on generically nonincident arcs. The second concerns points of the horizontal family of complete incidence fibres. The two notions agree on their common incidence interpretation but should not be conflated. In particular the vertical $\mathbb{P}^4$ is not a collection of spurious curves: its complement of S consists of valid limits that require different coefficient directions. No variation of a stability parameter is involved.

55. THE EXTENSION CLASS AND RAMIFIED COLLISION MODELS

The nilradical as a module does not determine a nonreduced scheme. We compute the missing algebra extension, and then determine how arbitrary ramification changes the horizontal normalization and the vertical torsion of the collision family. The two calculations separate intrinsic nonreducedness of a fibre from torsion introduced by a nonflat pullback.

55.1. The square-zero algebra is not locally split along the doubled lines. Write $X = X_2$, $X_{\text{red}} = \mathcal{Q}_P \cup \mathbb{F}_2$, $S \simeq \mathbb{P}^2 \subset \mathcal{Q}_P$ for the singular-conic plane, and $D \simeq \mathbb{P}^1$ for the doubled-line locus. The closed immersions are denoted $j : S \hookrightarrow X_{\text{red}}$ and $i : D \hookrightarrow X_{\text{red}}$. By Theorem 47.3, the nilradical is $N = j_*\mathcal{O}_S(-1)$. The square-zero extension of sheaves of algebras

$$0 \longrightarrow N \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_X \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X_{\text{red}}} \longrightarrow 0 \quad (55.1)$$

defines a class $\xi \in \text{Ext}_{X_{\text{red}}}^1(L_{X_{\text{red}}/\mathbb{C}}, N)$. Here L is the cotangent complex; the degree-one group can equally be computed using the naive cotangent complex. It is not the ordinary extension group of the sheaf of differentials.

Theorem 55.1 (The nonsplitting locus and its obstruction sheaf). *The algebra extension (55.1) splits locally on $X_{\text{red}} \setminus D$ and does not split locally at any point of D . Moreover*

$$\mathcal{E}xt_{X_{\text{red}}}^1(L_{X_{\text{red}}/\mathbb{C}}, N) \simeq i_*\mathcal{O}_D, \quad (55.2)$$

where the image of ξ is the section 1. In a conic chart the class is represented by the conormal homomorphism

$$eA \longmapsto 0, \quad eB \longmapsto 0, \quad eC \longmapsto eC. \quad (55.3)$$

In particular the nilpotent algebra is not the trivial square-zero extension of its reduced support, even Zariski locally along D .

Proof. Work first in the polynomial chart

$$P_0 = \mathbb{C}[\lambda, e, A, B, C], \quad I = (eA, eB, e^2C), \quad J = (eA, eB, eC), \quad R_0 = P_0/J.$$

Then $\mathcal{O}_X = P_0/I$ and $N = J/I$ is generated by $n = eC$ with annihilator (e, A, B) . Hence, as a module, $N = \mathbb{C}[\lambda, C]n$. Its extension class is the homomorphism $J/J^2 \rightarrow N$ induced by lifting the polynomial generators to P_0/I , namely (55.3). This is the presentation description of square-zero extensions [Stacks Project, Section 91.2, especially Lemma 91.2.3 and Remark 91.2.4].

We compute the whole local degree-one group. The module of relations on eA, eB, eC over P_0 is generated by the three Koszul relations on A, B, C , since multiplication by e is injective in P_0 . For a homomorphism to N , the relations $C(eA) - A(eC) = 0$ and $C(eB) - B(eC) = 0$ force the images of eA and eB to vanish: A and B annihilate N , whereas multiplication by C on N is injective. The image of eC is unrestricted. Consequently $\text{Hom}_{R_0}(J/J^2, N) = N$.

The image of a derivation from the polynomial presentation is $\delta(eC) = C\delta(e) + e\delta(C) = C\delta(e)$ in N ; its values on eA, eB are zero. All multiples of C occur. Therefore

$$\text{Ext}_{R_0}^1(L_{R_0/\mathbb{C}}, N) = \frac{\text{Hom}_{R_0}(J/J^2, N)}{\text{im Hom}_{R_0}(\Omega_{P_0/\mathbb{C}} \otimes R_0, N)} = N/CN \simeq \mathbb{C}[\lambda]. \quad (55.4)$$

The class of the given algebra maps to $n \bmod CN$, hence to 1. Only the truncation in degrees $-1, 0$ is used in this computation; we have not asserted that the full cotangent complex has length two, or that J is a complete intersection.

The annihilator of the last module is the ideal of $D = V(e, A, B, C)$ in this chart. At every point of D the class is a nonzero generator, so an algebra section is impossible. Where C is invertible, R_0 is the polynomial algebra $\mathbb{C}[\lambda, A, B, C, C^{-1}]$ and its variables give an explicit section into $(P_0/I)[C^{-1}]$. Outside S , the module N is zero. These opens, together with the primitive charts away from D , prove the asserted local splitting elsewhere.

The complete-fibre charts cover X . Their extension classes are restrictions of the same global algebra extension. Thus their local generators glue to a nowhere vanishing section of the obstruction sheaf supported on D . The map $\mathcal{O}_D$ sending 1 to this section is an isomorphism on every displayed chart, and is zero off D on both sides. This proves (55.2). We identify the image of the global class in the local obstruction sheaf; no assertion that the entire global hyperextension group is one-dimensional is required. $\square$

Corollary 55.2 (Associated subvarieties of the contact fibre). *The associated subvarieties of X_2 are its two reduced components $\mathcal{Q}_P$ and $\mathbb{F}_2$, and the embedded subvariety S . The embedded associated prime disappears precisely off S . The support of the nilradical is S , whereas the locus where its algebra extension fails to split locally is the strictly smaller curve D .*

Proof. The primary decomposition

$$(eA, eB, e^2C) = (e) \cap (A, B, C) \cap (A, B, e^2)$$

gives the associated primes (e) , (A, B, C) , and (e, A, B) on conic charts. The last is the generic point of S ; the first two are those of the two components. The primitive charts away from their boundary are reduced and smooth. Since these charts cover all of X_2 , there are no additional associated subvarieties. The final distinction follows from Theorem 55.1 and $N = j_*\mathcal{O}_S(-1)$. $\square$

55.2. Arbitrary ramification of the ordered collision. For $m \geq 1$ replace the coefficient parameter in Theorem 47.1 by $\delta = \tau^m$. Let H_m be the full pullback and Y_m its horizontal closure. The following statements are over $\mathbb{C}[\tau]$; they also hold after localization or completion at $\tau = 0$.

Theorem 55.3 (Ramified torsion and toric normalization). *The horizontal space is the flat base change of the previous horizontal model. Its conic coordinate ring is*

$$\mathbb{C}[\lambda, e, C, \tau]/(e^2C + \tau^m). \quad (55.5)$$

The normalization of this chart is

$$\mathbb{C}[\lambda, s, r]^{\mu_m}, \quad \zeta(s, r) = (\zeta s, \zeta^{-2}r), \quad e = s^m, \quad C = -r^m, \quad \tau = s^2r. \quad (55.6)$$

The two central divisors in this normalization have multiplicities $2/\gcd(m, 2)$ and 1, respectively. If $m = 2q$, the normalized chart can equivalently be written

$$\mathbb{C}[\lambda, e, h, \tau]/(eh - \tau^q), \quad C = -h^2. \quad (55.7)$$

It is smooth for $q = 1$; for $q > 1$ its transverse surface singularity has equation $eh = \tau^q$.

The full pullback has the scheme-theoretic union sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{H_m} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{Y_m} \oplus \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{Q}_P} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{C}[\tau]/(\tau^m) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_S \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{C}[\tau]/(\tau^m) \rightarrow 0. \quad (55.8)$$

Its base torsion, with closed-immersion direct images understood, is

$$T_m = \mathcal{I}_{S/\mathcal{Q}_P} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{C}[\tau]/(\tau^m). \quad (55.9)$$

It has exact torsion order m . In particular $\mathrm{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{C}[\tau]}(\mathcal{O}_{H_m}, \mathbb{C}) = \tau^{m-1}T_m$, and all higher Tor sheaves vanish. For $m > 1$ the full pullback is not reduced along the generic point of its vertical component.

Proof. The map $\mathbb{C}[\delta] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}[\tau]$, $\delta \mapsto \tau^m$, is finite free. The union sequence and flat horizontal quotient in Theorem 47.1 therefore survive this base change. Its conic chart is

$$\mathbb{C}[\lambda, e, A, B, C, \tau]/(eA, eB, e^2C + \tau^m).$$

The horizontal ring is (55.5), either by flat saturation or by uniqueness of the flat quotient with the same generic fibre. Pulling back the original torsion ideal proves (55.9). Multiplication by τ^{m-1} is nonzero on this sheaf and multiplication by τ^m is zero. Its annihilator by τ is its last nonzero layer. The two-term resolution of the residue field proves the Tor statements. At the generic vertical point $e = 0$ and one of A, B is a unit, leaving the nonreduced equation $\tau^m = 0$ when $m > 1$.

For normalization, omit the independent coordinate λ . The ring in (55.5) is a domain: its relation is linear in C , with relatively prime coefficients e^2 and τ^m . Embed it in $\mathbb{C}[s, r]$ by the

displayed monomials. Its exponent lattice is generated by $(m, 0), (0, m), (2, 1)$. This lattice has index m in $\mathbb{Z}^2$ and is exactly

$$\{(a, b) \in \mathbb{Z}^2 : a - 2b \equiv 0 \pmod{m}\},$$

the character lattice of the invariant field in (55.6). Thus the invariant ring and the original ring have the same fraction field. The invariant ring is normal: an element of its fraction field integral over it is integral over the normal polynomial ring, belongs to that ring, and is fixed by the group. It is finite over the original ring, because s and r satisfy the monic equations $s^m = e$ and $r^m = -C$, and the invariant submodule of this finite module is finite. These facts prove that it is exactly the normalization, not a cover with a larger fraction field.

The inverse image of $\tau = 0$ is supported on $s = 0$ and $r = 0$. At the generic point of $s = 0$ the stabilizer has order $\gcd(m, 2)$, so the quotient has this ramification index there. Upstairs $\tau = s^2 r$ vanishes to order two. Downstairs its order is $2/\gcd(m, 2)$. At the generic point of $r = 0$ the stabilizer is trivial and the order is one. There are no other central prime divisors.

If $m = 2q$, first take invariants by the order-two subgroup, giving $\mathbb{C}[s^2, r]$. The remaining action has order q and opposite weights on s^2, r . Its invariant ring is generated by $e = s^{2q}$, $h = r^q$, and $\tau = s^2 r$, with the single relation $eh = \tau^q$. Every invariant monomial is a product of these three, as is seen by subtracting the smaller of its two exponents. This proves (55.7). The derivative criterion gives smoothness at $q = 1$ and the stated surface singularity for $q > 1$. $\square$

These local normalizations glue uniquely because they are integral closures in the common function field of Y_m . On the primitive chart the pullback is already $\mathbb{C}[\lambda, u, \tau]$, so no additional normalization is needed. For $m = 2$ the result recovers the ordered normal-crossing parameter space. For larger even m reducedness of the normalized central divisor does not imply smoothness of the total space. For odd m the doubled divisor remains. None of these operations normalizes the individual embedded curve or asserts its stable reduction as a map.

56. UNIVERSAL HORIZONTAL FAMILIES ON THE EFFECTIVE IMAGE

The sharp inverse precedes the boundary construction. This order also determines the correct category for the new universal models. We use the equivalence $\mathcal{F}_{\text{pen}}^{\text{eff}} \simeq [G/\text{PGL}(V)]$ of Theorem G.2, not the stack of all finite algebras of the same length.

Proposition 56.1 (Descent of the horizontal universal property). *Let $B \subset G$ be an integral invariant coefficient subspace, and let $U \subset B$ be an invariant dense generic-flat open for the pulled-back projective Hilbert graph. The universal horizontal modification of Theorem 53.1 is $\text{PGL}(V)$ -equivariant. Its quotient gives a representable proper birational morphism over $[B/\text{PGL}(V)]$, equipped with the descended flat horizontal family. Through the sharp effective inverse this is a modification of the corresponding effective failure-family image. It represents the same horizontal lifting property on admissible tests, checked on source-frame torsors.*

At a regular corank-two contact with smaller Smith exponent two, the completed local presentations for an arbitrary coefficient arc are those of Theorem 54.1, with the smooth frame and larger-exponent factors restored. The nilpotent algebra class and ramified torsion are the classes computed in Theorems 55.1 and 55.3. The first assertion is global on the specified coefficient subspace; the contact assertion describes its completed fixed-target local equations.

Proof. Apply a group element to the universal embedded flat quotient on the Hilbert graph. The resulting quotient has the same required horizontal restriction on the invariant open. The uniqueness in Theorem 53.1, applied over the group times the integral modification, lifts the action uniquely. Uniqueness also proves the identity and associativity axioms, so this is an action, not only pointwise equivariance. The universal family has the same equivariance. Taking a source-frame torsor and descending this projective equivariant family gives the representable

proper morphism of quotient stacks. Birationality holds on the dense open where the modification is an isomorphism. Admissibility and flatness can be checked on that faithfully flat torsor, and uniqueness of embedded quotients descends the universal property.

For the local assertion use the completed coefficient normal form and the fixed-target comparison of Proposition 43.2. Lemma B.2 restores the smooth complementary coefficients, and (B.2) restores the original incidence embedding. The comparison is on all Artin quotients, so it retains the square-zero extension and not merely its support or its vector-space dimension. Saturation commutes with the flat completions by Lemma 53.2. The seven coefficient presentations and the extension and torsion calculations therefore give the asserted completed equations. Finally transport this construction through the already established effective stack equivalence. $\square$

This proposition is a consequence of reconstruction and of the geometric universal property. It does not assert a boundary operation internal to the original closed multiplication table before reconstruction, nor does it include deformations leaving the effective pencil image. The sharp inverse for all pencils, including singular ones, retains its original hypotheses and proof; no higher-corank Hilbert classification is inferred from it.

57. A DETERMINANTAL MODEL FOR EVERY CONTACT ORDER

The distinction between a curve in a Hilbert scheme and a fibre of its parameter space is essential. This section constructs the former Hilbert graph over the whole polynomial coefficient space. Later we return to flat limits of the fibres of that graph. The two operations have different Hilbert polynomials and different universal properties.

Fix an integer $a \geq 1$ and set

$$B_a = \{(f, g, r) : f \text{ monic of degree } a, \quad \deg g, \deg r < a\}.$$

Write $[s : t]$ for the source coordinates and $x = t/s$. Homogenization to degree a gives forms F_0, F_1, F_2 . Let $U_a \subset B_a$ be the open locus where these forms have no common zero. The graph $C_b \subset X = \mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^2$ of $[F_0 : F_1 : F_2]$ has, for the Segre polarization, polynomial

$$P_a(l) = (a+1)l + 1.$$

The reduced closure of $(b, [C_b])$, $b \in U_a$, is denoted by $\Gamma_a \subset B_a \times \text{Hilb}^{P_a}(X)$, as in Section 39. It is an integral graph, not a quotient by projective changes of the target.

Put

$$d = a + 1, \quad m = \frac{d(d-1)}{2} + 1, \quad q = dm + 1, \quad N = (m+1) \binom{m+2}{2}. \quad (57.1)$$

For $0 \leq i \leq m$ and $j_0 + j_1 + j_2 = m$, let the corresponding column of the $q \times N$ matrix M_a be the coefficient vector of

$$s^{m-i} t^i F_0^{j_0} F_1^{j_1} F_2^{j_2} \quad \text{in } \mathbb{C}[s, t]_{dm}. \quad (57.2)$$

Thus its entries are explicit polynomials in the $3a$ coefficients. Order rows by the exponent of t , and order columns lexicographically in (i, j_0, j_1, j_2) . For each q -element column set J , write $\Delta_J = \det(M_a)_J$; identically zero determinants may be omitted. Let

$$\mathfrak{a}_a = (\Delta_J)_J \subset \mathcal{O}(B_a). \quad (57.3)$$

The size of this presentation is not a complexity bound. In particular, enumerating every maximal minor is not the recommended way to specialize one matrix.

Theorem 57.1 (Determinantal Hilbert graph). *For every $a \geq 1$ there is a canonical isomorphism over B_a*

$$\Gamma_a \simeq \text{Bl}_{\mathfrak{a}_a}(B_a) = \text{Proj}_{B_a} \bigoplus_{n \geq 0} \mathfrak{a}_a^n. \quad (57.4)$$

Under this isomorphism the rational Plücker coordinates of the Hilbert map are $[\Delta_J]_J$. The universal curve on this blow-up is the flat embedded extension of the graph on U_a . The normalization of Γ_a is the normalization of this Rees model. This assertion does not normalize any scheme fibre.

Let R be a discrete valuation ring containing $\mathbb{C}$, with uniformizer τ , fraction field K , and residue field k . For a coefficient arc $\gamma : \text{Spec } R \rightarrow B_a$ with $\gamma(\text{Spec } K) \subset U_a$, set

$$\mu(\gamma) = \min_J \text{ord}_\tau \Delta_J(\gamma), \quad \ell_J(\gamma) = \left(\tau^{-\mu(\gamma)} \Delta_J(\gamma) \right) \bmod \tau. \quad (57.5)$$

The special embedded curve is the unique Hilbert point whose Plücker vector is $[\ell_J(\gamma)]_J$. In particular this vector specifies its scheme structure, not merely its support or cycle. Two such arcs centred at the same coefficient point have the same point of Γ_a precisely when these nonzero vectors are proportional over k .

Proof. We first check the degree at which the Hilbert point is taken. The Gotzmann representation of $dl + 1$ has d terms of degree one and $(d-1)(d-2)/2$ terms of degree zero, since

$$\sum_{i=0}^{d-1} \binom{l+1-i}{1} = dl + \frac{d(3-d)}{2}.$$

Its total number of terms is m in (57.1). Gotzmann regularity and the Grassmannian construction of the Hilbert scheme therefore give a closed immersion into the Grassmannian of rank- q quotients in degree m ; see [Gotzmann(1978), Grothendieck(1961)]. We use the ordinary projective Hilbert scheme after the Segre embedding $X \hookrightarrow \mathbb{P}^5$, not an unproved multigraded regularity bound. The restriction

$$H^0(\mathbb{P}^5, \mathcal{O}(m)) \longrightarrow H^0(X, \mathcal{O}(m, m))$$

is onto. All kernels defining subschemes of X contain its fixed kernel. Hence this Hilbert immersion factors as a closed immersion into the Grassmannian of quotients of $H^0(X, \mathcal{O}(m, m))$, of dimension N .

For $b \in U_a$, evaluation on the graph is exactly

$$H^0(X, \mathcal{O}(m, m)) \longrightarrow H^0(C_b, \mathcal{O}(m, m)) = H^0(\mathbb{P}^1, \mathcal{O}(dm)).$$

This map is onto by the same regularity theorem. Its matrix is $M_a(b)$ and its Plücker coordinates are its q -minors. This proves that $\mathfrak{a}_a$ is nonzero and has no base point on U_a .

For an integral affine scheme $\text{Spec } A$ and a nonzero ideal $(h_0, \dots, h_n)$, the graph closure of $[h_0 : \dots : h_n]$ is $\text{Proj } A[(h_0, \dots, h_n)T]$. Indeed, on the chart indexed by a nonzero h_i , both schemes have ring $A[h_0/h_i, \dots, h_n/h_i] \subset \text{Frac}(A)$. These charts prove the assertion scheme-theoretically, with the Rees algebra rather than the symmetric algebra. Apply this to $\mathfrak{a}_a$. The Hilbert scheme is closed in the Plücker space, so the closure of its dense graph is this same blow-up. Pulling back the universal Hilbert family proves the flat-family assertion. Normalizing the identical integral schemes proves the normalization assertion.

Over R , at least one $\Delta_J(\gamma)$ is nonzero. Dividing all coordinates by their common valuation gives a primitive vector in a finite free R -module. Its special projective point is $[\ell_J]$. The Grassmannian and Hilbert equations hold over K and hence over R , since R has no τ -torsion. The resulting R -point is the unique extension by separatedness and properness. The Hilbert immersion makes equality of its special projective coordinates equivalent to equality of the embedded special curves. Keeping the coefficient point supplies the last assertion for the retained-coefficient graph. $\square$

Remark 57.2 (What the determinant construction supplies). The existence of a graph blow-up and the Hilbert immersion are classical. The explicit ideal (57.3) identifies their input for every B_a and makes the following valuation statements uniform in a . It is not a claim that arbitrary higher-contact fibres have only finitely many isomorphism classes. It does not identify points on the normalization solely from their Hilbert coordinates: distinct normalization points can lie over

one graph point. A generically nonincident DVR arc has a unique lift to that normalization by properness and the generic isomorphism. Equality of closed Hilbert points is a statement on Γ_a , not an assertion that the lifts coincide.

Proposition 57.3 (A finite determinacy bound for each arc). *Keep the matrix and coordinates above fixed. If two R -valued coefficient arcs agree modulo $\tau^{\mu(\gamma)+1}$ and the first is generically in U_a , the second is also generically in U_a and their embedded special curves agree. Thus a jet of length $\mu(\gamma) + 1$ suffices for this arc. The assertion concerns a Hilbert point, not the whole formal family.*

Proof. Polynomial evaluation preserves congruences. All maximal minors are therefore congruent modulo $\tau^{\mu+1}$, and at least one has the same nonzero coefficient in degree μ . The primitive vectors in (57.5) agree. To justify the generic-locus assertion, a triple with common homogeneous factor of positive degree has all images in (57.2) divisible by its m th power and cannot span $\mathbb{C}[s, t]_{dm}$. Thus a nonzero maximal minor forces absence of a common zero over an algebraic closure of K . $\square$

Proposition 57.4 (Smith data and specialization without enumerating minors). *Let the nonzero invariant factors of $M_a(\gamma)$ over R have valuations $e_1 \leq \dots \leq e_q$. Then*

$$\mu(\gamma) = \sum_{i=1}^q e_i.$$

The cokernel of this degree- m evaluation map is $\bigoplus_i R/(\tau^{e_i})$. Its least annihilating exponent is e_q , and its length is μ . The saturated row lattice of $M_a(\gamma)$ in R^N has special exterior line $[\ell_J]$. The kernel of the corresponding rank- q quotient over k , viewed in the Segre coordinate ring, is the degree- m part of the special ideal. It generates its ideal sheaf.

Proof. Smith normal form follows by choosing an entry of least valuation, using it to clear its row and column, and repeating. Elementary invertible operations preserve the ideal of maximal minors. In normal form that ideal is generated by $\tau^{e_1+\dots+e_q}$, which proves the formula and the cokernel statements. Over a DVR a saturated submodule of a finite free module is a direct summand. Saturating the row lattice divides its exterior line by exactly this common factor. Reduction gives the stated quotient. Gotzmann regularity, applied to the Hilbert point already constructed, says that its saturated homogeneous ideal is generated in degrees at most m , and its sheaf is generated by the degree- m part. $\square$

The exponent e_q here is an exponent for a finite module in one fixed projective degree. It is not a bound for saturation of every affine presentation of a pulled-back parameter graph.

58. FINITE COEFFICIENT-STATE CHAMBERS

A valuation without its leading coefficient loses information. The following finite statement keeps that information, including cancellation. Its use of coefficient weights is different from a one-parameter torus acting on the fixed target. Classical state polytopes organize initial ideals under the latter action [Bayer–Morrison(1988)]; here the weighted variables are the input coefficients of (57.2).

Write these coefficients as $z_1, \dots, z_{3a}$ and expand the finite set of nonzero minors as

$$\Delta_J(z) = \sum_{\alpha \in E} c_{J\alpha} z^\alpha,$$

where E is the union of their finite monomial supports. Allow a specified subset of the z_i to be identically zero, and omit the corresponding monomials first. For this theorem take $R = k[[\tau]]$ (or $k[\tau]_{(\tau)}$), where $k/\mathbb{C}$ is any field extension, so the residue coefficients are actual constants. No

coefficient-field choice was required for the preceding general DVR statements. On the remaining coordinates consider exact monomial arcs

$$z_i = \xi_i \tau^{w_i}, \quad \xi_i \in k^*, \quad w_i \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}. \quad (58.1)$$

The constant monic coefficient of f is not among these variables.

Theorem 58.1 (Finite decorated chamber classification). *For each fixed a and each choice of zero coordinates there is an explicit finite rational polyhedral fan in the nonnegative weight orthant, and for each relatively open cone a finite locally closed partition of the residue torus, with the following properties. The pairs for which (58.1) is generically in U_a are specified by these partitions. On each such pair of a cone and a residue stratum, the embedded Hilbert limit is given by a single displayed vector of polynomial functions of ξ , independent of w in that relatively open cone. These vectors classify the special embedded curves by projective equality. They include nonreduced curves and embedded scheme structure.*

One such fan is the hyperplane arrangement

$$(\alpha - \beta) \cdot w = 0 \quad (\alpha, \beta \in E) \quad (58.2)$$

intersected with the coordinate orthant and all its faces. The residue partition and the vectors require only finite polynomial operations on the coefficients $c_{J\alpha}$.

Proof. On the relative interior of a cone, the weak order of all numbers $\alpha \cdot w$ is fixed. Let $E_1, \dots, E_t$ be its ordered equality classes. For each J and h form

$$b_{Jh}(\xi) = \sum_{\alpha \in E_h} c_{J\alpha} \xi^\alpha.$$

Partition the residue torus by the first index $h(J)$ at which b_{Jh} is nonzero, allowing $h(J) = \infty$ when all are zero. Each condition is a finite list of polynomial equalities and one inequality, so there are finitely many locally closed pieces. Discard the piece on which all $h(J)$ are infinite. On the others let $h_* = \min_J h(J)$. The answer is the projective vector

$$L_J(\xi) = \begin{cases} b_{J, h_*}(\xi), & h(J) = h_*, \\ 0, & h(J) > h_*. \end{cases} \quad (58.3)$$

Indeed substitution into every minor is a finite sum of powers of τ , with its terms grouped exactly as above. Equalities in a residue stratum account for every possible cancellation, not just a generic noncancellation assumption. The least surviving exponent is the common valuation in (57.5). Theorem 57.1 proves both classification and retention of scheme structure. The same rank argument as in Proposition 57.3 identifies the discarded set with the triples having a generic common zero. $\square$

Remark 58.2 (Finite classification and its scope). For fixed residue coefficients, the theorem gives finitely many embedded limits as the positive integral weights vary. As the residue coefficients vary, it gives finitely many algebraic families, not finitely many curves. The arrangement need not be minimal and does not assert that every one of its walls changes the curve. The degree bound is uniform for each a , but no claim of efficient enumeration of its potentially enormous minors is made. Arbitrary formal arcs are treated by the pointwise jet bound, not by declaring their leading coefficient monomials to be exact arcs. In particular, repeated cancellation in a formal arc cannot be discarded by this theorem.

The construction gives a practical distinction between two sorts of audit. An individual polynomial arc can be evaluated and its row lattice saturated, without computing the whole arrangement. The finite arrangement is a proof of finite classification of exact monomial profiles. The next section computes the entire answer on a nontrivial two-dimensional slice, including its minimal walls and the geometry on those walls.

59. A TWO-WALL CLASSIFICATION ON A NONSYMMETRIC SLICE

The determinant construction can be evaluated without listing its maximal minors. We do so on a slice on which both a jet direction and a conic direction vary. Put

$$S = \operatorname{Spec} \mathbb{C}[b, c] \longrightarrow B_2, \quad (f, g, r) = (x^2, b, cx).$$

Let T be the schematic closure of $S_{b \neq 0}$ in $\Gamma_2 \times_{B_2} S$. Thus T is the horizontal main component of this base change, not its full pullback. All target coordinates $[F : G : R]$ in this section are fixed.

Theorem 59.1 (The two-wall surface). *The surface T is the blow-up of S at $(b, c) = (0, 0)$ followed by the blow-up of the point $e = c = 0$ in the chart $b = ec$. Equivalently,*

$$T \simeq \operatorname{Bl}_{(b, c)(b, c^2)} S.$$

The maximal-minor ideal in Theorem 57.1 restricts to the explicitly factored ideal

$$\mathfrak{a}_2 \mathcal{O}_S = b^{10}(b, c)^4(b, c^2)^6. \quad (59.1)$$

The surface is smooth and has the following three affine charts:

chart	coordinates	(b, c)
T_0	(b, k)	(b, bk)
T_1	(e, h)	(e^2h, eh)
T_2	(c, z)	(c^2z, c)

(59.2)

On T_1 and T_2 the universal curve has respectively the bihomogeneous ideals

$$I_1 = (R^2 - hFG, tG - esR, tR - ehsF), \quad (59.3)$$

$$I_2 = (FG - zR^2, tG - czsR, tR - csF). \quad (59.4)$$

On T_0 its ideal sheaf is generated by

$$t^2G - bs^2F, \quad sR - ktG, \quad tR - bksF, \quad R^2 - bk^2FG. \quad (59.5)$$

These equations define flat families of polynomial $3l + 1$. The fibre $T_{(0,0)}$ is a reduced chain $E_{11} \cup E_{21}$ of two projective lines. Their self-intersections are -2 and -1 , respectively. The first line parametrizes primitive tails, and the second the conic pencil through the attaching point; their intersection parametrizes the doubled conic $R^2 = 0$.

Proof. Perform the stated blow-ups. The first chart of the first blow-up is $c = bk$ and is unchanged by the second blow-up. In the other chart write $b = ec$ and blow up (e, c) . Its charts $c = eh$ and $e = cz$ give exactly (59.2). The transition maps are

$$\begin{aligned} k &= e^{-1}, \quad b = e^2h, & e &\neq 0 \text{ on } T_1, \quad k \neq 0 \text{ on } T_0, \\ z &= h^{-1}, \quad c = eh, & h &\neq 0 \text{ on } T_1, \quad z \neq 0 \text{ on } T_2. \end{aligned}$$

In the first overlap the inverse is $e = k^{-1}$, $h = bk^2$; in the second it is $h = z^{-1}$, $e = cz$. The third overlap is the composite, so the cocycle identity holds as an identity of rings. To check the alternative blow-up description, first blow up (b, c) ; on the chart $b = ec$ the transform of (b, c^2) is $c(e, c)$, whereas on $c = bk$ it is the invertible ideal (b) . Removing the invertible factors and applying the universal property of a blow-up proves the product-ideal assertion.

We next construct the morphism to the Hilbert scheme. On T_1 the Hilbert–Burch chart of Section 44 has centre and parameters $\lambda = B = C = 0$, $A = -h$, and retained coefficient e . Its equations are (59.3). On T_2 a Hilbert–Burch matrix is

$$\begin{pmatrix} F & R \\ -zR & -G \\ -t & -cs \end{pmatrix}.$$

Its minors are $-(FG - zR^2)$, $tR - csF$, and $-(tG - czsR)$. On every geometric fibre the ideal has height two: if $c \neq 0$, the equation $tR = csF$ and the other equations give a one-dimensional graph or its single-contact limit; if $c = 0$, they give the main section and the conic $FG - zR^2$ at $t = 0$. This conic is nonzero for every z . There is no common divisor of the three minors. The fibrewise Hilbert–Burch resolution

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}(-1, -2)^2 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}(-1, -1)^2 \oplus \mathcal{O}(0, -2) \longrightarrow \mathcal{O} \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_C \longrightarrow 0$$

is therefore exact, and its constant Euler characteristic gives flatness and the polynomial $3l + 1$. Equivalently one may apply the fibrewise flatness criterion successively to this complex of relatively locally free sheaves.

For T_0 , on $s \neq 0$ eliminate R from (59.5). The remaining equation in the relative $\mathbb{P}^1$ with coordinates $[F : G]$ is

$$x^2G = bF, \quad R = kxG.$$

It is a relative effective Cartier divisor, since $x^2G - bF$ is nonzero on every fibre. On $t \neq 0$, with $y = s/t$, the equations instead give $G = by^2F$ and $R = bkyF$, the graph of a section. These two descriptions prove flatness and exclude any excess component at infinity. This is also the primitive division family of Theorem 39.1, with $w = kx$. On the overlaps substitution of the displayed transitions makes the ideal sheaves identical; on $T_1 \cap T_2$ the quadratic equations differ by the invertible factor $-h$. Thus the three flat families glue in the fixed target. Their generic graph is $[t^2 : bs^2 : cst]$.

It remains to prove that the constructed surface is the whole horizontal graph, rather than a resolution mapping to it. For $a = 2$, the matrix M_2 has 13 rows and 75 columns. After restricting to $F_0 = t^2$, $F_1 = bs^2$, $F_2 = cst$, every column has exactly one nonzero entry. Its row index is $i + 2j_0 + j_2$ and its entry is $b^{j_1}c^{j_2}$. A nonzero maximal minor chooses exactly one column from each row. Consequently its ideal is the product of the ideals generated by the entries in the individual rows. With $J_1 = (b, c)$ and $J_2 = (b, c^2)$ those row ideals, in order from 0 to 12, are

$$b^4, b^3J_1, b^2J_2, bJ_1J_2, J_2^2, J_1J_2, J_2, J_1, \mathcal{O}_S, \mathcal{O}_S, \mathcal{O}_S, \mathcal{O}_S, \mathcal{O}_S.$$

They follow by taking all $0 \leq i \leq 4$ and $j_0 + j_1 + j_2 = 4$ with the indicated row index; divisibility removes redundant monomials. Their product proves (59.1).

The graph closure of the restricted rational Plücker map is therefore $\mathrm{Bl}_{b^{10}J_1^4J_2^6}S$, by the graph argument in Theorem 57.1. This is not an appeal to unrestricted base change for blow-ups. A principal nonzero factor does not change the Rees blow-up. Moreover blowing up $J_1^4J_2^6$ is the same as blowing up J_1J_2 : on either integral blow-up, invertibility of the product makes each factor invertible as a fractional ideal, and conversely. For completeness, if two nonzero finitely generated ideals have invertible product, then locally, after dividing their product by its generator, they are inverse fractional ideals. Thus each is invertible; apply this repeatedly to the positive powers. The universal properties supply inverse morphisms between the two blow-ups, identical on the dense open. This proves that the twice blown-up surface is exactly T . The flat curve constructed above equals its Hilbert universal curve since the two Hilbert morphisms agree on the dense open of an integral surface and the Hilbert scheme is separated. In particular no unproved normality of a graph image is used in the argument.

On T_1 the ideal of the origin pulls back to (eh) ; on T_0 it is (b) , and on T_2 it is (c) . Hence the exceptional fibre is reduced with a transverse intersection. The strict transform of the first exceptional curve loses one from its self-intersection when the second point is blown up. This gives $E_{11}^2 = -2$, $E_{21}^2 = -1$, and $E_{11}E_{21} = 1$. Substitution $h = 0$ and $e = 0$ in (59.3) gives its two modular descriptions and their common doubled conic. $\square$

Corollary 59.2 (Complete valued-arc limits on the slice). *Let R be a DVR containing $\mathbb{C}$, with uniformizer τ and residue field k . Let $b = \beta\tau^p$, $c = \gamma\tau^q$, where $p, q > 0$ and $\beta, \gamma \in R^*$; write*

bars for their residues. The special embedded curve has the following ideal sheaf. The displayed bihomogeneous ideals are understood with irrelevant saturation.

weights	residue parameter	special ideal	
$p < q$	$k = 0$	(R, t^2G)	(59.6)
$p = q$	$k = \bar{\gamma}/\bar{\beta}$	$(sR - ktG, tR, R^2)$	
$q < p < 2q$		(tG, tR, R^2)	
$p = 2q$	$h = \bar{\gamma}^2/\bar{\beta}$	$(tG, tR, R^2 - hFG)$	
$p > 2q$		(tG, tR, FG)	

These five cases exhaust all generically nonincident DVR arcs centred at the origin with $bc \neq 0$ in the fraction field, including units with arbitrary higher coefficients. If $c = 0$ identically, the first row applies. Moreover the determinantal order on this slice is

$$\mu = 10p + 4 \min(p, q) + 6 \min(p, 2q), \quad (59.7)$$

with $\mu = 20p$ when $c = 0$. The two walls $p = q$ and $p = 2q$ are actual walls for embedded limits; coefficients on the walls cannot be omitted.

Proof. For $p \leq q$, use $k = c/b$ on T_0 . For $q < p \leq 2q$ use $e = b/c$ and $h = c^2/b$ on T_1 . For $p > 2q$ use $z = b/c^2$ on T_2 . In each case these coordinates belong to R , and their reductions give the table. The formula for μ follows by taking valuations in (59.1); an ideal generated by two elements has valuation equal to the lesser of their valuations. It is unaffected by higher unit coefficients. For $k \neq 0$ the first generator t^2G of the primitive central fibre follows from $sR - ktG$ and tR after taking ideal sheaves. For $k = 0$ it must be retained. This explains why setting $k = 0$ in just the last three generators would give the wrong scheme. $\square$

Proposition 59.3 (Components, multiplicities, and the parameter boundary). *Every curve in (59.6) is Cohen–Macaulay and has no embedded associated points. In the first three rows the minimal primes are (G, R) and (t, R) ; the main section has multiplicity one and the tail multiplicity two. In the fourth row the primes are (G, R) and $(t, R^2 - hFG)$, each of multiplicity one. In the fifth they are (G, R) , (t, F) , and (t, G) , each of multiplicity one. The fourth curve is a main section attached to a smooth conic; the fifth is a chain of three reduced lines. The normalization of each reduced curve is the disjoint union of its smooth components. None of these attached curves is normal as a whole.*

The parameter surface T is normal and smooth. Its exceptional boundary has simple normal crossings, with

$$\begin{array}{c|cc} & E_{11} & E_{21} \\ \hline \text{ord}(b) & 1 & 2 \\ \text{ord}(c) & 1 & 1 \end{array}, \quad K_{T/S} = E_{11} + 2E_{21}.$$

These are statements about a parameter-space modification, not a stable reduction theorem for curves.

Proof. For the primitive rows, the affine presentation $R = kxG$, $x^2G = 0$ is a hypersurface in a smooth relative surface. Near infinity it is the smooth main section. The two generic lengths are read from x^2G ; the residue k changes the embedding but not the lengths. For the conic rows the Hilbert–Burch resolution above makes every local ring on the curve Cohen–Macaulay of dimension one. At the attaching point use $F = s = 1$: the ideals are $(xG, xR, R^2 - hG)$, with the analogous FG presentation in the last row. The ideal decompositions

$$(tG, tR, Q) = (G, R) \cap (t, Q), \quad Q \in \{R^2, R^2 - hFG, FG\},$$

as ideal sheaves give the claimed minimal components and lengths. A one-dimensional Cohen–Macaulay scheme has no embedded points. When $h \neq 0$ the conic is smooth. When $Q = FG$, its

two lines meet at $[0 : 0 : 1]$ and only the line $G = 0$ contains the attaching point $[1 : 0 : 0]$. This gives the chain description. The assertions on the normalization of the reductions follow.

The valuations follow directly from $b = e^2h$, $c = eh$: E_{11} is $h = 0$ and E_{21} is $e = 0$. For a blow-up of a smooth surface at a point the relative canonical divisor is its exceptional curve, as the Jacobian in a chart shows. Pulling the first exceptional divisor through the second blow-up adds one more copy of E_{21} . This proves the discrepancy formula. $\square$

Corollary 59.4 (Pointwise, but not uniform, finite determinacy). *Even on B_2 no integer n has the property that the coefficient n -jet determines every embedded graph limit. In contrast, Proposition 57.3 gives an explicit finite bound for each generically nonincident arc.*

Proof. Given n , choose $M > n$ and two distinct nonzero constants β_1, β_2 . The arcs

$$f = x^2, \quad g = \beta_i \tau^{2M}, \quad r = \tau^M x \quad (i = 1, 2)$$

agree modulo τ^{n+1} and are generically base-point free. Their limits are the distinct fixed-target conics $R^2 - \beta_i^{-1}FG$ attached to the same main section, by the fourth row of (59.6). This proves the claim. $\square$

Proposition 59.5 (No uniform saturation exponent for full pullbacks). *The uniformizer saturation exponents of the full pulled-back parameter graph at contact order two are unbounded. This is compatible with the finite degree-module statement of Proposition 57.4.*

Proof. In the symmetric family of Theorem 55.3, take $\delta = \tau^m$. Its full vertical torsion is a nonzero ideal module tensored with $\mathbb{C}[\tau]/(\tau^m)$. On a chart where that ideal is nonzero it is killed by τ^m and not by τ^{m-1} . Thus the least exponent at which uniformizer saturation stabilizes is at least m . Since m is arbitrary, there is no uniform bound with contact order fixed at two. This assertion is about the full parameter-family pullback; it does not replace the embedded-curve jet theorem with a negative statement. $\square$

60. BASE CHANGE AND COMPARISON OF HORIZONTAL MODELS

We now distinguish the Hilbert graph of embedded curves from the horizontal modification of a projective parameter family. In the notation of Section 53, let $W \rightarrow B$ be projective and of finite presentation, with B integral of finite type over $\mathbb{C}$. Fix a dense open $U \subset B$ over which W is flat with polynomial P . The admissible tests are locally Noetherian morphisms $Y \rightarrow B$ for which U_Y is schematically dense. The horizontal object W_Y^h is the schematic closure of W_{U_Y} in W_Y . Only tests for which this closure is flat belong to the represented horizontal-flat subfunctor. Throughout,

$$H_B = \overline{s(U)} \subset \text{Hilb}^P(W/B)$$

means the *horizontal Hilbert-main-component modification*. Its terminal property refers to this admissible category and this prescribed generic embedded quotient.

Lemma 60.1 (Flat schematic density). *Let $V \subset Y$ be a quasi-compact schematically dense open in a locally Noetherian scheme. If $Z \rightarrow Y$ is flat, then Z_V is schematically dense in Z .*

Proof. The assertion is local on Y and Z . For $Y = \text{Spec } A$, write $V = \bigcup_{i=1}^r D(f_i)$. Schematic density is the injectivity of $A \rightarrow \prod_i A_{f_i}$. Tensoring with any flat A -module preserves this injection; finiteness of the product identifies the tensor product with the product of the localizations. Apply this to the rings of affine opens of Z . A section vanishing on Z_V is zero. This is precisely the required schematic density. $\square$

Theorem 60.2 (Strict base change and coherent comparison). *Let $B' \rightarrow B$ be an integral finite-type base change such that $U' = U \times_B B'$ is nonempty. Use the pullback polarization and*

write $H_{B'}$ for the horizontal Hilbert-main-component modification of $W_{B'}$ relative to U' . There is a canonical closed immersion

$$H_{B'} = \overline{U'}^{H_B \times_B B'} \hookrightarrow H_B \times_B B'. \quad (60.1)$$

It is an equality if and only if U' is schematically dense in the full fibre product. In particular it is an equality for flat base change. For composable base changes meeting the indicated generic opens, these comparison maps compose to the comparison for the composite. They obey the corresponding cocycle identity.

If $B^\nu \rightarrow B$ is the normalization, then $H_{B^\nu} \rightarrow H_B$ is finite and birational, and the normalizations of these two integral schemes are canonically isomorphic over B .

Proof. The relative Hilbert scheme and its universal family commute with base change. In the resulting Hilbert scheme over B' , the closure of $s(U')$ is contained in the closed subscheme $H_B \times_B B'$, since the ideal of H_B vanishes on $s(U')$. It is therefore exactly the schematic closure on the right of (60.1). This proves the first assertion and the density criterion. Flat base change preserves the schematic density of $U \subset H_B$ by Lemma 60.1; note that the projection of the fibre product to H_B is flat.

For a further base change $B'' \rightarrow B'$, both routes give the schematic closure of U'' in the same relative Hilbert scheme. The closed immersions consequently agree, including their scheme structures. This proves transitivity and the cocycle, not merely agreement on closed points. Finally, normalization of a finite-type integral $\mathbb{C}$ -scheme is finite. The map $H_B \times_B B'' \rightarrow H_B$ is finite; its closed integral main component is finite and birational because it agrees on a dense normal open. Finite birational integral extensions have the same integral closure in their common function field. This proves the last assertion. $\square$

Example 60.3 (The full pullback need not commute). Take $B = \mathbb{A}_{x,y}^2$, $W = \text{Bl}_0 B$, and $U = B \setminus \{0\}$. The generic polynomial is $P = 1$. A flat family of length-one embedded subschemes of W/B is a section, so its relative Hilbert scheme is W itself and $H_B = W$. Restrict to $B' = \{y = 0\}$. With homogeneous coordinates $[u : v] = [x : y]$, the full pullback has equation $xv = 0$ in $\mathbb{A}_x^1 \times \mathbb{P}^1$. It contains a vertical projective line. The closure of $x \neq 0$ is instead $v = 0$, isomorphic to B' . Thus (60.1) is a strict inclusion. The parameter $y = 0$ is a nonflat base change; replacing the full pullback by its reduction would not remove its extra component.

Proposition 60.4 (Common refinements on one generic open). *Fix B, U . For two integral proper U -modifications Y_1, Y_2 , let $Y_1 \star_U Y_2$ be the schematic closure of the diagonal U in $Y_1 \times_B Y_2$. The projections are proper birational maps and this object is terminal among integral U -modifications equipped with maps to both Y_1 and Y_2 restricting to the identity on U . Repeated products are canonically associative and symmetric, and their comparison maps satisfy all product cocycles. If a refinement of a stratum has the same reduced closure and a smaller dense generic-flat open, its horizontal model is canonically unchanged.*

Proof. A pair of compatible maps gives a map into the product. Since its integral source has dense U , the map factors through the schematic closure of that open. The factorization is unique because the closure is a closed subscheme. Properness follows from properness of the product, and birationality from the common dense open. For three or more factors every iterated object is the closure of the same diagonal in the full product; this proves associativity, symmetry, and their compatibility. Shrinking a dense open of an integral section does not change its schematic closure, proving the last assertion. $\square$

The theorem supplies comparison for dominant restrictions and strict base changes, and the proposition supplies common refinements on a fixed generic problem. A stratum whose closure lies entirely outside U does not meet these hypotheses. In particular these results do not identify

Hilbert components with different generic polynomials. For such strata the original Noetherian-induction construction remains a choice of strata, not a canonical incidence poset. If one asks for a flat family whose fibres are the entire original fibres on two strata in one connected base, equality of their Hilbert polynomials is necessary. If W is already flat over all of B , the horizontal model is B itself. These observations specify both the full-base flat case and the precise limitation of the comparison theorem.

60.1. Comparison with full flattening. For an admissible $Y \rightarrow B$ on which W_Y is flat, Lemma 60.1 gives $W_Y = W_Y^h$. There is therefore a natural inclusion of functors and a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \{Y : W_Y \text{ is flat}\} & \longrightarrow & \{Y : W_Y^h \text{ is flat}\} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathrm{Hom}_B(Y, B) & \xlongequal{\quad} & \mathrm{Hom}_B(Y, B). \end{array}$$

The top arrow is not in general surjective: the extra projective line in Example 60.3 is exactly an obstruction to full flattening. The usual flattening functor of a finitely presented sheaf concerns its full tensor pullback and, when represented, is represented by a monomorphism; see [Stacks Project], Tag 052F. By contrast, a horizontal modification may have a positive-dimensional exceptional fibre. Flattening by blow-up uses a pure transform and must likewise not be confused with flatness of the full pullback. Theorem 57.1 computes a Rees ideal for the *embedded-curve graph*; it does not assert that the same ideal flattens every fibre of that parameter graph.

The horizontal main component is integral, hence reduced. Neither normality nor Cohen–Macaulayness follows from the construction: for $W = B$ the construction returns B , which may be a nonnormal integral curve or a non-Cohen–Macaulay integral higher-dimensional scheme. The explicit surface in Theorem 59.1 has stronger properties because its charts have been computed. Independence of polarization identifies representing objects for the same horizontal functor; it does not identify the ambient Hilbert schemes or their other components.

61. DETERMINANTAL SPECIALIZATION AFTER EFFECTIVE RECONSTRUCTION

The inverse theorem and the Hilbert-limit theorem solve distinct problems. We state their composition so that no operation on a raw unframed multiplication table is inferred.

Corollary 61.1 (Effective-family specialization). *On the effectively rigidified failure-family image, suppose that a reconstructed regular contact is given in the fixed-target polynomial chart B_a and that its DVR generic point lies in U_a . The embedded specialization of that contact is determined by the primitive maximal-minor vector of M_a , and by the coefficient jet modulo $\tau^{\mu+1}$. This rule is compatible with the fixed-target undo maps for changes of contact chart. For exact monomial coefficient profiles the finite decorated chamber theorem applies; on $f = x^2, g = b, r = cx$ its complete answer is the two-wall classification.*

Proof. The sharp inverse reconstructs the pencil on the effective image, as used in Proposition 56.1. The fixed-target comparisons identify the local graph family before and after undoing the contact coordinates. On each chart, Theorem 57.1 computes the same embedded Hilbert point from its degree- m quotient. Two presentations of this quotient have the same Hilbert point because the Hilbert immersion is injective as a morphism of functors. The finite jet statement follows from Proposition 57.3, and the last statements from Theorem 58.1 and Corollary 59.2. $\square$

This statement uses reconstruction first. Its finite jet is a jet of the recovered coefficient family in the stated chart, not a proved bound on the jet of an arbitrary multiplication table. A closed finite algebra alone contains no specified specialization arc. Nor does the corollary identify

different normalization branches lying over one embedded Hilbert point. The complete proof of the inverse remains part of Paper I; no external independent audit is asserted by this application.

62. EVALUATION IDEALS AND THEIR DIVISORIAL CONTENT

Throughout the new results the ground field k is algebraically closed of characteristic zero. The equations, flat families, and valuation formulas are defined over $\mathbb{Z}$ and remain valid over a field whenever the displayed nonzero residues are retained. We distinguish a rational projective map, a choice of homogeneous coordinates for that map, and a choice of projective embedding of its target.

62.1. A primitive ideal for a fixed projective map. Let B be a regular integral scheme of finite type over k , and let $I \subset \mathcal{O}_B$ be a nonzero coherent ideal. At a prime divisor D put $c_D = \min_{f \in I} \text{ord}_D(f)$, and set

$$C(I) = \sum_D c_D D, \quad I^{\text{pr}} = I \otimes \mathcal{O}_B(C(I)) \subset \mathcal{O}_B.$$

Only finitely many coefficients are nonzero locally. Regularity makes $C(I)$ Cartier. Equivalently, $I^{**} = \mathcal{O}_B(-C(I))$ and $I^{\text{pr}} = I \otimes (I^{**})^{-1}$. The inclusion follows by checking orders at prime divisors in the normal ring $\mathcal{O}_B$.

Proposition 62.1 (Content and the graph). *Suppose $h_0, \dots, h_N$ generate I and define a rational map $B \dashrightarrow \mathbb{P}^N$. Its schematic graph closure is $\text{Bl}_I B$, and*

$$\text{Bl}_I B \simeq \text{Bl}_{I^{\text{pr}}} B.$$

Multiplication of the homogeneous coordinates by one nonzero rational function, and an invertible change of their basis, leave I^{pr} unchanged, whenever the resulting coordinates are regular. These assertions concern the same projective embedding; changing that embedding need not preserve the primitive ideal.

Proof. On an affine factorial chart write $I = gJ$, where g is the greatest common divisor of the generators. Division by g identifies I^n with J^n compatibly with multiplication, hence identifies the two Rees algebras as graded algebras. The ratio chart with pivot h_i is $A[h_0/h_i, \dots, h_N/h_i]$ inside the fraction field. These charts are exactly the closure of the generic graph. They also show the invariance under a common rational scalar. An invertible matrix changes the generating list but not its ideal. The local constructions agree under the unit changes of g , and therefore glue. This is the classical Rees graph construction, not a new representability assertion [Stacks Project]. $\square$

Proposition 62.2 (Primitive finite determination). *On an affine factorial chart choose polynomial generators of I^{pr} . Let $\gamma : \text{Spec } k[[\tau]] \rightarrow B$ have generic point in the domain of the rational map, and put $\nu = \text{ord}_\gamma(I^{\text{pr}})$. A second coefficient arc congruent to γ modulo $\tau^{\nu+1}$ has the same closed projective limit. The bound is sufficient, and is not asserted to be optimal. It determines the closed graph point, not the whole formal family or a point of the normalization above it.*

Proof. Polynomial evaluation preserves this congruence. At least one primitive generator has order exactly ν , so the second arc has the same minimum order. After division by τ^ν , the two residue vectors are equal and nonzero. The projective limits coincide. Changing a local trivialization multiplies this vector by a unit. A change of regular coordinates preserves the congruence relation on local-ring maps. $\square$

The integer ν is posterior: an oracle for a formal series need not reveal it in a predetermined number of queries. For polynomial or localized-polynomial arcs, polynomial division and exact linear algebra over $k(\tau)$ compute it in finitely many operations. No efficiency claim follows from that termination statement.

62.2. The evaluation module. Write $V = k^2$, $W = k^3$, and $X = \mathbb{P}(V) \times \mathbb{P}(W)$. A triple of degree a binary forms gives, by substitution and multiplication, the map

$$E_m : \text{Sym}^m V^* \otimes \text{Sym}^m W^* \longrightarrow \text{Sym}^{(a+1)m} V^*. \quad (62.1)$$

Our convention is a quotient matrix: columns are images of domain basis vectors and rows are coefficients in the target. Thus

$$q = (a+1)m + 1, \quad N = (m+1) \binom{m+2}{2}, \quad M_{a,m} \in A^{q \times N}.$$

Its maximal-minor ideal is $\text{Fitt}_0(\text{coker } E_m)$. Source and target changes act through symmetric powers in (62.1); in chosen bases the matrix changes by invertible left and right matrices, together with the corresponding base automorphism. The Fitting ideal is consequently covariant. Scalar changes of a representative of the triple instead multiply all columns by a common scalar to the m th power. This is a line-bundle twist on projective coefficient space, not an invariant numerical order.

For $P_a(l) = (a+1)l + 1$ put

$$m_a = \frac{a(a+1)}{2} + 1. \quad (62.2)$$

Indeed, with $d = a+1$, the d linear terms $\binom{l+1-i}{1}$, $0 \leq i < d$, sum to $dl + d(3-d)/2$. Adding $(d-1)(d-2)/2$ constant terms gives $dl + 1$; the number of terms is $d(d-1)/2 + 1$. Gotzmann regularity applies in the ordinary projective space of the Segre embedding. The restriction of its degree- m section space to X is surjective: a monomial of bidegree (m, m) is a product of m Segre coordinates. The fixed kernel of this restriction belongs to every curve ideal in question. Thus the Hilbert immersion factors through the quotient space in (62.1). For $m \geq m_a$ the degree- m kernel generates the ideal *sheaf*; this is the truncation consequence of regularity, not a claim that the homogeneous ideal has no smaller minimal generators. These are the classical Hilbert-embedding inputs [Gotzmann(1978)].

Proposition 62.3 (Rank, incidence, and content on the full chart). *Let B_a be the affine space of triples (f, g, r) with f monic of degree a and $\deg g, \deg r < a$. For $m \geq m_a$, E_m has rank q exactly when the three homogenized forms have no common zero. The rank-drop support is irreducible of codimension two. In particular, $I_q(M_{a,m})$ has no divisorial content on B_a .*

Let C_f be the companion matrix for multiplication by x on $A[x]/(f)$. The smaller presentation

$$A^{2a} \xrightarrow{[g(C_f) \quad r(C_f)]} A^a \longrightarrow A[x]/(f, g, r) \longrightarrow 0 \quad (62.3)$$

defines a natural incidence Fitting ideal with the same radical as $I_q(M_{a,m})$. Equality of these two ideals is not asserted.

Proof. On the base-point-free locus restriction to the graph is the quotient onto $H^0(\mathbb{P}^1, \mathcal{O}((a+1)m))$ in a regularity degree. If a common form of positive degree divides the triple, every substituted degree- m section is divisible by its m th power, so the quotient cannot have rank q . There is no common zero at infinity since f is monic and the other leading coefficients vanish. The incidence variety

$$\{(x, f, g, r) : f(x) = g(x) = r(x) = 0\} \subset \mathbb{A}^1 \times B_a$$

is affine space of dimension $3a - 2$: solve for the three constant coefficients. Its projection is finite, because x satisfies the monic equation f . Its image is therefore closed, irreducible, and of that dimension. An ideal with codimension-two support in a regular integral scheme has order zero at every prime divisor. Finally (62.3) is multiplication by g, r in the finite free algebra $A[x]/(f)$. Its cokernel is the stated quotient, whose support is exactly the same incidence image. $\square$

Content removal need not commute with nonflat restriction. The full ideal in Proposition 62.3 is already primitive; its restriction to the two-dimensional families below has a large common factor. Thus the primitive construction does not turn the original minor order into an embedding-independent invariant.

Example 62.4 (Degree changes without graph changes). For $a = 1$, translation reduces the triple to (x, v, w) . In every degree $m \geq 1$ the maximal-minor ideal is

$$(v, w)^{m(m+1)/2}.$$

To see this, the row indexed by n , $0 \leq n \leq 2m$, has ideal $(v, w)^{\max(0, m-n)}$, and a full minor chooses one entry in every row. The product gives the formula. All these ideals are primitive and define the same blow-up, although their orders along an arc are different. Their Smith lengths are lengths of different evaluation modules, not lengths attached to the rational Hilbert map alone.

Proposition 62.5 (What survives a change of Hilbert degree). *For two degrees at least m_a , the graph modifications obtained from E_m are canonically isomorphic over B_a , with the same universal embedded curve and the same normalization. Their exceptional prime divisors therefore define the same divisorial valuations of $k(B_a)$. The orders of the evaluation ideals on those divisors, the Smith factors, and the primitive ideals themselves need not be equal. There is in general no inclusion-minimal nonzero ideal defining a given nontrivial blow-up: taking positive powers leaves its Proj unchanged.*

Proof. Both constructions are the closure of the same section in the same Hilbert scheme; the two Hilbert immersions only embed that scheme in different Grassmannians. The graph identification follows from Proposition 62.1. Normalization is intrinsic to the integral graph. On the normalization, an exceptional divisor is a prime divisor independently of its chosen relatively ample line bundle. Those line bundles can have different orders, as the preceding example demonstrates. Finally the Rees algebra of I^n is a Veronese subalgebra of that of I ; a proper nonzero ideal in a domain has strictly smaller powers at any point where it is proper. $\square$

The worst-case presentation has $m_a = \frac{1}{2}a^2 + O(a)$, $q = \frac{1}{2}a^3 + O(a^2)$, and $N = \frac{1}{16}a^6 + O(a^5)$. There are at most $\binom{N}{q}$ candidate maximal minors, with

$$\log \binom{N}{q} = \frac{3}{2}a^3 \log a + O(a^3 + a^2 \log a).$$

This is a size bound, not a practical algorithm. The next theorem replaces this list by a two-generated ideals and at most $a + 1$ curve equations on each chart of an all-order family.

63. A CHAIN MODEL FOR CONTACTS OF ARBITRARY ORDER

For $a \geq 2$ consider the marked family over $S_a = \text{Spec } k[b, c]$

$$[F_0 : F_1 : F_2] = [t^a : bs^a : cst^{a-1}]. \quad (63.1)$$

Let T_a be the closure of its Hilbert graph over $b \neq 0$ in $S_a \times \text{Hilb}^{P_a}(X)$. This is a strict restriction of the coefficient graph. The full fibre product with Γ_a can have additional vertical components and is not the definition of T_a .

Theorem 63.1 (The all-order chain model). *For $m \geq m_a$ set*

$$C = \frac{(a-1)m(m+1)}{2}, \quad E_j = m - j + 1 \quad (1 \leq j < a), \quad E_a = \frac{(m-a+1)(m-a+2)}{2}.$$

The restriction of the evaluation ideal is exactly

$$I_q(M_{a,m})\mathcal{O}_{S_a} = b^C J_{a,m}, \quad J_{a,m} = \prod_{j=1}^a (b, c^j)^{E_j}. \quad (63.2)$$

Its divisorial content is b^C . The ideals $J_{a,m}$ and all their powers are integrally closed, and

$$T_a = \text{Bl}_{J_{a,m}} S_a = \text{Bl}_{K_a} S_a, \quad K_a = \prod_{j=1}^a (b, c^j). \quad (63.3)$$

This surface is smooth. It is obtained by blowing up the origin and then, $a-1$ times, the intersection of the newest exceptional curve with the strict transform of $b=0$. Its exceptional divisors have valuations

$$v_i(b) = i, \quad v_i(c) = 1 \quad (1 \leq i \leq a).$$

The universal curve admits the explicit flat presentations below. The theorem classifies the marked family (63.1) for every a ; it does not identify the whole fibre of $\Gamma_a \rightarrow B_a$ with the fibre of this surface.

63.1. A row factorization, without enumerating minors.

Proof of (63.2). Every column has one nonzero entry. If h, l are the exponents of the second and third forms, that entry is $b^h c^l$ in row $n = i + a(m - h - l) + (a - 1)l$, $0 \leq i \leq m$. A nonzero full minor chooses one column in each row; columns belonging to distinct rows are necessarily distinct. The determinant ideal is therefore the product of the row ideals Q_n .

Put $d = am - n$. Rows with $n \geq am$ have $Q_n = (1)$. For $d \geq 0$ set

$$h_0 = \max \left(0, \left\lceil \frac{d - m}{a - 1} \right\rceil \right), \quad r = d - ah_0.$$

For a fixed h , the smallest feasible l is $\max(0, d - ah)$; feasibility requires $h \geq h_0$. Removing dominated monomials gives

$$Q_n = \begin{cases} (b^{h_0}), & r \leq 0, \\ b^{h_0} (b, c^a)^u (b, c^\rho), & r = au + \rho > 0, \quad 0 \leq \rho < a, \end{cases} \quad (63.4)$$

where the last factor is omitted for $\rho = 0$. In fact the minimal list in the second case is $b^{h_0+v} c^{\max(0, r-av)}$, $0 \leq v \leq \lceil r/a \rceil$. Expanding the right side of (63.4) and discarding dominated terms gives precisely this list.

The sum of the h_0 is $(a - 1)(1 + \dots + m) = C$. Among all rows, a positive residual value $r \in \{1, \dots, m\}$ occurs

$$\nu(r) = \min(a, m - r + 1)$$

times. One occurrence comes from $h_0 = 0$; for $h_0 = h \geq 1$ it comes from $m - a + 2 - h \leq r \leq m - h$. Counting the residual factors gives

$$\sum_{\substack{r \equiv j \pmod{a} \\ 1 \leq r \leq m}} \nu(r) = m - j + 1 \quad (1 \leq j < a), \quad \sum_{r=1}^m \nu(r) \left\lfloor \frac{r}{a} \right\rfloor = \sum_{n=a}^m (n - a + 1) = E_a.$$

For the first equality write $n = r + v$, $0 \leq v < a$, and count each $n \in \{j, \dots, m\}$ once. For the second, at a fixed n sum $\lfloor r/a \rfloor$ over $\max(1, n - a + 1) \leq r \leq n$; the answer is $\max(0, n - a + 1)$. This proves the ideal identity. The argument in fact works for every $m \geq a$; the regularity bound is used only to identify its graph with the Hilbert graph. $\square$

63.2. The Rees algebra and its rays.

Proposition 63.2 (The normal Rees algebra). *Put $\eta_i = \sum_{j=1}^a E_j \min(i, j)$. Then*

$$\mathcal{R}(J_{a,m}) = k[b^u c^v T^n : u, v, n \geq 0, \quad iu + v \geq n\eta_i \ (1 \leq i \leq a)]. \quad (63.5)$$

The right side is already normal, not merely the normalization of the Rees algebra. For the raw ideal in (63.2) replace $u \geq 0$ by $u \geq nC$ and the last inequalities by $iu + v \geq n(iC + \eta_i)$. The exceptional Rees valuations of the primitive ideal are exactly $v_1, \dots, v_a$.

Proof. For a prescribed integer exponent u of b , the least exponent of c in a product of the factors $(b, c^j)^{E_j}$ is obtained by replacing c^j by b first for the largest j . Thus every integer abscissa on the lower Newton boundary has an integer ordinate achieved by an actual monomial generator. Its successive slopes are $-a, \dots, -1$, each with positive integral horizontal length $E_a, \dots, E_1$. The integral lattice points above this boundary are exactly the monomials of the ideal. Replacing E_j by nE_j proves the same assertion for every power. The half-space description of that boundary is $iu + v \geq \eta_i$; adjoining the degree variable proves (63.5). A semigroup cut out by these integral linear inequalities is saturated in its group. Its semigroup algebra is normal. The compact facets have primitive inward normals $(i, 1)$, and their positive lengths show that none is redundant. They give exactly the exceptional prime divisors of the normalized blow-up. The shift by b^{nC} proves the raw formula. The raw ideal also records the nonexceptional strict transform of $b = 0$; this is its content, not an additional exceptional ray. $\square$

Proof of the surface assertions in Theorem 63.1. The graph Rees lemma and removal of b^C give the first equality in (63.3). The normal fan of the computed Newton polygon has, in order, the rays

$$(1, 0), (a, 1), (a-1, 1), \dots, (1, 1), (0, 1).$$

Every adjacent determinant is one. The same fan is obtained when all E_j are replaced by one, proving the second equality and smoothness. Successive subdivisions insert $(1, 1), (2, 1), \dots, (a, 1)$ and give the stated sequence of point blow-ups. Equivalently, a product of positive powers of nonzero ideals is invertible on an integral test scheme exactly when every factor is invertible as a fractional ideal; the blow-up universal property gives the same identification. $\square$

There are $a + 1$ affine charts. The first and last are

$$T_0 = \operatorname{Spec} k[b, k], \quad c = bk; \quad T_a = \operatorname{Spec} k[c, z], \quad b = c^a z.$$

For $1 \leq i < a$ the intermediate chart is

$$T_i = \operatorname{Spec} k[e, h], \quad c = eh, \quad b = e^{i+1} h^i, \quad e = b/c^i, \quad h = c^{i+1}/b. \quad (63.6)$$

Adjacent transition formulas are

$$\begin{aligned} k &= e^{-1}, \quad b = e^2 h \quad (T_0, T_1), \\ e_{i+1} &= h_i^{-1}, \quad h_{i+1} = e_i h_i^2 \quad (1 \leq i < a-1), \\ c &= e_{a-1} h_{a-1}, \quad z = h_{a-1}^{-1} \quad (T_{a-1}, T_a). \end{aligned} \quad (63.7)$$

All further overlaps are compositions of these formulas.

63.3. Low-degree equations for the universal curve. In the source chart $s = 1$, put $x = t/s$. Target coordinates F, G, R remain homogeneous. On T_0 use

$$R - kx^{a-1}G, \quad x^a G - bF. \quad (63.8)$$

On T_i , $1 \leq i < a$, use

$$\begin{aligned} A &= xR - ehF, \\ B_j &= x^{a-j}F^{j-1}G - e^{i+1-j}h^{i-j}R^j \quad (1 \leq j \leq i), \\ C_i &= R^{i+1} - hx^{a-i-1}F^iG. \end{aligned} \quad (63.9)$$

On T_a use

$$A = xR - cF, \quad B_j = x^{a-j}F^{j-1}G - zc^{a-j}R^j \quad (1 \leq j \leq a). \quad (63.10)$$

The ideal sheaves on X are obtained by bihomogenizing these equations and saturating by the source and target irrelevant ideals. In the first chart a convenient global list adds $tR - bksF$ to the bihomogenizations of (63.8); this prevents a spurious component at $s = 0$. In the other charts the listed bihomogenizations already give the following two-source-chart cover.

Proposition 63.3 (Flatness, exhaustion, and overlaps). *Equations (63.8)–(63.10) and (63.7) define the flat universal embedded curve over T_a . They cover all of that curve, including source infinity. Each intermediate chart has a monic Gröbner basis over $k[e, h]$, and the last chart has one over $k[c, z]$. Thus no coefficient stratum is excluded by a division of a leading coefficient.*

Proof. For the intermediate chart choose positive rational weights

$$\text{wt}(F) = \text{wt}(G) = 1, \quad \text{wt}(x) = \alpha, \quad \text{wt}(R) = 1 + \rho\alpha, \quad \frac{a-i-1}{i+1} < \rho < \frac{a-i}{i}, \quad \alpha > 0.$$

Refine by any monomial order. The leading monomials of (63.9) are respectively

$$xR, \quad x^{a-j}F^{j-1}G \quad (1 \leq j \leq i), \quad R^{i+1}.$$

Buchberger reductions are uniform in the coefficient ring. The S -polynomial of A, B_j is $-ehB_{j+1}$ for $j < i$, and is eC_i for $j = i$. The one for A, C_i is hFB_i . For $j < l$, that of B_j, B_l is

$$e^{i+1-l}h^{i-l}R^j((xR)^{l-j} - (ehF)^{l-j}),$$

and reduces by A . The remaining pairs have relatively prime leading monomials. This proves the monic basis assertion and a free standard monomial basis over $k[e, h]$.

For the last chart use lexicographic order $x > F > G > R$. The same reductions replace eh by c and the coefficient of R^j by zc^{a-j} ; the pair A, B_a has relatively prime leading monomials. The first chart eliminates R and leaves the monic hypersurface $x^aG - bF$. These bases make the target-graded coordinate rings flat over their parameter rings. Localizing in a target coordinate and taking the degree-zero part preserves flatness.

For completeness put $y = s/t$ on the other source chart. On every parameter chart the bihomogeneous equations reduce to

$$G = by^aF, \quad R = cyF. \quad (63.11)$$

For example A gives the second equation, and B_1 gives the first; the other equations then vanish. Here F is a unit on the projective target. This is the entire family near source infinity and is flat. On $s, t \neq 0$ the two displayed presentations agree by substitution.

Over the dense parameter torus all the equations are the graph of (63.1). Their flat coordinate algebras are torsion-free over the integral parameter ring, so each is the schematic closure of that generic graph. Substitution of (63.7) therefore identifies the ideal sheaves on each overlap, not merely their reduced supports: both are the same closure in the fixed X . The substitutions of b, c and the identity on $[F : G : R]$ are explicit, so no target automorphism is hidden in this argument. The glued family is projective, flat, and has generic polynomial P_a ; connectedness gives that polynomial on every fibre. Its Hilbert map agrees with the defining map of T_a on a dense open. The graph identification proves that it is the universal curve. $\square$

Proposition 63.4 (Boundary geometry and contractions). *The scheme fibre of $T_a \rightarrow S_a$ at the origin is the reduced chain $E_1 \cup \cdots \cup E_a$, with*

$$E_i^2 = -2 \ (i < a), \quad E_a^2 = -1, \quad E_i E_{i+1} = 1, \quad K_{T_a/S_a} = \sum_{i=1}^a i E_i.$$

If B', C' are the strict transforms of the two axes, then

$$\operatorname{div}(b) = B' + \sum i E_i, \quad \operatorname{div}(c) = C' + \sum E_i.$$

The Picard group is freely generated by the exceptional classes. A relative divisor $D = \sum d_i E_i$ is nef precisely when

$$d_{i-1} - 2d_i + d_{i+1} \geq 0 \ (1 \leq i < a), \quad d_{a-1} - d_a \geq 0, \quad d_0 = 0.$$

Deleting rays gives the toric contraction morphisms. In particular, contracting the intermediate chain between $(i, 1)$ and $(j, 1)$ gives an A_{j-i-1} singularity when $j - i > 1$.

Proof. In an intermediate chart $(b, c) = (e^{i+1}h^i, eh) = (eh)$; at the end charts its pullback is (b) or (c) . Thus the fibre is reduced, with ordinary crossings. The self-intersections follow either from the successive point blow-ups or the relation between adjacent primitive rays. The Jacobian in (63.6) is $e^{i+1}h^i$, and the axis orders are the stated valuations. Each point blow-up adds a free exceptional generator to the Picard group of the preceding smooth surface, starting with $\operatorname{Pic}(\mathbb{A}^2) = 0$. The only contracted complete curves are the E_i , so intersecting with them gives the nef inequalities. Coarsening a fan gives a proper birational toric morphism. The two rays $(i, 1), (j, 1)$ have determinant $j - i$ and lie at height one; the resulting affine surface is the cyclic quotient, equivalently the hypersurface $uv = w^{j-i}$. $\square$

The unweighted ideal K_a is degree-independent and has exactly the required Newton rays, but is not an inclusion-minimal graph ideal. The powers K_a^n already preclude such a minimality assertion. Its boundary chain has a modular meaning for the marked family: it is the universal modification on integral tests on which every (b, c^j) becomes invertible. This is not a proposed intrinsic boundary complex for all pencils of all contact types.

64. EMBEDDED LIMITS AND THE PUNCTUAL GENUS CORRECTION

The parameter fibre of T_a is a reduced chain; its universal curves need not be reduced or Cohen–Macaulay. These are different assertions about different schemes. We now determine both the one-dimensional parts and the embedded zero-dimensional structure of every curve over that chain.

64.1. All formal arcs in the marked family. Let $b = \beta\tau^p$, $c = \gamma\tau^q$, with $p, q > 0$ and $\beta, \gamma \in k[[\tau]]^*$. The units may be arbitrary formal series. The following ideals are written on $s = 1$ with homogeneous target coordinates. At source infinity they are glued to $G = R = 0$; equivalently, take the ideal sheaves specified by Proposition 63.3.

Theorem 64.1 (The complete arc table). *There are a walls $p = jq$, $1 \leq j \leq a$, and $a + 1$ open chambers. The special embedded ideals are as follows:*

$$\mathcal{O}_0 \ (p < q) : \ (R, x^a G), \tag{64.1}$$

$$\mathcal{W}_1 \ (p = q) : \ (R - \kappa x^{a-1} G, x^a G), \quad \kappa = \bar{\gamma}/\bar{\beta}, \tag{64.2}$$

$$\mathcal{O}_i \ (iq < p < (i+1)q) : \ (xR, R^{i+1}, x^{a-j} F^{j-1} G \ (1 \leq j \leq i)), \quad 1 \leq i < a, \tag{64.3}$$

$$\mathcal{W}_j \ (p = jq) : \ (xR, x^{a-r} F^{r-1} G \ (1 \leq r < j), R^j - \lambda x^{a-j} F^{j-1} G), \quad 2 \leq j \leq a, \tag{64.4}$$

$$\mathcal{O}_a \ (p > aq) : \ (xR, x^{a-j} F^{j-1} G \ (1 \leq j \leq a)). \tag{64.5}$$

In (64.4), $\lambda = \bar{\gamma}^j / \bar{\beta}$. Each wall is a one-dimensional family with nonzero residue parameter; each open chamber gives one fixed embedded curve. The closure of the j th wall family is $E_j \simeq \mathbb{P}^1$, with endpoints $\mathcal{O}_{j-1}, \mathcal{O}_j$. These are all components, points, and adjacencies of the parameter fibre of T_a . There is only one normalization branch at every point of this smooth parameter surface. The fan is minimal for these fixed-target embedded limits.

Proof. In the first chart $k = c/b$ has nonnegative valuation exactly when $p \leq q$. Its residue is zero in the first chamber and is κ on the first wall. In T_i the two coordinates have valuations $p - iq$ and $(i + 1)q - p$. Setting their positive-valuation coordinates to zero in (63.9) gives (64.3). Setting $e = 0$ and retaining $h = \lambda \neq 0$ gives the next wall; the lower wall is its expression in the adjacent chart. In the last chart $z = b/c^a$ has nonnegative valuation exactly when $p \geq aq$. Its nonzero residue gives $\mathcal{W}_a$ with $\lambda = \bar{z}^{-1}$; $z = 0$ gives (64.5). Properness and the chart cover exhaust all arcs. If c is identically zero, the first chart gives (64.1) as well.

Every nonzero wall residue is attained by an arc with $p = jq$. The transition formulas identify its two endpoints as stated. The Newton facets in Proposition 63.2 are all present; equivalently, the residue term in (64.2) or (64.4) changes the ideal sheaf as the residue varies. A wall cannot therefore be removed while retaining the embedded limit map. This minimal fan belongs to the marked two-parameter problem, not to an arbitrary coefficient presentation on B_a . $\square$

Theorem 64.2 (A sharp, degree-independent jet bound on the family). *Let a formal arc in S_a be centred at the origin and satisfy $\text{ord}(b) = p < \infty$. Its closed embedded Hilbert limit is determined by the coefficient arc modulo τ^{p+1} . This bound is independent of a and of the Hilbert embedding degree. For every $p \geq 1$ it is optimal as a uniform sufficient bound over arcs with that value of p .*

Proof. If $\text{ord}(c) > p$, including $c = 0$, any congruent arc is still in $\mathcal{O}_0$. Otherwise congruence preserves p, q and the leading coefficients of both b, c . It preserves every wall residue in Theorem 64.1, which proves sufficiency. For necessity take $c = \tau^p$ and $b = \beta\tau^p$ for two different nonzero constants β . The arcs agree modulo τ^p , but the first-wall ideals differ: on $G = 1$, the nonzero class x^{a-1} has $R = \beta^{-1}x^{a-1}$ and $x^a = 0$. Thus that jet does not determine the fixed-target limit. $\square$

Here p is the intersection order with the marked base-point divisor $b = 0$. It is not the raw Smith length. In degree m the latter is

$$\mu = Cp + \sum_{j=1}^a E_j \min(p, jq), \quad (64.6)$$

whereas the primitive degree- m ideal has order given by the sum without Cp , and the unweighted graph ideal has order $\sum_{j=1}^a \min(p, jq)$. These are three distinct quantities, none of which should be substituted for the optimal family bound $p + 1$. For $a = 3, m = 7$, arcs $(b, c) = (\tau, \tau^2)$ and (τ^2, τ^3) have the same special Hilbert curve but raw Smith lengths 84 and 168. Ramifying an arc multiplies all ideal orders, while leaving its embedded closed limit unchanged.

64.2. Local rings and associated points. Let L_0 denote the main component $G = R = 0$. Let L denote the tail $x = R = 0$, and put

$$P = (x = 0, [F : G : R] = [0 : 1 : 0]).$$

All local ideals below are ordinary ideals in the indicated affine rings, before passage to sheaves. Write $H_P^0(\mathcal{O}_C)$ for the largest submodule supported at the closed point P , not for the whole nilradical of a curve with a generically thick tail.

Theorem 64.3 (Pure tails and punctual excess). *For $\mathcal{O}_0$ and $\mathcal{W}_1$ the curve is Cohen–Macaulay, with components L_0, L of generic multiplicities 1, a . For $1 \leq i < a$, the curve $\mathcal{O}_i$ has the same*

two minimal components and multiplicities. On $F = 1$ its ideal is

$$(xR, x^{a-i}G, R^{i+1}) = (G, R) \cap (xR, x^{a-i}, R^{i+1}). \quad (64.7)$$

On $G = 1$ it is

$$(xR, R^{i+1}, x^{a-i}(x, F)^{i-1}). \quad (64.8)$$

There is precisely one embedded associated point when $i \geq 2$, namely P , and none when $i = 1$. Its punctual module is

$$H_P^0(\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{O}_i}) \simeq x^{a-i}k[x, F]/x^{a-i}(x, F)^{i-1}, \quad R \cdot H_P^0 = 0, \quad \text{length } H_P^0 = \binom{i}{2}. \quad (64.9)$$

For $2 \leq j \leq a$ put $d = a - j$. The wall curve $\mathcal{W}_j$ has on $F = 1$ the complete-intersection ideal

$$(xR, R^j - \lambda x^d G). \quad (64.10)$$

On $G = 1$ its ideal is

$$(xR, x^{d+1}(x, F)^{j-2}, R^j - \lambda x^d F^{j-1}). \quad (64.11)$$

Its pure quotient on this chart is obtained by adding x^{d+1} . The kernel is

$$H_P^0(\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{W}_j}) \simeq x^{d+1}k[x, F]/x^{d+1}(x, F)^{j-2}, \quad R \cdot H_P^0 = 0, \quad \text{length } H_P^0 = \binom{j-1}{2}. \quad (64.12)$$

For $j < a$ the minimal components are again L_0, L with multiplicities $1, a$. For $j = a$ the tail is the reduced plane curve $R^a = \lambda F^{a-1}G$. In both cases the only possible embedded point is P , and it occurs exactly when $j \geq 3$.

Proof. Eliminating R in the first two cases leaves a hypersurface, and gives the multiplicities directly. For $\mathcal{O}_i$, localization at F reduces all the monomials in (64.3) to (64.7). The intersection identity follows by monomial divisibility. The second component is primary to (x, R) and is free of rank a over $k[G]$, with transverse basis

$$1, x, \dots, x^{a-i-1}, R, \dots, R^i.$$

The entire ring in (64.7) has a length-two Hilbert–Burch resolution; alternatively its three monomial generators have the two syzygies coming from xR^{i+1} and $x^{a-i}GR$. It is one-dimensional Cohen–Macaulay and has no embedded point.

On $G = 1$ the ideal is (64.8). Adding x^{a-i} gives the pure primary ideal (xR, R^{i+1}, x^{a-i}) . The kernel is generated by the image of x^{a-i} , with annihilator $(R, (x, F)^{i-1})$ on that generator. This proves (64.9). For $i \geq 2$ an explicit primary decomposition is

$$(xR, R^{i+1}, x^{a-i}) \cap (xR, R^{i+1}, (x, F)^{a-1}).$$

The second factor is primary to (x, F, R) . The displayed length is the number of monomials in two variables of total degree below $i - 1$.

For a wall, the equations reduce to (64.10) and (64.11). The former is a regular sequence of length two. In the latter, after adjoining x^{d+1} , there is a free $k[F]$ -basis

$$1, x, \dots, x^d, R, \dots, R^{j-1};$$

the relation $R^j = \lambda F^{j-1}x^d$ and $xR = 0$ give its multiplication. Hence this pure ring is Cohen–Macaulay of rank a over $k[F]$. The kernel of the pure quotient is generated by x^{d+1} and has exactly the annihilator described in (64.12). No extra relation arises from multiplying $R^j - \lambda x^d F^{j-1}$ by x : the resulting $x^{d+1}F^{j-1}$ already lies in $x^{d+1}(x, F)^{j-2}$. A monomial reduction in x, F , followed by reduction in R , proves that these are all the relations. This also computes the length. For $d > 0$ the pure ideal is primary to (x, R) ; for $d = 0$ it is the reduced cuspidal tail ideal $(x, R^a - \lambda F^{a-1})$.

There are no missing associated points. Away from P the F chart or its overlap has just been treated. On $R = 1$ the nonterminal cases have empty special fibre, while on the last wall F, G are units and (64.10) applies. Source infinity is (63.11). These charts cover the curve. $\square$

Theorem 64.4 (The cuspidal wall and its nilradical). *On the last wall, $\mathcal{W}_a$ consists of its reduced curve $L_0 \cup Q_a$ together with a punctual nilradical at P , where*

$$Q_a : x = 0, \quad R^a = \lambda F^{a-1}G.$$

The normalization of Q_a is $\mathbb{P}^1$, with map

$$[u : v] \longmapsto [u^a : \lambda^{-1}v^a : u^{a-1}v]. \quad (64.13)$$

The main component meets Q_a transversely at its smooth point $[1 : 0 : 0]$. Put $g_a = (a-1)(a-2)/2$. The nilradical $\mathcal{N}$ has length g_a and, for $a \geq 3$, nilpotence order $a-1$. More precisely, on $G = 1$ it is the ideal generated by x with

$$\mathcal{N} \simeq xk[x, F]/x(x, F)^{a-2}, \quad R\mathcal{N} = 0, \quad \text{length}(\mathcal{N}^r) = \binom{a-r}{2} \quad (1 \leq r \leq a-2). \quad (64.14)$$

For $a = 2$ it is zero. The Hilbert polynomial of the reduced curve is $(a+1)l + 1 - g_a$; this exact nilradical restores $P_a(l) = (a+1)l + 1$. Thus the punctual part is forced by arithmetic genus, not removable excess in a flat Hilbert limit.

Proof. Set $j = a, d = 0$ in (64.11). The ring is

$$k[x, F, R]/(xR, x(x, F)^{a-2}, R^a - \lambda F^{a-1}).$$

Its reduction is the domain $k[F, R]/(R^a - \lambda F^{a-1})$; the nilradical is exactly (x) . The formula for its module follows from Theorem 64.3. A basis of its r th power consists of $x^u F^v$ with $u \geq r$ and $u + v \leq a-2$. Counting these monomials gives (64.14) and proves the nilpotence statement, including nonvanishing of x^{a-2} . The parametrization (64.13) is birational; on the cusp chart its local semigroup is generated by $a-1, a$. Its missing nonnegative exponents number g_a . The only singularity of the plane tail is that cusp, while at the attaching point $F = 1$ the full reduced local ring is $k[x, R]/(xR)$ after eliminating G . The normalization of the whole reduction is consequently two copies of $\mathbb{P}^1$. A plane curve of degree a has arithmetic genus g_a ; attaching the main line at one point gives the stated reduced Hilbert polynomial. The exact sequence $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{N} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{W}_a} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{(\mathcal{W}_a)_{\text{red}}} \rightarrow 0$ then proves the correction formula. $\square$

Proposition 64.5 (The terminal chamber). *The curve $\mathcal{O}_a$ has three minimal components: L_0 with multiplicity one, the tail $x = G = 0$ with multiplicity one, and the tail $x = F = 0$ with multiplicity $a-1$. Their reduced supports form a chain of three lines. On $F = 1$ the ideal is (G, xR) ; on $G = 1$ it is*

$$(xR, (x, F)^{a-1}).$$

The latter has pure quotient (x, F^{a-1}) and punctual kernel $xk[x, F]/x(x, F)^{a-2}$ of length g_a . On $R = 1$ the ideal is $(x, F^{a-1}G)$, a hypersurface with no embedded point. Thus P is the only embedded associated point when $a \geq 3$, and there is none when $a = 2$. The full nilradical is not just this punctual module: the $F = 0$ tail is generically nonreduced for $a > 2$.

Proof. Localize (64.5) in each target coordinate. On $G = 1$ the monomials $x^{a-j}F^{j-1}$ generate $(x, F)^{a-1}$. Adding x yields the pure ring, free of rank $a-1$ over $k[R]$; the kernel has the stated two-variable basis and is killed by R . On $R = 1$, xR eliminates x and leaves $F^{a-1}G$. These ordinary affine calculations give the minimal multiplicities and all associated points. The normalization of the reduction is the disjoint union of its three lines. The pure plane tail $F^{a-1}G = 0$ has arithmetic genus g_a , so the same length correction also recovers P_a in this terminal chamber. $\square$

64.3. The first higher-contact instance. For $a = 3$ the Gotzmann degree is 7, and

$$I_{29}(M_{3,7})\mathcal{O}_{S_3} = b^{56}(b, c)^7(b, c^2)^6(b, c^3)^{15}. \quad (64.15)$$

The parameter fibre has three components, with self-intersections $-2, -2, -1$. Every one is one-dimensional, their successive intersections are single reduced points, and there are no other intersections or normalization branches. The seven embedded curve families are collected here; each ideal is on $s = 1$.

region	ideal	length H_P^0
$p < q$	(R, x^3G)	0
$p = q$	$(R - \kappa x^2G, x^3G)$	0
$q < p < 2q$	(xR, x^2G, R^2)	0
$p = 2q$	$(xR, x^2G, R^2 - \lambda xFG)$	0
$2q < p < 3q$	(xR, x^2G, xFG, R^3)	1
$p = 3q$	$(xR, x^2G, xFG, R^3 - \lambda F^2G)$	1
$p > 3q$	(xR, x^2G, xFG, F^2G)	1

At the last wall this length-one module is square-zero and is supported at the cusp of the cubic tail. At the preceding open chamber it is an embedded point on a generically triple line. These are different local algebras with the same required Euler-characteristic correction. For $a \geq 4$ the last-wall nilradical is no longer square-zero, as (64.14) shows. This is why the first-contact extension algebra alone cannot describe higher contacts.

The entire S_3 parameter fibre has been classified above, including its universal curves. The full B_3 parameter fibre has more coefficient directions, and no equality with this three-component chain is asserted. The distinction remains important when the marked family is inserted into a local Smith normal form of a pencil.

65. RAMIFICATION AND THE COMPLETE PARAMETER BOUNDARY

Let $a \geq 2$ and retain the marked family and its Hilbert graph T_a from Theorem 63.1. We work over an algebraically closed field k of characteristic zero. For positive integers ρ, σ consider the finite flat coefficient map

$$S' = \text{Spec } k[u, v] \longrightarrow S_a, \quad b = u^\rho, \quad c = v^\sigma.$$

Its pullback family is $[t^a : u^\rho s^a : v^\sigma st^{a-1}]$. Put

$$Y = T_a \times_{S_a} S', \quad Z = Y^\nu, \quad \nu : Z \longrightarrow Y, \quad \pi : Z \longrightarrow S'.$$

Here Y is the retained-coefficient Hilbert graph, whereas Z is its normalization. The closed fibre $F = \pi^{-1}(0)$ is a scheme of *parameters*. It is not one of the embedded curves parameterized by the Hilbert graph. This distinction matters: the conductor of ν , the nilradical of F , and the punctual nilradical of a universal curve fibre are three different objects.

For $1 \leq i \leq a$ define

$$g_i = \gcd(\rho, i\sigma), \quad n_i = (A_i, B_i) = \left(\frac{i\sigma}{g_i}, \frac{\rho}{g_i} \right), \quad e_i = \frac{\rho\sigma}{g_i}, \quad \ell_i = \min(A_i, B_i). \quad (65.1)$$

Also set $n_0 = (0, 1)$ and $n_{a+1} = (1, 0)$, ordered clockwise, and $\Delta_i = |\det(n_i, n_{i+1})|$ for $0 \leq i \leq a$.

Theorem 65.1 (Ramified Hilbert boundary). *The following assertions hold for every a, ρ, σ as above.*

- (1) *The scheme Y is integral, is a local complete intersection, and is the full schematic Hilbert graph of the pulled-back family. Its normalization Z is the normal toric surface with maximal cones $\langle n_i, n_{i+1} \rangle$, $0 \leq i \leq a$. In particular its exceptional prime divisors $D_1, \dots, D_a$ are copies of $\mathbb{P}^1$.*

- (2) The fibre F is Cohen–Macaulay of pure dimension one, with no embedded associated points. Its reduction is a nodal chain of a projective lines, and its generic length along D_i is ℓ_i . Its nilradical $\mathcal{N}_F$ satisfies

$$\mathcal{N}_F^L = 0, \quad L = \max_i \ell_i; \quad \mathcal{N}_F^{L-1} \neq 0 \quad \text{if } L > 1.$$

It is reduced exactly when, for every i , either $\rho \mid i\sigma$ or $i\sigma \mid \rho$.

- (3) On the open orbit of D_i , the normalization maps to the i th exceptional curve of Y with residue degree g_i . The finite map $Z \rightarrow T_a$ has ramification index e_i there. A general closed point of that exceptional curve of Y has exactly g_i distinct normalization lifts. All torus-fixed boundary points have a single normalization lift.
- (4) The conductor, regarded as an ideal on Z , is the divisorial ideal

$$\mathfrak{c}_{Z/Y} = \mathcal{O}_Z \left(- \sum_{i=1}^a \kappa_i D_i \right), \quad \kappa_i = \frac{\rho i \sigma - \rho - i \sigma}{g_i} + 1. \quad (65.2)$$

The notation denotes a reflexive ideal and does not assert that the divisor is Cartier. There is no additional condition supported only at a boundary crossing. In particular, Y is normal if and only if $\rho = 1$.

The theorem concerns the complete boundary of this ramified marked family, not the complete fibre of the full coefficient graph over B_a . None of its multiplicities depends on a choice of Hilbert embedding degree.

65.1. The normalized Rees algebra. For $m \geq m_a$ let E_j and C be the integers of Theorem 63.1, and put

$$I = \prod_{j=1}^a (u^\rho, v^{j\sigma})^{E_j}, \quad \eta_i = \sum_{j=1}^a E_j \min(i, j).$$

The raw evaluation ideal on S' is $u^\rho C I$.

Proposition 65.2 (All powers and all normalization charts). *The integral closure of the Rees algebra of I in $k(u, v)(Q)$ is*

$$\overline{\mathcal{R}(I)} = k \left[u^\alpha v^\beta Q^n : \begin{array}{l} \alpha, \beta, n \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}, \\ i\sigma\alpha + \rho\beta \geq n\rho\sigma\eta_i \quad (1 \leq i \leq a) \end{array} \right]. \quad (65.3)$$

Thus its degree- n part is $\overline{I}^n Q^n$, including $n = 0$. For the raw ideal one replaces $\alpha \geq 0$ by $\alpha \geq n\rho C$ and the right side of the i th inequality by $n\rho\sigma(\eta_i + iC)$. The affine chart for the cone $\tau_i = \langle n_i, n_{i+1} \rangle$ is exactly

$$Z_i = \text{Spec } k[\tau_i^\vee \cap \mathbb{Z}^2]. \quad (65.4)$$

Adjacent charts glue by inverting the characters of their shared face in the common Laurent ring $k[u^{\pm 1}, v^{\pm 1}]$.

Proof. The coefficient map is free with basis $u^j v^k$, $0 \leq j < \rho$, $0 \leq k < \sigma$. Flat base change of the Rees algebra consequently gives $Y = \text{Bl}_I S'$; see the classical flat-base-change lemma for blow-ups [Stacks Project]. The open $uv \neq 0$ is schematically dense by flat base change from T_a . Its coordinate ring is a domain, so Y is integral. The same density identifies Y with the closure of the pulled-back Hilbert section. In particular no separate vertical component has been discarded in this equality.

The Newton polygon of I is the image, under $(x, y) \mapsto (\rho x, \sigma y)$, of the polygon calculated in Proposition 63.2. Its compact supporting inequalities are precisely those in (65.3). All compact edges have positive length. The semigroup of the Rees algebra contains the two degree-zero basis vectors and a degree-one vector, so its group is the whole $\mathbb{Z}^3$. Saturating that semigroup therefore gives the integral lattice points in its rational cone. Indeed, a rational positive combination

becomes an element of the original semigroup after clearing denominators; its monomial is integral. Conversely every supporting valuation is nonnegative on an integral element. The saturated semigroup ring is normal. This is the standard semigroup-normalization theorem [37, Proposition 5 and Section 2.6], here applied to the explicit polygon. It proves the formula in every degree.

The normal fan is unchanged by the positive edge lengths E_j . Its primitive compact rays are exactly n_i , giving (65.4). Normalization commutes with localization, so the stated overlaps give the global normalization, not unrelated normalizations of completed rings. The shift by $u^{n\rho C}$ proves the raw formula and does not change Proj. $\square$

Proposition 65.3 (Singularities and divisor data). *The singularities of Z are precisely those torus-fixed points whose corresponding determinant in the following list is greater than one:*

$$\Delta_0 = \frac{\sigma}{g_1}, \quad \Delta_i = \frac{\rho\sigma}{g_i g_{i+1}} \quad (1 \leq i < a), \quad \Delta_a = \frac{\rho}{g_a}. \quad (65.5)$$

The affine chart has cyclic divisor class group $\mathbb{Z}/\Delta_i\mathbb{Z}$. Its cyclic quotient type is determined without ambiguity by the two primitive rays in (65.4): orient them positively, extend the first to a lattice basis, and write the second as (p, Δ_i) in that basis. The chart is $\mathbb{A}^2/\mu_{\Delta_i}$ with weights $(-p, 1)$, up to swapping the coordinates. For $\Delta_i = 1$ it is smooth. Moreover

$$\operatorname{div}(u) = U' + \sum_i A_i D_i, \quad \operatorname{div}(v) = V' + \sum_i B_i D_i, \quad K_{Z/S'} = \sum_i (A_i + B_i - 1) D_i,$$

where U', V' are the strict transforms of the axes. Rational intersection numbers are

$$D_i D_{i+1} = \Delta_i^{-1}, \quad D_i^2 = -\frac{|\det(n_{i-1}, n_{i+1})|}{\Delta_{i-1} \Delta_i}, \quad D_i D_j = 0 \quad (|i - j| > 1).$$

Proof. The determinant formulas follow by substitution. For a cone generated by primitive vectors r_1, r_2 , its ray sublattice has index $|\det(r_1, r_2)|$. The corresponding toric chart in that sublattice is $\mathbb{A}^2$. The lattice quotient is cyclic because the first ray is primitive; in the indicated basis its generator acts with weights $(-p, 1)$. Primitivity of the second ray implies $\gcd(p, \Delta_i) = 1$, so there are no pseudoreflections and the quotient is smooth exactly for index one. The divisor class group is the cokernel of the map from the character lattice to the free group on the two rays; its Smith form is $(1, \Delta_i)$. Normal surface charts are regular away from their closed toric point.

A character has order its pairing with a primitive ray. This proves the two divisor formulas. The torus form $(du/u) \wedge (dv/v)$ has simple poles on each invariant divisor, which proves the relative canonical formula. The two adjacent invariant divisors meet with rational intersection $1/\Delta_i$: pull back to the finite affine cover, where the axes meet with intersection one and the covering degree is Δ_i . Intersecting the principal-character relations with D_i then gives the displayed self-intersection. These calculations also specify a toric resolution by subdivision into unimodular cones; its curves and intersection numbers are obtained by the same determinant rule. $\square$

65.2. The scheme fibre, not only its cycle. The following elementary lattice observation rules out hidden zero-dimensional embedded components in the parameter fibre.

Lemma 65.4 (The two coordinate ideal on a subdivided surface). *Let τ be a two-dimensional cone inside the first quadrant with primitive boundary vectors l, h , and suppose τ is not the whole first quadrant. In $A = k[\tau^\vee \cap \mathbb{Z}^2]$ one has*

$$(u, v) = \langle u^x v^y : \langle l, (x, y) \rangle \geq \min(l_1, l_2), \quad \langle h, (x, y) \rangle \geq \min(h_1, h_2) \rangle_k. \quad (65.6)$$

The exponents may be negative; the inequalities imply membership in A . The ideal is divisorial, and $A/(u, v)$ is Cohen–Macaulay of dimension one whenever its support is nonempty.

Proof. If both rays are on the same side of $(1, 1)$, either u/v or v/u is regular on the chart, and the ideal is principal. Otherwise write $l = (l_1, l_2)$, $h = (h_1, h_2)$ with $l_1 < l_2$ and $h_1 > h_2$; equality cases belong to the preceding argument. For a lattice point satisfying the displayed inequalities, put $L = x + y$. If $L \leq 0$ and $l_1, h_2 > 0$, the first inequality forces $y > 0$, while the second forces $y < 0$. If one of l_1, h_2 is zero, its inequality instead forces the weak sign, and the other strict inequality gives the contradiction. They cannot both vanish, since the original quadrant was excluded. Thus $L \geq 1$.

If neither $(x - 1, y)$ nor $(x, y - 1)$ belonged to the dual cone, the only possible failed inequalities would be

$$l_1 L + (l_2 - l_1)y < l_2, \quad h_1 L - (h_1 - h_2)y < h_1.$$

The first implies $y \leq 0$ and the second $y > 0$, since $L \geq 1$ and y is integral. This is impossible. Thus the monomial is a multiple of u or v . The reverse inclusion is immediate.

The formula is the intersection of the symbolic valuation ideals of the invariant height-one primes. All noninvariant height-one conditions are supplied by membership in the normal ring A . Consequently this rank-one ideal is reflexive. A reflexive module over a normal surface has depth two at closed points. The exact sequence with middle term A now gives depth at least one for its quotient, as asserted. $\square$

Proof of the fibre assertions in Theorem 65.1. Every maximal cone of Z is a proper subcone of the quadrant, so Lemma 65.4 applies. Globally it says

$$(u, v)\mathcal{O}_Z = \mathcal{O}_Z \left(- \sum_i \ell_i D_i \right). \quad (65.7)$$

The fibre thus has no embedded associated points. Its generic length is the indicated DVR order ℓ_i . Reducing the ideal replaces each positive order by one, so the reduction is the chain of invariant projective lines. At a cone with two exceptional edges, the reduced union has ring $k[z_1, z_2]/(z_1 z_2)$: on the cyclic quotient cover the two axes have invariant coordinate rings generated by the respective Δ_i th powers. Thus the crossings really are nodes, even when the ambient surface is singular.

The radical ideal has order one at every D_i . Its L th power lies in (65.7) by the divisorial description, whereas localization at a divisor of length L shows nonvanishing of the preceding nilradical power if $L > 1$. Finally $\min(\rho, i\sigma)/g_i = 1$ is equivalent to one of the two integers $\rho, i\sigma$ dividing the other. This proves all claims, including the exact nilpotence order rather than only a bound from a cycle. $\square$

66. CONDUCTORS, NORMALIZATION LIFTS, AND LOGARITHMIC COMPATIBILITY

We finish the ramified-boundary theorem by calculating the full conductor ideal. The generic transverse calculation alone would not exclude a further condition at the intersection of two exceptional curves; the depth argument below is what excludes it.

Lemma 66.1 (A reduced binomial curve). *Let r, q be positive integers, let $g = \gcd(r, q)$, and put $r' = r/g$, $q' = q/g$. The normalization of $k[[U, V]]/(U^r - V^q)$ is the product of g power-series rings. On each branch its conductor has order*

$$c = gr'q' - r' - q' + 1,$$

and the length of the total normalization quotient is

$$\delta = \frac{rq - r - q + g}{2}.$$

The same formulas hold with a nonzero scalar multiplying V^q .

Proof. Factor the equation into g distinct factors $U^{r'} - \zeta V^{q'}$. Each branch is parametrized, after multiplying one parameter by a nonzero scalar, by $U = t^{q'}, V = t^{r'}$. Its semigroup is $\langle r', q' \rangle$. In each residue class modulo r' its smallest element is one of jq' , $0 \leq j < r'$. This gives conductor $(r' - 1)(q' - 1)$ and exactly $(r' - 1)(q' - 1)/2$ gaps, including the cases $r' = 1$ or $q' = 1$.

A function supported on only one normalization branch belongs to the original curve ring precisely when its restriction to that branch is divisible, in the branch ring, by the product of the other factors. Indeed their ideals in the two-variable regular ring intersect in their product. That product has order $(g - 1)r'q'$ on the selected branch. To remain in the curve ring after multiplication by every function of its normalization, a further factor of the branch conductor is necessary and sufficient. This gives c .

Two distinct factors have intersection multiplicity $r'q'$. The exact sequence for a union of two principal curves, with last term the intersection ring, shows that their normalization defects add with this intersection multiplicity. Induction over the g factors yields $g(r' - 1)(q' - 1)/2 + \binom{g}{2}r'q'$, which is the stated δ . $\square$

Lemma 66.2 (No isolated conductor condition). *Let A be a two-dimensional Cohen–Macaulay domain essentially of finite type over a field, with finite normalization $\bar{A}$. Its conductor $\{z \in \bar{A} : z\bar{A} \subset A\}$ is a divisorial ideal of $\bar{A}$. It is determined by its orders at the height-one primes of $\bar{A}$.*

Proof. Inside its fraction field one has $A = \bigcap_{\text{ht } \mathfrak{p}=1} A_{\mathfrak{p}}$. For completeness, a failure of this equality would give a finite nonzero quotient $(A + Az)/A$ supported in codimension two. The middle term is torsion-free, hence has depth at least one, while A has depth two. The depth lemma excludes such a zero-dimensional quotient, after localizing at a point of its support.

It follows that the condition $z\bar{A} \subset A$ can be checked in all $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Their normalizations are semilocal one-dimensional normal rings, and the conductor there is an ideal specified by a nonnegative order at each maximal ideal. Finite normalization identifies these with the height-one primes of $\bar{A}$. Intersecting these valuation conditions with $\bar{A}$ gives exactly the conductor; by definition this is a divisorial ideal. Thus no extra condition supported only in codimension two can occur. $\square$

Proof of the conductor and lifting assertions in Theorem 65.1. The first, intermediate, and last charts of Y are respectively

$$\begin{aligned} & k[u, v, \theta]/(v^\sigma - u^\rho \theta), \\ & k[e, h, u, v]/(u^\rho - e^{i+1}h^i, v^\sigma - eh) \quad (1 \leq i < a), \\ & k[u, v, z]/(u^\rho - v^{a\sigma}z). \end{aligned} \tag{66.1}$$

The intermediate rings are free over $k[e, h]$ on the monomials $u^j v^k$ with $j < \rho$, $k < \sigma$; the equations are a regular sequence. The end charts are hypersurfaces. Integrality was proved above. Thus every chart is Cohen–Macaulay and a local complete intersection, as required in the first assertion of the theorem.

On the open orbit of the old exceptional curve E_i , the coordinates c and $w = b/c^i$ are regular, with w invertible. The pulled-back chart there has equation

$$u^\rho = wv^{i\sigma}. \tag{66.2}$$

At a closed point $w = w_0 \neq 0$, a formal root of the unit w removes it from the equation. Lemma 66.1, with $r = \rho, q = i\sigma$, gives g_i geometric branches and conductor order κ_i . The transverse normalization defect is

$$\delta_i = \frac{\rho i\sigma - \rho - i\sigma + g_i}{2}. \tag{66.3}$$

These formulas also descend to the generic point: the residue field extension is generated by the character

$$\zeta_i = \frac{u^{\rho/g_i}}{v^{i\sigma/g_i}}, \quad w = \zeta_i^{g_i}. \quad (66.4)$$

The numerator and denominator have equal order on D_i , and their exponent difference is primitive in the perpendicular lattice. Hence ζ_i is a coordinate on its open orbit and the residue degree is exactly g_i .

Under the lattice map $\text{diag}(\rho, \sigma)$ the ray n_i maps to $e_i(i, 1)$. This proves the ramification index, with $e_i g_i = \rho\sigma$, in agreement with the total covering degree. These are the usual lattice ramification rules for toric covers [38, Definition 1 and Lemma 1]; here both the ray and residue character are explicit. The power map $\zeta_i \mapsto \zeta_i^{g_i}$ has exactly g_i points above a nonzero closed residue and a single point above each endpoint. The chart semigroups in (66.1) have the same cones as their saturations, so each torus-fixed point also has one preimage. This proves the assertions about lifts on the whole boundary.

Off the exceptional chain, Y and Z both coincide with S' , so there is no other conductor divisor. Lemma 66.2 applied to (66.1) extends the computed orders across every crossing and proves (65.2). For $\rho = 1$ all orders vanish, so the conductor is the unit ideal and $Y = Z$. If $\rho > 1$, then $a\sigma \geq 2$ and the binomial formula gives $\kappa_a > 0$. Thus Y is not normal. This completes the proof of the theorem. $\square$

66.1. Equal-power covers: an explicit conductor on every chart. The conductor theorem includes unequal powers and singular normal charts. In the equal-power case there is a simpler algebraic form which also checks the global conductor at crossings directly.

Corollary 66.3 (Equal-power conductor). *If $\rho = \sigma = d$, the normalized surface Z is the smooth chain model in the coordinates u, v . Its fibre over $0 \in S'$ is reduced, but v has d lifts over every nonendpoint point of each old exceptional curve, and*

$$\mathfrak{c}_{Z/Y} = \mathcal{O}_Z \left(-(d-1) \sum_{i=1}^a i D_i \right), \quad \delta_i = i \binom{d}{2}.$$

On an intermediate normalization chart $k[E, H]$ one has

$$u = E^{i+1} H^i, \quad v = EH, \quad e = E^d, \quad h = H^d,$$

and the conductor is the principal ideal (u^{d-1}) . On the first chart it is again (u^{d-1}) ; on the last chart, with $u = v^a Z_0$, it is $(v^{a(d-1)})$.

Proof. Here $g_i = d$, so $n_i = (i, 1)$ and $\ell_i = 1$. The theorem proves all numerical and global statements. To verify the interior ideal without omitting a possible condition at $E = H = 0$, write

$$A_i = k[E^d, H^d, E^{i+1} H^i, EH] \subset k[E, H].$$

The exponent semigroup is the disjoint union

$$\coprod_{0 \leq j, k < d} ((i+1)j + k, ij + k) + d\mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}^2.$$

Indeed the monic relations in (66.1) reduce to this list, whose residue pairs modulo d are distinct. The exponent $c = ((i+1)(d-1), i(d-1))$ plus any nonnegative lattice point belongs to this union: choose j from the coordinate difference modulo d , then k from the second coordinate modulo d ; each representative coordinate is at most the corresponding coordinate of c plus $d-1$. Congruence modulo d therefore makes the two remainders nonnegative multiples of d . Conversely if either coordinate is smaller than that of c , increase the other coordinate until the residue pair

has $j = d - 1$. The resulting point is outside the union. The conductor is therefore exactly the rectangle $c + \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}^2$, namely (u^{d-1}) .

On the first chart the semigroup of $k[u, uK, K^d] \subset k[u, K]$ is $\{(x, y) : x \geq y \bmod d\}$, giving conductor (u^{d-1}) . On the last chart that of $k[v, v^a Z_0, Z_0^d]$ satisfies $x \geq a(y \bmod d)$, giving $(v^{a(d-1)})$. The adjacent substitutions of (63.7), with b, c replaced by u, v , make these generators differ by units on overlaps. This verifies the claimed global ideal directly. $\square$

Example 66.4 (Third contact with unequal ramification). For $a = 3$, $\rho = 2$, $\sigma = 3$, the exceptional rays are $(3, 2), (3, 1), (9, 2)$. The chart indices, from the v -axis to the u -axis, are $3, 3, 3, 2$. Thus the normalized surface has four cyclic quotient singularities. The boundary generic lengths are $2, 1, 2$, so its nilradical is nonzero and square-zero, with no embedded associated point. The residue degrees are $1, 2, 1$, the ramification indices are $6, 3, 6$, and the conductor orders are $2, 3, 8$. The corresponding transverse defects are $1, 3, 4$. These numbers distinguish four different structures: the cyclic quotient singularities of the normalization, the nonreduced parameter fibre, the failure of normality of Y , and the branch identifications made by its Hilbert coordinates.

66.2. Compatibility as marked logarithmic geometry. Let $\partial S'$ denote the two coordinate axes and let ∂Z be their strict transforms together with the full reduced exceptional chain. These are the toroidal boundaries; their logarithmic structures are the sheaves of functions invertible off the boundaries, with their usual maps to the structure sheaves.

Proposition 66.5 (Principalization and compatible root covers). *The fan of Z is the coarsest subdivision of the quadrant on which each function*

$$(p, q) \mapsto \min(\rho p, j\sigma q), \quad 1 \leq j \leq a,$$

is linear on every cone. Equivalently, Z is the terminal normal toric modification making all $(u^\rho, v^{j\sigma})$ invertible. The same terminal property holds among normal integral S' -schemes whose inverse image of the coefficient torus is dense and on which all these ideals become invertible.

The pair is log crepant:

$$K_Z + \partial Z = \pi^*(K_{S'} + \partial S').$$

In particular it is log canonical. Replacing u, v by U^r, V^s and normalizing the pullback gives, canonically, $Z_{a, \rho r, \sigma s}$. These identifications are associative under successive root covers. The construction also glues under changes $u \mapsto \epsilon u, v \mapsto \eta v$ by units, or on a smooth surface with two specified transverse Cartier divisors.

Proof. The bend of the j th function is the ray n_j . Every such ray is necessary, and their ordered subdivision makes every function linear. On a toric chart, linearity is precisely the condition that one monomial generator divides the other. This proves the fan and toric universal statements.

For a general test, the product ideal is invertible if and only if all its factors are invertible: locally a factor of an invertible product of nonzero fractional ideals has a fractional inverse. The blow-up property therefore gives a unique map to Y . Pull back the finite normalization $Z \rightarrow Y$ and close the unique generic section over the dense coefficient torus. This is a finite birational integral scheme over the normal test and is consequently isomorphic to it. This proves the lift to Z and its uniqueness.

The logarithmic canonical equality follows from the torus form used in Proposition 65.3. A toric subdivision resolving the cyclic cones pulls back the same equality to a smooth surface with a simple normal crossing boundary. That pair is log canonical, which proves the assertion downstairs. This is a statement about a parameter-space pair, not stable or semistable reduction of the universal curves.

Normalization of the successive pullbacks is integral closure in the same field $k(U, V)$. Transitivity of integral dependence gives the canonical identification, and uniqueness gives associativity.

In lattice terms it is composition of the diagonal maps; no arbitrary refinement is inserted. Unit changes preserve each ideal $(u^\rho, v^{j\sigma})$. On a surface with ordered transverse divisors the ideals are intrinsically $\mathcal{O}(-\rho U) + \mathcal{O}(-j\sigma V)$, so their normalized blow-ups glue. The conclusions are local in smooth or étale coordinate charts. They do not identify fans after arbitrary unmarked coordinate changes. $\square$

Corollary 66.6 (Fibres of toric surface modifications). *Let $W \rightarrow \mathbb{A}^2$ be any normal toric modification obtained by a finite nontrivial subdivision of the first quadrant. If its interior primitive rays are (p_j, q_j) , the fibre over the origin is a pure one-dimensional Cohen–Macaulay scheme. Its reduction is a nodal chain of projective lines, with generic lengths $\min(p_j, q_j)$ and nilradical of exact order $\max_j \min(p_j, q_j)$. In particular, it is reduced exactly when every interior ray has a coordinate equal to one. This assertion does not use the failure algebra or the reconstruction theorem.*

Proof. Apply Lemma 65.4 on every cone of the subdivision and then the argument proving (65.7). Every maximal cone is proper because the subdivision is nontrivial. The invariant divisors over the origin are exactly the interior rays, and their ordered orbit closures form the claimed chain. $\square$

66.3. The embedded curves and the information lost by normalization. The flat universal curve on Y is the pullback of the family on T_a ; its further pullback to Z remains flat. This normalizes the *parameter space*, not the embedded curve. Consequently every wall and chamber ring of Theorem 64.1, including the genus-correction nilradical of Theorem 64.4, is retained unchanged at its specified residue.

Corollary 66.7 (Hilbert equality and normalization labels). *For a coefficient arc with positive orders $p = \text{ord } u$, $q = \text{ord } v$, the normalized wall rays are $pp = i\sigma q$. On such a wall the additional normalization coordinate is*

$$\overline{u^{\rho/g_i} / v^{i\sigma/g_i}} \in k^*.$$

The embedded curve remembers only its g_i th power. Thus if $g_i > 1$, equal retained coefficients and equal embedded Hilbert limits need not give equal normalization points. Every such root label is realized by an actual generically base-point-free arc. In the interiors of the adjacent cones all arcs meet the unique corresponding torus-fixed point.

Proof. The valuation vector lies in the unique cone of the normal fan containing it in its relative interior. On a ray the primitive perpendicular character is (66.4); its power is the wall parameter b/c^i of the old Hilbert graph. The map to that graph therefore identifies exactly the g_i roots on the open orbit. Choose $u = \beta\tau^{A_i}$, $v = \gamma\tau^{B_i}$; since $\gcd(\rho/g_i, i\sigma/g_i) = 1$, the expression $\beta^{\rho/g_i} / \gamma^{i\sigma/g_i}$ takes every nonzero value. These arcs have $u \neq 0$ generically. The assertion for two-dimensional cones follows directly from the affine character charts. This is an explicit distinction between a Hilbert point and a normalization lift, not a classification of target-automorphism orbits. $\square$

67. COORDINATE DESCENT AND COMPARISONS OF COMPACTIFICATIONS

We first give an actual gluing statement at a fixed degree. It removes the dependence on a monic pivot chart without identifying constructions with different generic Hilbert polynomials.

Theorem 67.1 (Equivariant gluing of the fixed-degree graphs). *Put*

$$\mathcal{P}_a = \mathbb{P}(H^0(\mathbb{P}^1, \mathcal{O}(a)) \otimes k^3), \quad H_a = \text{Hilb}^{P_a}(\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^2),$$

and let $\mathcal{U}_a \subset \mathcal{P}_a$ be the base-point-free locus. The closure

$$\mathcal{G}_a = \overline{\{(F, [\text{graph}(F)]) : F \in \mathcal{U}_a\}} \subset \mathcal{P}_a \times H_a$$

is an integral projective compactification of the graph of degree- a morphisms with their coefficients retained. It carries a flat universal embedded curve and a compatible $\mathrm{PGL}_2 \times \mathrm{PGL}_3$ action. On every monic pivot patch it is isomorphic, after the specified undoing of a target change, to $\mathbb{A}^2 \times \Gamma_a$. These patch isomorphisms satisfy the cocycle identity on all overlaps, including boundary points. The normalization also carries the action. The morphism

$$[\mathcal{G}_a/(\mathrm{PGL}_2 \times \mathrm{PGL}_3)] \longrightarrow [\mathcal{P}_a/(\mathrm{PGL}_2 \times \mathrm{PGL}_3)]$$

is representable and proper, with projective pullback to a scheme trivializing the group torsor.

Proof. The Hilbert scheme is projective and separated, so the closure is projective and integral and is an isomorphism over $\mathcal{U}_a$. Pullback of the universal Hilbert family is flat. A pair of source and target automorphisms takes a graph to the graph of the transformed map, preserves $\mathcal{O}(1, 1)$, and hence acts on its Hilbert scheme. It preserves the closure and its universal curve.

Here are the patch maps explicitly. Choose a source point where some coordinate form is nonzero, send it to $[0 : 1]$, and permute that target coordinate into position zero. In the projective coefficient patch normalize its t^a coefficient to one and write

$$F_0 = f^h, \quad F_1 = \alpha_1 f^h + g^h, \quad F_2 = \alpha_2 f^h + r^h, \quad \deg g, \deg r < a.$$

This identifies the coefficient patch with $\mathbb{A}^2 \times B_a$. The target matrix and its inverse are

$$U(\alpha) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ -\alpha_1 & 1 & 0 \\ -\alpha_2 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad U(\alpha)^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ \alpha_1 & 1 & 0 \\ \alpha_2 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (67.1)$$

The first matrix identifies the graph with the polynomial-contact graph; the second returns it to the original fixed target. Since the product with $\mathbb{A}^2$ is flat, taking the closure of the generic graph commutes with this product. Thus the closure on the patch is exactly the asserted product, with its scheme structure.

The patches cover $\mathcal{P}_a$: a nonzero form cannot vanish at $a + 1$ distinct chosen source points, so finitely many such choices and the three target pivots suffice. On an overlap the change is the composition of the actual source matrices, the target permutations, and (67.1). Its inverse reverses that composition. The product of the matrices on a triple overlap is the identity as a projective transformation. The induced Hilbert maps therefore satisfy the same identity. No comparison based only on reduced closed points is used.

For normalization, the product of the smooth connected group with the normal variety $\mathcal{G}_a^\nu$ is normal. The action composed with normalization is dominant and lifts uniquely to the normalization; uniqueness proves the action identities. Finally an equivariant morphism induces a representable map of the quotient stacks. After a torsor is trivialized its pullback is the projective morphism $\mathcal{G}_a \rightarrow \mathcal{P}_a$; properness descends. $\square$

This theorem glues *all* pivot charts of a fixed-degree rational-map problem. Its construction is classical graph compactification; the explicit patch maps state exactly how the contact graphs sit in it. It is not a gluing of every Smith and Kronecker stratum of every quadratic-pencil Hilbert problem. In particular, an adjugate tuple that vanishes identically supplies no point of $\mathcal{P}_a$.

Corollary 67.2 (Moving contacts and mixed target coefficients). *Over $\mathbb{A}_\alpha^1 \times S_a$ the family*

$$((x - \alpha)^a, b, c(x - \alpha)^{a-1})$$

has strict Hilbert graph $\mathbb{A}_\alpha^1 \times T_a$, with the universal curve obtained by substituting $x - \alpha$ for x . Over the further open parameter space $1 - uv \neq 0$, the same statement holds for

$$((x - \alpha)^a, b + uc(x - \alpha)^{a-1}, vb + c(x - \alpha)^{a-1}), \quad (67.2)$$

after undoing the target matrix $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & u \\ 0 & v & 1 \end{pmatrix}$. For $a = 2$ both latter coordinate polynomials can have nonzero constant and linear terms. This family is an equivariant enlargement of the marked slice, not the unrestricted six-coefficient contact family.

Proof. Translation is a source automorphism over $\mathbb{A}_\alpha^1$. The indicated target matrix is invertible precisely on the stated open, with inverse lower block $(1 - uv)^{-1} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -u \\ -v & 1 \end{pmatrix}$. They identify the entire ambient families, not just their generic fibres. Applying these isomorphisms to the flat universal curve and its graph closure proves the result. $\square$

Proposition 67.3 (Conservation of the Hilbert polynomial). *A projective flat finitely presented family over a connected base cannot have, as its fibres, just the graphs of morphisms of two different degrees. A degree drop from a to $a - d$ in a limit of $\mathcal{G}_a$ must be accompanied by additional scheme structure whose Hilbert polynomial contributes the missing degree and Euler characteristic. The extra structure may include punctual nilpotents, as in Theorem 64.4.*

Proof. The Hilbert polynomial for $\mathcal{O}(1, 1)$ is locally constant in a projective flat family, whereas the two graphs have polynomials $(a + 1)l + 1$ and $(a - d + 1)l + 1$. These differ for $d > 0$. In a fixed-degree Hilbert compactification the polynomial is retained by the whole limiting scheme, not by deleting its tails or embedded associated points. $\square$

Thus comparison across different generic polynomials cannot consist of an equality of the unaugmented flat graph functors. The horizontal comparison and common-refinement results in Section 60 continue to apply on a fixed dense open with a fixed generic embedded quotient. They are not changed into a false full-pullback statement by the equivariant gluing above.

67.1. Tropical data, residues, and coordinate changes.

Proposition 67.4 (Comparison of coefficient presentations). *For a finite list of polynomial projective coordinates, the finite weight-layer and residue construction of Theorem 58.1 extends to exact monomial profiles with nonnegative weights, including specified unit coordinates, and to polynomial coordinates translated about any fixed centre. It gives finitely many algebraic families of closed projective points, not finitely many embedded curves or abstract isomorphism types.*

Under an invertible monomial change of coefficient torus coordinates, the weights transform by the exponent matrix and the residues by the same monomial substitution; the finite partitions have a common pullback refinement. Under a general polynomial coordinate change, the corresponding statement holds after composing the projective coordinate polynomials with that change. An exact monomial arc need not remain monomial in the new coordinates, and the two displayed fans need not be isomorphic.

Proof. Expand each of the finitely many polynomials into its finite monomial support, after any specified translation or polynomial substitution. The equalities of weights partition the nonnegative orthant into a finite rational polyhedral arrangement. Within a cone, group terms of equal weight and partition the residue torus by the first nonzero coefficient sum in each polynomial. Zero polynomials are kept as zero; identically zero input coordinates are a separate designated pattern. Every choice is finite, and the residual vector is polynomial on each locally closed piece. Weight zero introduces constant residue terms but does not change the argument. For a monomial substitution the weight and residue formulas follow directly from substitution. For a polynomial substitution repeat the finite expansion on the original monomial arc; this compares the resulting points even when there is no transformation of fans by a linear weight map. For localized-polynomial changes work on an open where denominators are units and clear them by a common denominator, which does not change the projective map. $\square$

Applied to maximal minors, valuations are realizable valuated-matroid data: the minors satisfy all Plücker equations, and the minimum valuation in each nonzero relation is attained at least twice. On the coordinate stratum of the nonzero minors these are points of the tropicalization of that Grassmannian stratum, as in Speyer–Sturmfels [Speyer–Sturmfels(2004), Theorem 2.1 and Section 3]. It is not enough to check only a selected set of tropical quadratic relations and then claim realizability. Valuations forget residues; our first wall already has the same valuations for every $\kappa \neq 0$ but different embedded ideals. The primitive Hilbert vector retains these residues and determines the degree- m kernel. It does not select among normalization branches over a graph point.

On S_a the individual nonzero minors are monomials. The normal fan of their Newton polygon is exactly the chain fan, after removal of content; all its walls are effective. This identifies the computed fan with the restriction to nonnegative weights of the state fan of this marked torus orbit, in the classical initial-ideal setting of [Bayer–Morrison(1988)]. No such minimality claim is made for the full coefficient-support arrangement. In comprehensive Gröbner terminology, which organizes specializations by leading-coefficient conditions [Manubens–Montes(2006)], Proposition 63.3 gives a particularly simple system: a single monic basis on every affine parameter chart, with no further coefficient conditions. Its explicit standard monomials, rather than a Hilbert-scheme elimination, recover the curve ideals.

Proposition 67.5 (Equality up to a target automorphism). *Let two embedded curves with polynomial P_a have degree- m ideal kernels $K, K' \subset H^0(X, \mathcal{O}(m, m))$, $m \geq m_a$. They differ by a target automorphism exactly when there is $A \in \mathrm{PGL}_3$ for which*

$$(1 \otimes \mathrm{Sym}^m A^*)K' = K.$$

This is an invariant, finite algebraic criterion: equality of the two fixed-rank subspaces is given by rank conditions, with $\det A \neq 0$. It does not classify abstract curve isomorphisms. On a fixed wall of the marked family, all nonzero residue values are related by a diagonal target automorphism, although their fixed-target Hilbert points differ.

Proof. An automorphism acts on sections by pullback. The Hilbert immersion in degree m makes equality of the kernels equivalent to equality of ideal sheaves. This proves both implications and the algebraic criterion. Scaling F, G, R independently scales κ , or scales λ by the ratio between R^j and $F^{j-1}G$; every nonzero ratio is available over k . No assertion about different walls is needed for this last observation. $\square$

67.2. A concrete comparison with Quot and stable-map limits.

Proposition 67.6 (A Quot contraction of the entire exceptional chain). *The marked family defines a flat quotient on the fixed source*

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(-a) \xrightarrow{(t^a, bs^a, cst^{a-1})} \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}^{\oplus 3} \longrightarrow \mathcal{Q} \longrightarrow 0 \quad (67.3)$$

over all of S_a . The resulting morphism from T_a to the fixed-source Quot scheme is constant on its entire exceptional chain. The common central quotient is

$$\mathcal{Q}_0 \simeq \mathcal{O}_{a[1:0]} \oplus \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}^{\oplus 2}.$$

After adding three fixed source markings away from $[1 : 0]$, this also gives stable quotients in the sense of Marian–Oprea–Pandharipande. In contrast, the Hilbert map distinguishes every point of the chain.

Proof. The first coordinate t^a makes the sheaf map fibrewise injective, even when $b = c = 0$. Both source and target bundles are flat over S_a ; the fibrewise injectivity criterion for this finite-presentation sequence gives flatness of its cokernel over S_a . Thus it defines a morphism to the

Quot scheme already before the blow-up. At the origin the sequence is multiplication by t^a in its first summand, which gives the stated quotient. Its pullback along $T_a \rightarrow S_a$ therefore contracts the chain. The Hilbert map on that chain is a closed immersion because T_a is a closed graph in $S_a \times H_a$. For three markings the source is stable, the torsion is away from the markings, and $\omega_{\mathbb{P}^1}(p_1 + p_2 + p_3) \otimes \mathcal{O}(a\epsilon)$ has positive degree for every $\epsilon > 0$. These verify the actual stability conditions of [Marian–Oprea–Pandharipande(2011), Section 2]; no unstable unmarked rational source is being called a stable quotient. $\square$

Corollary 67.7 (Non-Cohen–Macaulay limits of smooth rational graphs). *For each $a \geq 3$ the Hilbert closure of smooth rational graphs in $\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^2$ with polynomial P_a contains a curve whose reduction is a line attached to a rational cuspidal plane curve of degree a , and whose punctual nilradical has length g_a and nilpotence order $a - 1$. This curve is invisible as a distinct punctual structure to the associated-cycle map. It is not the scheme-theoretic image of a map from a reduced nodal curve.*

Proof. Take $b = \tau^a, c = \tau$. The generic graph is smooth because its projection to the source is an isomorphism. Its limit is $\mathcal{W}_a$ with $\lambda = 1$, so Theorem 64.4 proves the first assertions. An associated one-cycle records generic lengths at one-dimensional components and discards finite-length submodules. Finally the scheme-theoretic image of a morphism from a reduced scheme is reduced: if a local target function has a power mapping to zero, its pullback is nilpotent and hence zero. The asserted nonreduced curve cannot be such an image. This does not rule out comparison spaces between stable-map and Hilbert compactifications; it rules out identifying this Hilbert limit with the unmodified scheme image of a stable map. $\square$

This application is independent of the finite failure algebra and of Paper I. General comparisons between stable maps and stable quotients already involve spaces dominating both constructions [Manolache(2014)]; the explicit contraction above is a different, fixed-source Hilbert-to-Quot calculation, not a replacement for those virtual-class comparison theorems.

67.3. Return to the reconstructed pencil. A specified effective failure family first reconstructs its pencil by Paper I. Wherever its fixed-target contact comparison lands in B_a , the graph in Theorem 67.1 supplies compatible models under source and target frame changes. If its coefficient map factors through (63.1) or (67.2), the chain, all local rings, and the punctual modules above pull back as strict horizontal families. The inherited complete-quadric comparison determines the target in that application; forgetting that target and its coefficient map would lose the meaning of the embedded limit. This statement does not identify every complete-quadric Hilbert component with $\mathcal{G}_a$, does not cover an identically zero adjugate tuple, and does not turn Kronecker data alone into a higher-corank fibre classification. No boundary operation on an isolated unframed multiplication table is inferred.

APPENDIX A. EXTENSION CLASSES AND NORMALIZED RAMIFICATION CHARTS

We record two local consequences that separate properties of the embedded curve from properties of its parameter space.

A.1. The presentation complex and explicit splitting. For a polynomial presentation $R = P/J$ and an R -module N , square-zero $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra extensions with specified kernel N and specified quotient R are classified by $\text{Ext}_R^1(L_{R/\mathbb{C}}, N)$. We use cohomological degrees: J/J^2 is in degree -1 and $\Omega_{P/\mathbb{C}} \otimes_P R$ in degree 0 . The group is

$$\text{coker}(\text{Hom}_R(\Omega_{P/\mathbb{C}} \otimes_P R, N) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_R(J/J^2, N)).$$

Indeed a lift of polynomial generators gives a conormal map; changing lifts changes it by a derivation. The part of the cotangent complex in degrees at most -2 contributes only in Ext

degrees at least two when the target is in degree zero. This justifies truncation for this particular group, not a claim that the whole cotangent complex is two-term.

In the chart of Theorem 55.1, invert C . Then the extension algebra is explicitly

$$\mathbb{C}[\lambda, A, B, C, C^{-1}, n]/(n^2, An, Bn), \quad e = n/C.$$

Writing its elements as $r + an$ gives multiplication $(r + an)(s + bn) = rs + (rb + sa)n$, where the coefficients of n are restricted modulo (A, B) . This is the actual split algebra on this chart. On an overlap of two obstruction charts, let ξ_i be the conormal representative obtained from the same algebra extension. A change of polynomial lifts changes ξ_i by a derivation. Therefore $[\xi_i] = [\xi_j]$ under the induced overlap map on the Ext sheaves. Taking the trivialization that sends 1 to $[\xi_i]$ makes the overlap function exactly 1, rather than an unspecified unit. This proves the asserted trivialization of the local obstruction sheaf. It does not trivialize the nilradical line bundle on the singular-conic plane, and it does not identify the entire global hyper-Ext group with its sheaf of local degree-one groups. The singular-conic plane is the locus where the linear part of the conic equation at the attaching point vanishes; the doubled-line curve is its discriminant-zero locus. Thus the support of the embedded associated subvariety and the obstruction to an algebra retraction are different loci.

Proposition A.1 (Singularities and divisor classes after ramification). *Let $m \geq 1$ and put $g = \gcd(m, 2)$. For the normalized transverse surface in Theorem 55.3, the character lattice and its saturated semigroup are*

$$M_m = \{(a, b) \in \mathbb{Z}^2 : a - 2b \equiv 0 \pmod{m}\}, \quad M_m \cap \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^2.$$

The primitive rays of the dual cone in $N_m = \text{Hom}(M_m, \mathbb{Z})$ are $(1/g, 0)$ and $(0, 1)$. Its divisor class group is $\mathbb{Z}/(m/g)$. For odd m it is the cyclic quotient of type $\frac{1}{m}(1, -2)$; it is smooth for $m = 1$ and has a unique singular point for every odd $m > 1$. For even $m = 2q$ it is of type $\frac{1}{q}(1, -1)$, with equation $eh = \tau^q$; it is smooth for $q = 1$ and has a unique singular point otherwise. In the full chart the additional coordinate λ gives the product with an affine line. The singular locus is correspondingly empty or that line.

Proof. The exponent lattice and its saturation were computed in Theorem 55.3. Their dual lattice is $N_m = \mathbb{Z}^2 + \mathbb{Z}(1/m, -2/m)$. On the first coordinate axis its primitive nonzero vector is $(1/g, 0)$; on the second it is $(0, 1)$. This follows by solving the congruence in the unused coordinate. The index of the lattice generated by these two rays in N_m is m/g . The torus-invariant divisor sequence is the cokernel of

$$M_m \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}^2, \quad (a, b) \longmapsto (a/g, b).$$

For odd m its image is $a - 2b \equiv 0 \pmod{m}$. For even $m = 2q$ write $a = 2a'$; its image is $a' - b \equiv 0 \pmod{q}$. In both cases the cokernel is the stated cyclic group. This computes the class group of the normal affine toric surface, including the smooth cases.

For odd m neither weight has a nontrivial stabilizer on a coordinate axis away from the origin. The quotient is therefore smooth away from the origin. Its cone is unimodular exactly when $m = 1$, proving singularity at the origin otherwise. For even m taking invariants under the order-two pseudoreflexion first gives coordinates s^2, r with residual opposite weights of order q . The displayed hypersurface and its derivatives prove the remaining assertions. Formation of the product with the independent coordinate does not change this transverse analysis. $\square$

Lemma A.2 (Gluing integral closures). *Let an integral Noetherian scheme be covered by affine charts $\text{Spec } A_i$ in a fixed function field. Their integral closures in that field glue to its normalization. In particular the ramified invariant charts and the unchanged primitive charts in Theorem 55.3 glue without a choice of a cyclic cover or an ordering of branches.*

Proof. Integral closure commutes with localization. One implication is immediate by localizing a monic equation. For the other, clear the finitely many denominators in a monic equation for an element integral over a localization: a suitable multiple of that element by an element of the multiplicative set is integral over the original ring. Thus both chart normalizations restrict to the same ring on every principal overlap. Affine refinements and the cocycle identity of localization give the gluing. All rings here are finite-type over $\mathbb{C}$, so these normalizations are finite. $\square$

APPENDIX B. DESCENT AND THE SCHEME STRUCTURE OF THE CONTACT CHARTS

This section records the descent, exactness, and overlap arguments used by the contact theorems. In particular, formal coordinates are never used as a substitute for an algebraic family in the fixed target. The coefficient projection is retained in every graph point.

B.1. The category of embedded deformations. Fix a framed coefficient atlas S , a central point s , and a central embedded curve. The test category has objects (A, β) , where A is a local Artin $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra with residue field $\mathbb{C}$ and $\beta : \widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{S,s} \rightarrow A$ is a local map. Its morphisms are local algebra maps commuting with β . The Hilbert deformation functor is covariant on this algebra category, or contravariant on the opposite category of test schemes. It is *set-valued*: an object is an embedded ideal quotient, and two objects are equal only when their ideals in the fixed target coincide. No automorphism group of the target is divided out.

Let $X = \text{CQ}(V)$, let $\mathcal{L}$ be the universal pencil line, and let $\mathcal{Y} = \mathcal{L} \times_{\mathbb{P}(\text{Sym}^2 V)} X$. For each completed contact neighbourhood the comparison diagram is

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \widehat{\mathcal{Y}}_{i,A} & \xrightarrow{\Theta_i} & \widehat{\mathcal{N}}_{i,A} & \xrightarrow{\Theta_i^{-1}} & \widehat{\mathcal{Y}}_{i,A} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \widehat{\mathcal{L}}_{i,A} & = & \widehat{\mathcal{L}}_{i,A} & = & \widehat{\mathcal{L}}_{i,A}. \end{array} \quad (\text{B.1})$$

The last upper object maps to $X \times \text{Spec } A$ by the original incidence embedding. The middle upper object is the normal-coordinate graph target, not a new fixed target. The operation producing a Hilbert quotient always includes the last arrow. On a common domain of two choices define $\Phi_{ji} = \Theta_j \Theta_i^{-1}$. Then

$$\Phi_{kj} \Phi_{ji} = \Phi_{ki}, \quad \Theta_j^{-1} \Phi_{ji} \Theta_i = 1. \quad (\text{B.2})$$

These identities hold on the ambient targets and hence on their ideal quotients and on every Artin base change. They give the triple-overlap cocycle and show why a parameter-dependent congruence does not identify distinct curves in the fixed target.

Proposition B.1 (Precise patching and algebraic comparison). *On an affine contact chart let D be a Noetherian ring and let J cut out the closed contact support. Use the ring-theoretic completion $\widehat{D}$, the open $U = \text{Spec } D \setminus V(J)$, and the overlap $V = \text{Spec } \widehat{D} \setminus V(J\widehat{D})$. Finitely presented ideal quotients on U and $\text{Spec } \widehat{D}$, with compatible quotient algebra structures on V , patch uniquely to an ideal quotient on $\text{Spec } D$. Quotients with contact-supported torsion are allowed. Base flatness, equality, and the closed incidence equations are detected by this patching cover.*

Consequently, suppose an algebraic family of finite presentation has first supplied a morphism $h : T \rightarrow H$ into a Hilbert scheme or its fixed coefficient graph. If recovery makes h a monomorphism and the embedded comparison identifies completed local rings at all closed points, then h is an open immersion. This conclusion uses the algebraic family, not only an isomorphism of formal functors.

Proof. Completion of a Noetherian ring is flat and induces an isomorphism over D/J . Bhatt's flat formal-gluing statement [Bhatt(2014), Proposition 5.6(4), Example 5.8] therefore applies to quasi-coherent sheaves. Apply its monoidal equivalence to the quotient, its unit, multiplication,

and its structure map from the ambient ring. Surjectivity and finite presentation descend on the jointly surjective flat cover given by the completion and the open complement. The glued algebra is thus an ordinary finitely presented quotient, not a derived replacement. The same cover detects base flatness and the vanishing of the prescribed incidence equations. The gluing theorem supplies existence; faithful flatness alone would not supply the missing overlap descent datum. Iteration over disjoint supports and over projective affine charts gives the claimed form for the incidence target.

For the last assertion, use the completed local criterion for etaleness at closed points, whose residue fields are $\mathbb{C}$ [Stacks Project, Lemma 41.11.3]. The morphism is already of finite presentation. Its etale locus is open; its closed complement in a finite-type complex chart would contain a closed point if nonempty. Thus it is etale everywhere under consideration. An etale monomorphism is an open immersion. Completed comparison here means comparison on all Artin quotients, including nilpotent test rings; an agreement of tangent dimensions or closed reduced points is insufficient. $\square$

The reduced graph closure is compatible with completion by Lemma 53.2, using the finite stabilized colon ideal, not a general assertion that closure commutes with every base change. Its completed rings remain reduced for the following precise reason. A reduced local complex finite-type ring is excellent, so its formal fibres are geometrically reduced; see [Stacks Project, Tag 0BJ0]. The injection into the finite product of its minimal-prime fraction fields remains injective after flat completion. Each resulting generic formal fibre is reduced. The completion, as a subring of their product, is therefore reduced. Normalization is unchanged on the regular total charts; this says nothing about normalizing their possibly nonreduced fibres.

Lemma B.2 (The larger Smith exponent is a smooth graph factor). *In the formal corank-two model $\begin{pmatrix} f & g \\ g & fk+r \end{pmatrix}$, the coefficient parameters of k are independent smooth factors for the relative embedded graph comparison. They are not forgotten in the retained coefficient point.*

Proof. The generating triples $(f, g, fk + r)$ and (f, g, r) are related over the completed parameter ring by

$$T_k = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ -k & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad T_k^{-1} = T_{-k}, \quad \det T_k = 1.$$

Thus their projective graph targets are isomorphic over the parameter disc. Apply T_k on that target and T_k^{-1} before patching into the fixed incidence target. This gives inverse operations on embedded ideals over every Artin coefficient algebra. The independence of the coefficients of k is the coefficient normal form of Theorem 38.2. Therefore the completed graph rings acquire these parameters as power-series variables. This is an isomorphism of relative graph presentations with a specified inverse, not a constant ambient automorphism of X or an unlabelled Hilbert-point inversion. $\square$

B.2. Exactness and recovery at every conic.

Lemma B.3 (Height, flatness, and the recovery minors). *The three minors in (44.2) have codimension two on every geometric fibre of the six-parameter family. Their Hilbert–Burch complex is fibrewise exact, and its cokernel is flat over that parameter space. At a conic-tail point the ambient restriction maps in degrees $(0, 2)$ and $(1, 1)$ have respectively ranks five and four, from ambient spaces of dimension six. Thus recovery uses kernels of ranks one and two, including at doubled lines.*

Proof. At $e = 0$ the ideal is $(zG, zH, Q) = (G, H) \cap (z, Q)$, where $Q \neq 0$ and is independent of z . There is no common codimension-one factor: any factor common to zG, zH divides z , which

does not divide Q . The displayed union has pure support of codimension two. At $e \neq 0$, on $s = 1$ eliminate H from $zG - e(H + BF) = 0$. The other linear minor becomes

$$(z^2 + e^2C)G + (e^2A - eBz)F = 0.$$

It is nonzero, with coefficient of z^2G equal to one. Together with the first linear equation it is a regular sequence in the affine polynomial ring; the remaining quadratic follows from the syzygies. At $s = 0$ the two bilinear equations force $G = H = 0$. There is no component at infinity and no intermediate parameter value at which the height drops. The perfect-height-two criterion therefore gives the Hilbert–Burch resolution on every fibre. The fibrewise exactness criterion for a complex of base-flat locally free modules gives exactness and flatness of the cokernel [Stacks Project, Lemma 10.99.5].

On $C_0 \cup Q$ use its union sequence and the plane-hypersurface sequence $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(j-2) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(j) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_Q(j) \rightarrow 0$. They give $h^0 = 5, 4$ and $H^1 = 0$ in the respective degrees, and surjectivity of restriction from the ambient six-dimensional spaces. This argument uses only that the quadratic equation is nonzero, so includes reducible conics and doubled lines. The nonzero 5 by 5 and 4 by 4 restriction minors define the constant-rank opens. Normalize the selected R^2 coefficient of the kernel quadratic to one, and normalize the two bilinear equations by their tG, tH coefficient matrix. Its 2 by 2 pivot is invertible at the conic-tail point. These are the open minors used by the recovery maps. The coefficient projection supplies f and hence c ; recovery of e from the normalized bilinear equation would not replace that projection. $\square$

Lemma B.4 (Connectedness, scheme exhaustion, and unlabelled descent). *Let $p : Z \rightarrow B$ be proper and birational, with Z integral and normal and B integral and normal of finite type over $\mathbb{C}$. Its geometric fibres are connected. A nonempty proper union of constructed closed families which is open in the support of a fibre therefore exhausts that support. If algebraic charts cover those families and compute the fibre ideals, the same charts determine the complete scheme fibre.*

For the disjoint-contact product theorem, the map from the product of local families to the Hilbert fibre is a representable algebraic morphism of finite presentation. Completed comparison on all Artin rings and ideal recovery make it an open immersion. Its properness and the preceding connectedness then give the asserted isomorphism. The construction descends without global spectral labels.

Proof. Stein factorization gives connected geometric fibres followed by a finite birational map to B . Normality of B makes the latter an isomorphism; equivalently use [Stacks Project, Lemma 37.53.6]. The stated union is closed by properness and open by the local chart descriptions, hence is the whole nonempty connected support. Connectedness alone does not compute nilpotents: those are supplied by the fibre ideals on the covering charts.

For the product assertion, the contact-supported quotients are finite-presentation algebraic quotients on disjoint finite contact neighbourhoods. Patching them to the fixed main curve produces a flat embedded family with the required polynomial, so Hilbert representability supplies the morphism before formal comparison is applied. Restriction to the supported quotients recovers each factor on every test scheme, giving a monomorphism. Proposition B.1 now applies to its completed local maps, including nonreduced Artin tests. A proper open immersion has open-and-closed image; connectedness supplies surjectivity. On the finite étale cover ordering the distinct supports, changes of order permute the corresponding factors and the supported quotients. These permutation maps satisfy the cocycle identity, so descent gives the unlabelled object. This does not impose an ordering through a collision of supports. $\square$

Our convention for $\mathbb{F}_2 = \mathbb{P}(\mathcal{O} \oplus \mathcal{O}(2))$ is the projectivization of one-dimensional subspaces. The chart $[1 : v]$ is $\text{Tot } \mathcal{O}(2)$; its section at infinity is the subline $\mathcal{O}(2)$ and has normal bundle

$\text{Hom}(\mathcal{O}(2), \mathcal{O}) = \mathcal{O}(-2)$. This fixes the negative section and the sign used in the component-intersection formulas.

B.3. The quotient overlap maps and divisor classes. Write the ordered directions as $w_{\pm} = \lambda \pm h$, and the ordered root parameter as t . On the blow-up of (h, t) use $t = eh$ or $h = ut$. The involution sends h to $-h$ in the first chart and t to $-t$ in the second. Its fixed locus is the exceptional divisor. Its invariant coordinates are respectively $(\lambda, e, C = -h^2)$ and $(\lambda, u, \delta = t^2)$; their rings are polynomial even at the fixed locus.

For completeness, a change of direction coordinate $\phi(w) = (aw + b)/(cw + d)$, with $\Delta_{\phi} = ad - bc \neq 0$, gives on the first invariant chart

$$\begin{aligned} K &= (c\lambda + d)^2 + c^2C, \\ \lambda' &= ((a\lambda + b)(c\lambda + d) + acC)/K, \\ C' &= \Delta_{\phi}^2 C/K^2, \quad e' = Ke/\Delta_{\phi}. \end{aligned} \tag{B.3}$$

On the second chart it gives

$$\begin{aligned} K &= (c\lambda + d)^2 - c^2\delta u^2, \\ \lambda' &= ((a\lambda + b)(c\lambda + d) - ac\delta u^2)/K, \\ u' &= \Delta_{\phi} u/K, \quad \delta' = \delta. \end{aligned} \tag{B.4}$$

These formulas are used where both directions are in both affine charts, so K is invertible. They follow by taking the mean and half-difference of $\phi(w_+), \phi(w_-)$. The overlap between the two blow-up charts is $e = 1/u$, $C = -\delta u^2$. These identities supply every overlap, since any two directions admit a common point at infinity outside them. The triple-overlap identities follow from composition of the fractional linear maps, before taking invariants.

Lemma B.5 (Projectivity and ramification of the collision quotient). *The finite involution quotient of the ordered blow-up is projective over the unordered coefficient line. If T_0 is the strict transform of $t = 0$ and F_0 its exceptional divisor, and if S, E are their respective images, then for the quotient map q*

$$q^*S = T_0, \quad q^*E = 2F_0, \quad \text{div}(t) = T_0 + F_0, \quad \text{div}(\delta) = 2S + E.$$

In particular $\mathcal{O}_S(S) = \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(-1)$.

Proof. Choose a relatively ample line bundle on the blow-up and tensor its two translates. It has the permutation linearization. Squaring kills the characters of every stabilizer on its fibres. It thus descends to the finite quotient; equivalently, products of the translates of sufficiently high-degree sections give invariant sections and their affine projective charts. The descended line bundle is ample, since its finite pullback is ample. This proves projectivity without assuming that the action is free. In these charts its overlap maps are those of the tensor product linearization, followed by their squares, so they satisfy descent on triple overlaps.

The invariant charts show ramification index two at the generic exceptional divisor and index one at the generic strict transform. They prove the first two identities. The blow-up of (h, t) gives $\text{div}(t) = T_0 + F_0$, and $\delta = t^2$ gives the last identity after pullback by q . On $S = \text{Sym}^2 \mathbb{P}^1$ the divisor $E|_S$ is the doubled-line conic, of class $2H$. Since $E + 2S$ is principal, $2[S|_S] = -2H$ in $\text{Pic}(\mathbb{P}^2) = \mathbb{Z}H$. This group has no two-torsion, so $[S|_S] = -H$ as claimed. $\square$

In the full conic pullback the finite colon calculation is $((eA, eB) : e^2C) = (A, B)$ and further colons have the same value. Thus for the original unramified coefficient line all torsion is already annihilated by δ . The horizontal ring is integral and dominates $\mathbb{C}[\delta]$, hence is torsion-free over that base. The discrete valuation rings used to infer flatness are the nonfield localizations of $\mathbb{C}[\delta]$,

not localizations of the threefold coordinate ring. The higher Tor groups vanish by (53.5); for ramified arcs their first Tor is only the last layer of the larger torsion ideal.

Finally choose $\delta_0 > 0$ and the positive root at that base point. On the punctured analytic disc the local system $R^2 p_* \mathbb{Q}$ for the horizontal parameter space has basis the two ruling classes of $\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^1$. The loop $\delta(\theta) = \delta_0 \exp(2\pi\sqrt{-1}\theta)$ lifts to an exchange of the two roots, and acts by exchanging that basis. Its invariant line is the sum and its anti-invariant line the difference. In the normalization after $\delta = t^2$, the element $h = t/e$ is taken in the fraction field of the integral base-changed horizontal ring; adjoining it is finite and birational. This is normalization of the base-changed total space. It is neither normalization of the original total graph nor normalization of its central fibre. The resulting normal crossings belong to the parameter space, not to a stable-map model of every embedded curve.

APPENDIX C. DETAILED RECONSTRUCTION STATEMENTS AND COMPARISONS

A degeneracy locus usually forgets the map that defines it. We study an inverse problem in which neither the ambient embedding nor the normal directions are retained: can the abstract nonreduced failure scheme recover a quadratic pencil? The answer is affirmative for every complex pencil, including singular pencils. The first relation, rather than its reduced determinant support, carries this information. The inverse is also global: a thickening over a projective reduction recovers an entire varying pencil subbundle and its actual source bundle, up to one constant left transformation. No fibrewise choice of coordinates or projective line-bundle ambiguity is left. A single unmarked local algebra suffices for the constant-pencil problem; a Schubert line gives another geometric realization.

Let V be a complex vector space of dimension $n \geq 3$, and put

$$W = \operatorname{Sym}^2 V, \quad N = \binom{n+1}{2}, \quad R \in \operatorname{Gr}(2, W), \quad S_R = W/R, \quad p = N - 2.$$

The cube-zero algebra $A_R = \mathbb{C} \oplus V \oplus S_R$ has multiplication $\operatorname{Sym}^2 V \rightarrow S_R$, with $(V \oplus S_R)S_R = 0$. On $X_R = \operatorname{Gr}(n, V \oplus S_R)$, let $\mathcal{K}$ denote the tautological bundle. For any $m \geq 2$, set

$$\widehat{D}_R = V(\operatorname{Fitt}_0 \operatorname{coker}[\operatorname{Sym}^m(\mathcal{O} \oplus \mathcal{K}) \rightarrow A_R \otimes \mathcal{O}]). \quad (\text{C.1})$$

This is the maximal-minor scheme of multiplication, not merely its support. It is independent of $m \geq 2$. Its reduction is the Schubert divisor where $\mathcal{K} \rightarrow V$ drops rank. Write $B_R = \operatorname{Gr}(n, S_R)$, let $\mathfrak{b}_R$ be its ideal in $\widehat{D}_R$, and define

$$Z_R^{[k]} = V(\mathfrak{b}_R^{k+1}) \subset \widehat{D}_R, \quad d = n + 2p = n^2 + 2n - 4.$$

An isomorphism of these neighbourhoods means an abstract complex scheme isomorphism; it is supplied with no ambient or tensor marking.

Theorem C.1 (Sharp intrinsic reconstruction). *For all quadratic pencils $R, R' \subset \operatorname{Sym}^2 V$,*

$$Z_R^{[d]} \simeq Z_{R'}^{[d]} \iff R' = gR \text{ for some } g \in \operatorname{PGL}(V).$$

For every $0 \leq k < d$, the isomorphism class of $Z_R^{[k]}$ is independent of R . Thus d is the smallest uniform reconstruction order. The same statements hold after restriction, using the graph projection, to any Schubert line in B_R . The resulting abstract curve-supported neighbourhood is independent of the choice of that line.

The Grassmannian statement is Theorem 6.1. The curve-supported statement is Corollary E.2. Its more general form, Theorem E.1, applies over any smooth connected projective curve with a rank- n bundle having nontrivial projectivization. For example, $\mathcal{O}_C(-P) \oplus \mathcal{O}_C^{n-1}$ works on every

such pointed curve. The curve is intrinsic as the reduction; a chosen embedding of the curve is not part of the isomorphism data.

C.1. A moving family, not only its individual fibres. The same finite object also reconstructs a pencil that varies over its projective reduction. Let B be a smooth connected projective complex variety, let $\mathcal{U}$ have rank n , and let $\mathcal{R}$ be a rank-two subbundle of $\mathrm{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$ with locally free quotient. Use the local ideal $(\det T)I_p(\gamma \mathrm{Sym}^2 T)$ in $\mathrm{Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V)$ and truncate at order d . Theorem 7.2 states that two resulting abstract finite schemes are isomorphic exactly when their data are related by an isomorphism of reduced bases, one constant linear left map, and an actual isomorphism of the source bundles, carrying one pencil subbundle to the other. The projection and both tensor factors are forgotten in the input. The varying coefficient line is recovered as a subbundle, not by pointwise choices of projective coordinates.

This strengthens the constant-pencil curve theorem in two directions: the reduced base and source bundle may vary in the comparison, and the pencil need not be constant on that base. Example F.6 has a nonconstant unordered cross-ratio and six spectral collision points, all retained by the same finite scheme. Theorem F.4 then identifies the remaining freedom in an isomorphism. Its quotient is the group of the recovered linear data; its kernel acts trivially on the associated graded scheme and has a terminating commutator filtration. Explicit nonlinear shears show why that kernel cannot be omitted. These statements are consequences of the unmarked inverse, not additional claims of novelty for the classical Pluecker map or for spectral cross-ratios.

C.2. A single unmarked local algebra suffices. The strongest form of the inverse needs no positive-dimensional support. Choose an n -dimensional source space U , write $T = (t_{ij})$ for its universal map to V , and let $\mathfrak{m} = (t_{ij})$. Define

$$\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]} = \mathbb{C}[t_{ij}] / ((\det T)I_p(\gamma_R \mathrm{Sym}^2 T) + \mathfrak{m}^{d+1}).$$

Theorem C.2 (Local algebraic inverse). *For every pair of complex quadratic pencils, an ungraded algebra isomorphism $\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]} \simeq \mathfrak{A}_{R'}^{[d]}$ exists if and only if $R' = gR$ for some $g \in \mathrm{PGL}(V)$. The order $d = n^2 + 2n - 4$ is the smallest uniform order already for these single-point objects.*

The full statement and proof are Theorem 7.3. Proposition 1.1 separates the general truncation argument from the pencil-specific orbit rigidity: nonlinear coordinate changes form an explicitly described unipotent kernel, whereas the first relation space carries the reconstruction data. The extra local ingredient is that the residual coefficient module has factor-support ranks $(1, \binom{N}{2})$. Transposition reverses these unequal ranks and therefore cannot carry one pencil ideal to another. This orients the unordered matrix factors without a nontrivial projective bundle. Theorem 7.2 consequently removes that restriction from the moving-family theorem as well. This is not a claim that the reduced determinant cone alone remembers the pencil: the nonreduced first relation kernel and its residual coefficients are indispensable. Proposition 7.4 also identifies the entire tangent-identity kernel, including its affine-space parametrization and nonadditive group law.

C.3. Conductors, collision singularities, and actual failure orbits. Normalization alone does not describe the gluing of its branches. Theorems 50.1 and 50.3 determine two successive local models. On the coprime two-divisor stratum the completed image is

$$\mathbb{C}[[z, x_1, \dots, x_c, y_1, \dots, y_c]] / (x_i y_j).$$

Its conductor is (x, y) , its intrinsic singular ideal is $(x, y)^c$, and its depth is $\dim(z) + 1$. When two common binary roots collide, the model is instead

$$\mathbb{C}[[u, \Delta]] \oplus (u_1, \dots, u_m)t \subset \mathbb{C}[[u, t]], \quad \Delta = t^2,$$

up to a specified smooth factor. Its conductor has a ramified double cover in the normalization. These formulas determine the Cohen–Macaulay cases and distinguish the singular scheme from its reduced support. Proposition 51.1 organizes the reduced intersections of different divisor-degree images by the common part of two chosen divisors.

The boundary also has a direct role in the pencil inverse. Theorem 52.1 constructs a common point in every intrinsic first-relation orbit closure of a pencil failure algebra. A scalar-matrix contraction of the flag-pencil relation has $\gcd a^{D-q_n}$, where $q_3 = 3$ and $q_n = 4$ for $n \geq 4$. The selected degree- $n(n-1)$ divisor is unique but ramified; its normalization fibre has tangent dimension $\binom{n^2+3n-5-q_n}{3n-4-q_n} - 1$. Proposition 52.3 gives its entire Artin algebra by reciprocal-polynomial equations. This specializes *actual* failure algebras through flat families; it does not merely place an unrelated common-factor example beside the inverse theorem. The exact order of the flag coefficient filtration, proved in Lemma 52.2, is the link between the pencil representation and the divisor collision.

C.4. Factorization loci and the geometric comparison. The normalization mechanism has classical precedents. Chipalkatti’s coincident-root locus parametrizes one binary form with a prescribed root partition. His Proposition 5.1, Theorem 5.4, and Corollary 5.8 distinguish multiple normalization points from failure of tangent injectivity and describe the singular support [19]. Kurmann gives local incidence equations, proves their scheme-theoretic equality in Theorem 1.5, and expresses smoothness through splittings of partitions in Proposition 2.1 [20]. In particular, uniqueness plus tangent injectivity is not a new general principle of the present paper.

Here the datum is an r -plane of forms in e variables, not one binary form; the selected divisor has prescribed degree, not a root partition. The residual datum is a Grassmannian subspace, and for $e > 2$ divisor degrees need not fill an interval. These changes produce high-codimension conductor strata and non-Cohen–Macaulay branch gluings. Theorems 50.1 and 50.3 compute the image rings, not merely the incidence graph or singular support. Ferrand’s conductor-square formalism [21] is the standard algebraic framework; the particular conductor ideals, singular Fitting ideals, and depths are calculated here for these Grassmannian strata.

There is a second, closer binary comparison. Hu–Lin–Shao [23, §2.2, Corollary 3.6, and Theorem 1.1] study tuples of binary forms, define common-factor strata using resultant homomorphisms, and resolve the map-space boundary by successive blow-ups. On the open set of linearly independent r -tuples, passing to their span is the frame quotient onto $\mathrm{Gr}(r, S_D)$; the common-divisor condition is invariant under this quotient. Thus our binary loci genuinely meet that theory rather than forming an unrelated example. We do not identify its resultant scheme structure with our image structure without a scheme comparison, nor claim a new general resolution. Our multivariate local rings and the pencil-orbit boundary are the specific additional conclusions.

Rigidification is used as infrastructure, not as an independent headline innovation. The appropriate primary general result is Abramovich–Olsson–Vistoli, Appendix A, Theorem A.1 [22], for compatible flat finitely presented normal inertia subgroups, without a centrality assumption. Our argument identifies the particular substitution subgroup and twisted right-factor subgroup and retains their actual group laws. The boundary statement is on the maximal-lower-Hilbert-function first-relation stratum throughout.

The comparison with regular-pencil Segre strata is made in Remark 52.5. The common closed flag orbit is not presented as a new classification of congruence orbits. The new pencil-side conclusion is its explicit ramified boundary under intrinsic cotangent changes, together with the complete normalization-fibre algebra. The separate documentary status of Ballico’s 1993 paper, discussed below, remains unchanged: absent its full theorem text, no nonanticipation conclusion is drawn.

C.5. The intrinsic mechanism. In the graph neighbourhood of B_R , with tautological bundle $\mathcal{U}$ and graph map $T : \mathcal{U} \rightarrow V$, the ideal is

$$(\det T)I_p(\gamma_R \operatorname{Sym}^2 T).$$

Its generators have degree d . This degree calculation alone only explains why lower orders are constant. The inverse requires three further intrinsic operations. Multiplication in the finite scheme recovers the first relation kernel and hence the whole homogeneous cone. The rank-one Fano scheme of its reduced determinant cone then recovers the two tensor rulings. On the socle Grassmannian one may distinguish them by projective triviality, already on a Schubert line. In general the unequal coefficient-support ranks orient them without that restriction. Properness forces the induced map to $\operatorname{PGL}(V)$ to be constant. After choosing its linear lift, the actual normal-bundle map lies in the commutant of $\operatorname{End}(V)$, which recovers the right bundle without a line twist (Lemma 3.2). Finally, cancellation of the intrinsic determinant ideal recovers the coefficient module. For pencils its exterior representation is irreducible, and exterior duality identifies its single coefficient line with the Pluecker line of R .

Theorem 4.1 separates this geometric mechanism from the particular multiplication algebra. The curve theorem shows why the mechanism is not tied to the dimension of the original parameter Grassmannian. The geometric orientation used here has a local replacement: coefficient-support asymmetry. Theorem 7.3 uses it to reconstruct the pencil from one unmarked Artin local algebra.

Theorem 3.3 gives the broader principle. It reconstructs simultaneously varying subspaces in several Schur modules from the unmarked first-relation thickening, provided one coefficient support is nonzero and proper. The coefficient spaces may have arbitrary prescribed ranks; they need not be lines coming from quadratic pencils. Its proof isolates the actual factor-descent step from classical linear-preserver theory. Example 3.4 shows why the global descent is not equivalent to fibrewise reconstruction: two Zariski locally trivial families have the same Artin fibre and isomorphic nilradical graded vector bundles in every degree, but their abstract total schemes differ. The inverse detects the inequivalent degree-three coefficient maps. This is the mechanism behind the moving-pencil theorem, rather than an assertion of novelty for canonical grading or for the numerical value of the first relation degree.

C.6. An exact image criterion and a pencil-native global consequence. The coefficient inverse admits an intrinsic converse. Theorem D.1 starts with an unmarked first relation whose homogeneous radical is a determinant cone. After recovering its unordered rulings, invariance under one full factor group is necessary and sufficient for the residual relation to come from coefficient subspaces in the Cauchy modules. Both orderings satisfy this test precisely when every coefficient support is zero or full. Thus the strict-support condition is exactly the criterion for a unique admissible orientation in the recognized class. Theorem D.2 computes its entire affine stabilizer, including the transpose component and the universal nonlinear automorphism kernel. Corollary D.4 expresses the inverse as an equivalence of geometric orbit sets, with those ambiguities specified rather than suppressed.

A global consequence lies inside the quadratic-pencil problem itself. Fix a plane $H = \langle x, y \rangle \subset V$. For a degree- m map $f = [a : b] : \mathbb{P}^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(H)$, take the pencil subbundle

$$\mathcal{R}_f = (ax + by)H.$$

Every fibre is equivalent to $\langle x^2, xy \rangle$. Nevertheless, Theorem K.1 proves

$$Y_f \simeq Y_{f'} \iff f' = \alpha \circ f \circ \sigma, \quad \alpha, \sigma \in \operatorname{PGL}_2(\mathbb{C}),$$

for their unmarked order- d failure thickenings with trivial source bundle. Their fibre algebras and every nilradical graded vector bundle depend only on n, m , not on f . Their abstract pencil, quotient and first-relation bundles are fixed as well. Thus the entire covering equivalence problem,

not only one chosen pair, is retained in the global multiplication and is invisible to those additive data. The maps z^3 and $z^3 + z$ give an explicit separating pair of quadratic pencils (Corollary K.2).

Neither complete reducibility of Cauchy modules, linear preservers of a Segre cone, nor division by the common factor of a pencil is new in isolation. Their synthesis here has a precise output: recognition of the image and its exact orientation ambiguity after all matrix markings are forgotten, followed by recovery of a whole covering map from a locally isotrivial pencil thickening. A projective factor map alone would not recover the actual source bundle; the intrinsic normal map and its commutant do so. A pointwise pencil inverse would not recover a covering map; one constant left transformation over the entire proper base does so. These distinctions specify the geometric content beyond the classical ingredients. The recognized coefficient class is not the class of all determinant-radical relations. Its geometric orbit statement alone does not describe nonreduced deformation groupoids; the relative comparison below uses a further scheme-theoretic inverse.

C.7. Intrinsic strata, infinitesimal parameters, and pencil moduli. The relative inverse begins with a geometric condition on the first relation, not invariance under a factor group. For a space K of homogeneous forms, the divisor-incidence functor defines a canonical scheme-theoretic image in the relation Grassmannian. Its exact-gcd open is the locally closed stratum of Lemma 10.1, now identified by its incidence universal property in Corollary 11.5. Multiplication by the universal common-divisor line is an isomorphism onto this open. Consequently the common factor is recovered even over a nonreduced parameter base. The condition is scheme-theoretic: merely asking all geometric fibres to have the specified common factor is insufficient. When that divisor is a power of a determinant, the remaining parameter is an arbitrary gcd-free residual subspace, modulo the full determinant-preserver group (Theorem 10.3). This is a smooth quotient stack, and neither of the two factor symmetries is required.

For pencils the exact common divisor is δ^{n-1} , and the primitive residual relation has degree $3n - 4$ (Lemma G.1). The Cauchy projection and the Pluecker equations recognize its image as a locally closed scheme, not just a set of complex points. The resulting relative theorem is

$$\mathcal{F}_{\text{pen}}^{\text{eff}} \simeq [\text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V) / \text{PGL}(V)]. \quad (\text{C.2})$$

Here the superscript records two explicit operations on morphisms: first remove tangent-identity nonlinear substitutions, then remove the ineffective right matrix factor, and fppf stackify. Theorem G.2 proves this equivalence over arbitrary complex parameter schemes, retaining all singular pencils. It does not identify the unrigidified algebra stack with the pencil stack. Its tangent complex is $[\text{pgl}(V) \rightarrow \text{Hom}(R, \text{Sym}^2 V/R)]$, so the effective stack is smooth of dimension $n - 3$, with precisely the pencil stabilizer jumps. Rank-incidence and spectral Fitting strata retain their scheme structures and deformation equations by Corollary G.3. This is an exact-image and rigidification comparison; the displayed rank and spectral consequences are its functorial restrictions, not an independent classification of those loci. The two quotient operations have the universal properties of Theorem H.1 and Corollary H.2.

The ambient determinant-divisor stratum is substantially larger. Theorem J.1 computes its normal space to the pencil stratum in three parts: non-Pluecker lines, non-scalar right-factor directions, and other Cauchy summands. Theorem J.2 constructs through every pencil a projective Grassmannian of relations with the same determinant radical, containing a projective line whose other points admit neither factor symmetry. Thus the family inverse describes how the coefficient and pencil loci sit in, and can be left within, a larger intrinsic stratum. It does not falsely infer deformation stability from fibrewise recognition.

C.8. The normalization of a natural common-divisor boundary. There is a different geometric question beyond the pencil image: what happens when a divisor of a first relation

is no longer uniquely recoverable in a family? Let E have dimension $e \geq 2$, set $S_j = \text{Sym}^j E$ and $s_j = \dim S_j$, and fix $g, h \geq 1$, $D = g + h$, and $2 \leq r \leq s_h$. Let $Y_g \subset \text{Gr}(r, S_D)$ be the scheme-theoretic image of the incidence of a line of degree- g divisors of a rank- r relation bundle. This definition uses the vanishing of the universal quotient map; it does not first recover a pencil, impose a factor symmetry, or choose a reduced structure on a set.

Theorem C.3 (The divisorial boundary). *The multiplication morphism*

$$\mathbb{P}(S_g) \times \text{Gr}(r, S_h) \longrightarrow Y_g, \quad ([f], J) \longmapsto fJ$$

is finite and is the normalization. The locus Y_g is integral, of dimension $s_g - 1 + r(s_h - r)$. At a geometric relation K it is normal exactly when $F_K = \gcd(K)$ has one degree- g divisor $[f]$ and $\gcd(f, F_K/f) = 1$. At the preimage $([f], K/f)$, if this last gcd has degree k , the fibre tangent dimension is $s_k - 1$.

The theorem is proved in Section 11. Lemma 11.3 supplies equations for the entire normalization fibre, not only its tangent space. For example, $K = \langle x^2y, x^2z \rangle$ has a unique linear divisor, but the normalization fibre is $\text{Spec } \mathbb{C}[a, b]/(a, b)^2$, of length three. A different relation has two reduced divisor lifts; yet another has a gcd-degree jump at a normal point. The exact criterion distinguishes these behaviours. Corollary 11.8 carries this intrinsic boundary to the first-relation algebra stack. It is not a classification of all finite-flat smoothings or of all linear orbits in that boundary.

A direct consequence on the pencil side is proved separately in Section I. Every quadratic pencil admits an explicit congruence degeneration to $\langle x_1^2, x_1x_2 \rangle$; its orbit is the closed flag variety $\text{Fl}(1, 2; V)$, and it is the unique closed orbit in the full pencil Grassmannian. The construction is uniform for regular and singular pencils and lifts to a finite-flat family of their failure algebras with exact common factor δ^{n-1} . This proves a particular universal orbit-closure adjacency by equations, rather than by copying a prescribed invariant locus through the effective-stack equivalence. Its elementary highest-weight mechanism is distinct from the normalization theorem, which deals with a larger boundary of arbitrary first relations.

C.9. Framed families and spectral consequences. Once tensor coordinates are retained, the parameter map is simpler. The first relation spaces give a closed immersion of $\text{Gr}(2, W)$ into a Grassmannian, by Theorem 6.3. Its proof factors through the classical Pluecker embedding, tensoring a line with a fixed space, and a fixed linear inclusion. This is the framed encoding consequence of the coefficient calculation, not a substitute for the unmarked inverse. Theorem M.1 glues the actual universal order- d neighbourhood. It is finite locally free over the relative socle of rank $\binom{n^2+d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}$, and projective and flat over the pencil parameter scheme. It commutes with arbitrary complex base change with that socle retained. Over a nonreduced base, the specified relative socle ideal need not be the absolute nilradical. These marked statements alone do not identify unmarked moduli stacks or deformation groupoids. The common-divisor descent and ineffective-inertia analysis in Theorem G.2 supply that separate step.

For regular pencils, the spectral sheaf and its Fitting incidence schemes are read from the reconstructed pencil. We retain these consequences because they exhibit information genuinely lost by coarser invariants: fixed discriminants and fixed reduced rank loci can conceal different elementary divisors. In Theorem N.2, every classical dominance specialization is transported to a flat family of the finite neighbourhoods, with every strict transition detected at order d . The spectral orbit classification itself is classical, not a second independent Torelli theorem.

C.10. Prior work and the publication object. The Weierstrass–Segre classification is used in its root-labelled form; compare [4, Theorem 1.1 and Corollary 2.1]. The orthogonal nilpotent input is isolated in Lemma N.1, with precise references to [5, Proposition 1 and Theorem 1], an

independent dimension calculation, and an explicit distinction between full orthogonal orbits and their special-orthogonal components.

Ballico's relative multiplication construction [2, Theorem 0.2; §1, Remark 1.2 and equation (6)] is a substantive antecedent for studying quadratic-normality failure on finite linear sections of an embedded surface. Here the defining algebra varies, and the inverse starts from an unmarked infinitesimal failure scheme. The opening page of the distinct earlier paper [1, p. 5] concerns higher-order embedding properties and restriction maps to finite subschemes. Its remaining theorem and proof text has not been inspected; that first page does not establish the absence of an inverse statement. No anticipation or nonanticipation conclusion relative to that article is asserted.

The Artin-local aspect is compared at theorem level with [7, 8] in Section 1, including the distinction between canonical grading of a nonhomogeneous local algebra and orbit rigidity of our already homogeneous first relation. The linear-preserver input is classical [9]; its precise hypotheses and a proof in the required case are included in Lemma 3.1. The algebraic-group quotient step is supplied by the homomorphism theorem [11, Theorem 5.39 and Remark 5.42]; its use in the exact stabilizer calculation distinguishes a scheme-theoretic quotient from a bare bijection of complex points.

The present article consists of intrinsic reconstruction, the canonical common-divisor boundary, relative rigidification, explicit pencil specialization, and spectral readout. The reciprocal-likelihood theorem and projective critical schemes are preserved in a separate applications manuscript. Its finite-flat critical divisor requires supplied split semisimple data and simple disjoint projective poles; its totally real cover requires a supplied real definite realization and separated data. None of those hypotheses enters the all-pencil theorem here. Independent web, exterior-operator, K3, polarized, and boundary results are preserved in an explicitly non-submitted research archive. They are not inputs to any proof in this article and are not part of its significance claim. Every proof required here is included here.

APPENDIX D. RECOGNITION AND THE EXACT AMBIGUITY OF COEFFICIENT SYSTEMS

The support inequality in the preceding section is not merely a sufficient test in the class under consideration. We characterize that class intrinsically and determine exactly when its orientation is unique. We then compute the full linear stabilizer, including the cases in which an orientation is lost. These are statements about unmarked first relations, not about a supplied matrix presentation.

Throughout this section $n \geq 2$, $q \geq 1$, and $D = n + q$. Let E have dimension n^2 , put $S = \text{Sym } E$, and let $0 \neq K \subset S_D$. The affine cone is in E^* . Suppose that the radical of the homogeneous ideal (K) is a reduced hypersurface linearly equivalent to the determinant hypersurface in square n -by- n matrices. We call this the *determinant-radical condition*. The ideal (K) is taken in the full symmetric algebra, not in its Artin truncation. Its reduced equation gives a line $\mathbb{C}\delta \subset S_n$, and unique factorization gives the intrinsic residual subspace

$$J = K/\delta \subset S_q. \quad (\text{D.1})$$

Changing the generator δ does not change this subspace. The reduced singular loci of the recovered cone determine its unordered tensor rulings. An ordering identifies $E = V^* \otimes U$, with $\dim U = \dim V = n$, up to separate factor changes. The subgroup induced by $\text{GL}(U)$ on the second factor is independent of those changes. An ordering is called *admissible* when J is invariant under this full subgroup. Admissibility is therefore an intrinsic condition on an ordered ruling, and does not ask for a chosen basis of either factor.

Theorem D.1 (Intrinsic recognition and orientation dichotomy). *Under the determinant-radical condition, an ordering is admissible if and only if its Cauchy decomposition has*

$$J = \bigoplus_{\lambda \vdash q, \ell(\lambda) \leq n} L_\lambda \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda U, \quad L_\lambda \subset \mathbb{S}_\lambda V^*. \quad (\text{D.2})$$

The coefficient spaces are unique and are recovered by projection and contraction. Suppose at least one ordering is admissible and put $r_\lambda = \dim L_\lambda$ and $m_\lambda = \dim \mathbb{S}_\lambda \mathbb{C}^n$. Then exactly one of the following alternatives occurs.

(i) Some $0 < r_\lambda < m_\lambda$. Precisely one of the two orderings is admissible, and every linear isomorphism between such relation spaces preserves that ordering.

(ii) Every r_λ is either zero or m_λ . Both orderings are admissible. The residual space is a sum of full Cauchy summands, and transposition preserves K after identifications of the two matrix factors.

Conversely, every nonzero system in (D.2) satisfies the determinant-radical condition after multiplication by δ . Thus the theorem characterizes the image of the coefficient construction, without assuming a coefficient presentation as part of the input.

Proof. The determinant polynomial is irreducible for $n \geq 2$. Every element of K belongs to the radical (δ) , so $K \subset \delta S_q$ and the cancellation in (D.1) is legitimate. The intrinsic recovery of the unordered factors follows from Lemma 3.1 and the rank-one rulings. Changing either factor frame conjugates its full general linear group into itself; scalar changes act as scalars on S_q . Consequently the definition of admissibility is independent of all these choices.

For an ordering, the Cauchy formula is

$$S_q = \bigoplus_{\lambda \vdash q, \ell(\lambda) \leq n} \mathbb{S}_\lambda V^* \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda U.$$

As representations of $\text{GL}(U)$, the nonzero $\mathbb{S}_\lambda U$ are irreducible and pairwise nonisomorphic. Finite-dimensional rational representations of this group over $\mathbb{C}$ are completely reducible. Hence an invariant subspace splits across its isotypic components. In the λ -component, evaluation identifies that subspace with

$$\text{Hom}_{\text{GL}(U)}(\mathbb{S}_\lambda U, J) \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda U.$$

Schur's lemma embeds the displayed multiplicity space uniquely in $\mathbb{S}_\lambda V^*$; this is L_λ . This proves necessity in (D.2), including the absence of unrecorded cross-summand graphs. Sufficiency follows since the second factor is full. Projection onto a Cauchy summand followed by contraction with the dual of its second factor recovers L_λ .

If the reverse ordering is also admissible, J is invariant under both full factor groups. Their product acts irreducibly on each Cauchy summand, and these product representations are pairwise nonisomorphic. Complete reducibility now makes J a sum of whole summands. Equivalently, all r_λ are zero or full. Conversely a sum of whole summands is invariant under both groups and under the factor exchange. This proves the dichotomy. One may also see uniqueness directly from the contraction ranks (r_λ, m_λ) : a factor exchange reverses them, which is impossible at a nonzero proper support. Every linear isomorphism of relation spaces preserves the determinant cone; Lemma 3.1 leaves just the two factor alternatives. It must therefore preserve the unique admissible ordering in case (i).

Finally choose a nonzero L_λ . At an invertible matrix $T : U \rightarrow V$, the map $\mathbb{S}_\lambda T$ is invertible. A nonzero covector in L_λ consequently has a nonzero matrix coefficient at T . Thus the residual coefficients do not vanish simultaneously at any invertible matrix. All elements of δJ vanish on the determinant hypersurface. Their common zero set is exactly that hypersurface; the Nullstellensatz and its reduced irreducible equation give $\text{rad}(\delta J) = (\delta)$, as asserted. $\square$

The complete reducibility and Cauchy statements here are classical representation theory; see [3]. Their role is to supply an intrinsic image criterion *after* the matrix factors have been recovered. For a relation space that fails the admissibility criterion, the theorem does not assert a one-sided coefficient description. In particular it is not a classification of arbitrary homogeneous ideals or arbitrary degeneracy schemes.

D.1. Stabilizers and the full transpose ambiguity. Use the normal action $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$. Its action on polynomial functions is inverse pullback, so it gives an honest representation ρ on $E = V^* \otimes U$. The kernel of $\rho : \mathrm{GL}(V) \times \mathrm{GL}(U) \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}(E)$ is the diagonal scalar subgroup. For a recognized system define

$$G_L = \{g \in \mathrm{GL}(V) : (\mathbb{S}_\lambda g^{-1})^* L_\lambda = L_\lambda \text{ for every } \lambda\}, \quad H_K = \mathrm{Stab}_{\mathrm{GL}(E)}(K).$$

These are closed subgroup schemes, with the stabilizer scheme structures from their actions on Grassmannians.

Theorem D.2 (Exact coefficient stabilizer). *In case (i) of Theorem D.1,*

$$H_K \simeq (G_L \times \mathrm{GL}(U)) / \mathbb{G}_m. \quad (\text{D.3})$$

In case (ii), after choosing bases for the two factors,

$$H_K \simeq ((\mathrm{GL}_n \times \mathrm{GL}_n) / \mathbb{G}_m) \rtimes C_2, \quad (\text{D.4})$$

where C_2 is generated by transposition. These are isomorphisms of affine algebraic groups over $\mathbb{C}$, and hence of their represented functors on commutative complex algebras.

For the ungraded algebra $A(K) = S/((K) + \mathfrak{m}^{D+1})$, they give the split exact sequence

$$1 \longrightarrow U_K \longrightarrow \mathrm{Aut}(A(K)) \longrightarrow H_K \longrightarrow 1. \quad (\text{D.5})$$

Here U_K is the universal higher-order substitution group from Proposition 1.2, of dimension $n^2(\mathrm{length} A(K) - 1 - n^2)$.

Proof. Every element of $H_K(\mathbb{C})$ preserves the radical of (K) , and therefore the determinant cone. In case (i), the unique admissible orientation excludes its transposed component. The remaining map is $\rho(g, h)$. Cancellation of the determinant line and projection onto each Cauchy summand show that it preserves J if and only if $g \in G_L$; the arbitrary right map acts on the full factor and introduces no additional condition. The kernel is the diagonal $\mathbb{G}_m$. In case (ii), every separate factor transformation and transposition preserves each active full summand. These exhaust the determinant preservers, so they exhaust $H_K(\mathbb{C})$. The transposition has order two and lies outside the preserving component for $n \geq 2$, giving the asserted semidirect product. Its action on the left-right quotient is conjugation by the matrix-transpose map; no particular formula for its action on chosen factor lifts is needed.

We justify the scheme statement as well. The homomorphism theorem for algebraic groups identifies the quotient by the kernel with the closed image [11, Theorem 5.39 and Remark 5.42]. Every finite-type group scheme over a characteristic-zero field is smooth [10, Lemma 39.8.2]. Thus the stabilizer and the image are reduced closed subgroup schemes. The equalities on complex points just proved imply equality of their defining radical ideals. This gives (D.3) and (D.4) as algebraic-group isomorphisms, not only as bijections on complex points. Finally Proposition 1.2 applies in degree D and gives (D.5) with the stated kernel, splitting and dimension. $\square$

For completeness, the omitted zero system has $K = 0$. Then $A(K)$ is the free truncated symmetric algebra, $H_K = \mathrm{GL}(E)$, and its linear automorphisms need not preserve any matrix factors. The determinant-radical condition deliberately excludes this third possibility. A full nonzero coefficient system and a zero system therefore lose information in different ways: the former retains unordered matrix geometry and has exactly a transpose ambiguity, while the latter retains no intrinsic matrix geometry at all.

D.2. The zero/full case over a projective reduction. The local transpose ambiguity also has an exact global form. Fix a nonempty set of active partitions and take the corresponding $\mathcal{L}_\lambda$ to be full, with all other coefficient bundles zero. Use the same construction as in (3.4), without its strict-support hypothesis.

Proposition D.3 (Global ambiguity for full coefficient systems). *Let Y_i be two such schemes, for the same n, q and active partitions, over smooth connected projective bases B_i with source bundles $\mathcal{U}_i$. They are isomorphic as abstract complex schemes if and only if there are an isomorphism $\sigma : B_1 \rightarrow B_2$ and an actual bundle isomorphism $\mathcal{U}_1 \simeq \sigma^* \mathcal{U}_2$. An isomorphism exchanging the two ruling families over a fixed σ exists precisely when, in addition, the common source bundle is projectively trivial. Equivalently,*

$$\mathcal{U}_1 \simeq \mathcal{M}^{\oplus n}, \quad \sigma^* \mathcal{U}_2 \simeq \mathcal{M}^{\oplus n}$$

for a line bundle $\mathcal{M}$ on B_1 . Thus even the full systems recover the actual source-bundle class; the extra ambiguity is an exchange, not an undetected line twist.

Proof. An abstract isomorphism recovers the reduction, the actual normal bundle map, the first relation, and the unordered determinant rulings by the proof of Theorem 3.3, which uses strict support only to orient the rulings. Over the connected base the choice to preserve or exchange the two components is constant. In the preserving case, projectivity makes the left projective map constant. A constant lift and Lemma 3.2 give an actual isomorphism of the source bundles.

In the exchanging case each source projective bundle is identified with the constant left projective bundle on the other side. It is therefore trivial. A vector bundle with a trivialized projectivization is a line twist of a constant vector space: locally lift the given projective trivialization to linear frames; on intersections their differences are scalar matrices, whose scalar cocycle is the required line bundle. After pullback by σ , write $\mathcal{U}_i^* = \mathcal{M}_i^* \otimes W_i$, with W_i constant of dimension n . The normal bundles become $\mathcal{M}_i^* \otimes (V_i \otimes W_i)$. Their actual isomorphism induces a morphism from B_1 to the projective-linear isomorphisms between two constant n^2 -spaces. This target is affine; the morphism is constant. Choose its constant linear lift. On removing it, the actual bundle map is scalar on each projective fibre. In local line frames its off-diagonal entries vanish and all diagonal entries agree. Reducedness makes these equalities hold as bundle maps. Their common entry is a nowhere vanishing section of $\mathcal{H}om(\mathcal{M}_1^*, \mathcal{M}_2^*)$, and hence $\mathcal{M}_1 \simeq \mathcal{M}_2$. This proves necessity of the common actual line twist, and thus of the source-bundle isomorphism.

Conversely any actual source-bundle isomorphism, together with a constant left identification, preserves all active full Cauchy summands, so it gives an isomorphism of the schemes. If the source bundles have the common line-twist presentation above, choose identifications of the constant factor spaces and transpose their tensor factors, leaving the line factor intact. This is a global actual normal map. It preserves the determinant line, every active full summand, and the truncation, and supplies an exchanging isomorphism. These constructions prove all the claims. $\square$

D.3. The intrinsic orbit space. Fix a rank vector $\mathbf{r}$ with at least one proper nonzero entry and form the product of Grassmannians

$$X_{\mathbf{r}} = \prod_{\lambda \vdash q, \ell(\lambda) \leq n} \text{Gr}(r_\lambda, \mathbb{S}_\lambda V^*).$$

Zero and full factors in this product are points. Let $\mathcal{Z}_{\mathbf{r}}$ denote the set of subspaces of $\text{Sym}^D \mathbb{C}^{n^2}$ satisfying the determinant-radical condition and the intrinsic admissibility test, with ranks $\mathbf{r}$ in the unique admissible orientation.

Corollary D.4 (Geometric orbit classification). *The coefficient construction induces bijections*

$$X_r(\mathbb{C})/\mathrm{PGL}(V) \simeq \mathcal{Z}_r/\mathrm{GL}_{n^2}(\mathbb{C}) \simeq \{A(K) : K \in \mathcal{Z}_r\}/\simeq. \quad (\mathrm{D.6})$$

Their stabilizers, including the ineffective right factor and the nonlinear kernel of the last passage, are precisely those in Theorem D.2. For a nonempty zero/full rank pattern there is just one relation orbit for that pattern, with the stabilizer in (D.4).

Proof. The recognition theorem gives surjectivity of the first map. A linear isomorphism of two such relations is orientation-preserving; its left factor carries every L_λ to the corresponding coefficient space, and its right factor is unrestricted. Scalars act trivially on the Grassmannians. This proves injectivity and the first bijection. The first-relation orbit proposition gives the second. For a zero/full pattern each coefficient Grassmannian is a point, and the full-stabilizer theorem supplies the last claim. $\square$

Equation (D.6) is a statement about geometric orbit sets with the explicitly computed affine stabilizers. It does not identify nonreduced moduli stacks or assert that every infinitesimal deformation remains in this class. For smooth projective reduced bases, its uniquely oriented case combines with actual factor descent in Theorem 3.3. The following pencil-native application shows that this global step separates an entire covering problem that fibrewise classification cannot see.

APPENDIX E. RECONSTRUCTION ON A PROJECTIVE CURVE

The global part of the inverse argument has a more economical geometric realization. It uses a proper base to make the projective left frame constant, and a nontrivial right projective bundle to distinguish the rulings. Neither step requires the whole socle Grassmannian. We now replace that Grassmannian by a curve. In particular, a neighbourhood supported on one Schubert line already retains every pencil.

Let C be a smooth connected projective complex curve, and let $\mathcal{U}$ be a rank- n bundle on C , where $n \geq 3$. Assume that $\mathbb{P}_C(\mathcal{U}^*)$ is not projectively trivial. A sufficient numerical condition is

$$\deg \det \mathcal{U} \not\equiv 0 \pmod{n}. \quad (\mathrm{E.1})$$

Indeed a projectively trivial rank- n bundle is a line-bundle twist of a trivial bundle, so its determinant degree is divisible by n . Fix V of dimension n , put $E = \mathrm{Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V)$, and let $\mathfrak{a}$ be the zero-section ideal in $\mathrm{Sym} E^*$. For a pencil $R \subset \mathrm{Sym}^2 V$, the quotient $\gamma_R : \mathrm{Sym}^2 V \rightarrow S_R$ defines the homogeneous ideal

$$\mathcal{I}_{R,C} = (\det T)I_p(\gamma_R \mathrm{Sym}^2 T), \quad p = \binom{n+1}{2} - 2, \quad (\mathrm{E.2})$$

where $T : \mathcal{U} \rightarrow V$ is the universal map on $\mathrm{Tot} E$. The expression is independent of local frames: both determinant multiplication and the maximal-minor construction are bundle constructions. Define

$$Y_{R,C}^{[k]} = \mathrm{Spec}_C(\mathrm{Sym} E^*/(\mathcal{I}_{R,C} + \mathfrak{a}^{k+1})).$$

Only its abstract complex scheme is retained, not its projection to C , its embedding in $\mathrm{Tot} E$, or either tensor factor.

Theorem E.1 (Curve-supported reconstruction). *For fixed $(C, \mathcal{U}, V)$ as above and $d = n^2 + 2n - 4$, every pair of quadratic pencils satisfies*

$$Y_{R,C}^{[d]} \simeq Y_{R',C}^{[d]} \iff R' = gR \text{ for some } g \in \mathrm{PGL}(V). \quad (\mathrm{E.3})$$

All lower-order neighbourhoods are independent of R . The order- d schemes are finite locally free over C of rank $\binom{n^2+d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}$, where $N = \binom{n+1}{2}$. No regularity condition is imposed on the pencil.

Proof. On any frame chart, the ideal in (E.2) is generated in degree d . Its degree- d piece K_R is a subbundle of rank $\binom{N}{2}$, by the fixed coefficient inclusion (6.8); its quotient is locally free. The quotient algebra has its full symmetric powers in degrees less than d , has $\text{Sym}^d E^*/K_R$ in degree d , and is zero above that degree. This proves the rank and the assertion about lower orders.

Its reduction is C , and its nilradical $\mathfrak{n}$ recovers $L = \mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2$ and

$$K_R = \ker[\text{Sym}^d L \longrightarrow \mathfrak{n}^d].$$

Thus the abstract finite-order scheme reconstructs the entire graded algebra $\text{Sym } L/(K_R)$, by the same argument as Lemma 6.2. The ideal here means the homogeneous ideal generated by the recovered kernel, not its radical. No splitting of the reduction or supplied projection is used.

The reduction of this reconstructed cone is the determinant cone. Indeed its ideal has the determinant factor, and when T is invertible the quadratic quotient has full rank. Its rank-one Fano scheme has two ruling components, $\mathbb{P}(V) \times C$ and $\mathbb{P}_C(\mathcal{U}^*)$. The hypothesis distinguishes the first one intrinsically. An abstract isomorphism of neighbourhoods may induce a nonidentity automorphism of C ; pull back the second bundle along that automorphism. The oriented ruling map is nevertheless a morphism from C to PGL_n . It is constant, since C is connected projective and $H^0(C, \mathcal{O}_C) = \mathbb{C}$. Lemma 2.2 therefore supplies one constant projective left frame.

Cancel the intrinsic determinant ideal and apply the coefficient construction of Theorem 4.1. For pencils, Lemma 5.2 leaves just the single line $\mathbb{C}\beta_R$. Exterior duality (5.8) recovers R with respect to that same projective frame. This proves the forward implication in (E.3). Conversely a linear lift of g induces the bundle map on E and the quotient isomorphism on S_R , and carries all the displayed ideals and their truncations to the corresponding ideals for R' . This proves the converse. $\square$

Corollary E.2 (One Schubert line suffices). *Let $\ell \simeq \mathbb{P}^1$ be any Schubert line in $B_R = \text{Gr}(n, S_R)$, and use the canonical graph projection $Z_R^{[d]} \rightarrow B_R$ to form its restriction $Z_{R,\ell}^{[d]}$. Its abstract isomorphism class is independent of the choice of ℓ , and*

$$Z_{R,\ell}^{[d]} \simeq Z_{R',\ell'}^{[d]} \iff R' = gR \text{ for some } g \in \text{PGL}(V).$$

The smallest uniform reconstruction order for these curve-supported neighbourhoods is again d . Their reductions all have dimension one, instead of $n(p-n)$.

Proof. The tautological bundle on a Schubert line is $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(-1) \oplus \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}^{n-1}$. Pulling back the homogeneous ideal of the graph neighbourhood gives exactly (E.2) with that bundle. Its isomorphism type depends on this bundle and R , not on the chosen inclusion of the line in the socle. The determinant degree is -1 , so Theorem E.1 applies. Its lower-order schemes are all independent of the pencil, while $\langle x_1^2, x_1 x_2 \rangle$ and $\langle x_1^2, x_2^2 \rangle$ are inequivalent. This proves the uniform minimality assertion. $\square$

This restriction is made in the construction; it is not a claim that an abstract neighbourhood canonically chooses a Schubert line. No line is supplied to an isomorphism in the corollary: the reduced curve is recovered as the reduction of its source. Nor is the corollary a statement about one unmarked Artinian normal slice. The projective curve and the nontrivial ruling remain essential to this argument. The same theorem applies, for example, to $\mathcal{U} = \mathcal{O}_C(-P) \oplus \mathcal{O}_C^{n-1}$ on every smooth projective connected curve with a point P . It isolates the properness and ruling obstruction used in reconstruction, independently of the original Grassmannian realization.

APPENDIX F. RECONSTRUCTION OF MOVING PENCILS AND THEIR ISOMORPHISMS

The inverse need not be applied separately to constant pencils. A single unmarked finite scheme can retain a pencil varying over its entire projective reduction. We prove this assertion,

including the recovery of the normal bundle and the ambiguity in lifting the recovered data to an isomorphism. The coefficient lines in this section are subbundles; constancy of the pencil is not assumed.

F.1. The family and its first relation bundle. Fix $n \geq 3$, and write

$$N = \binom{n+1}{2}, \quad p = N - 2, \quad d = n + 2p = n^2 + 2n - 4, \quad M = \binom{N}{2}.$$

An admissible datum consists of a smooth connected projective complex variety B , a rank- n vector bundle $\mathcal{U}$ on B , a constant n -dimensional vector space V , and a rank-two locally direct-summand subbundle

$$\mathcal{R} \subset \mathrm{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}_B.$$

We require that $\mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^*)$ is not a trivial projective bundle. Put $\mathcal{S} = (\mathrm{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}_B)/\mathcal{R}$ and $\mathcal{E} = \mathrm{Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V \otimes \mathcal{O}_B)$. On its total space, let T be the universal map and let γ denote the quotient onto $\mathcal{S}$. Define the homogeneous ideal and its truncations by

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{R}} &= (\det T) I_p(\gamma \mathrm{Sym}^2 T), \\ \mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{R}}^{[k]} &= \mathrm{Sym}(\mathcal{E}^*)/(\mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{R}} + \mathfrak{a}^{k+1}), \quad Y_{\mathcal{R}}^{[k]} = \mathrm{Spec}_B \mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{R}}^{[k]}, \end{aligned} \tag{F.1}$$

where $\mathfrak{a}$ is the positive-degree ideal. Determinant-line changes of frame multiply local generators by units, so this is an ideal sheaf, independent of all frames. This construction is the pullback of the coefficient construction in Theorem M.1, with an arbitrary rank- n source bundle. It is not necessary to choose an embedding of B in a socle Grassmannian.

Lemma F.1 (A varying coefficient line). *The ideal $\mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{R}}$ has no component of degree less than d and is generated by its degree- d component $\mathcal{K}_{\mathcal{R}}$. This component is a subbundle of $\mathrm{Sym}^d \mathcal{E}^*$ of rank M . After cancellation of the determinant line, its degree- $2p$ coefficient module determines $\mathcal{R}$ as a subbundle, once the two tensor factors of $\mathcal{E}$ are supplied. In particular, $Y_{\mathcal{R}}^{[d]} \rightarrow B$ is finite locally free of rank*

$$\binom{n^2 + d}{d} - M.$$

Proof. Put $F(H) = \bigwedge^p \mathrm{Sym}^2 H$ for rank- n vector spaces or bundles H . This is an irreducible polynomial representation by Lemma 5.2; its dimension is M . Write $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}} = \bigwedge^p \mathcal{S}^*$, viewed, by $\bigwedge^p \gamma^*$, as a line subbundle of $F(V)^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$. The residual minors are precisely the image of

$$\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}} \otimes F(\mathcal{U}) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Sym}^{2p}(V^* \otimes \mathcal{U}), \quad \beta \otimes \xi \longmapsto [T \mapsto \beta(F(T)\xi)]. \tag{F.2}$$

The full map $F(V)^* \otimes F(U) \rightarrow \mathrm{Sym}^{2p}(V^* \otimes U)$ is the nonzero inclusion of its unique Cauchy summand: evaluation at $T = 1$ is nonzero, as in (5.6). Restricting to a nonzero line on the left therefore has rank M in every fibre. The coefficients vary algebraically. The constant-rank criterion makes the image a subbundle; equivalently one may choose a nonvanishing maximal minor of this coefficient map locally on the Grassmannian of pencils and pull it back to B . Multiplication by the determinant, a nonzero polynomial in every fibre, again has constant rank M .

All defining generators have degree d , proving the assertion about the ideal. For the recovery assertion, the residual image, inside the indicated Cauchy summand, is $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}} \otimes F(\mathcal{U})$. Contraction with $F(\mathcal{U})^*$ has image exactly $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}}$ as a line subbundle of $F(V)^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$. This statement is an equality of images of bundle maps, not just equality at closed points. Exterior duality identifies it with the Pluecker line $\bigwedge^2 \mathcal{R}$, up to the fixed determinant line of $\mathrm{Sym}^2 V$. The Grassmannian Pluecker embedding consequently recovers the morphism $B \rightarrow \mathrm{Gr}(2, \mathrm{Sym}^2 V)$, and its pullback of the tautological bundle recovers $\mathcal{R}$. Finally, the truncated algebra is the sum of its free graded

pieces below d and the locally free degree- d quotient by $\mathcal{K}_{\mathcal{R}}$. Its rank is the asserted binomial sum minus M . $\square$

F.2. The unmarked inverse.

Theorem F.2 (Reconstruction of a moving pencil). *Let $(B_i, \mathcal{U}_i, V_i, \mathcal{R}_i)$, $i = 1, 2$, be admissible data of the same rank n . Then*

$$Y_{\mathcal{R}_1}^{[d]} \simeq Y_{\mathcal{R}_2}^{[d]} \quad (\text{F.3})$$

as abstract complex schemes if and only if there exist an isomorphism $\sigma : B_1 \rightarrow B_2$, a constant linear isomorphism $g : V_1 \rightarrow V_2$, and a bundle isomorphism $h : \mathcal{U}_1 \rightarrow \sigma^ \mathcal{U}_2$ such that*

$$\sigma^* \mathcal{R}_2 = (\text{Sym}^2 g) \mathcal{R}_1. \quad (\text{F.4})$$

The reduced base, normal tensor orientation, isomorphism class of the actual source bundle, and the varying pencil are recovered together. Neither the projection onto the base nor the ambient bundle is supplied in (F.3). The constant left map cannot be replaced by a separately chosen change of coordinates in each fibre. A pair (g, h) defining the same normal-bundle map is unique up to simultaneous multiplication by a nonzero constant.

Proof. Let $\mathfrak{n}_i$ be the nilradical of $\mathcal{O}_{Y_{\mathcal{R}_i}^{[d]}}$. Since the positive-degree ideal is nilpotent and B_i is reduced, the reduction is exactly B_i , and this ideal is exactly $\mathfrak{n}_i$. There are no relations below degree d , so multiplication intrinsically recovers

$$\mathcal{E}_i^* = \mathfrak{n}_i / \mathfrak{n}_i^2, \quad \mathcal{K}_i = \ker \left[\text{Sym}^d(\mathfrak{n}_i / \mathfrak{n}_i^2) \longrightarrow \mathfrak{n}_i^d \right]. \quad (\text{F.5})$$

The map is well defined since $\mathfrak{n}_i^{d+1} = 0$. An abstract isomorphism gives σ , an isomorphism of these normal bundles, and the matching relation subbundles. In particular it gives an isomorphism of the untruncated homogeneous cones

$$\text{Spec}_{B_i}(\text{Sym } \mathcal{E}_i^* / (\mathcal{K}_i)).$$

This cone is reconstructed from the first relation module; it is not the associated graded algebra of the finite scheme, whose degrees above d vanish.

The reduction of this cone is the determinant cone. Indeed the residual quadratic map is surjective wherever T is invertible, whereas the determinant factor annihilates the ideal wherever T is singular. On a frame chart the determinant hypersurface is reduced over the smooth base, so the radical ideal is precisely the determinant ideal. Successive relative reduced singular loci give the lower matrix-rank cones. The rank-one cone has the two ruling parameter schemes

$$\mathbb{P}(V_i) \times B_i, \quad \mathbb{P}_{B_i}(\mathcal{U}_i^*),$$

by Lemma 2.1. Only the first is projectively trivial. Thus an isomorphism cannot interchange them. The induced map on the trivial ruling is a morphism $B_1 \rightarrow \text{Isom}(\mathbb{P}(V_1), \mathbb{P}(V_2))$. After choosing one identification this target is the affine variety PGL_n . Since B_1 is connected and projective, every such morphism is constant. Choose one constant linear lift g .

We check that no line-bundle ambiguity remains in the other factor. Locally trivialize both source bundles. The linear rank-one preserver with its left projective map fixed to $[g]$ is of the form

$$T \longmapsto gTh^{-1} \quad (\text{F.6})$$

by Lemma 2.2. Once this particular g is fixed, the local linear map h is unique: if two right maps give the same value for every T , they are equal. The local maps therefore agree on overlaps and glue to an actual bundle isomorphism $\mathcal{U}_1 \rightarrow \sigma^* \mathcal{U}_2$. Alternatively, after removing g the normal-bundle map commutes with $\text{End}(V_1)$; the commutant is the right-factor homomorphism

bundle. Rescaling the constant lift g rescales h by the same constant. This proves both existence and the asserted uniqueness for a given normal-bundle map.

Cancel the intrinsic determinant ideal in the recovered homogeneous ideal. On a frame chart the determinant polynomial is a non-zero-divisor and $((\det T)\mathcal{J} : (\det T)) = \mathcal{J}$; the identities glue without selecting a global determinant generator. Apply Lemma F.1 to the degree- $2p$ part. The right map h acts on the full factor $F(\mathcal{U})$, so contraction against its dual removes that change of frame. The remaining line subbundle transforms by the one constant left map g . Exterior duality yields exactly (F.4). This uses the subbundle version proved above, not the constant-coefficient hypothesis in Theorem 4.1.

Conversely σ, g, h satisfying (F.4) identify the quotient bundles $\mathcal{S}_i$, the quadratic maps, and their maximal-minor ideals. The determinant changes by a unit in local frames. The map (F.6) consequently identifies both the homogeneous ideals and every truncation, proving (F.3). $\square$

Corollary F.3 (Uniform sharpness over an admissible base). *For fixed $B, \mathcal{U}, V$, all schemes $Y_{\mathcal{R}}^{[k]}$ with $k < d$ are independent of $\mathcal{R}$. Order d is the smallest uniform order at which the moving pencil is recoverable in the sense of Theorem F.2.*

Proof. Below d the ideal $\mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{R}}$ contributes no relations, and the algebra is $\bigoplus_{j=0}^k \text{Sym}^j \mathcal{E}^*$. Constant pencils are among the admissible subbundles. The pencils $\langle x_1^2, x_1 x_2 \rangle$ and $\langle x_1^2, x_2^2 \rangle$ are inequivalent: all members of the first have a common linear factor and those of the second do not. A base automorphism does not change either constant pencil. The theorem separates their order- d schemes, whereas every lower truncation agrees. This proves uniform, not pairwise, minimality. $\square$

F.3. The part of an isomorphism that the inverse does not record. The recovered data classify isomorphism classes, but an isomorphism of finite schemes need not itself be linear in the nilpotent directions. The following statement identifies this distinction without replacing it by a claim about moduli stacks.

Fix an admissible datum, put $Y = Y_{\mathcal{R}}^{[d]}$, and let $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}}$ be the group of triples (σ, g, h) satisfying (F.4), modulo $(g, h) \sim (cg, ch)$ for $c \in \mathbb{C}^*$. Its group law is composition of their induced normal-bundle maps. Write $\text{Aut}_{\mathbb{C}}(Y)$ for the group of complex scheme automorphisms. For $j \geq 1$, define G_j to consist of the automorphisms inducing the identity on the reduction and satisfying

$$(\alpha^* - 1)(\mathfrak{n}^k) \subseteq \mathfrak{n}^{k+j} \quad \text{for every } k \geq 0, \quad \mathfrak{n}^0 = \mathcal{O}_Y. \quad (\text{F.7})$$

They act on sheaves on the same underlying topological space.

Theorem F.4 (Linear data and the nilpotent kernel). *There is an exact sequence of groups*

$$1 \longrightarrow G_1 \longrightarrow \text{Aut}_{\mathbb{C}}(Y) \longrightarrow \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}} \longrightarrow 1. \quad (\text{F.8})$$

The displayed homogeneous presentation of Y supplies a splitting. Moreover $G_{d+1} = 1$, $[G_i, G_j] \subseteq G_{i+j}$, and there are natural injections

$$G_j/G_{j+1} \hookrightarrow H^0(B, \text{Der}_{\mathbb{C}}(\text{gr}_{\mathfrak{n}} \mathcal{O}_Y)_j) \quad (\text{F.9})$$

into additive groups of degree- j derivations. Thus the kernel is nilpotent and records precisely the automorphisms invisible on the associated graded scheme. No surjectivity onto the derivation spaces is asserted.

Proof. An automorphism induces a base map and a degree-one bundle map. The proof of Theorem F.2 identifies these with a unique class of triples in $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}}$. The graded algebra is generated in degree one over degree zero, with relation subbundle $\mathcal{K}_{\mathcal{R}}$. Hence its entire graded automorphism is already determined by that triple. The kernel is the identity on every graded piece, which is exactly condition (F.7) for $j = 1$. Conversely the homogeneous maps $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$ give actual automorphisms of Y , respect composition, and induce the prescribed triples. This proves exactness

and the splitting. A choice of the homogeneous presentation supplies that section; the assertion does not endow an arbitrary unmarked presentation with a preferred section.

For $\alpha \in G_j$, put $D_\alpha = \alpha^* - 1$. It raises filtration by j , and is therefore nilpotent as an additive operator. The inverse of $1 + D_\alpha$ is the finite geometric series. Composition of filtration-raising operators shows that a commutator of elements of G_i, G_j raises filtration by at least $i + j$. Also $G_{d+1} = 1$ follows by taking $k = 0$, since $\mathfrak{n}^{d+1} = 0$.

The leading term of D_α defines maps $\mathfrak{n}^k / \mathfrak{n}^{k+1} \rightarrow \mathfrak{n}^{k+j} / \mathfrak{n}^{k+j+1}$. They are independent of lifts. The identity

$$D_\alpha(ab) = aD_\alpha(b) + D_\alpha(a)b + D_\alpha(a)D_\alpha(b)$$

reduces to the Leibniz identity in the indicated graded degree, since $2j \geq j + 1$. Thus the leading term is a sheaf derivation over $\mathbb{C}$, including its action on degree zero; it need not be an $\mathcal{O}_B$ -linear derivation. Leading terms add under composition, and their kernel is exactly G_{j+1} . They glue globally, proving (F.9) and all assertions. $\square$

Example F.5 (A nontrivial invisible automorphism). Let $B = \mathbb{P}^1$ and $\mathcal{U} = \mathcal{O}(-1) \oplus \mathcal{O}^{n-1}$. The bundle $\mathcal{E}^* = V^* \otimes \mathcal{U}$ has at least two trivial direct summands. Choose their degree-one generators x, y . The substitution

$$x \mapsto x + y^2$$

fixing y , the other summands and $\mathcal{O}_B$, defines a nonidentity automorphism of $Y_{\mathcal{R}}^{[d]}$ in G_1 , for every admissible $\mathcal{R}$. Indeed each relation has degree d ; its change under this substitution has degree at least $d + 1$ and vanishes in the truncation. The inverse is $x \mapsto x - y^2$. The automorphism is nonidentity because there are no degree-two relations. Therefore identifying all finite-scheme automorphisms with the stabilizer of the pencil would be false, even in this simple case. The inverse theorem and the exact sequence retain, rather than suppress, this higher-order freedom.

F.4. A nonconstant family across spectral collisions.

Example F.6. Take $n = 4$, $B = \mathbb{P}_{[s:t]}^1$, $\mathcal{U} = \mathcal{O}(-1) \oplus \mathcal{O}^3$, and $V = \mathbb{C}^4$. In diagonal quadratic coordinates set

$$A = \text{diag}(1, 1, 1, 1), \quad B_{s,t} = \text{diag}(0, s, t, 2s + 3t).$$

The map $\mathcal{O} \oplus \mathcal{O}(-1) \rightarrow \text{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}$ with columns $A, B_{s,t}$ has rank two everywhere. The first diagonal entry shows that any scalar relation involving A has zero coefficient on A ; the next two entries then force $s = t = 0$, which is impossible on $\mathbb{P}^1$. Its image $\mathcal{R}$ is therefore a locally direct-summand pencil bundle. Since it contains the nondegenerate form A , it is regular at every point, including all spectral collisions.

On the open set of four distinct eigenvalues, an ordered cross-ratio of $0, s, t, 2s + 3t$ is

$$\chi = \frac{t(s + 3t)}{(2s + 3t)(t - s)}.$$

The rational function $J = (\chi^2 - \chi + 1)^3 / (\chi^2(1 - \chi)^2)$ is invariant under the six cross-ratio transformations arising from permutations of four points. It is nonconstant: at $[s : t] = [1 : 2]$ and $[1 : 3]$, the values of χ are $7/4$ and $15/11$, and the corresponding values of J differ. Thus the pencil family is not projectively isotrivial, even allowing a change of parameter within each pencil. The discriminant of $\det(zA - B_{s,t})$ is

$$4s^2t^2(2s + 3t)^2(s - t)^2(s + 3t)^2(s + t)^2. \quad (\text{F.10})$$

No factor is inverted in forming $Y_{\mathcal{R}}^{[20]}$. This finite scheme is locally free over its entire projective reduction of rank $\binom{36}{20} - 45$. By Theorem F.2, its unmarked isomorphism class recovers the whole morphism into the pencil Grassmannian, including the six collision points and the pencil there, up to one constant transformation of V and an automorphism of the base. This is a consequence

about a genuinely moving family, not just the pointwise Pluecker encoding. The cross-ratio and discriminant calculations are classical elementary readouts; their role here is to exhibit a family to which the unmarked global inverse applies.

Remark F.7 (Scope of the family statement). The reduction in this section is smooth, projective and reduced. The source projective bundle is assumed nontrivial, which orients the two rulings. The theorem allows all fibre pencils, singular or regular; regularity is used only in the spectral description of the last example. Theorem M.1 separately allows arbitrary complex base change with its specified relative socle ideal. The present intrinsic inverse does not replace that ideal by an absolute nilradical over a nonreduced base. Nor does (F.8) assert an equivalence of unmarked moduli stacks or a description of every infinitesimal deformation. It is an exact classification of geometric isomorphisms, their graded data, and the residual automorphism kernel for the stated admissible objects.

APPENDIX G. THE EFFECTIVE MODULI STACK OF PENCIL FAILURE ALGEBRAS

We apply the common-divisor inverse to the actual first relations of quadratic pencils. Their common divisor has a higher multiplicity than the single determinant factor used to recover their support. Removing that multiplicity places every pencil, without a regularity hypothesis, in the smooth stratum of the preceding section.

Keep $W = \text{Sym}^2 V$, $N = \binom{n+1}{2}$, $p = N - 2$, and put

$$\begin{aligned} M &= \binom{N}{2}, & s &= n - 1, & h &= 3n - 4, \\ \mu &= (\underbrace{3, \dots, 3}_{n-2}, 2, 0), & A &= \mathbb{S}_\mu V^*, & F &= \mathbb{S}_\mu U. \end{aligned} \tag{G.1}$$

Both A and F have dimension M . The Cauchy inclusion $A \otimes F \subset S_h(E)$ will be fixed; its subspace and all its projections are equivariant, independent of a choice of bases.

Lemma G.1 (Exact common multiplicity). *For every $R \in \text{Gr}(2, W)$, including every singular pencil, the first relation space of its order- d failure algebra is*

$$K_R = \delta^{n-1} \tilde{J}_R, \quad \tilde{J}_R = L_R^0 \otimes F \subset S_h(E), \quad \gcd(\tilde{J}_R) = 1. \tag{G.2}$$

Here $L_R^0 \subset A$ is the Pluecker line of R , under the canonical projective identification $\mathbb{P}(A) = \mathbb{P}(\wedge^2 W)$. The common divisor of K_R is therefore exactly δ^{n-1} , up to scalar. Its degree remains $d = sn + h = n^2 + 2n - 4$.

Proof. Exterior duality and $\wedge^2 \text{Sym}^2 H = \mathbb{S}_{(3,1)} H$ give

$$\bigwedge^{N-2} \text{Sym}^2 H = \mathbb{S}_\lambda H, \quad \lambda = (\underbrace{n+1, \dots, n+1}_{n-2}, n, n-2) = \mu + (n-2)^n.$$

Thus this representation is $(\det H)^{n-2} \otimes \mathbb{S}_\mu H$. Applied to the universal matrix, its coefficient polynomials factor as δ^{n-2} times the matrix coefficients of $\mathbb{S}_\mu T$. The additional determinant in the failure ideal gives (G.2). On the left, exterior duality also yields

$$A \simeq \bigwedge^2 W \otimes (\det V)^{-3},$$

which identifies the residual line with the Pluecker line.

We prove a slightly stronger assertion: the matrix coefficient space $\beta \otimes \mathbb{S}_\mu U$ has greatest common divisor 1 for every nonzero $\beta \in \mathbb{S}_\mu V^*$. Its common divisor is taken to a scalar multiple of itself by the full right group. Its zero divisor is therefore invariant under right multiplication.

A nonconstant invariant divisor cannot meet the open orbit of invertible matrices. Since the complement of that orbit is the irreducible determinant hypersurface, any such common divisor is a power of δ .

It remains to exclude δ . Choose a rank- $n - 1$ map T_0 . The representation $\mathbb{S}_\mu$ has length $n - 1$, so $\mathbb{S}_\mu T_0 \neq 0$. Choose a nonzero vector in its image. The span of its left $\mathrm{GL}(V)$ -orbit is the entire irreducible representation. Consequently some left translate gT_0 has a coefficient not annihilated by β . Not all residual coefficients vanish on the rank- $n - 1$ locus. They have no determinant factor, proving the assertion. The same argument at an invertible matrix shows that the coefficient vector is nonzero everywhere on the invertible locus. $\square$

Let $\mathcal{P} = \mathrm{Gr}(2, W)$. The morphism

$$\iota : \mathcal{P} \longrightarrow X_{h,M}(E), \quad R \longmapsto L_R^0 \otimes F \quad (\mathrm{G.3})$$

is a closed immersion. Indeed, the Pluecker embedding is followed by the closed immersion $\mathbb{P}(A) \rightarrow \mathrm{Gr}(M, A \otimes F)$, $L \mapsto L \otimes F$, and then by a linear Grassmannian inclusion. The inverse to the middle map is contraction with F^* . This factorization proves the assertion on schemes, including nonreduced test schemes, rather than only on points. Lemma G.1 shows that its image lies in the open set $X_{h,M}(E)$.

Define the *pencil relation stratum* Z_{pen} inside $Z_{n-1,3n-4,M}^{\mathrm{det}}$ by the following intrinsic scheme conditions. Recover the common-divisor line, its determinant root, and its unordered tensor rulings by Theorem 10.3. In an ordering, the primitive residual relation is required to lie in the indicated Cauchy summand, to have the form $L \otimes F$, and to satisfy the Pluecker equations on L under $A \simeq \wedge^2 W \otimes (\det V)^{-3}$. These are equations on subbundles; a test on the fibres alone is not their definition. Use both orderings and descend. The two ordered images are disjoint: their support ranks are respectively $(1, M)$ and $(M, 1)$, with $M > 1$. Each is closed in the residual Grassmannian. Thus this prescription defines a locally closed scheme, independent of the tensor frames. It is an intrinsic image criterion for a natural family of first relations, not a definition by an algebra isomorphism to a preselected pencil.

Theorem G.2 (Effective all-pencil moduli and deformations). *The stack of first relations in Z_{pen} is*

$$[Z_{\mathrm{pen}} / \mathrm{GL}(E)] \simeq [\mathcal{P} / G^\circ]. \quad (\mathrm{G.4})$$

There is an exact sequence of groups

$$1 \longrightarrow \mathrm{GL}(U) \longrightarrow G^\circ \longrightarrow \mathrm{PGL}(V) \longrightarrow 1, \quad (\mathrm{G.5})$$

and its kernel acts trivially on $\mathcal{P}$. Quotient the morphisms in the algebra stack first by the nonlinear tangent-identity kernel of Proposition 10.4, and then by this ineffective right group, and fppf stackify. The resulting effective pencil failure stack satisfies

$$\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{pen}}^{\mathrm{eff}} \simeq [\mathrm{Gr}(2, \mathrm{Sym}^2 V) / \mathrm{PGL}(V)]. \quad (\mathrm{G.6})$$

This equivalence is valid over all complex parameter schemes. It identifies automorphisms after the specified quotients, infinitesimal deformation groupoids, and families of degenerating pencils, including singular pencils.

The stack is smooth of dimension $n - 3$. At R , its tangent complex is

$$[\mathrm{pgl}(V) \xrightarrow{d_R} \mathrm{Hom}(R, W/R)], \quad d_R(X)(r) = (X \otimes 1 + 1 \otimes X)r \bmod R. \quad (\mathrm{G.7})$$

In particular, the dimension of its space of first-order isomorphism classes is $n - 3 + \dim \mathrm{Stab}_{\mathrm{PGL}(V)}(R)$. Within this stratum, every infinitesimal pencil deformation and its effective failure-algebra deformation lift together across a small extension of local Artinian complex algebras.

Proof. In the determinant frame of Theorem 10.3, the residual pencil locus is $\iota(\mathcal{P}) \amalg \tau\iota(\mathcal{P})$, where τ exchanges the two factors. The disjointness just proved and the equivariance of the Cauchy and Pluecker maps give, as schemes with group action,

$$\iota(\mathcal{P}) \amalg \tau\iota(\mathcal{P}) \simeq G \times^{G^\circ} \mathcal{P}.$$

Quotienting by G gives (G.4). All maps used here are morphisms and all inverse operations are contractions, common-divisor descent, or the inverse on the Pluecker image. Consequently this calculation remains valid on a nonreduced base. It is not an inference from equality of complex-point stabilizers.

The map in (G.5) sends the class of (g, h) to $[g]$. If $g = aI$, multiplication by the diagonal scalar a^{-1} writes its class uniquely as $(I, a^{-1}h)$. This proves the asserted kernel. The action on the Pluecker line is the projective action of g ; the full right factor has no effect on R . Every $\mathrm{PGL}(V)$ -valued isomorphism lifts fppf locally to G° , and two lifts differ by that kernel. The quotient of morphisms and stackification therefore gives $[\mathcal{P}/\mathrm{PGL}(V)]$. Combining this with Proposition 10.4 proves (G.6). No splitting of (G.5) over the base is required.

A Grassmannian chart writes a nearby pencil as the graph of a map $R \rightarrow W/R$. Infinitesimal coordinate changes act by d_R , giving (G.7). Grassmannian charts and $\mathrm{PGL}(V)$ are smooth, so the quotient is smooth and the graph coefficients lift over every small extension. A coordinate change can also be lifted in the smooth group, and its action determines a compatible lift of the corresponding object. Torsors over a local Artinian complex algebra can be trivialized, since smooth torsors lift a point of their algebraically closed residue field. This proves the lifting assertion for deformation groupoids. Finally,

$$\dim \mathcal{P} - \dim \mathrm{PGL}(V) = 2(N - 2) - (n^2 - 1) = n - 3.$$

Taking kernel and cokernel of d_R gives the stated first-order dimension, including stabilizer jumps at singular pencils. $\square$

Corollary G.3 (Native specialization loci). *Every $\mathrm{PGL}(V)$ -invariant locally closed subscheme $Q \subset \mathrm{Gr}(2, \mathrm{Sym}^2 V)$, with its specified scheme structure, has a corresponding intrinsic effective failure stratum isomorphic to $[Q/\mathrm{PGL}(V)]$. Its infinitesimal equations and its specializations are retained, not just its closed points. In particular, this applies to rank-incidence and spectral Fitting conditions on the universal pencil, including their intersections. A family in such a locus specializes to a pencil in its closure exactly when its effective failure family has the corresponding specialization in the associated closure stratum.*

Proof. Restrict the equivariant closed immersion (G.3) and its inverse to Q . The construction of Z_{pen} and its two quotient steps then restrict to give the stated isomorphism. Equations for a rank or a Fitting condition are equivariant equations in the universal pencil, so they are included in this argument with their scheme structures. Apply the same construction to the closure of Q to obtain the specialization assertion. $\square$

Remark G.4. Theorem G.2 does not say that the unrigidified algebra stack is the pencil stack. At a complex pencil its linear stabilizer remains $(G_R \times \mathrm{GL}(U))/\mathbb{G}_m$, and its full algebra automorphism group also has the nonlinear kernel in Proposition 1.2. Both are real automorphisms, not redundant notation. They are explicitly removed only in the effective comparison. Nor is the quotient asserted to be proper, although its framed Grassmannian is projective.

The parameter base in this theorem is distinct from the intrinsic projective reduction in Theorem 7.2. Here projective coordinate changes may vary over the parameter scheme. In that moving theorem, properness of the intrinsic reduction forces one constant left map and recovers an actual source bundle. Neither assertion is substituted for the other. The present equivalence upgrades the geometric orbit statement to a family statement without changing the hypotheses or conclusions of the moving inverse.

APPENDIX H. UNIVERSAL PROPERTIES OF THE TWO RIGIDIFICATIONS

The effective stacks used above have a universal characterization. This specifies what is forgotten from isomorphisms, as opposed to what is retained from objects. We use rigidification in its standard sense of removing a flat normal subgroup of inertia; see [18, Tag 04V2]. The argument below gives the universal property directly in the present situation, including the nonconstant subgroup obtained by descent.

Let $H_0 \subset \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_D(E))$ be a $\mathrm{GL}(E)$ -invariant locally closed subscheme. Let $\mathcal{A}_{H_0}$ be the stack of algebras satisfying the trace, filtration and Hilbert-function conditions of Proposition 10.4, whose intrinsic kernel is in H_0 . Write $\mathcal{R}_{H_0} = [H_0 / \mathrm{GL}(E)]$.

Theorem H.1 (First-relation rigidification). *Taking the first relation defines an fppf gerbe*

$$q : \mathcal{A}_{H_0} \longrightarrow \mathcal{R}_{H_0}.$$

Its relative inertia $\mathcal{U}$ consists exactly of the substitutions which induce the identity on $\mathcal{N}/\mathcal{N}^2$. It is a smooth affine normal subgroup of the inertia. In a homogeneous presentation its underlying scheme is $\mathrm{Hom}(\mathcal{E}, \mathcal{N}^2)$, with the substitution group law. For every stack $\mathcal{Z}$ in groupoids on complex schemes, precomposition with q identifies

$$\mathrm{Hom}(\mathcal{R}_{H_0}, \mathcal{Z}) \simeq \{F \in \mathrm{Hom}(\mathcal{A}_{H_0}, \mathcal{Z}) : F(\mathcal{U}) = 1\}. \quad (\mathrm{H.1})$$

The right side is the full subgroupoid, including all natural isomorphisms, of functors killing the indicated relative inertia. The construction is compatible with base change on the relation stack.

Proof. A relation bundle has its homogeneous truncated algebra as a lift. Every algebra over that relation bundle is locally isomorphic to this lift. The first-relation proposition shows that an isomorphism of relation bundles lifts fppf locally, and any two lifts differ by a unique element of the indicated kernel. These assertions are exactly the gerbe and relative-inertia assertions. The kernel is intrinsic, so it is stable under conjugation. Its local affine-space description shows smoothness and flatness; no additive group law is being asserted.

For clarity, we prove the descent implicit in (H.1). Given F on the right and an object y of $\mathcal{R}_{H_0}$, choose local lifts a_i over an fppf cover. Locally choose comparison isomorphisms on overlaps above the identity of y . Two choices differ by $\mathcal{U}$, hence have the same image under F . On triple overlaps the failure of the chosen lifts to satisfy the cocycle condition is again in $\mathcal{U}$. Their images therefore give a genuine descent datum for $F(a_i)$, which is effective because $\mathcal{Z}$ is a stack. Refinements and different lift choices give canonically isomorphic descended objects. An arrow between two objects of $\mathcal{R}_{H_0}$ is treated in the same way, using local lifts of that arrow. This constructs the descended functor. Natural isomorphisms descend by the same argument, proving full faithfulness as well as essential surjectivity. Conversely every functor pulled back by q kills its relative inertia. All the constructions use covers and isomorphism sheaves, so commute with base change. $\square$

Corollary H.2 (The effective pencil stack is a successive rigidification). *On the pencil relation stratum the second morphism*

$$[\mathcal{P}/G^\circ] \longrightarrow [\mathcal{P}/\mathrm{PGL}(V)], \quad \mathcal{P} = \mathrm{Gr}(2, \mathrm{Sym}^2 V),$$

is the rigidification by the normal relative inertia induced from $\ker(G^\circ \rightarrow \mathrm{PGL}(V)) = \mathrm{GL}(U)$. Consequently Theorem G.2 has the universal property of first killing $\mathcal{U}$ and then this right-factor inertia. It does not kill the stabilizer of the pencil in $\mathrm{PGL}(V)$.

Proof. The right factor acts trivially on $\mathcal{P}$, and the quotient map of groups is fppf surjective. Objects and isomorphisms of the second quotient therefore lift locally to the first, with differences in that kernel. Apply the descent proof of Theorem H.1. Over an object represented by a G° -torsor the subgroup is its conjugation-associated $\mathrm{GL}(U)$ -bundle; it need not be a constant

group scheme on the base. This describes the actual subgroup stack and shows that no global splitting is assumed. Composing with the first rigidification gives the asserted successive universal property. All remaining pencil automorphisms survive in the target. $\square$

APPENDIX I. A COMMON CLOSED SPECIALIZATION OF ALL QUADRATIC PENCILS

We give an orbit-closure consequence directly on the pencil side. Unlike restricting an equivalence to a previously specified locus, the following argument constructs the specialization. It works for every pencil, including pencils with singular generic member. Its mechanism is elementary projective representation theory; the additional failure algebra statement uses the all-pencil, exact-multiplicity construction.

Theorem I.1 (Explicit common closed orbit). *Let $\dim V = n \geq 3$. The action of $\mathrm{PGL}(V)$ on $\mathcal{P} = \mathrm{Gr}(2, \mathrm{Sym}^2 V)$ has a unique closed orbit, namely*

$$\mathcal{C} = \{\ell H : \ell \subset H \subset V, \dim \ell = 1, \dim H = 2\}. \quad (\text{I.1})$$

It is the flag variety $\mathrm{Fl}(1, 2; V)$, of dimension $2n - 3$. More precisely, after a fixed change of coordinates every pencil has a degeneration along the one-parameter subgroup

$$\lambda(t) = \mathrm{diag}(1, t, t^2, \dots, t^2)$$

to $\langle x_1^2, x_1 x_2 \rangle$. The pencil family is a subbundle on the whole affine line.

Proof. Take independent forms q_0, q_1 . The rational function q_1/q_0 on $\mathbb{P}(V^*)$ is nonconstant. In characteristic zero its differential is not identically zero: on an affine coordinate chart the common kernel of the coordinate derivations of the rational function field is $\mathbb{C}$. Choose a point $[v]$ where $q_0(v) \neq 0$ and this differential is nonzero. Replace q_1 by $q_1 - (q_1(v)/q_0(v))q_0$. Then $q_1(v) = 0$, whereas its differential has a nonzero value on some vector w independent of v . Euler's identity shows that its value on the radial vector v is zero. Extending v, w to a basis of V^* gives dual coordinates in which

$$[x_1^2]q_0 = a \neq 0, \quad [x_1^2]q_1 = 0, \quad [x_1 x_2]q_1 = b \neq 0.$$

Here brackets denote a coefficient.

Apply $\lambda(t)$ to the variables. The forms

$$Q_0(t) = q_0(x_1, tx_2, t^2 x_3, \dots, t^2 x_n), \quad Q_1(t) = t^{-1} q_1(x_1, tx_2, t^2 x_3, \dots, t^2 x_n)$$

have polynomial coefficients: the only possible weight-zero term in q_1 was removed. Their limits are ax_1^2 and $bx_1 x_2$. For $t \neq 0$ they span a coordinate transform of R ; at zero they are independent. Thus their coefficient matrix has rank two everywhere, defines a subbundle, and supplies the asserted morphism from $\mathbb{A}^1$ to $\mathcal{P}$.

The orbit of $\langle x_1^2, x_1 x_2 \rangle$ is exactly $\mathcal{C}$. A pencil of the form ℓH recovers ℓ as its gcd and H by division. These are scheme-theoretic inverse operations on the exact-gcd-one-degree stratum by Corollary 11.5, applied to $g = h = 1, r = 2$. Under that inverse the condition $\ell \subset H$ is the usual closed flag incidence. The flag-to-pencil map is therefore a locally closed immersion; since the flag variety is projective it is a closed immersion. It identifies $\mathcal{C}$ with the flag variety, and the dimension is $(n - 1) + (n - 2)$. Every pencil orbit closure contains $\mathcal{C}$, by the constructed family and equivariance. Any closed orbit must consequently be $\mathcal{C}$, proving uniqueness. $\square$

Corollary I.2 (Flat closed specialization of failure algebras). *For every quadratic pencil R there is a finite locally free family over $\mathbb{A}^1$, of rank $\binom{n^2+d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}$, whose nonzero fibres are isomorphic to $\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]}$ and whose zero fibre is $\mathfrak{A}_{\langle x_1^2, x_1 x_2 \rangle}^{[d]}$. The intrinsic first relations throughout the family have exact gcd δ^{n-1} . In a fixed determinant frame, the two ordered copies of the flag orbit form the*

unique closed G -orbit in the pencil relation locus. Equivalently the effective pencil failure stack has the common closed specialization described in Theorem I.1.

Proof. Let R_t be the polynomial subbundle just constructed. Its Pluecker line gives, under the fixed exterior-duality identification, a line bundle $L_t^0 \subset \mathbb{S}_\mu V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{A}^1}$. Set

$$\mathcal{K}_t = \delta^{n-1}(L_t^0 \otimes \mathbb{S}_\mu U), \quad \mathcal{A}_t = \text{Sym}(E \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{A}^1})/((\mathcal{K}_t) + \mathfrak{m}^{d+1}).$$

The first is a rank- M subbundle. The second is finite locally free by its graded direct-sum presentation, with the claimed rank. Lemma G.1 gives the exact gcd at every fibre, including zero; in fact this family lies scheme-theoretically in the fixed-divisor exact stratum. Equivariance and the local inverse identify its nonzero fibres as asserted. In a determinant frame the pencil locus is $G \times^{G^\circ} \mathcal{P}$. The previous closed-orbit calculation therefore gives the assertion for G . This is a statement inside that locus; it does not assert closedness under arbitrary degenerations of the determinant form in the full relation Grassmannian. $\square$

The closed specialization is very coarse compared with the unmarked local inverse: many pairwise nonisomorphic finite algebras have this same limiting fibre. The full first relation, not its common limit, retains the original pencil. The explicit family also differs from transport of spectral rank loci: it crosses from arbitrary pencils to a singular common-factor pencil without a regularity hypothesis. Theorem 11.4, on the other hand, describes divisor collisions in the larger natural first-relation boundary, outside the exact pencil image. These are two distinct geometric statements, and neither is a classification of every congruence-orbit adjacency of quadratic pencils.

APPENDIX J. TRANSVERSE DEFORMATIONS WITH UNCHANGED DETERMINANT SUPPORT

The larger determinant-divisor stratum has deformations which are not pencil deformations and need not satisfy either factor-invariance condition. We now identify their tangent directions and construct complete families in which the homogeneous radical remains exactly the determinant ideal. Thus the intrinsic stratum theorem has content outside the coefficient class, not merely a different description of the same symmetry hypothesis.

Let $J = L \otimes F$ be the primitive relation of a pencil $R \in \text{Gr}(2, W)$. In degree $h = 3n - 4$, write the equivariant Cauchy decomposition as

$$S_h(E) = (A \otimes F) \oplus H_{\text{other}},$$

where A, F, L are as in (G.1). The summand H_{other} contains every partition different from μ ; this notation denotes its full vector space, not a quotient chosen separately at each pencil.

Theorem J.1 (Normal directions to the pencil stratum). *The normal space at J of the pencil locus in $X_{h,M}(E)$ has the following equivariant direct-sum description:*

$$\begin{aligned} N_J \simeq & \text{Hom}\left(\bigwedge^2 R, \bigwedge^2 (W/R)\right) \\ & \oplus (\text{Hom}(L, A/L) \otimes \mathfrak{sl}(F)) \\ & \oplus \text{Hom}(L \otimes F, H_{\text{other}}). \end{aligned} \tag{J.1}$$

The summands respectively record departure from the Pluecker locus, departure from a full right multiplicity factor inside the same Cauchy summand, and departure into other Cauchy summands. They are all transverse directions in the effective first-relation stack: the infinitesimal G° -orbit lies in the pencil tangent space, so no vector in N_J is removed by that orbit. Every such direction is the first-order term of a local algebraic family in the determinant-divisor stratum. This last assertion refers to the common-divisor stratum; preservation of the entire homogeneous radical for complete families is supplied below.

Proof. The tangent space of a Grassmannian and the Cauchy splitting give

$$\mathrm{Hom}(J, S_h(E)/J) = (\mathrm{Hom}(L, A/L) \otimes \mathrm{End}(F)) \oplus \mathrm{Hom}(L \otimes F, H_{\mathrm{other}}). \quad (\mathrm{J}.2)$$

Under $L \mapsto L \otimes F$, the tangent to $\mathbb{P}(A)$ is the first factor tensored with the identity of F . In characteristic zero the trace splits $\mathrm{End}(F) = \mathbb{C}I \oplus \mathfrak{sl}(F)$. It remains to identify the normal space of the Pluecker embedding. The natural map $\wedge^2 W \rightarrow \wedge^2(W/R)$ has kernel $R \wedge W$. At the line $\wedge^2 R$, the tangent image is $\mathrm{Hom}(\wedge^2 R, (R \wedge W)/\wedge^2 R)$, which is the image of $\mathrm{Hom}(R, W/R)$. Its quotient in the projective tangent space is $\mathrm{Hom}(\wedge^2 R, \wedge^2(W/R))$. The common determinant twist in A cancels in this Hom space. Substitution in (J.2) proves (J.1) as a normal-space isomorphism. No splitting of the tangent sequence of the Pluecker embedding is being asserted.

The left group preserves the Pluecker locus, and the right group fixes $L \otimes F$; hence the differential of its orbit is in the pencil tangent. Passing to the quotient tangent complexes in (10.4) does not change this normal quotient. Finally $X_{h,M}(E)$ is open in a Grassmannian. A tangent vector is integrated by a graph with coefficients linear in one parameter, after restricting to a neighbourhood of zero which stays in this open set. Multiplication by δ^{n-1} and Proposition 10.4 give the claimed family of finite flat algebras. $\square$

Theorem J.2 (Complete fixed-support families through every pencil). *Put $e = n^2$. For every pencil R there is an e -dimensional subspace $B \subset J = \tilde{J}_R$ such that $\mathrm{gcd}(B) = 1$ and the forms in B have no common zero on the invertible matrix locus. The projective Grassmannian*

$$\Sigma_B = \{J' \in \mathrm{Gr}(M, S_h(E)) : B \subset J'\} \simeq \mathrm{Gr}(M - e, S_h(E)/B) \quad (\mathrm{J}.3)$$

contains J , is contained in $X_{h,M}(E)$, and satisfies

$$\sqrt{(\delta^{n-1}J')} = (\delta) \quad \text{for every geometric } J' \in \Sigma_B. \quad (\mathrm{J}.4)$$

Its universal first relation gives a finite flat family of the prescribed Hilbert function. It contains a projective line through J whose every other point is invariant under neither full factor group. Consequently determinant-radical relations through each pencil admit positive-dimensional complete families outside the recognized coefficient class, and their intrinsic deformation problem is described by Theorem 10.3.

Proof. By Lemma G.1, the residual coefficient vector is nonzero on every invertible matrix. Evaluation gives a morphism

$$\mathrm{GL}_n/\mathrm{G}_m \longrightarrow \mathbb{P}(J^*).$$

Its projective image closure Y has dimension at most $e - 1$. Since $M > e$ for $n \geq 3$, a general projective linear subspace of codimension e in $\mathbb{P}(J^*)$ misses Y . For such a subspace $\mathbb{P}(B^\perp)$, the associated e -plane $B \subset J$ has no common zero on the invertible locus. To justify the generic avoidance directly, the incidence of pairs consisting of a point of Y and an e -plane annihilated by it has dimension strictly smaller than $\mathrm{Gr}(e, J)$. Its projection is closed because Y is projective.

The condition $\mathrm{gcd}(B) = 1$ is a second nonempty open condition on $\mathrm{Gr}(e, J)$. To see nonemptiness, take any nonzero $b_1 \in J$. It has only finitely many irreducible factors. Since $\mathrm{gcd}(J) = 1$, a general $b_2 \in J$ avoids divisibility by each such factor; then $\mathrm{gcd}(b_1, b_2) = 1$. Extend their span to an e -plane. Openness follows from Lemma 10.1. The two nonempty opens intersect, as $\mathrm{Gr}(e, J)$ is irreducible.

Every J' containing this B has greatest common divisor 1, and its forms cannot vanish simultaneously on an invertible matrix. The common zero set of $\delta^{n-1}J'$ is thus exactly $V(\delta)$. The Nullstellensatz over an algebraically closed field proves (J.4). This is a statement about geometric homogeneous radicals. The scheme-theoretic family used here is the universal subbundle $\delta^{n-1}\mathcal{J}'$, not an operation of taking radicals on a nonreduced parameter ring. Multiplication by this fixed

nonzero form gives a subbundle; its quotient in degree d and all the lower symmetric powers are locally free. The truncated algebras are therefore finite flat.

For the final assertion, choose $j_0 \in J \setminus B$, a complement C to $\mathbb{C}j_0$ in J containing B , and a nonzero decomposable vector

$$\eta \in \operatorname{Sym}^h V^* \otimes \operatorname{Sym}^h U \subset H_{\text{other}}.$$

The inequality $M > e$ allows the choice of C . The family

$$J_{[a:b]} = C \oplus \mathbb{C}(aj_0 + b\eta), \quad [a:b] \in \mathbb{P}^1,$$

is a projective line in Σ_B through $J = J_{[1:0]}$. For $b \neq 0$ its projection to the (h) -Cauchy summand is exactly the line $\mathbb{C}\eta$. A decomposable line in $\operatorname{Sym}^h V^* \otimes \operatorname{Sym}^h U$ is invariant under neither full factor group: each of the two irreducible factors has dimension greater than one. Equivariance of the Cauchy projection therefore excludes both possible admissible orientations of $J_{[a:b]}$. The determinant-preserver theorem says that these are the only orientations after any change of the recovered matrix coordinates. This proves the assertion intrinsically, not only in the chosen matrix frame. $\square$

Remark J.3. The three normal modes and the complete fixed-support families separate two questions. The effective pencil stratum has exactly the deformation theory of quadratic pencils, including their singular boundary. The larger determinant-divisor stratum contains additional directions, explicitly described here, which cease to be pencil or coefficient relations. Retaining the determinant radical does not suppress these directions. Conversely, no classification of all ideals with a prescribed radical is needed to describe this larger locally closed stratum and its family inverse. These assertions enlarge the reconstruction problem without replacing the all-pencil theorem by a generic statement.

APPENDIX K. COVERING MAPS INSIDE ONE FIBRE ORBIT OF QUADRATIC PENCILS

We give a consequence native to the pencil construction. It embeds the equivalence problem for maps $\mathbb{P}^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1$ into unmarked finite failure schemes, while keeping the fibre algebra and every nilradical graded vector bundle fixed. Unlike a varying spectral invariant, the phenomenon occurs within a single orbit of singular pencils.

Fix $n \geq 3$, a two-dimensional subspace $H = \langle x, y \rangle \subset V$, and the trivial source bundle $\mathcal{U} = \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}^n$. Let $f = [a:b] : \mathbb{P}^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(H)$ be a morphism of degree $m \geq 1$, where a, b are homogeneous of degree m with no common zero. Its tautological line subbundle is

$$\mathcal{L}_f = \mathcal{O}(-m) \xrightarrow{(a,b)} H \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}.$$

Multiplication in $\operatorname{Sym} V$ defines a rank-two subbundle

$$\mathcal{R}_f = \mathcal{L}_f H \subset \operatorname{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}, \quad \mathcal{R}_f|_{[s:t]} = \langle (ax + by)x, (ax + by)y \rangle. \quad (\text{K.1})$$

Let $Y_f = Y_{\mathcal{R}_f}^{[d]}$ be its order- d failure thickening, with

$$N = \binom{n+1}{2}, \quad p = N - 2, \quad d = n^2 + 2n - 4, \quad M = \binom{N}{2}, \quad e = n^2.$$

All schemes below are compared without projection, grading, embedding, matrix factors, or coefficient markings.

Theorem K.1 (Unmarked realization of the covering equivalence problem). *For fixed $n \geq 3$ and $m \geq 1$, the schemes Y_f have the following properties.*

(i) *They are finite locally free over their reduction $\mathbb{P}^1$, of rank $\binom{e+d}{d} - M$, and are Zariski locally trivial with the same Artin algebra as fibre. Every fibre pencil is equivalent to $\langle x^2, xy \rangle$.*

(ii) Writing $\mathfrak{n}_f$ for their nilradicals, their graded vector bundles are independent of f :

$$\begin{aligned} \mathfrak{n}_f^j / \mathfrak{n}_f^{j+1} &\simeq \mathcal{O}^{\binom{e+j-1}{j}} \quad (1 \leq j < d), \\ \mathfrak{n}_f^d &\simeq \mathcal{O}^{\binom{e+d-1}{d}-3M} \oplus \mathcal{O}(m)^{\oplus 2M}. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{K.2})$$

Their abstract first-relation bundles are all $\mathcal{O}(-2m)^{\oplus M}$, and their pencil and quotient bundles are respectively $\mathcal{O}(-m)^2$ and $\mathcal{O}(2m) \oplus \mathcal{O}^{N-3}$.

(iii) For two degree- m maps,

$$Y_f \simeq Y_{f'} \iff f' = \alpha \circ f \circ \sigma \quad \text{for some } \alpha, \sigma \in \text{PGL}_2(\mathbb{C}). \quad (\text{K.3})$$

Thus the double-orbit set of degree- m morphisms $\mathbb{P}^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1$ is realized faithfully by unmarked quadratic-pencil failure schemes with all the additive data in (ii) fixed. This is a statement about isomorphism classes, not an equivalence of their automorphism groupoids.

Proof. The pencil and local triviality. Multiplication by a nonzero linear form is injective on H . Since (a, b) never vanishes, the map $\mathcal{O}(-m) \otimes H \rightarrow \text{Sym}^2 H \otimes \mathcal{O}$ has rank two everywhere. Its image is a subbundle with locally free quotient. In the basis x^2, xy, y^2 its two columns are

$$\begin{pmatrix} a & 0 \\ b & a \\ 0 & b \end{pmatrix}, \quad \text{with Pluecker coordinates } (a^2, ab, b^2). \quad (\text{K.4})$$

It follows that $\mathcal{R}_f \simeq \mathcal{O}(-m)^2$. The quotient of $\text{Sym}^2 H \otimes \mathcal{O}$ is a line bundle of degree $2m$. A constant complement to $\text{Sym}^2 H$ in $\text{Sym}^2 V$ gives $\mathcal{S}_f \simeq \mathcal{O}(2m) \oplus \mathcal{O}^{N-3}$. On an open set where $\mathcal{L}_f$ is trivialized, complete its nonvanishing generator to a frame of $H \otimes \mathcal{O}$. The inverse frame map takes $\mathcal{R}_f$ to $\langle x^2, xy \rangle$. Extend it by the identity on a fixed complement of H in V . With the source bundle trivial, it identifies the defining minors and the truncated algebra with a product on that open set. This proves local triviality, not merely equality of fibre isomorphism classes. Lemma F.1 gives finite local freeness and the asserted rank.

The entire graded bundle calculation. The first relations occur in degree d , so all lower positive graded pieces are the full constant symmetric powers of $E = V^* \otimes \mathbb{C}^n$. Put $F(V) = \bigwedge^p \text{Sym}^2 V$, of dimension M . The coefficient line $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}_f} = \bigwedge^p \mathcal{S}_f^*$ is $\mathcal{O}(-2m)$. Under exterior duality

$$F(V)^* \simeq \bigwedge^2 (\text{Sym}^2 V) \otimes \det(\text{Sym}^2 V)^*,$$

its inclusion is the Pluecker line of $\mathcal{R}_f$. The constant determinant twist does not affect the bundle calculation. Thus it lies in a fixed three-dimensional subspace of $F(V)^*$, with column (a^2, ab, b^2) . There is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}(-2m) \xrightarrow{(a^2, ab, b^2)^t} \mathcal{O}^3 \xrightarrow{\begin{pmatrix} -b & a & 0 \\ 0 & -b & a \end{pmatrix}} \mathcal{O}(m)^2 \longrightarrow 0. \quad (\text{K.5})$$

Indeed the composite is zero; the maximal minors of the second map are $b^2, -ab, a^2$, which have no common zero. It is therefore everywhere surjective. Its rank-one kernel is the image of the displayed nowhere vanishing column. Taking a constant complement proves

$$(F(V)^* \otimes \mathcal{O}) / \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}_f} \simeq \mathcal{O}^{M-3} \oplus \mathcal{O}(m)^2. \quad (\text{K.6})$$

The fixed Cauchy inclusion, followed by multiplication by the fixed determinant, embeds $F(V)^* \otimes F(\mathbb{C}^n)$ as an M^2 -dimensional constant subspace of $\text{Sym}^d E$. The first relation bundle is precisely $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}_f} \otimes F(\mathbb{C}^n)$ in that subspace. Choose a constant complement to the whole subspace, not to its varying relation subbundle. The top graded quotient is therefore

$$\mathcal{O}^{\binom{e+d-1}{d}-M^2} \oplus \left((F(V)^* \otimes \mathcal{O}) / \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}_f} \right)^{\oplus M}.$$

Equation (K.6) gives exactly (K.2). It also shows that the first relation bundle is $\mathcal{O}(-2m)^{\oplus M}$. All assertions in (ii) concern vector bundles; their multiplication maps have not been identified.

The global inverse is the covering equivalence. Suppose $Y_f \simeq Y_{f'}$. Their reductions give an automorphism of $\mathbb{P}^1$. By Theorem 7.2, or the actual descent theorem with the pencil coefficient line, the varying pencil subbundles are identified by that base map and a single constant $g \in \mathrm{GL}(V)$. For a nonzero $\ell \in H$, the common polynomial divisor of the two-dimensional space $\ell H \subset \mathrm{Sym}^2 V$ is precisely ℓ , up to scalar: x and y have no common nonconstant divisor in $\mathrm{Sym} V$. Dividing the pencil space by this common factor recovers H . These operations are equivariant under $\mathrm{GL}(V)$. Consequently an equality between $g(\ell H)$ and a pencil of the form $\ell' H$ forces $gH = H$ and $[g\ell] = [\ell']$. The constant restriction $g|_H$ therefore supplies a single $\alpha \in \mathrm{PGL}(H)$ for the whole map. Replacing the recovered base map by its inverse if necessary gives the right-hand side of (K.3).

Conversely choose linear lifts of α on H and extend by the identity on a complement in V . Together with the base map and the identity identification of the trivial source bundles, this gives equivalent pencil data. Their homogeneous normal maps induce an isomorphism of the finite schemes. This proves (iii) and the theorem. $\square$

Corollary K.2 (A pencil-native separating pair). *For every $n \geq 3$, the degree-three maps*

$$f_0 = [s^3 : t^3], \quad f_1 = [s^3 + st^2 : t^3]$$

give nonisomorphic unmarked order- d failure schemes of quadratic pencils, although they have the same Artin fibres, the same conormal and first-relation bundles, the same pencil and quotient bundles, and isomorphic nilradical graded vector bundles in every degree. For $n = 3$ their common finite rank is 167945, and their top graded bundle is

$$\mathcal{O}^{75537} \oplus \mathcal{O}(3)^{\oplus 30}.$$

Proof. The pairs of cubics have no common zero. In the affine coordinate $z = s/t$ the maps are z^3 and $z^3 + z$. The first has two ramification points, both of index three. The second has the two distinct zeros of $3z^2 + 1$, each of index two, and infinity of index three. Independent projective changes in source and target preserve this multiset of indices, so the two maps are inequivalent. The theorem proves all the geometric assertions. For $n = 3$, $e = 9$, $d = 11$, $M = 15$, whence $\binom{20}{11} - 15 = 167945$ and $\binom{19}{11} - 45 = 75537$. $\square$

This consequence uses the global inverse essentially. Pointwise local reconstruction returns the same pencil orbit at every point for every f ; it cannot recover the map f . Even supplementing it with all the abstract bundles displayed in the theorem leaves the covering equivalence problem unresolved. It is the multiplication in the total unmarked thickening, followed by descent to one constant left transformation, that recovers that problem. The double-orbit description is not an assertion that the scheme has the automorphism group of the cover: the unused complement of H , the right factor, and the higher-order kernel remain present, as recorded by the previous automorphism theorems.

APPENDIX L. SPECTRAL TORSION AND RANK-PRESERVING SPECIALIZATION

The finite-neighbourhood theorem recovers more than the discriminant or the corank of each member of a regular pencil. We identify its classical spectral invariant and then give a flat specialization on which the entire discriminant and every reduced rank locus remain constant, while the recovered invariant changes. The two specializations are separated at exactly the order of Theorem 6.1. The parameter space throughout is the usual Grassmannian of pencils; the failure map is the original multiplication map, not an added coefficient-evaluation block.

L.1. The spectral torsion sheaf. Let $R \subset \text{Sym}^2 V$ be a regular pencil, meaning that it contains a nonsingular quadratic form. On its parameter line $L_R = \mathbb{P}(R)$, the tautological quadratic form gives an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_{L_R}(-1) \xrightarrow{q_R} V \otimes \mathcal{O}_{L_R} \longrightarrow \mathcal{T}_R \longrightarrow 0. \quad (\text{L.1})$$

The first arrow is injective because its determinant is nonzero at the generic point of the smooth integral curve L_R . Thus $\mathcal{T}_R$ is a torsion sheaf of length n , whose zeroth Fitting divisor is the full discriminant. The pair $(L_R, \mathcal{T}_R)$ is considered up to isomorphism of the parameter line. Its definition involves no choice of a basis of R . The relation with elementary divisors is classical; see [4, §2, Corollary 2.1 and equation (5)]. We record the argument to make precise which datum is recovered.

Lemma L.1 (Sheaves on the affine spectral line). *Let A, B be symmetric complex matrices with A invertible. On the affine line with coordinate z , the cokernel of $zA - B$ is the finite-dimensional $\mathbb{C}[z]$ -module on $\mathbb{C}^n$ for which multiplication by z is $C = A^{-1}B$. An isomorphism of such sheaves, in this fixed coordinate, is equivalent to similarity of the corresponding matrices.*

Proof. Multiplication on the target by A^{-1} identifies the presentation with $zI - C$. Reduction of a polynomial vector modulo these relations sends $\sum_j z^j v_j$ to $\sum_j C^j v_j$; constant vectors give the inverse identification. The equivalence between coherent sheaves on an affine scheme and finitely generated modules identifies a finite-length sheaf supported in this affine line with this module. The support is finite, so its underlying complex vector space is finite dimensional. A module isomorphism is a linear isomorphism G satisfying $GC = C'G$, which is exactly similarity. Extension by zero across a point outside the support loses no sheaf data. $\square$

Lemma L.2 (Polynomial square roots of invertible operators). *For every invertible complex matrix K there is $h \in \mathbb{C}[x]$ with $h(K)^2 = K$. If K is self-adjoint for a nondegenerate symmetric form and commutes with C , then $h(K)$ has both properties.*

Proof. Write the minimal polynomial as $\prod_\lambda (x - \lambda)^{a_\lambda}$, where $\lambda \neq 0$. In its local Artinian factor choose a square root $\mu_\lambda^2 = \lambda$, and put

$$h_\lambda(x) = \mu_\lambda \sum_{j=0}^{a_\lambda-1} \binom{1/2}{j} \left(\frac{x - \lambda}{\lambda} \right)^j.$$

The formal binomial identity, truncated modulo $(x - \lambda)^{a_\lambda}$, gives $h_\lambda(x)^2 = x$. The Chinese remainder theorem joins these polynomials to a single class modulo the minimal polynomial. Evaluation at K proves the assertion even when K is not semisimple. Polynomials in one self-adjoint operator remain self-adjoint, and every polynomial in K commutes with every operator commuting with K . $\square$

Theorem L.3 (Spectral reconstruction at the first relation). *Let $n \geq 3$, $d = n^2 + 2n - 4$, and let R, R' be regular pencils. The following are equivalent:*

- (1) *the unmarked schemes $Z_R^{[d]}$ and $Z_{R'}^{[d]}$ are isomorphic;*
- (2) *there is an isomorphism $f : L_R \rightarrow L_{R'}$ with $\mathcal{T}_R \simeq f^* \mathcal{T}_{R'}$;*
- (3) *the pencils R, R' are projectively equivalent.*

In particular the finite scheme determines the full root-labelled spectral torsion sheaf, not only its Fitting divisor or its support. This is an equivalence of isomorphism classes of objects; it is not an assertion identifying their automorphism groups or moduli stacks.

Proof. The equivalence of the first and third conditions is Theorem 6.1. A congruence of pencils induces an isomorphism of (L.1), so the third implies the second.

For the converse choose a common affine coordinate whose point at infinity avoids the two spectral supports, using f to identify the lines. Write the corresponding symmetric pairs as (A, B) and (A', B') , with A, A' invertible, and set $C = A^{-1}B$, $C' = A'^{-1}B'$. Choose the presentation $zA - B$ for the affine coordinate on both lines. Lemma L.1 identifies the two sheaves with the modules of C, C' , so their isomorphism gives a similarity. After applying that change of coordinates, assume $C' = C$. Both A and A' are nondegenerate symmetric forms for which C is self-adjoint. Then $K = A^{-1}A'$ commutes with C and is self-adjoint for A . Lemma L.2 provides a polynomial h with $h(K)^2 = K$. Put $H = h(K)$. It commutes with C , is self-adjoint for A , and satisfies

$$H^t A H = A', \quad H^t B H = H^t A C H = A' C = B'.$$

Thus the pairs, and hence the pencils, are congruent. This also shows why the spectral sheaf alone suffices here; no additional pairing on that sheaf is required over $\mathbb{C}$. $\square$

For $x \in \text{Supp } \mathcal{T}_R$, put

$$\ell_a(x) = \text{length}(\mathcal{T}_{R,x}/\mathfrak{m}_x^a \mathcal{T}_{R,x}), \quad a \geq 0. \quad (\text{L.2})$$

If the elementary-divisor exponents at x are $e_1, \dots, e_b$, the structure theorem over the discrete valuation ring $\mathcal{O}_{L_R,x}$ gives

$$\ell_a(x) = \sum_{j=1}^b \min(a, e_j), \quad \ell_a(x) - \ell_{a-1}(x) = \#\{j : e_j \geq a\}. \quad (\text{L.3})$$

Thus these intrinsic local lengths recover every exponent, including repeated roots. The corank of the pencil at x gives only $\ell_1(x)$, and the multiplicity of the discriminant gives only the eventual value $\ell_a(x) = \sum_j e_j$. The intermediate values are genuinely additional information.

L.2. A specialization with constant discriminant and coranks. The following family keeps both ends of this length profile fixed. Fix $i \in \mathbb{C}$ with $i^2 = -1$, and set

$$N_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & i \\ i & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad P_t = \frac{t}{2} N_0, \quad A_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & I_2 \\ I_2 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad C_t = \begin{pmatrix} P_t & I_2 \\ 0 & P_t \end{pmatrix}. \quad (\text{L.4})$$

Put

$$B_t = A_0 C_t = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & P_t \\ P_t & I_2 \end{pmatrix}, \quad R_t = \langle A_0, B_t \rangle \subset \text{Sym}^2 \mathbb{C}^4. \quad (\text{L.5})$$

Both matrices are symmetric and A_0 is invertible. They are independent for every t . For $n > 4$, append I_{n-4} to A_0 and append $\text{diag}(\mu_5, \dots, \mu_n)$ to B_t , where the μ_j are fixed distinct nonzero numbers. Denote the resulting matrices by $A^{(n)}, B_t^{(n)}$ and their pencil again by R_t .

Theorem L.4 (Separation inside fixed reduced rank data). *For every $n \geq 4$, the family R_t , $t \in \mathbb{A}^1$, has the following properties.*

- (1) *Its full discriminant, with multiplicities, is independent of t :*

$$\det(sA^{(n)} + uB_t^{(n)}) = s^4 \prod_{j=5}^n (s + \mu_j u). \quad (\text{L.6})$$

For every minor size, the reduced determinantal locus on the marked parameter line is also independent of t .

- (2) *At the root $s = 0$, the spectral module has exponents $(3, 1)$ for $t \neq 0$ and $(2, 2)$ for $t = 0$. Consequently $Z_{R_t}^{[d]} \not\cong Z_{R_0}^{[d]}$ for every $t \neq 0$, whereas all the punctured fibres are isomorphic.*

- (3) The schemes $Z_{R_t}^{[d]}$ form a flat projective family over $\mathbb{A}^1$, with fixed reduction. After one identification of the socle quotient bundles, every truncation of order $k < d$ is a constant family. Thus the first separating order remains exactly $d = n^2 + 2n - 4$ even under the constraints in part (1).

Proof. The identities $N_0^2 = 0$ and $\text{rank } N_0 = 1$ give

$$C_t^2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & tN_0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad C_t^3 = 0, \quad C_t = \begin{pmatrix} I_2 \\ P_t \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} P_t & I_2 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (\text{L.7})$$

The right factor in the last expression is surjective and the left factor is injective. Hence $\text{rank } C_t = 2$ for every t , whereas $\text{rank } C_t^2 = 1$ precisely when $t \neq 0$. The nilpotent partitions are therefore $(3, 1)$ and $(2, 2)$. Also $\det A_0 = 1$ and $\det(sI_4 + uC_t) = s^4$, proving (L.6). At $s = 0$ the full pencil has corank two for all t ; at each remaining root it has corank one, and elsewhere corank zero. Equality of these functions on $\mathbb{P}^1(\mathbb{C})$ implies equality of the reduced closed determinantal subschemes for each minor size.

At the unique multiplicity-four root, formula (L.3) yields respectively

$$(\ell_1, \ell_2, \ell_3, \dots) = (2, 3, 4, \dots), \quad (2, 4, 4, \dots).$$

No automorphism of the parameter line can exchange this root with a simple one. Theorem L.3 separates the special fibre from the punctured fibres and identifies the latter with one another. This is a statement about geometric fibres; no choice of a simultaneous trivializing congruence on $\mathbb{A}^1 \setminus 0$ is needed.

For flatness we use the relative gluing of Theorem M.1; the following coordinates identify its pullback in the present family. First note that $t \mapsto R_t$ is a morphism to $\text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V)$, not merely a collection of pencils. In symmetric matrix coordinates the two fixed linear functionals

$$a(Q) = Q_{13} + iQ_{14}, \quad b(Q) = Q_{33}$$

satisfy $a(A^{(n)}) = b(B_t^{(n)}) = 1$ and $a(B_t^{(n)}) = b(A^{(n)}) = 0$. Their common kernel is a fixed complement to every R_t . It trivializes $S_{R_t} = \text{Sym}^2 V / R_t$, and hence identifies the relative socle Grassmannian with $B \times \mathbb{A}^1$.

On a frame chart of its tautological bundle, the graph description (6.4) identifies the truncated algebra with

$$\bigoplus_{j=0}^{d-1} \text{Sym}^j E^* \oplus (\text{Sym}^d E^* / K_{R_t}). \quad (\text{L.8})$$

By Theorem 6.3, K_{R_t} is a subbundle of constant rank $\binom{N}{2}$, with locally free quotient. This statement commutes with pullback to the present base and with right changes of frame, so the local descriptions glue. Thus (L.8) is locally free on $B \times \mathbb{A}^1$, of rank $\binom{n^2+d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}$. The graph projection is a finite flat morphism to that base. Since B is projective, its composition with projection to $\mathbb{A}^1$ is flat and projective. Below degree d there is no relation, and the fixed complement identifies the entire lower truncated algebra, including multiplication, with a constant family. These arguments prove flatness of the finite neighbourhoods; they make no assertion about flatness of the unrestricted failure schemes. $\square$

The qualifier “reduced” in part (1) is necessary. At $s = 0$, in a local parameter $z = s/u$, the gcd of the three-row minors of the four-dimensional block is a unit times z for $t \neq 0$ and a unit times z^2 for $t = 0$. Both radicals are (z) . Thus the family retains exactly the higher Fitting information discarded by reduction; it does not contradict the classical classification by the full determinantal ideals.

L.3. An independently visible change of reciprocal geometry. For a regular pencil let its reciprocal curve be the projective closure of the inverses of its nonsingular members. These curves and their strata are studied independently of multiplication-failure schemes in [4, §3].

Corollary L.5 (A conic specializes to a line). *For the four-dimensional family (L.5), the reciprocal curve is a smooth plane conic when $t \neq 0$ and a projective line when $t = 0$. The unmarked twentieth neighbourhood distinguishes these two cases, while all earlier neighbourhoods, the full discriminant, and all reduced rank loci agree.*

Proof. For $s \neq 0$, multiplication on the right by the fixed invertible matrix A_0^{-1} identifies the projective inverse with

$$(sI_4 + uC_t)^{-1} = s^{-1}I_4 - us^{-2}C_t + u^2s^{-3}C_t^2.$$

If $t \neq 0$, the matrices I_4, C_t, C_t^2 are linearly independent: their span has dimension equal to the degree three of the minimal polynomial. The closure is therefore the quadratic Veronese image $[s : u] \mapsto [s^2 : -su : u^2]$, a smooth conic in its spanning plane. At $t = 0$ the last term vanishes, and I_4, C_0 are independent, giving a line. The remaining assertions follow from Theorem L.4, with $d = 20$. The degree drop does not assert that the reciprocal curves themselves form a flat family; the flat family proved above consists of the finite failure neighbourhoods. $\square$

APPENDIX M. THE UNIVERSAL FINITE NEIGHBOURHOOD AND SPECTRAL STRATA

The finite-order construction is a family of actual neighbourhoods in multiplication-failure schemes. This fact is needed when passing from individual pencils to degenerations and infinitesimal parameter spaces. We establish it before discussing the spectral incidence schemes.

Put $P = \text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V)$, and write $\mathcal{R}$ and $\mathcal{S} = (\text{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}_P)/\mathcal{R}$ for its universal relation and quotient bundles. Let

$$\pi : \mathcal{B} = \text{Gr}_P(n, \mathcal{S}) \longrightarrow P, \quad \mathcal{E} = \text{Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}),$$

where $\mathcal{U}$ is tautological of rank n . As before, $N = n(n+1)/2$, $p = N - 2$, $d = n + 2p$, and $M = \binom{N}{2}$.

Theorem M.1 (Universal neighbourhood and arbitrary base change). *The universal multiplication-failure scheme has a canonical order- d neighbourhood $\mathcal{Z}^{[d]}$ of $\mathcal{B}$. There is a rank- M vector subbundle $\mathcal{K} \subset \text{Sym}^d \mathcal{E}^*$ such that*

$$\mathcal{Z}^{[d]} = \text{Spec}_{\mathcal{B}} \left(\text{Sym} \mathcal{E}^* / (\mathcal{K}, \text{Sym}^{d+1} \mathcal{E}^*) \right). \quad (\text{M.1})$$

This is finite locally free over $\mathcal{B}$, of rank

$$\binom{n^2 + d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}, \quad (\text{M.2})$$

and is projective and flat over P . Its construction, its ideal-adic filtration, and its identification with the actual multiplication-failure neighbourhood commute with every morphism of complex schemes $T \rightarrow P$, including nonreduced ones. For $k < d$, its order- k truncation is $\text{Spec}_{\mathcal{B}} \bigoplus_{j=0}^k \text{Sym}^j \mathcal{E}^$, with truncated multiplication. After trivializing $\mathcal{S}$ on the parameter base, these lower-order families are constant.*

Proof. The locus in $\text{Gr}_P(n, V \oplus \mathcal{S})$ on which projection to $\mathcal{S}$ is injective is canonically $\text{Tot } \mathcal{E}$. It is an open neighbourhood of $\mathcal{B}$, not a choice of formal coordinates. On a frame chart of $\mathcal{U}$, let $T : \mathcal{U} \rightarrow V$ be the universal graph map and let $\gamma : \text{Sym}^2 V \rightarrow \mathcal{S}$ be the quotient. The same block elimination that proves (6.4) works over its coordinate ring: the ideal of the multiplication-failure scheme is

$$(\det T)I_p(\gamma \text{Sym}^2 T).$$

Every generator is homogeneous of degree d .

Here is also a coordinate-free description of its first relation bundle. The coefficient map, followed by determinant multiplication, is a morphism

$$\det V^* \otimes \det \mathcal{U} \otimes \det \mathcal{S}^* \otimes \bigwedge^p \mathrm{Sym}^2 \mathcal{U} \longrightarrow \mathrm{Sym}^d \mathcal{E}^*. \quad (\text{M.3})$$

The inclusion used in this expression is $\det \mathcal{S}^* \hookrightarrow (\bigwedge^p \mathrm{Sym}^2 V)^*$. The determinant factors evaluate $\det T$, and the remaining factors evaluate $\bigwedge^p \mathrm{Sym}^2 T$ followed by the quotient. Thus the image is exactly the span of the displayed maximal minors, not a separately inserted coefficient module.

On a frame chart this map is the fixed injective linear coefficient map ν of Theorem 6.3, restricted to a line subbundle tensored with the fixed space $\bigwedge^p \mathrm{Sym}^2 \mathbb{C}^n$. Its image is a subbundle of rank M : locally split the line in the source, and split the fixed complex linear inclusion ν . Both splittings remain splittings over any complex algebra. Denote its image by $\mathcal{K}$. A right change of frame of $\mathcal{U}$ changes the graph coordinates and this coefficient map contragrediently. The determinant character in (M.3) is exactly the one arising from $\det T$. Hence these local ideals and their degree- d subbundles agree on overlaps. In particular, they glue as ideals of the given graph neighbourhood.

Let $\mathfrak{b}$ be the ideal of the zero section inside the multiplication-failure scheme. In graph coordinates its preimage is the positive-degree ideal. Quotienting by $\mathfrak{b}^{d+1}$ therefore gives precisely (M.1). This identifies the gluing with the actual ideal-adic neighbourhood, not merely with algebras having the correct geometric fibres. Its underlying module is

$$\bigoplus_{j=0}^{d-1} \mathrm{Sym}^j \mathcal{E}^* \oplus (\mathrm{Sym}^d \mathcal{E}^* / \mathcal{K}).$$

All terms are locally free. Counting monomials in n^2 variables gives (M.2). The morphism $\mathcal{B} \rightarrow P$ is smooth and projective, so the asserted flatness and projectivity follow. Finally the graph description, the split coefficient inclusion, and the homogeneous quotient all commute with base change. Below degree d the ideal contributes no relation. This proves the final assertion as well. $\square$

Remark M.2. Over a nonreduced base, the theorem concerns the specified relative socle subscheme $\mathcal{B}_T$ and its ideal. It does not identify that ideal with the absolute nilradical of $\mathcal{Z}_T^{[d]}$, which can also contain nilpotents from the base. On geometric fibres $\mathcal{B}_t$ is exactly the reduction. Nor is this theorem an equivalence of unmarked deformation groupoids: extra automorphisms of truncated algebras are not being identified with pencil congruences.

M.1. Spectral incidence schemes from the first relation space. On the regular-pencil locus, pass locally to ordered generators (A, B) with A invertible, and put $C = A^{-1}B$. For a marked point with affine coordinate z , set $X = C - zI$. The next elementary presentation works over an arbitrary coefficient ring; no diagonalization or division by eigenvalue differences is involved.

Lemma M.3 (Truncated spectral presentation). *Let D be a commutative ring, $X \in \mathrm{Mat}_n(D)$, and $a \geq 1$. There is a natural isomorphism*

$$\mathrm{coker}(wI - X) \otimes_{D[w]} D[w]/(w^a) \simeq \mathrm{coker}(X^a : D^n \rightarrow D^n). \quad (\text{M.4})$$

Equivalently, the a -square block presentation with diagonal blocks X and subdiagonal blocks $-I$ is equivalent, by invertible row and column operations over D , to $I_{n(a-1)} \oplus X^a$.

Proof. Map the class of $\sum_{j=0}^{a-1} w^j v_j$ to the class of $\sum_{j=0}^{a-1} X^j v_j$ modulo $X^a D^n$. The relation $wv = Xv$ and the relation $w^a v = 0$ show that this map is well-defined. Sending a constant

vector to its class is inverse. Eliminating successively the blocks with coefficient $-I$ gives the stated presentation equivalence, using only unit pivots. This also proves naturality under ring homomorphisms. $\square$

Theorem M.4 (Scheme-theoretic spectral readout). *In the fixed tensor presentation of Theorem 6.3, the first relation subspace determines, on the regular-pencil locus, every closed spectral incidence scheme*

$$\mathfrak{S}_{a,h} = V(I_{n-h+1}((C - zI)^a)), \quad 1 \leq a, h \leq n. \quad (\text{M.5})$$

This determination commutes with arbitrary complex base change. At a geometric point, membership is equivalent to $\text{length}(\mathcal{T}_z/\mathfrak{m}_z^a \mathcal{T}_z) \geq h$. Consequently the schemes of specified spectral length profiles, and not only their reduced supports, can be read from the order- d relation subspace.

Proof. The closed immersion Φ of Theorem 6.3 has an inverse on its scheme-theoretic image. Thus a family of relation subspaces in that image recovers its morphism to P , over any base, and hence its universal pencil. In the displayed chart its spectral sheaf has presentation $(z+w)I - C = wI - X$. Lemma M.3 gives the presentation X^a for restriction to the order- a fat point centred at z . Its $(h-1)$ -st Fitting ideal is exactly the ideal in (M.5); Fitting ideals of finitely presented modules commute with base change. On a field the cokernel has dimension at least h exactly when these minors vanish.

These descriptions are independent of the chosen frames. A change of basis in V conjugates X ; a change of affine coordinate replaces the parameter ideal at the marked point by a unit multiple locally. Alternatively, restriction of the spectral sheaf to the fat diagonal on its parameter line defines the same finite module without a coordinate. Thus the Fitting ideals glue. Rank equality is imposed by the corresponding rank inequality together with the open complement of the next inequality. Intersecting these locally closed conditions gives each specified length profile. Formula (L.3) then identifies its geometric fibres with the prescribed elementary-divisor partition. $\square$

M.2. Realizing the complete Segre stratification. Let P_σ denote the reduced closure in P of a regular Segre stratum, and let $J_\sigma = \Phi(P_\sigma)$. Because Φ is a closed immersion, it gives isomorphisms

$$P_\sigma \simeq J_\sigma, \quad P_{\sigma_1} \cap_P \cdots \cap_P P_{\sigma_s} \simeq J_{\sigma_1} \cap_{\Phi(P)} \cdots \cap_{\Phi(P)} J_{\sigma_s}, \quad (\text{M.6})$$

where the intersections carry their scheme structures. In particular their local rings and formal completions are preserved. Pulling back Theorem M.1 realizes these parameter schemes by flat projective families of the actual finite failure neighbourhoods. The classical inclusions among Segre-stratum closures [4, Theorem 5.1] are therefore all realized, rather than just the one degeneration of Theorem L.4.

There are two distinct assertions here. The Segre closure order is classical, and transport of closed subschemes through a closed immersion is formal. The geometric input proved here is the base-change-compatible realization by actual multiplication-failure neighbourhoods and the recovery of their spectral Fitting schemes. The ambient parameter space in (M.6) is the image of Φ , not a moduli space of every possible unmarked deformation of a finite scheme.

APPENDIX N. FIXED-DISCRIMINANT STRATA AND ALL ADMISSIBLE SPECIALIZATIONS

The universal family of Section M and the example of Section L lead to a classification of the entire fixed-discriminant, fixed-reduced-rank locus. The spectral orbit order is classical. Every allowed specialization is realized here by a flat family of the original finite multiplication-failure neighbourhoods, and the same first relation detects every strict transition.

Fix distinct $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_s \in \mathbb{C}$, positive m_i with $\sum m_i = n \geq 3$, and $1 \leq c_i \leq m_i$. Fix a nonsingular symmetric A , and let $\mathfrak{p}_A$ be its self-adjoint endomorphisms. Consider the reduced locally closed

variety

$$X_{m,c}(A) = \left\{ C \in \mathfrak{p}_A : \det(zI - C) = \prod_i (z - \alpha_i)^{m_i}, \quad \dim \ker(C - \alpha_i I) = c_i \right\}. \quad (\text{N.1})$$

Exclude $s = 1, c_1 = n$, for which C is scalar and $\langle A, AC \rangle$ is not a pencil. Every other datum is realized. Put $R_C = \langle A, AC \rangle$, $d = n^2 + 2n - 4$, and $Z_C = Z_{R_C}^{[d]}$. The full binary determinant is $\det(A) \prod_i (u + \alpha_i v)^{m_i}$. The coranks and labelled roots specify all reduced determinantal loci on the line.

Write $\mathcal{P}(m, c)$ for partitions into exactly c positive parts. For equal-size partitions, $\mu \preceq \lambda$ means $\sum_{j \leq a} \mu_j \leq \sum_{j \leq a} \lambda_j$ for every a ; write λ' for the conjugate partition.

N.1. The classical orthogonal input. We isolate the orbit theorem used below, with its precise group and source. Let (H, A) be a nondegenerate complex symmetric space of dimension m . The acting group is the full orthogonal group $O(A)$, and the operators are A -self-adjoint, not elements of the skew-adjoint Lie algebra $\mathfrak{o}(A)$.

Lemma N.1 (Self-adjoint nilpotent orbits). *The full $O(A)$ -orbits of self-adjoint nilpotent operators are indexed by all partitions λ of m . If $\mathcal{O}_\lambda$ denotes the orbit, then*

$$\dim \mathcal{O}_\lambda = \frac{1}{2} \left(m^2 - \sum_a (\lambda'_a)^2 \right), \quad \mathcal{O}_\mu \subset \overline{\mathcal{O}_\lambda} \iff \mu \preceq \lambda.$$

An $O(A)$ -orbit is one $SO(A)$ -orbit when λ has an odd part. When every part is even, it is the disjoint union of two $SO(A)$ -orbits, interchanged by an isometry of determinant -1 . The closure statement above is for the full orthogonal orbit and does not identify the closures of its two components.

Proof. The classification and closure assertions are [5, Proposition 1, p. 444; Theorem 1, p. 447], respectively, with $\varepsilon = 1$ and $G(V)$ as defined in [5, §1.1, p. 443]. Remark 1 on p. 444 specifies that all partitions occur; the order in §1.4 on p. 446 is precisely the row-dominance order used here. The proof of Theorem 1 occupies pp. 447–451. These references concern the full group, not its identity component.

For the dimension formula there is a short independent calculation. The trace pairing on $\text{End } H$ is nondegenerate on both its self-adjoint and skew-adjoint summands. For a self-adjoint nilpotent N , the commutator with N exchanges the summands, and the two resulting maps are adjoint up to sign for that pairing. They have equal rank. Consequently $\dim \text{GL}(H)N = 2 \dim O(A)N$, also the identity in [5, §2.4, Remark 8(i), p. 456]. The general linear centralizer has dimension $\sum_{i,j} \min(\lambda_i, \lambda_j) = \sum_a (\lambda'_a)^2$, as follows by writing homomorphisms between the cyclic $\mathbb{C}[t]$ -modules of the Jordan decomposition. This proves the stated dimension.

We give the component argument explicitly. The good bases of [5, Lemma 1, p. 444] decompose the symmetric space orthogonally into cyclic Jordan blocks, each with a reversed-identity Gram matrix. If one block has odd size, its negative identity, extended by the identity on the other blocks, centralizes N and has determinant -1 . The centralizer then meets both components of $O(A)$, so the orbit is a single $SO(A)$ -orbit.

For the converse, write

$$E_k = \ker N^k / (\ker N^{k-1} + N \ker N^{k+1}).$$

The form induced by $A(u, N^{k-1}v)$ on E_k is nondegenerate and symmetric; this is immediate on the same cyclic blocks. A commuting isometry induces $g_k \in O(E_k)$. A filtration of the Jordan module by its cyclic lengths and powers of t gives

$$\det g = \prod_k (\det g_k)^k.$$

Indeed the multiplicity-space action of a length- k block occurs k times on the associated graded; the strictly triangular terms of a module automorphism do not change its determinant. If all lengths are even, this product is one. The centralizer lies in $SO(A)$, and the index-two quotient of $O(A)$ therefore gives exactly two $SO(A)$ -orbits. Since $SO(A)$ is connected, these are the connected components of the full orbit. This does not preclude their closures from meeting. $\square$

Theorem N.2 (Classification and specialization at the first relation). *The following statements hold.*

- (1) *The $O(A)$ -orbits in $X_{\mathbf{m},c}(A)$ are indexed by $\lambda \in \prod_i \mathcal{P}(m_i, c_i)$, with dimensions*

$$\dim \mathcal{O}_\lambda = \frac{1}{2} \left(n^2 - \sum_i \sum_a (\lambda'_{i,a})^2 \right). \quad (\text{N.2})$$

Unmarked isomorphism classes of Z_C are these tuples modulo the permutation group induced on the roots by projective transformations preserving their multiplicities and coranks.

- (2) *A specialization from λ to μ inside (N.1) exists if and only if*

$$\mu_i \preceq \lambda_i \quad \text{for every } i. \quad (\text{N.3})$$

Every such pair is realized over a smooth pointed algebraic curve, after shrinking at the special point, with A fixed and with constant full determinant and reduced rank loci.

- (3) *Every such pencil family induces a flat projective family of Z_C . After shrinking the curve, every truncation of order $k < d$ is constant. If at least one dominance inequality is strict, the generic and special Z_C are nonisomorphic; their first distinguishing order is d .*
- (4) *The recovered spectral module at α_i has length profile*

$$L_{i,a} = \sum_j \min(a, \lambda_{i,j}). \quad (\text{N.4})$$

Every $L_{i,a}$ can only increase in the stated specialization. All these inequalities together are equivalent to (N.3), giving an intrinsic numerical criterion for every admissible transition.

Proof. We use Lemma N.1. Its full-orthogonal classification and dominance order have exactly the group and self-adjoint convention needed here. The comparison for Grassmannian Segre strata is [4, Theorem 5.1].

The primary spaces $V_i = \ker(C - \alpha_i I)^{m_i}$ are an orthogonal direct sum: the Chinese remainder idempotents are polynomials in the self-adjoint C , hence self-adjoint projections. Each restricted form is nondegenerate, and $C|_{V_i} = \alpha_i I + N_i$, with N_i self-adjoint nilpotent. The prescribed corank is its number of Jordan blocks. The classical theorem gives the indexing. Conversely, a Jordan block is self-adjoint for the reversed-identity Gram matrix; an isometry with the chosen nondegenerate form realizes each partition.

The space of orthogonal decompositions has dimension $(n^2 - \sum_i m_i^2)/2$. Adding the nilpotent orbit dimensions proves (N.2). These are dimensions in the fixed- A matrix space, not in an unmarked moduli stack. Full orthogonal orbits need not be connected; no irreducibility assertion is needed. Theorem L.3 identifies the unmarked neighbourhood with the pencil, and its spectral module determines the partition at each root. A projective change of the line can therefore do exactly the stated root permutations. For one or two roots the projective stabilizer may be infinite; only its finite permutation image is used.

For necessity, the same polynomial idempotents decompose a family with fixed characteristic polynomial into subbundles of ranks m_i . The rank of N_i^a cannot increase at specialization. Since $m_i - \text{rank } N_i^a = \sum_j \min(a, \lambda_{i,j})$, this gives the length inequalities. Summing the first a columns of conjugate Young diagrams shows that they are equivalent to dominance: conjugation reverses the dominance order.

For sufficiency, fix an orthogonal decomposition of (V, A) . The closure criterion puts a chosen representative of μ_i in the closure of the orbit for λ_i . Thus the special tuple lies in the closure of the product of the generic orbits. Choose an irreducible component of that closure containing the point and meeting the generic orbit product. Successive general hyperplane sections through the point, avoiding the closed complement, give an integral algebraic curve with generic point in that open orbit product. Normalize it and choose a point over the prescribed point. A normal complex curve is smooth. Remove the other points outside the generic orbit product. A constant curve suffices in the equality case. The resulting block operator $\bigoplus_i(\alpha_i I + N_i(t))$ is self-adjoint for the same A . Its determinant is unchanged, and its coranks agree generically and specially, hence throughout the shrunk curve. This gives the required specialization. It does not assert constancy of the full higher Fitting ideals.

For part (3), pull back Theorem M.1 along the curve's morphism to $P = \text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V)$. That theorem identifies the family with the actual ideal-adic neighbourhoods and proves flatness and projectivity under arbitrary base change. No inference from fibrewise isomorphisms is needed. An affine Grassmannian chart around the special pencil supplies a fixed complement to nearby R_C , identifying S_{R_C} , B , and E . There is no relation below degree d , so all lower neighbourhoods become constant. For a strict dominance transition, $\sum_{i,a}(\lambda'_{i,a})^2$ strictly increases; this sum is invariant under permutations of the decorated roots. The generic and special tuples therefore cannot be related by such a permutation. Part (1) separates their unmarked degree- d neighbourhoods. Flatness is asserted only for these finite neighbourhoods, not unrestricted failure schemes. $\square$

Corollary N.3 (Exactly when the coarse data lose a labelled class). *The number of root-labelled congruence classes with the prescribed data is $\prod_i \#\mathcal{P}(m_i, c_i)$. It is one precisely when, for every i , either $c_i = 1$ or $m_i - c_i \leq 1$. The first possible ambiguity with fixed full determinant and all reduced rank loci occurs in dimension four, at $(m, c) = (4, 2)$, with partitions $(3, 1)$ and $(2, 2)$.*

Proof. Subtracting one from every part identifies $\mathcal{P}(m, c)$ with partitions of $m - c$ into at most c parts. There is one if $c = 1$ or $m - c \leq 1$. Otherwise $(m - c)$ and $(m - c - 1, 1)$ are distinct admissible partitions. The theorem gives the count and the minimal example. $\square$

N.2. The first relation as a standard graded Betti space. The finite invariant has a usual Hilbert-scheme interpretation. The first Betti space means the generator space in the first free module of a minimal graded resolution of the quotient, not the space of relations among generators of its defining ideal. The following statement retains the marked quotient presentation.

Proposition N.4 (A graded Hilbert locus and its first Betti space). *In the fixed coordinates of Theorem 6.3, let $S = \text{Sym } H^*$, $N = \binom{n+1}{2}$, $M = \binom{N}{2}$, and $Q_R = S/((K_R) + S_{\geq d+1})$. Then*

$$\text{Tor}_1^S(Q_R, \mathbb{C})_d = K_R. \quad (\text{N.5})$$

This identity commutes with arbitrary complex base change. The functor of graded quotients with Hilbert function

$$h_j = \begin{cases} \dim S_j, & 0 \leq j < d, \\ \dim S_d - M, & j = d, \\ 0, & j > d \end{cases}$$

is represented by $\text{Gr}(M, S_d)$. The pencil locus is a closed copy of $\text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V)$. Its degree- d first Betti space recovers every scheme-theoretic pencil parameter, including parameters over nonreduced bases.

Proof. Put $J = (K_R) + S_{\geq d+1}$ and $S_+ = \bigoplus_{j>0} S_j$. The augmented sequence $0 \rightarrow J \rightarrow S \rightarrow Q_R \rightarrow 0$ gives $\text{Tor}_1^S(Q_R, \mathbb{C}) = J/S_+J$, since its map to S/S_+ is zero. Its degree- d part is K_R . The

same argument over a base algebra applies to the degree- d subbundle with locally free quotient and commutes with pullback. A graded quotient with the indicated locally free components has zero ideal below degree d , a rank- M subbundle in degree d , and the full ideal in higher degrees. Conversely, every such subbundle defines an ideal, as its positive-degree products lie above degree d . This is the Grassmannian functor. The closed immersion and its inverse on the image are Theorem 6.3. This is not an inference from closed-point Torelli to unmarked deformation-groupoid equivalence. $\square$

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AI assistance was used in developing and drafting the arguments and finite verification scripts. All structural proofs are supplied for independent mathematical scrutiny; computational receipts are not formal proof certificates. No AI system is listed as an author.

For the present revision, GPT-6 Astra Pro assisted specifically with the incidence normalization and overlap criterion in Section 11, the universal-property proof in Section H, the explicit specialization in Section I, and the associated exact tests and exposition. These arguments require independent human verification. No statement here represents a completed journal review or a formal proof-assistant certification.

Additional disclosure for the present revision. GPT-6 Astra Pro assisted specifically with the conductor and collision models, the scalar-matrix degeneration, the flag-jet calculation, the reciprocal-polynomial fibre presentation, literature comparisons, and exact computational checks. The proofs above state the complete mathematical arguments; finite computations are consistency checks, not universal proof certificates. No journal decision or historical priority determination is inferred from the build and source audits.

ASSISTANCE IN THE PRESENT REVISION

An AI assistant helped formulate and write the binary conductor stratification, the simultaneous incidence atlas, the evaluated singular Fitting ideal, and the minimal-relation-module argument for pure-power fibres. It also prepared the source-preserving reorganization and finite exact consistency checks. The written proofs, rather than those finite checks, are the mathematical basis of the statements and are submitted to independent scrutiny.

Revision 154. AI assistance was used for the polarized moduli compatibility, spectral divisor-fibre construction, homological calculations and proof expansions. The fixed five-variable Betti table uses exact computer-assisted rational elimination with its complete finite inputs recorded. The general theorems rely on the written arguments and the explicitly attributed classical results, not on regression counts or source-preservation receipts.

Revision 155. AI assistance was used to formulate and draft the exact quadratic coefficient-section theorem and the reciprocal power-ideal description of spectral Fitting schemes, to check their finite examples, and to prepare the companion-paper organization. Classical apolar and orthogonal-orbit results are explicitly attributed. The general claims rely on the written proofs; finite exact tests and source preservation are not formal proof certificates.

Revision 157. AI assistance was used in deriving and drafting the universal power-ideal formula, its complete-quadric graph interpretation, the contact-divisor and resolved-pencil statements, and their exact finite checks. Classical determinantal, apolar and complete-quadric results are attributed at their points of use. The proofs, rather than the computations, support the general statements. No formal proof certification or journal endorsement is claimed.

Scope of the new intrinsic construction. The source-normalized envelope is an algebra bundle with an intrinsic projective power diagram. It is not a claimed preferred subquotient of the sharp failure algebra. Singular-pencil classification is read through the classical complex symmetric

Kronecker form. The explicit Hilbert tail is a boundary calculation for the stated transverse family, not a classification of every fibre of the incidence compactification. Exact computations accompanying the source check finite instances; they do not certify the general proofs.

Revision 169. AI assistance was used in deriving and drafting the all-order row factorization, monic chart equations, associated-point and genus-correction calculations, equivariant chart gluing, Quot comparison, and finite exact checks. The written arguments are offered for independent mathematical scrutiny. No external independent audit of the sharp inverse, formal proof-assistant certification, or journal endorsement is represented as completed by this revision.

Revision 170. AI assistance was used in deriving and drafting the ramified parameter-fibre, conductor, and normalization-label arguments and in preparing auxiliary exact checks. The written proofs are submitted for independent scrutiny. Compilation, finite checks, and source preservation are not represented as an external proof audit, a formal proof certificate, or a journal endorsement.

APPENDIX O. INTRODUCTION

A flat embedded limit, the normalization of its parameter space, and the scheme fibre of that normalized space need not retain the same information. The conductor measures a further difference: it records precisely which functions on the normalization descend to the original parameter space. Computing its generic order on boundary divisors is not by itself a computation of the conductor at their intersections. This distinction is particularly relevant when a change of coefficients turns a smooth Hilbert graph into a nonnormal surface.

The first result of this paper gives an identity of actual conductor ideals under finite flat changes of a smooth coefficient space. It applies to any normal proper birational model, in any dimension. Its proof uses classical trace duality. The geometric applications then leave the diagonal toric setting: two coefficient divisors become tangent, distinct divisorial valuations can agree on the two original coordinate functions, and one Hilbert point can have normalization lifts with different singularity types.

O.1. The conductor identity. Let $h : X \rightarrow S$ be a finite flat dominant map of smooth varieties over a characteristic-zero field, and let $f : T \rightarrow S$ be proper birational with T normal. Write

$$Y = T \times_S X, \quad Z = Y^\nu, \quad \pi : Z \rightarrow X, \quad \psi : Z \rightarrow T.$$

The fibre product is integral. Let R_h be the Cartier divisor of $\text{Fitt}_0 \Omega_{X/S}$, and let R_ψ have coefficient $e_Q - 1$ at a prime divisor Q of Z , where e_Q is the ramification index over T . Theorem P.1 gives

$$\mathfrak{c}_{Z/Y} = \mathcal{O}_Z(R_\psi - \pi^* R_h).$$

This is not just an isomorphism of rank-one modules or an equality on an open set containing the generic points of the divisors. It identifies the conductor as a reflexive ideal at every point. In particular its order at Q is $v_Q(\text{Fitt}_0 \Omega_{X/S}) - e_Q + 1$.

The resulting defect cycle is twice the generic length of the normalization quotient, weighted by residue degrees (Corollary P.4). The conductor divisors add under towers of finite flat covers in the precise sense of Theorem P.5; this involves reflexive products, not an unproved equality of ordinary tensor products. No smoothness or Cohen–Macaulay assumption on T beyond normality is needed for the conductor identity. The normalization of a rational Hilbert graph is therefore an immediate source of examples.

O.2. Tangent polynomial contacts. For $a \geq 2$ consider the marked family of embedded graphs of

$$[s_0 : t_0] \mapsto [t_0^a : bs_0^a : cs_0 t_0^{a-1}] \quad \text{in } \mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^2.$$

We prove directly that its retained-coefficient Hilbert graph is the smooth chain blow-up of $\prod_{j=1}^a (b, c^j)$. This proof gives a finite row factorization of the evaluation ideal, removes its principal content, and derives an exhaustive affine cover. It uses no assertion about an unmarked finite algebra and no theorem from the reconstruction paper.

Now change coefficients by $b = u^r$, $c = u + v^s$, with $r, s \geq 2$. The conductor identity determines every divisorial conductor order and generic defect for every a, r, s ; the residue extensions are computed rather than inferred from the number of roots in a closed fibre (Theorem R.1). For $r = s = 2$ we compute the complete normal surface in every contact order (Theorem R.2). At order two its middle chart is

$$k[e, z, v]/(v^2 - ez(z - 1)), \quad u = ez,$$

with conductor (e) and scheme fibre $k[e, z]/(ez)$. The two points $z = 0, 1$ on that chart are rational double points. Each higher contact order adds one ordinary blow-up at a smooth endpoint. The full parameter fibre stays a reduced nodal chain, although the conductor orders grow along it.

The first two exceptional divisors both have values $(2, 1)$ on (u, v) , but their values on $u + v^2$ are 4 and 2. Thus the result cannot be read from a fan in the original two monomial weights. Moreover the Hilbert coordinate is z^2 along the second divisor. The points $z = 1$ and $z = -1$ give the same embedded Hilbert limit, while one normalization germ is singular and the other is regular. Explicit projective coefficient arcs realize both points (Corollary R.3).

O.3. Relation to classical results and scope. The trace complementary module and the equality of the Kähler and Dedekind differentials for finite flat complete intersections are classical; precise formulations appear in [39, Sections 49.8, 49.12 and 49.15]. Our proof of the conductor identity exposes this dependence. It is not a claim to a new duality formalism. The Newton-polyhedron criterion, normalized Rees constructions and the complete-ideal theory used in the marked chain belong to the established theory of integral closure [40, Chapters 1, 5 and 14]. The same reference states Jacobian containment results and the Lipman–Sathaye theorem in its conductor chapter. Here the stronger geometric hypotheses permit an equality of the actual conductor with a specified complementary module, followed by the explicit nonmonomial normalization and fibre calculations above. No exhaustive priority claim for the general identity is made.

The diagonal family $b = u^\rho$, $c = v^\sigma$ is treated separately in Section S. There the full coordinate ideal on a proper toric cone is divisorial; a proof on the character lattice shows that the scheme fibre has no embedded points. The reduction at a cyclic quotient crossing is computed as an ordinary node, and ordinary powers give the exact nilpotence order. The conductor is then recovered from the same coefficient-change identity, including an explicit unequal-cover chart and overlap generators.

The conductor theorem is not restricted to these two surface families. The complete surface and fibre classifications, however, refer to the stated families. Neither the conductor formula nor the examples assert a classification of all higher-corank or singular quadratic-pencil Hilbert fibres. Normalizing the parameters does not normalize the embedded universal curves. All uses of a finite failure algebra require the separate effective reconstruction hypotheses; none enters the proofs in this paper. The accompanying technical supplement retains the earlier power-ideal, equivariant, contact and reconstruction-application arguments for reference, without making them prerequisites of the present central route.

APPENDIX P. CONDUCTORS UNDER FINITE FLAT CHANGE OF COEFFICIENTS

Throughout this section k is a field of characteristic zero. A variety is an integral separated scheme of finite type over k . If V is normal and $D = \sum d_Q Q$ is a Weil divisor, $\mathcal{O}_V(D)$ denotes the subsheaf of its function field specified by $v_Q(z) + d_Q \geq 0$ at every prime divisor. Products of such sheaves are ordinary products unless a double dual is explicitly written. For a finite dominant morphism of normal varieties, pullback of a Weil divisor means its valuation pullback, with the ramification indices as coefficients; no Cartier assumption is implicit.

Let $h : X \rightarrow S$ be a finite flat dominant morphism of smooth varieties, and let $f : T \rightarrow S$ be a proper birational morphism with T normal. There is no restriction on their common dimension. Set

$$Y = T \times_S X, \quad Z = Y^\nu, \quad \nu : Z \longrightarrow Y, \quad \pi : Z \longrightarrow X, \quad \psi : Z \longrightarrow T.$$

The Jacobian ideal $\mathfrak{j}_h = \text{Fitt}_0 \Omega_{X/S}$ is invertible and nonzero. Write $\mathfrak{j}_h = \mathcal{O}_X(-R_h)$. For a prime divisor Q of Z over a prime divisor P of T , let e_Q be its ramification index, and put $R_\psi = \sum_Q (e_Q - 1)Q$. These definitions use the morphisms, not choices of local coordinates.

Theorem P.1 (Conductor and coefficient change). *In the preceding situation, Y is integral and S_2 , and its normalization is finite. The conductor, as an actual ideal of $\mathcal{O}_Z$, is*

$$\mathfrak{c}_{Z/Y} = \mathcal{O}_Z(R_\psi - \pi^* R_h). \quad (\text{P.1})$$

In particular it is reflexive, and its coefficient at Q is

$$c_Q = v_Q(j_h) - e_Q + 1 \geq 0. \quad (\text{P.2})$$

There is no further condition supported in codimension at least two. The scheme Y is normal if and only if $c_Q = 0$ for every Q . The conductor is supported over the locus on which f is not an isomorphism. If T is smooth, Y is moreover a local complete intersection and hence Cohen–Macaulay.

The identity is an application of classical complementary modules and finite duality, not a new duality theorem. Its use here is that the same formula computes a global conductor for nonmonomial coefficient changes, for singular normal models, and for models in higher dimension. The explicit tangency calculations in Section R will supply its first nonmonomial Hilbert-boundary application.

P.1. Trace lattices and the actual conductor ideal. We give the algebraic argument, including the identification as an ideal rather than just an isomorphism of abstract modules. For a normal Noetherian domain A with fraction field K , a finite separable extension L/K , and a finite A -subalgebra $E \subset L$, define

$$E^\dagger = \{z \in L : \text{Tr}_{L/K}(zE) \subset A\}.$$

The trace pairing identifies this with $\text{Hom}_A(E, A)$. This is the Dedekind complementary module [39, Section 49.8]. We shall also use the classical equality of the different and the Kähler different for a finite flat local complete intersection map [39, Section 49.12].

Lemma P.2 (A trace-lattice identity). *Suppose E is finite locally free over A , is a domain with fraction field L , and $E^\dagger = j^{-1}E$ for a nonzero $j \in E$. Let B be the finite normalization of E in L . Then, inside L ,*

$$(E : B) = jB^\dagger. \quad (\text{P.3})$$

Here $(E : B) = \{z \in L : zB \subset E\}$ is contained in B and is the ordinary conductor. The assertion is local on $\text{Spec } E$ when $E^\dagger$ is only locally generated in this way.

Proof. For every E -module M there is the elementary adjunction

$$\text{Hom}_E(M, \text{Hom}_A(E, A)) \simeq \text{Hom}_A(M, A).$$

The forward map evaluates at $1 \in E$; the inverse sends a functional λ to $m \mapsto (e \mapsto \lambda(em))$. Apply it to $M = B$. After extension to K , all functionals are given uniquely by the trace pairing on the field L . Thus the adjunction identifies the two submodules of L by the same multiplier, not by an unspecified unit:

$$B^\dagger = \{z \in L : zB \subset j^{-1}E\} = j^{-1}(E : B).$$

Since $1 \in B$, a conductor multiplier lies in $E \subset B$. Conversely $(E : B)$ is a B -ideal. This proves the claimed equality as ideals. Localization and change of a local generator multiply both sides by the same unit, so the local identities glue. $\square$

Lemma P.3 (The complementary module on a normal model). *Let $A \subset B$ be a finite inclusion of normal domains essentially of finite type over a characteristic-zero field, with separable fraction fields $K \subset L$. On $\text{Spec } B$ one has*

$$B^\dagger = \mathcal{O}_B \left(\sum_Q (e_Q - 1)Q \right),$$

where Q runs over prime divisors and e_Q is computed over its height-one contraction to A .

Proof. A normal domain is the intersection of its height-one localizations in its fraction field. Hence $z \in B^\dagger$ if and only if the trace of zb is in A_P for every height-one $P \subset A$ and every $b \in B$. The ring $B \otimes_A A_P$ is the semilocal normalization of the DVR A_P in L . Its maximal ideals are the primes Q over P . The local complementary module has valuation $-(e_Q - 1)$ at Q : residue characteristic zero gives tame ramification and a separable residue extension. This is the inverse-different formula for DVRs. One may see the exponent after an unramified extension by writing a uniformizer of A_P as a unit times an e_Q th power; the derivative has order $e_Q - 1$. Unramified trace duality contributes order zero.

Going down over the normal domain A , together with incomparability for integral extensions, shows that every height-one prime of B contracts to a height-one prime of A . Thus all height-one primes of B are included. Intersecting the preceding valuation conditions in L is exactly the displayed divisorial sheaf. This also proves its reflexivity without assuming that B is Cohen–Macaulay. $\square$

Proof of Theorem P.1. On an affine open of T , the coordinate algebra of Y is finite locally free over the coordinate domain of T . It therefore injects into its generic algebra. Birationality of f identifies that generic algebra with the single field $k(X)$, not a product of fields. Consequently every such algebra is a domain. This proves integrality, including the exclusion of vertical or embedded structure. The finite flat morphism h is a local complete intersection: it is a morphism between smooth varieties of equal dimension. Its base change is syntomic of relative dimension zero. The flat depth formula, with zero-dimensional complete-intersection fibres, transfers S_2 from T to Y . If T is smooth the same description makes Y a local complete intersection. Finiteness of normalization follows from excellence.

Let C be the finite locally free algebra of X over an affine part of S , and A the coordinate algebra of an affine part of T above it. Put $E = C \otimes A$. Finite locally free duality and its trace element commute with arbitrary base change: this is checked by dualizing a finite free module. The complete-intersection different formula therefore identifies the image of the trace in the invertible relative dualizing module with $j_h E$.

We may now localize A at a point of T . The finite algebra E is semilocal, so this invertible module and the pulled-back Jacobian ideal are free. Choose a generator j of $j_h E$. Under the trace identification the preceding assertion is exactly $E^\dagger = j^{-1}E$. This argument does not require a single global Jacobian equation on X , or apply a finite trace to a nonfinite localization of C .

Apply Lemma P.2, and then Lemma P.3, to the normalization B . They give

$$\mathfrak{c}_{Z/Y} = j \mathcal{O}_Z(R_\psi) = \mathcal{O}_Z(R_\psi - \pi^* R_h).$$

The ideal on the left is contained in $\mathcal{O}_Z$, so all its valuation orders are nonnegative. This is an equality of sheaves, and therefore already includes every point of codimension at least two. It is the unit ideal precisely when $B = E$. On an open where $T = S$ the base change is X , which is normal, so no conductor occurs there. All claims follow. $\square$

P.2. Defect cycles and composition. Write $C(Z/Y) = \pi^* R_h - R_\psi$ for the effective conductor divisor. Let $g : Y \rightarrow T$ be the finite projection. For a prime divisor $P \subset T$, let

$$\delta_P = \text{length}_{\mathcal{O}_{T,P}} ((\psi_* \mathcal{O}_Z) / (g_* \mathcal{O}_Y))_P.$$

This is a length on the base DVR; it is not the length at an individual normalization branch.

Corollary P.4 (Normalization defect). *In the situation of Theorem P.1,*

$$2\delta_P = \sum_{Q|P} [k(Q) : k(P)] c_Q. \quad (\text{P.4})$$

Thus $2 \sum_P \delta_P P = \psi_* C(Z/Y)$. The generic defect cycle is supported on the exceptional locus of $T \rightarrow S$.

Proof. Localize at P . Both the order E and its normalization B are free lattices of the same rank over the DVR $A = \mathcal{O}_{T,P}$. If a basis of E is expressed in a basis of B by a matrix M , then $v_A(\det M) = \text{length}_A(B/E) = \delta_P$. The matrices of the trace pairing satisfy $G_E = M^t G_B M$. Therefore

$$2\delta_P = v_A(\text{disc } E) - v_A(\text{disc } B).$$

The first discriminant is the norm of the different generator j_h , so its order is $\sum_{Q|P} [k(Q) : k(P)] v_Q(j_h)$. The second has order $\sum_{Q|P} [k(Q) : k(P)] (e_Q - 1)$ by tame DVR duality. Subtraction proves the formula. This argument also verifies that the right side is even; no geometric splitting assumption was used. $\square$

Theorem P.5 (Transitivity of conductor divisors). *Let $X_2 \xrightarrow{h_2} X_1 \xrightarrow{h_1} S$ be finite flat dominant maps of smooth varieties. For a fixed normal proper birational model $T \rightarrow S$, let*

$$Z_i = (T \times_S X_i)^\nu, \quad \chi : Z_2 \longrightarrow Z_1, \quad W = Z_1 \times_{X_1} X_2.$$

Then W is integral, $Z_2 = W^\nu$ canonically, and

$$C(Z_2/T \times_S X_2) = \chi^* C(Z_1/T \times_S X_1) + C(Z_2/W). \quad (\text{P.5})$$

These identifications are associative for successive finite flat covers. In terms of ideals, the equality is the reflexive product of the two conductor ideals after reflexive pullback; it need not be an equality of ordinary tensor products.

Proof. Finite flatness injects the coordinate rings of W into their generic field $k(X_2)$, so W is integral. The finite normalization map to $T \times_S X_1$ remains finite after base change. The two resulting integral rings have the same fraction field and one is integral over the other; their integral closures therefore coincide. This proves the canonical identification and finiteness of χ .

The chain rule gives $R_{h_1 h_2} = h_2^* R_{h_1} + R_{h_2}$. For a prime of Z_2 above Z_1 and T , ramification indices multiply; thus $e_1 e_2 - 1 = e_2(e_1 - 1) + (e_2 - 1)$ gives $R_{\psi_1 \chi} = \chi^* R_{\psi_1} + R_\chi$. Apply Theorem P.1 to the original model and also to the normal model $Z_1 \rightarrow X_1$. Subtracting the two divisor identities gives (P.5). The second summand is an actual effective conductor divisor even when Z_1 is singular; this is why normal, rather than only smooth, models were allowed. Integral closure in one field and the chain rule are associative. Equality in codimension one gives the stated reflexive-product interpretation, and asserts no equality for unsaturated products. $\square$

Corollary P.6 (Normal Hilbert models). *Let S be smooth and let a rational map from S to a separated Hilbert scheme be defined on a dense open. Let T be the normalization of its retained-coefficient graph closure, assumed proper over S . Every finite flat dominant map $X \rightarrow S$ from a smooth variety has the conductor and defect formulas above for $T \times_S X$ and its normalization, compatibly with towers of covers. The pulled-back universal embedded family remains flat.*

Proof. The normalized graph is a normal proper birational model of S , so the theorem applies directly. Flatness of the universal family is preserved by every base change, including normalization of parameters. If the original graph was not normal, $T \times_S X$ is the pullback of its normalization, not silently the original graph. The result computes the new conductor defect; it does not classify all fibres of that Hilbert scheme or normalize the embedded universal curves. $\square$

APPENDIX Q. THE MARKED HILBERT GRAPH

We give the chain construction in full, so the applications require no unpublished predecessor theorem. Fix $a \geq 2$, let $S_a = \text{Spec } k[b, c]$, and consider

$$[s_0 : t_0] \mapsto [t_0^a : bs_0^a : cs_0t_0^{a-1}]. \quad (\text{Q.1})$$

Over $b \neq 0$ this is a morphism, and its graph is an embedded curve in $X_0 = \mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^2$. Its Hilbert polynomial with respect to $\mathcal{O}_{X_0}(1, 1)$ is $P_a(l) = (a+1)l + 1$. Define T_a to be the schematic closure of the resulting section in $S_a \times \text{Hilb}^{P_a}(X_0)$. This definition retains the coefficients; it does not take a quotient by source or target automorphisms.

Theorem Q.1 (The marked chain). *Put $K_a = \prod_{j=1}^a (b, c^j)$. Then*

$$T_a = \text{Bl}_{K_a} S_a. \quad (\text{Q.2})$$

This is a smooth surface obtained by blowing up the origin and then $a-1$ times the intersection of the newest exceptional curve with the strict transform of $b=0$. Its exceptional divisors E_i have $v_{E_i}(b) = i$, $v_{E_i}(c) = 1$ and form a chain of projective lines. An open cover consists of the first and last charts

$$T^{(0)} = \text{Spec } k[b, k_0], \quad c = bk_0; \quad T^{(a)} = \text{Spec } k[c, w_a], \quad b = c^a w_a,$$

and the intermediate charts

$$T^{(i)} = \text{Spec } k[e_i, h_i], \quad c = e_i h_i, \quad b = e_i^{i+1} h_i^i \quad (1 \leq i < a). \quad (\text{Q.3})$$

They are actual charts of the full blow-up, with adjacent transitions

$$\begin{aligned} k_0 &= e_1^{-1}, & b &= e_1^2 h_1, \\ e_{i+1} &= h_i^{-1}, & h_{i+1} &= e_i h_i^2 \quad (1 \leq i < a-1), \\ c &= e_{a-1} h_{a-1}, & w_a &= h_{a-1}^{-1}. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{Q.4})$$

All nonadjacent overlaps are obtained by composing these substitutions. The universal embedded curve over T_a is flat and retains the original fixed target X_0 .

Q.1. A finite evaluation calculation. Let $d = a+1$ and $m_a = a(a+1)/2 + 1$. Gotzmann's regularity theorem gives a closed Grassmannian embedding of the projective Hilbert scheme in degree $m \geq m_a$ [41]. Indeed the Gotzmann representation of $dl+1$ has d linear binomial terms and $(d-1)(d-2)/2$ constant terms, hence m_a terms. We use the ordinary Hilbert scheme after the Segre embedding. The fixed quadratic Segre relations lie in every ideal; the relevant quotient therefore factors through $H^0(X_0, \mathcal{O}(m, m))$, without invoking multigraded regularity.

The restriction matrix M has $q = (a+1)m + 1$ rows and $N = (m+1) \binom{m+2}{2}$ columns. The column indexed by $0 \leq l, h, l+h \leq m$, $0 \leq t \leq m$ is the monomial $b^h c^l$ in row

$$n = t + a(m - h - l) + (a-1)l,$$

and is zero in every other row. It is the evaluation of a basis monomial of bidegree (m, m) . Over $b \neq 0$ it is surjective, since restriction to the graph is $H^0(\mathbb{P}^1, \mathcal{O}((a+1)m))$ in a regularity degree. Its full minors are Plücker coordinates of the Hilbert point.

Proposition Q.2 (Content and row factorization). *For every $m \geq m_a$ put*

$$C = \frac{(a-1)m(m+1)}{2}, \quad E_j = m - j + 1 \ (j < a), \quad E_a = \frac{(m-a+1)(m-a+2)}{2}.$$

Then the ideal of maximal minors is exactly

$$I_q(M) = b^C J_{a,m}, \quad J_{a,m} = \prod_{j=1}^a (b, c^j)^{E_j}. \quad (\text{Q.5})$$

The divisorial content is b^C , whereas $J_{a,m}$ and all its powers are integrally closed. Changing m changes the weights C, E_j , but not the graph (Q.2).

Proof. A nonzero full minor chooses one column from each row; columns from different rows are distinct. Thus $I_q(M)$ is the product of the row ideals Q_n . Put $d_0 = am - n$. Rows with $n \geq am$ have $Q_n = (1)$. For $d_0 \geq 0$ set

$$h_0 = \max \left(0, \left\lceil \frac{d_0 - m}{a - 1} \right\rceil \right), \quad r_0 = d_0 - ah_0.$$

For a fixed h , the least feasible l is $\max(0, d_0 - ah)$, and feasibility is equivalent to $h \geq h_0$ until this minimum is reached. The minimal monomials of Q_n are therefore $b^{h_0+t} c^{\max(0, r_0-at)}$, with $0 \leq t \leq \max(0, \lceil r_0/a \rceil)$. Consequently $Q_n = (b^{h_0})$ if $r_0 \leq 0$, and if $r_0 = av + j > 0$, $0 \leq j < a$, then

$$Q_n = b^{h_0} (b, c^a)^v (b, c^j),$$

where the last factor is omitted when $j = 0$.

The sum of h_0 over the rows is $(a-1)(1 + \dots + m) = C$. A positive residual value $r_0 \leq m$ occurs $\min(a, m - r_0 + 1)$ times. One occurrence has $h_0 = 0$; the others are specified by $m - a + 2 - h_0 \leq r_0 \leq m - h_0$. The total exponents of the residual factors are

$$\sum_{\substack{1 \leq r_0 \leq m \\ r_0 \equiv j \pmod{a}}} \min(a, m - r_0 + 1) = m - j + 1 \quad (1 \leq j < a),$$

and

$$\sum_{r_0=1}^m \min(a, m - r_0 + 1) \lfloor r_0/a \rfloor = \sum_{n=a}^m (n - a + 1) = E_a.$$

For the first count, write $n = r_0 + t$, $0 \leq t < a$, and count each $n = j, \dots, m$ once. For the second, at fixed n sum $\lfloor r_0/a \rfloor$ for $\max(1, n - a + 1) \leq r_0 \leq n$; the result is $\max(0, n - a + 1)$. This proves (Q.5).

For a fixed integer exponent of b , the smallest exponent of c in $J_{a,m}$ is obtained by choosing b first in factors with largest j . Each integer abscissa of its lower Newton polygon is thus attained by an actual generator. The successive integral slopes are $-a, \dots, -1$ with positive horizontal lengths $E_a, \dots, E_1$. All lattice points above the polygon belong to the ideal. Replacing E_j by nE_j proves the same assertion for every power, hence integral closure by the monomial Newton-polyhedron criterion [40, Proposition 1.4.6]. There is no common height-one factor of $J_{a,m}$, since it contains powers of both b and c . Thus b^C is precisely the divisorial content. $\square$

Proof of Theorem Q.1. For an integral affine base, the closure of a rational projective map with coordinates $f_0, \dots, f_N$ is the blow-up of their ideal. On the open where its i th homogeneous coordinate is nonzero the coordinate ring is $A[f_j/f_i]$ inside $\text{Frac}(A)$; these are exactly the affine charts of the Rees Proj. Applying this to the full minors gives the closure of the Hilbert map, since both the Grassmannian and the Hilbert scheme are closed in the chosen projective space and contain its generic image.

Multiplication in degree n by b^{nC} gives a graded isomorphism $\mathcal{R}(J_{a,m}) \simeq \mathcal{R}(b^C J_{a,m})$. Therefore the principal content does not change Proj, though it does change the raw degree- m Fitting ideal. The all-power integral-closure result makes the Rees algebra normal. Its fan has, in clockwise order, rays

$$(0, 1), (1, 1), (2, 1), \dots, (a, 1), (1, 0).$$

The same is true for K_a , by the identical argument with all $E_j = 1$. Each adjacent determinant has absolute value one, so these normal blow-ups are the same smooth surface. Inserting the rays in order gives the stated sequence of point blow-ups. The dual bases on consecutive cones give exactly (Q.3) and the end charts; their Laurent identities give (Q.4). Thus the cover is exhaustive. Finally pull back the universal Hilbert family along the graph isomorphism. This proves flatness and keeps the embedding in X_0 , not merely the abstract isomorphism class of a curve. $\square$

Proposition Q.3 (The marked principalization category). *Fix the dense coefficient torus $U = \{bc \neq 0\} \subset S_a$. Objects are integral locally Noetherian S_a -schemes V for which U_V is dense and every ideal $(b, c^j)\mathcal{O}_V$ is invertible as a nonzero fractional ideal. Morphisms are arbitrary S_a -morphisms between these objects, with the induced maps on U_V . Then T_a is terminal in this category. For normal objects after any finite flat coefficient cover, the corresponding normalized blow-up is terminal.*

Proof. A product of nonzero fractional ideals is invertible if and only if all its factors are invertible. To check the nontrivial direction locally, if $I_1 \cdots I_a = (t)$, then $I_i(t^{-1} \prod_{j \neq i} I_j) = \mathcal{O}$; this gives a fractional inverse. The blow-up universal property applied to K_a gives a unique map to T_a . After a finite flat cover the same property gives a map to the pulled-back blow-up. On a normal test, pull back its finite normalization and close the generic section over U_V . This is a finite integral birational scheme over the test and hence is the test itself. The lift is unique by density and separatedness. No identification of an arbitrary test with U is required; its specified structural map on U_V is retained. $\square$

APPENDIX R. TANGENT COEFFICIENT DIVISORS

We now apply the conductor identity to a coefficient change which is not diagonal in the given parameters. Throughout this section k is algebraically closed of characteristic zero. Let $a \geq 2$, and let $T_a \rightarrow \operatorname{Spec} k[b, c]$ be the Hilbert graph of

$$[s_0 : t_0] \mapsto [t_0^a : bs_0^a : cs_0 t_0^{a-1}].$$

The construction and proof of the chain model are given in Section Q; in particular, its exceptional divisors E_i have valuations $v_{E_i}(b) = i$, $v_{E_i}(c) = 1$, for $1 \leq i \leq a$. For integers $r, s \geq 2$ put

$$b = u^r, \quad c = u + v^s. \tag{R.1}$$

Set

$$Y_a = T_a \times_{\operatorname{Spec} k[b, c]} \operatorname{Spec} k[u, v], \quad Z_a = Y_a^\nu.$$

The two reduced divisors $u = 0$ and $u + v^s = 0$ have intersection multiplicity s at the origin. Thus this is not a change by units of two transverse boundary coordinates. We do not replace v by an s th root of $c - u$ on the original coefficient surface.

Theorem R.1 (The conductor for tangent covers). *The morphism (R.1) is finite flat of degree rs , with Jacobian ideal $(u^{r-1}v^{s-1})$. The graph Y_a is integral and a local complete intersection. For every i there is exactly one prime divisor $D_i \subset Z_a$ over E_i . Its ramification index e_i , residue*

degree f_i , and valuations are as follows:

$$i \leq r : \quad g_i = \gcd(rs, i), \quad (v_{D_i}(u), v_{D_i}(v), e_i, f_i) = \left(\frac{si}{g_i}, \frac{i}{g_i}, \frac{rs}{g_i}, g_i \right), \quad (\text{R.2})$$

$$i \geq r : \quad g_i = \gcd(r, is), \quad (v_{D_i}(u), v_{D_i}(v), e_i, f_i) = \left(\frac{is}{g_i}, \frac{r}{g_i}, \frac{rs}{g_i}, g_i \right). \quad (\text{R.3})$$

The two formulas agree at $i = r$. The full conductor on Z_a is

$$\mathfrak{c}_{Z_a/Y_a} = \mathcal{O}_{Z_a} \left(- \sum_{i=1}^a k_i D_i \right), \quad k_i = \begin{cases} ((rs-1)i - rs) / \gcd(rs, i) + 1, & i \leq r, \\ ((r-1)is - r) / \gcd(r, is) + 1, & i \geq r. \end{cases} \quad (\text{R.4})$$

No other conductor component or additional condition in codimension two occurs. The generic normalization defect over E_i is $f_i k_i / 2$. These assertions hold for all a, r, s in the stated range, not only for monomial arcs in the coefficient surface.

Proof. The intermediate extension defined by $u^r = b$, followed by $v^s = c - u$, is free with basis $u^j v^l$, $0 \leq j < r$, $0 \leq l < s$. The total algebra is $k[u, v]$, and its fraction field has degree rs over $k(b, c)$. Differentiating gives the determinant $rsu^{r-1}v^{s-1}$. The graph and local complete-intersection claims follow from Theorem P.1 and the smoothness of T_a .

Fix i , write $w = b/c^i$, and localize at the generic point of E_i . The residue field is $k(w)$, with w transcendental. At a prime of the normalization above this DVR let $\alpha = v(u)$, $\beta = v(v)$, and $e = v(c)$. Then

$$r\alpha = ie, \quad v(u + v^s) = e. \quad (\text{R.5})$$

The fundamental equality for the finite normalization of a DVR is $\sum ef = rs$. We shall obtain lower bounds on a single e and f whose product is already rs ; this also proves uniqueness of the prime, rather than assuming it from a Newton polygon.

Suppose first that $i < r$. Then $\alpha < e$, so cancellation in $u + v^s$ forces $s\beta = \alpha$ and $\overline{u/v^s} = -1$. If $g = \gcd(rs, i)$, the valuation equalities force e to be a positive multiple of rs/g . The unit character $v^{rs/g}/c^{i/g}$ has residue η with $\eta^g = (-1)^r w$. The polynomial $T^g - (-1)^r w$ is irreducible over $k(w)$, for example by the w -adic Eisenstein criterion. Hence $f \geq g$. The fundamental equality now forces $e = rs/g$, $f = g$, and a single prime above E_i . This proves (R.2) for $i < r$.

If $i = r$, the residue $\zeta = \overline{u/c}$ satisfies $\zeta^r = w$. It has degree r and is not 1. Since $v^s = c(1 - u/c)$, one has $s\beta = e$. Consequently $e \geq s$ and $f \geq r$, and again equality and uniqueness follow. Both displayed formulas give $(\alpha, \beta, e, f) = (s, 1, s, r)$.

If $i > r$, then $\alpha > e$, so $s\beta = e$ and $\overline{c/v^s} = 1$. Set $g = \gcd(r, is)$. The relations force $e \geq rs/g$, and the residue of $u^{r/g}/v^{is/g}$ has g th power w . The same irreducibility and degree argument gives $e = rs/g$, $f = g$ and (R.3).

The conductor coefficient is now $(r-1)\alpha + (s-1)\beta - e + 1$ by Theorem P.1. Substitution yields (R.4). The theorem is an equality of ideals, so no extra intersection condition is being inferred merely from these orders. Away from the exceptional locus the pullback is the normal plane $\text{Spec } k[u, v]$. The defect formula follows from Corollary P.4. $\square$

The residue degrees in this theorem describe extensions of function fields of divisors. They do not count prime divisors. Over a general nonzero closed residue, algebraic closedness and characteristic zero turn the indicated power maps into g_i distinct closed lifts. Special points require the local models, which we compute next in an all-order nonmonomial case.

R.1. The complete square-tangency model. For the rest of this section take $r = s = 2$. We describe the full normal surface and its scheme fibre, not just its divisorial valuations.

Theorem R.2 (Square tangency in every contact order). *For $b = u^2$, $c = u + v^2$, the surface Z_2 is covered by*

$$B_0 = k[u, v, k_0]/(u + v^2 - u^2 k_0), \quad (\text{R.6})$$

$$B_1 = k[e, z, v]/(v^2 - ez(z - 1)), \quad (\text{R.7})$$

$$B_2 = k[c, q, v]/(v^2 - c(1 - q)). \quad (\text{R.8})$$

The maps to $\text{Spec } k[u, v]$ are the evident one on B_0 , $u = ez$ on B_1 , and $u = cq$ on B_2 . The overlaps are

$$k_0 = e^{-1}, \quad z = uk_0; \quad c = ez^2, \quad q = z^{-1}.$$

There are precisely two singular points, both of type A_1 ; in the middle chart they are $(e, z, v) = (0, 0, 0)$ and $(0, 1, 0)$. The conductors on these charts are respectively

$$B_0, \quad eB_1, \quad cB_2. \quad (\text{R.9})$$

For every $a > 2$, the normal surface Z_a is obtained from Z_2 by $a - 2$ successive ordinary blow-ups at the specified smooth endpoint of the exceptional chain. Its fibre over $(u, v) = (0, 0)$ is a reduced nodal chain of a projective lines, with no embedded points. The two A_1 points persist and no new singularities occur. For every $a \geq 2$,

$$\mathfrak{c}_{Z_a/Y_a} = \mathcal{O}_{Z_a}(-2D_2 - 3D_3 - \cdots - aD_a). \quad (\text{R.10})$$

In particular D_1 and D_2 have the same values $(v(u), v(v)) = (2, 1)$ but different values 4 and 2 on $u + v^2$. A fan in the two original monomial weights cannot distinguish them.

Proof. The three charts of T_2 in Section Q give raw pullback rings

$$A_0 = k[u, v, k_0]/(u + v^2 - u^2 k_0),$$

$$A_1 = k[e, h, u, v]/(u^2 - e^2 h, \quad u + v^2 - eh),$$

$$A_2 = k[u, v, w]/(u^2 - (u + v^2)^2 w).$$

They cover the entire pullback because they are base changes of an open cover of the blow-up. Their integrality has already been proved by finite flatness, so all fractional expressions below lie in their single fraction field.

The ring A_0 is smooth: where $u \neq 0$ the derivative with respect to k_0 is nonzero, and where $u = 0$ the derivative with respect to u is 1. For A_1 adjoin $z = u/e$, integral because $z^2 = h$. Eliminating u, h gives B_1 . For A_2 put $c = u + v^2$ and adjoin $q = u/c$, integral because $q^2 = w$. This gives B_2 . These extensions are finite and birational. The two displayed hypersurfaces are smooth except at the points specified in the theorem; their isolated singularities and the hypersurface S_2 property prove normality. At $z = 0$ and $z = 1$ the factors $z - 1$ and z , respectively, are units, so completion and a unit change of e give $v^2 = ez$ or $v^2 = e(z - 1)$. These are A_1 singularities. The point $c = v = 0, q = 1$ of B_2 is the same second point. The fractional identities on overlaps prove the stated gluing of the finite normalizations.

We verify the conductors at the intersections directly. Over $D = k[e, h]$, the normal ring B_1 is free with basis $1, z, v, zv$, using $z^2 = h$ and $v^2 = e(h - z)$. The subring A_1 is exactly the free sublattice with basis $1, ez, v, ezv$. Thus an element $A + Bz + Cv + Dzv$ belongs to A_1 if and only if B, D are divisible by e . Requiring its product with z also to belong to A_1 forces A, C to be divisible by e . These necessary conditions say that the element is in eB_1 , and they are sufficient because $eB_1 \subset A_1$ and eB_1 is a B_1 -ideal. This proves the middle equality in (R.9). Over $k[c, w]$, use the basis $1, q, v, qv$ with $q^2 = w$ and $v^2 = c(1 - q)$. The sublattice is $1, cq, v, cqv$; the identical argument gives cB_2 . On the overlap $c/e = z^2$ is a unit, so these are the same ideal. On the first overlap e is a unit, giving B_0 . This is an explicit intersection calculation, independent of any extension of a generic divisor formula.

The complete fibre is equally explicit:

$$B_0/(u, v) = k[k_0], \quad B_1/(u, v) = k[e, z]/(ez), \quad B_2/(u, v) = k[q]. \quad (\text{R.11})$$

For the last equality, $cq = 0$ and $c(1 - q) = 0$ imply $c = 0$. The overlaps compactify the two affine axes of the middle node into two projective lines. These rings are reduced, pure one-dimensional, and have no embedded points. Notice that the second singularity of the ambient surface lies at a smooth point of the fibre.

It remains to prove the assertion for all a , rather than infer it from low-order pictures. The morphism $T_{j+1} \rightarrow T_j$ blows up the last point with coordinates $(c, w_j) = (0, 0)$, where $w_j = b/c^j$. Its inverse image on Z_j is a unique smooth endpoint with local parameters v, q_j . In a neighbourhood of this point put

$$H_j = 1 - v^{j-2}q_j, \quad c = \frac{v^2}{H_j}, \quad u = cv^{j-2}q_j, \quad w_j = q_j^2 H_j^{j-2}. \quad (\text{R.12})$$

For $j = 2$ these are the last chart above, localized at $q_2 = 0$; $H_2 = 1 - q_2$ is a unit. The pullback of (c, w_j) is (v^2, q_j^2) . Its normalized blow-up is the ordinary blow-up of (v, q_j) : the integral closure of $(v^2, q_j^2)^n$ is $(v, q_j)^{2n}$ for every n , by its two-dimensional Newton polygon, and Proj of this Veronese algebra is the ordinary blow-up.

For completeness this computes the required normalized base change, not a substitute birational model. The finite morphism $Z_j \rightarrow T_j$ is flat. Indeed Z_j is a normal surface and hence Cohen–Macaulay, whereas T_j is smooth; a system of parameters of the latter is a regular sequence on the former, giving local freeness over the regular local ring. Flat base change of the blow-up is therefore the blow-up of the pulled-back ideal. The finite birational map from this pullback to Y_{j+1} induces the same function field, so their normalizations agree by transitivity of integral dependence.

On the last chart of the ordinary blow-up set $q_j = vq_{j+1}$. Formula (R.12) becomes the same formula with $j + 1$, proving the induction and uniqueness of the next centre. The old fibre ideal at that centre is $(u, v) = (v)$, so its pullback is the reduced total transform of one smooth component. The blow-up adds one projective line and one node, not an embedded point or a multiple component. The centre is disjoint from the two A_1 points; thus no singularities are added. Finally Theorem R.1 gives $k_1 = 0$ and $k_i = i$ for $i \geq 2$, as well as the valuation comparison for D_1, D_2 . This proves every assertion. $\square$

Corollary R.3 (One Hilbert limit, different normalization germs). *For every $a \geq 2$, two coefficient arcs of the square-tangency family can have the same closed coefficients and the same embedded Hilbert limit, while their normalization lifts have nonisomorphic completed local rings: one is regular and the other has an A_1 singularity. Both arcs are generically base-point-free as projective maps.*

Proof. On D_2 in the middle chart the old Hilbert coordinate is $h = z^2$. The points $z = 1$ and $z = -1$ therefore map to the same point $e = 0, h = 1$ of T_2 , and hence give the same embedded curve. The former is an A_1 point of Z_2 , whereas the latter is smooth. They are untouched by the later endpoint blow-ups.

For the point $z = -1$ take $v = \tau$, $e = \tau^2/2$, $u = -\tau^2/2$. For the point $z = 1$ take

$$z = 1 + \tau, \quad v = \tau, \quad e = \frac{\tau}{1 + \tau}, \quad u = \tau.$$

Both satisfy $v^2 = ez(z - 1)$ over $k[[\tau]]$ and have $b = u^2$, $c = u + v^2$. In both cases u is nonzero over $k((\tau))$. If the homogeneous source coordinate s_0 is nonzero, the second coordinate $u^2 s_0^a$ is nonzero; if $s_0 = 0$, the first coordinate t_0^a is nonzero. Thus the entire projective map, including

source infinity, is base-point-free on the generic fibre. The regular and A_1 completed local rings have different embedding dimensions, so they cannot be isomorphic. $\square$

APPENDIX S. DIAGONAL COVERS AND THE COMPLETE SCHEME FIBRE

The diagonal calculation provides a second application and a comparison with the tangent case. It also isolates the local algebra needed to pass from generic multiplicities to a complete scheme fibre. Let $b = u^\rho$, $c = v^\sigma$, where ρ, σ are positive integers, and let $Y = T_a \times_{S_a} \operatorname{Spec} k[u, v]$, $Z = Y^\nu$. Put

$$g_i = \gcd(\rho, i\sigma), \quad n_i = (A_i, B_i) = \left(\frac{i\sigma}{g_i}, \frac{\rho}{g_i} \right), \quad e_i = \frac{\rho\sigma}{g_i}, \quad \ell_i = \min(A_i, B_i). \quad (\text{S.1})$$

Set $n_0 = (0, 1)$ and $n_{a+1} = (1, 0)$, in clockwise order.

Theorem S.1 (Diagonal parameter boundary). *The surface Y is integral and a local complete intersection. Its normalization is the normal toric surface with consecutive cones $\langle n_i, n_{i+1} \rangle$. The scheme fibre F of $Z \rightarrow \operatorname{Spec} k[u, v]$ over the origin is Cohen–Macaulay of pure dimension one, without embedded points. Its reduction is a nodal chain of a projective lines D_i . The generic length on D_i is ℓ_i , and the nilradical has exact order $\max_i \ell_i$ (order one means it is zero). The conductor is*

$$\mathfrak{c}_{Z/Y} = \mathcal{O}_Z \left(- \sum_{i=1}^a \kappa_i D_i \right), \quad \kappa_i = \frac{\rho i \sigma - \rho - i \sigma}{g_i} + 1. \quad (\text{S.2})$$

There is one divisor over each E_i , with ramification index e_i and residue degree g_i . In particular Y is normal if and only if $\rho = 1$.

S.1. The raw charts and the graded semigroup. Flat base change of the exhaustive cover of T_a gives the rings

$$A_0 = k[u, v, k_0]/(v^\sigma - u^\rho k_0), \quad (\text{S.3})$$

$$A_i = k[u, v, e, h]/(u^\rho - e^{i+1} h^i, v^\sigma - e h) \quad (1 \leq i < a), \quad (\text{S.4})$$

$$A_a = k[u, v, w]/(u^\rho - v^{a\sigma} w). \quad (\text{S.5})$$

The middle ring is finite free over $k[e, h]$, with basis $u^j v^l$, $0 \leq j < \rho$, $0 \leq l < \sigma$. The end rings are similarly the pullbacks of the end charts. They inject into the single generic field $k(u, v)$ by finite flatness over the respective coordinate domains of T_a . Thus these equations have neither a hidden vertical component nor an embedded component. They cover Y , not just a surface birational to Y .

For the exponents E_j of Proposition Q.2 put

$$I = \prod_{j=1}^a (u^\rho, v^{j\sigma})^{E_j}, \quad \eta_i = \sum_{j=1}^a E_j \min(i, j).$$

Let $H \subset \mathbb{Z}^3$ be the semigroup generated by $(1, 0, 0)$, $(0, 1, 0)$ and $(\alpha, \beta, 1)$ for the monomial generators $u^\alpha v^\beta$ of I . Its algebra is the ordinary Rees algebra. The group generated by H is all $\mathbb{Z}^3$: subtracting the first two coordinate vectors from any degree-one generator gives $(0, 0, 1)$ in the group. The rational cone of H has the complete half-space description

$$\alpha, \beta, n \geq 0, \quad i\sigma\alpha + \rho\beta \geq n\rho\sigma\eta_i \quad (1 \leq i \leq a). \quad (\text{S.6})$$

Indeed its degree-one section is the Minkowski sum of the Newton segments of the factors plus the nonnegative quadrant; each compact edge has inward normal $(i\sigma, \rho)$ and positive length. The coordinate and degree facets account for its noncompact faces. The normalization is therefore

$$\overline{\mathcal{R}(I)} = k[u^\alpha v^\beta Q^n : (\alpha, \beta, n) \in \mathbb{Z}^3 \text{ satisfying (S.6)}]. \quad (\text{S.7})$$

To justify the grading in this assertion, a lattice point in the cone is a rational nonnegative combination of the listed generators. Multiplying by a common denominator puts a positive multiple in H , so its monomial is integral, satisfying a monic equation $T^N - u^{N\alpha}v^{N\beta}Q^{Nn}$. Conversely an integral monomial lies in the cone by every facet valuation. Thus the saturation is $\text{Cone}(H) \cap \mathbb{Z}^3$ with its unchanged third-coordinate grading, not a claim that the original semigroup was saturated in a fixed degree. This is the standard affine semigroup-normalization theorem; see [40, Chapters 1 and 5].

The raw evaluation ideal is $u^{\rho^C}I$. The degree-preserving isomorphism $fQ^n \mapsto u^{n\rho^C}fQ^n$ identifies its Rees algebra with $\mathcal{R}(I)$ and, on their fraction fields, identifies the normalizations by $Q \mapsto u^{\rho^C}Q$. This distinguishes a graded presentation from its Proj. Formula (S.7) gives the fan in Theorem S.1.

S.2. A coordinate ideal on an arbitrary proper cone.

Lemma S.2 (The full coordinate ideal). *Let l, h be clockwise primitive rays spanning a two-dimensional cone strictly smaller than the nonnegative quadrant, and lying in that quadrant. In the character lattice $M = \mathbb{Z}^2$ put*

$$A = k[\{m \in M : \langle l, m \rangle, \langle h, m \rangle \geq 0\}].$$

The characters $u = \chi^{(1,0)}$, $v = \chi^{(0,1)}$ belong to A , and

$$(u, v)A = \bigoplus_{\substack{m \in M : \langle l, m \rangle \geq \min(l_1, l_2) \\ \langle h, m \rangle \geq \min(h_1, h_2)}} k\chi^m. \quad (\text{S.8})$$

It is the intersection of the two height-one symbolic valuation ideals with these orders. In particular it is reflexive, and $A/(u, v)A$ has no zero-dimensional associated prime whenever it is nonzero.

Proof. Negative exponents are allowed exactly when both dual-cone inequalities hold. They are characters regular on this chart, although they need not be polynomials in the original plane. Divisibility by u means $m - (1, 0)$ satisfies both inequalities; divisibility by v means $m - (0, 1)$ does. The forward inclusion in (S.8) follows immediately.

If $l_1 \leq l_2$ and $h_1 \leq h_2$, the character v/u is regular, so $(u, v) = (u)$ and the reverse inclusion follows. If both inequalities are reversed, use $(u, v) = (v)$. Equality of one pair of coordinates causes no difficulty in these cases.

In the remaining case $l_1 < l_2$ and $h_1 > h_2$. Write $m = (x, y)$, $L = x + y$. We first prove $L \geq 1$ for an integral m on the right of (S.8). If $L \leq 0$, the low-ray inequality $l_1L + (l_2 - l_1)y \geq l_1$ forces $y \geq 0$, with $y > 0$ if $l_1 > 0$; the high-ray inequality $h_1L - (h_1 - h_2)y \geq h_2$ forces $y \leq 0$, with $y < 0$ if $h_2 > 0$. At least one of l_1, h_2 is positive, because the full quadrant is excluded. This is a contradiction.

Subtraction of $(1, 0)$ can fail only at the high ray: the low threshold is already l_1 . Subtraction of $(0, 1)$ can fail only at the low ray: the high threshold is already h_2 . If both fail, then

$$l_1L + (l_2 - l_1)y < l_2, \quad h_1L - (h_1 - h_2)y < h_1.$$

Since $L \geq 1$ and y is integral, the first inequality gives $y \leq 0$, while the second gives $y > 0$. This contradiction proves that one of u, v divides χ^m in A .

In a normal affine toric ring the two ray valuations are the height-one valuations of its invariant prime divisors. The monomial ideal on the right is their symbolic-ideal intersection; orders at all other height-one primes are nonnegative automatically, since each character is a unit on the coefficient torus. Consequently it is the divisorial ideal specified by these orders and is reflexive. The normal surface ring is S_2 , and a reflexive ideal has depth two at each closed point. In $0 \rightarrow (u, v)A \rightarrow A \rightarrow A/(u, v)A \rightarrow 0$, the depth lemma therefore gives depth at least one for the

quotient at every closed point in its support. All nonempty support has dimension one, so there is no zero-dimensional associated prime. $\square$

Proof of the fibre assertions in Theorem S.1. Every maximal cone in the fan is proper because $a \geq 2$. Apply Lemma S.2 to obtain, on the whole surface,

$$(u, v)\mathcal{O}_Z = \mathcal{O}_Z \left(- \sum_i \ell_i D_i \right).$$

This is an equality of actual ideals. It proves purity, Cohen–Macaulayness and the generic lengths by localization at the DVR of D_i . The radical is the divisorial ideal with order one on each D_i . If $L = \max \ell_i$, every ordinary product of L sections of the radical has order at least L on all D_i and hence belongs to $(u, v)\mathcal{O}_Z$. This proves the upper bound on the ordinary power of the nilradical, without asserting that an ordinary product of reflexive ideals is reflexive. At a component with $\ell_i = L > 1$, the quotient of a DVR by its L th uniformizer power has nonzero $(L - 1)$ st nilradical power, proving exactness.

At a crossing choose the standard finite cyclic cover of the toric chart. If its adjacent determinant is Δ , its ring is $k[x, y]^{\mu_\Delta}$, with weights coprime to Δ in each coordinate. The reduced boundary union is the invariant ring of $k[x, y]/(xy)$, since invariants are exact in characteristic zero. The latter invariant ring is

$$k[x^\Delta, y^\Delta]/(x^\Delta y^\Delta).$$

Equivalently it is $k[x^\Delta] \times_k k[y^\Delta]$. Thus the completed node ring is $k[[X, Y]]/(XY)$ even if the ambient toric surface is singular. At end charts only one boundary axis is in the fibre. The exceptional orbit closures are projective lines by the complete one-dimensional star fans, so they glue to the claimed chain. $\square$

S.3. The conductor and its extension across intersections. The diagonal map has Jacobian ideal $(u^{\rho-1}v^{\sigma-1})$. Over E_i , the primitive normalized valuation is n_i ; its ramification index is e_i in (S.1). The residue character $\zeta = u^{\rho/g_i}/v^{i\sigma/g_i}$ satisfies $\zeta^{g_i} = b/c^i$. This polynomial is irreducible over $k(b/c^i)$, so there is one divisor with residue degree g_i ; $e_i g_i = \rho\sigma$. Theorem P.1 now gives

$$(\rho - 1)A_i + (\sigma - 1)B_i - e_i + 1 = \frac{\rho i \sigma - \rho - i \sigma}{g_i} + 1,$$

including every intersection as an equality of conductor ideals. For reference, the following general extension argument also explains why a separate hidden punctual condition is impossible here.

Lemma S.3 (*S_2 extension of conductor conditions*). *Let A be an S_2 Noetherian domain with finite normalization B . Then $A = \bigcap_{\text{ht } P=1} A_P$ in its fraction field, and*

$$(A : B) = B \cap \bigcap_{\text{ht } P=1} (A_P : B \otimes_A A_P). \quad (\text{S.9})$$

When the local conductor is written by valuations in the semilocal normalization of A_P , the intersection includes each of its maximal ideals, namely the primes of B above P .

Proof. For the first assertion take a fraction z in all A_P and consider the finite module $M = (A + Az)/A$. If it is nonzero, a minimal prime of its support has height at least two. Localize there; M then has finite length, A has depth at least two, and the torsion-free module $A + Az$ has depth at least one. The exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow A \longrightarrow A + Az \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow 0$$

and the depth inequality $\text{depth } M \geq \min(\text{depth } A - 1, \text{depth}(A + Az))$ give depth at least one, contrary to nonzero finite length. Thus $M = 0$. Testing $zb \in A$ for each $b \in B$ gives (S.9).

Localization of finite normalization gives a semilocal normal one-dimensional ring over A_P . Its maximal ideals are not to be identified with P itself; all primes above P must be used. Every nonzero conductor ideal of this semilocal Dedekind ring is specified by its orders in these DVRs. Intersecting their conditions inside B proves the assertion, with no additional condition in codimension two. In the geometric applications all rings are excellent, so computing these orders after faithfully flat completion is legitimate; in the present paper they were computed directly by trace and valuation. $\square$

The coefficients in (S.2) vanish when $\rho = 1$. If $\rho > 1$, the last is positive, since $a\sigma \geq 2$: for $R, Q \geq 2$, $RQ - R - Q + \gcd(R, Q) > 0$. This proves the normality criterion. Its asymmetry records the orientation of the chain $\coprod_j (b, c^j)$, not a symmetry-breaking assertion about arbitrary covers of the plane.

If $\rho = \sigma = d$, the conductor generators on the first and every intermediate normalized chart are u^{d-1} , and on the last chart $v^{a(d-1)}$. Indeed their valuations are the conductor coefficients on all rays of that chart, including order zero on its nonexceptional axis; the ideal identity follows from the theorem. At an intermediate intersection the same character is used on both sides. At the last intersection $u = v^a \zeta$, where ζ is a unit, so the generators are related by the unit ζ^{d-1} . This verifies their gluing, not just equality of divisorial orders on one chart.

S.4. Quotient conventions and an unequal-cover chart. To specify the quotient type without an orientation ambiguity, order the two primitive rays r_1, r_2 counterclockwise and put $\Delta = \det(r_1, r_2) > 0$. Extend r_1 to an oriented lattice basis (r_1, t) and write $r_2 = pr_1 + \Delta t$. Then the chart has cyclic type $\frac{1}{\Delta}(-p, 1)$, where p is read modulo Δ and $\gcd(p, \Delta) = 1$. This follows because $t = (-pr_1 + r_2)/\Delta$ acts on the smooth covering characters with these weights. Interchanging the two rays interchanges the weights; changing t changes p by a multiple of Δ .

Example S.4 (An unequal cover at a quotient crossing). Take $(a, \rho, \sigma) = (3, 2, 3)$. On the first raw chart

$$A = k[u, v, \theta]/(v^3 - u^2\theta)$$

the normalization is the cubic Veronese ring

$$B = k[s^3, s^2t, st^2, t^3] = k[u, v, w, \theta]/(v^2 - uw, vw - u\theta, w^2 - v\theta).$$

The map is $u = s^3, v = s^2t, w = st^2, \theta = t^3$. The extra generator $w = v^2/u$ is integral, and the Veronese ring is normal (it is the invariant ring for the scalar μ_3 action). It has the same fraction field and is finite, so is the normalization. The cone rays are $(0, 1), (3, 2)$ and the quotient type is $\frac{1}{3}(1, 1)$.

Here $B = A + Aw$, $w^2 = v\theta$, and $uw = v^2, vw = u\theta$. Thus $(u, v)B$ is contained in the conductor. Conversely the valuation of w on the exceptional ray is one, while u, v, θ have values 3, 2, 0. The conductor coefficient is two by (S.2); every invariant monomial of order at least two is divisible by u or v , since $w^2 = v\theta$. Consequently

$$\mathfrak{c}_{B/A} = (u, v)B, \quad B/(u, v) = k[w, \theta]/(w^2).$$

This displays both the conductor and the nonreduced full fibre at the quotient point. The fibre has generic length two and no embedded associated prime. On the complete surface the three conductor orders are 2, 3, 8, while the three generic fibre lengths are 2, 1, 2; these are different invariants.

S.5. Marked logarithmic compatibility. For the diagonal family the normal fan is the coarsest subdivision on which each $\min(\rho p, j\sigma q)$ is linear. Equivalently it is terminal among normal integral tests with dense coefficient torus which make every $(u^\rho, v^{j\sigma})$ invertible, with the category specified as in Proposition Q.3. For ordered transverse Cartier divisors U, V on a smooth surface, these

ideals are intrinsically $\mathcal{O}(-\rho U) + \mathcal{O}(-j\sigma V)$. Unit changes of local equations preserve them; normalized blow-ups consequently glue. Subsequent root covers compose by integral closure in the same function field. The conductor-divisor transitivity is the special case of Theorem P.5, which also applies when the coefficient change is not diagonal.

If ∂Z is the full reduced toroidal boundary and $\partial S'$ is the union of the coordinate axes, then

$$K_Z + \partial Z = \pi^*(K_{S'} + \partial S').$$

Both sides are Cartier (indeed represented by the divisor of the logarithmic torus form); Z itself is simplicial, so its invariant Weil divisors are $\mathbb{Q}$ -Cartier. A toric resolution preserves this equality and has a simple normal crossing reduced boundary, proving log canonicity of the pair. This is a statement about the parameter space, not stable or semistable reduction of its universal embedded curves.

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